

The Scarlet Letter

Nathaniel Hawthorne · 1850

Standard Ebooks edition (modernized spelling), based on the 1850 Ticknor, Reed and Fields text with the Preface to the Second Edition

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

Common Core edition (standards shown for this framework only)

26 chapter lessons plus 3 seminar day(s), a test day and an essay day: 33 class days of 90 minutes, 5 a week (block schedule), 7 weeks
Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

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Cover: Caspar David Friedrich, Wanderer above the Sea of Fog (c. 1818). Public domain (Wikimedia Commons).

Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–26), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Unit test (eleven rigor versions) with answer keys and scoring guides
6. Final paper
7. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: The Scarlet Letter was published in Boston in March 1850; the second edition added Hawthorne's preface dated 30 March 1850. The reading text is the Standard Ebooks transcription, which modernizes some spellings (e.g. 'storybooks', 'rosebush'). It has 26 sections: the preface, 'The Customhouse' and Chapters I–XXIV. Cite chapter and paragraph from this edition.

Content note for teachers: Adultery (central but not depicted), public shaming, a threat to remove a child, self-harm by a guilty minister, a woman's suicidal thoughts, witchcraft accusation, and period language about Native people. See the chapter notes and the 988 safe-messaging script.

Grades: Grades 10–12 (scales to graduate via rigor levels). Scaffolded-support track (grade-9 floor): students work from teacher-selected passages with scaffolds, sentence starters and partial-credit probes. **Weeks:** 7. **Class days:** 33 × 90 minutes (26 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does The Scarlet Letter suggest about sin and guilt?
- What does The Scarlet Letter suggest about public shame and private identity?
- What does The Scarlet Letter suggest about hypocrisy and truth?
- What does The Scarlet Letter suggest about nature and the individual against society?
- What does The Scarlet Letter suggest about women and independence?

Objectives

- Students will cite at least 2 quotations, with locations, to support each written claim about what the text says explicitly and implicitly (scored on the writing-prompt rubric).
- Students will trace one theme across at least 3 sections of the novel in the final paper, earning at least 70 of 100 rubric points.
- Students will explain how characters, setting and point of view interact in at least 3 exit tickets, each meeting the claim-evidence-reasoning criteria.

- Students will determine the in-context meaning of taught vocabulary, scoring at least 80% on the vocabulary items of the chapter quizzes.
- Students will write an argument with a clear claim, reasons and relevant evidence, scoring at least 80% on the unit test's short-answer scoring guides.

Standards: Common Core

RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.9-10.5, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.4, RL.11-12.5, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, L.9-10.4, L.11-12.4

Common Core State Standards (ELA-Literacy), thecorestandards.org

Assessments: Daily chapter quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-book test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Scaffolded support through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Chapter lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	I do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Week	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	*Introduction: author, context and reception* Preface to the Second Edition (20-minute preview) and The Customhouse The Customhouse (part 2) I: The Prison-Door II: The Marketplace	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*sin and guilt* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Introduction: author, context and reception • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
2	III: The Recognition *Socratic seminar on sin and guilt* IV: The Interview V: Hester at Her Needle VI: Pearl	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*public shame and private identity* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Socratic seminar on sin and guilt • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
3	VII: The Governor's Hall VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister IX: The Leech X: The Leech and His Patient XI: The Interior of a Heart	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*hypocrisy and truth* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
4	XII: The Minister's Vigil XIII: Another View of Hester *Socratic seminar on public shame and private identity* XIV: Hester and the Physician XV: Hester and Pearl	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*nature and the individual against society* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Socratic seminar on public shame and private identity • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
5	XVI: A Forest Walk XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner	5 × 90 min	*women and independence* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories,	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt

	XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side XX: The Minister in a Maze	(450 min)	background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	
6	XXI: The New England Holiday XXII: The Procession XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter *Socratic seminar on hypocrisy and truth* XXIV: Conclusion	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*sin and guilt* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Socratic seminar on hypocrisy and truth • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
7	*Whole-book test (90 minutes)* *Final paper writing workshop (drafting in class; finish the draft as homework)* *Final paper: peer review, revision and submission*	3 × 90 min (270 min)	*public shame and private identity* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Whole-book test (90 minutes) • Final paper writing workshop (drafting in class; finish the draft as homework) • Final paper: peer review, revision and submission • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Whole-book test and final essay

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: Introduction to The Scarlet Letter

Objective: Students will explain, in a 3-sentence exit ticket, how one fact about Nathaniel Hawthorne's life or times connects to sin and guilt in “The Scarlet Letter”, and will set up a reading journal with a prediction and a question for each of 3 themes (sin and guilt, public shame and private identity, hypocrisy and truth).

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2

Author biography

Nathaniel Hawthorne was born in Salem, Massachusetts, on 4 July 1804; his ancestor John Hathorne was a judge in the Salem witch trials of 1692, a family history Hawthorne felt as a burden. He later changed the spelling of his surname to Hawthorne; why is uncertain, though many link it to his discomfort with his ancestors. After graduating from Bowdoin College in 1825 he spent years writing in near-seclusion in Salem, publishing Twice-Told Tales in 1837. He lived briefly at the utopian Brook Farm community, worked at the Salem Custom House, and achieved fame with The Scarlet Letter (1850) and The House of the Seven Gables (1851). He served as U.S. consul in Liverpool and died on 19 May 1864 in Plymouth, New Hampshire.

Historical and cultural context

The novel is set in Puritan Boston in the 1640s, about twenty years after the founding of the Massachusetts Bay Colony (1630). The Puritan colony joined church and civil authority: magistrates punished moral offenses such as adultery publicly, and colonial laws allowed for punishments including whipping, the pillory and, in some periods, the wearing of letters. Real figures appear: Governor Richard Bellingham, the minister John Wilson, Mistress Ann Hibbins (executed for witchcraft in 1656) and Governor John Winthrop, whose death in 1649 coincides with the minister's vigil. Hawthorne wrote two centuries later, in 1849, after losing his post as surveyor of the Salem Custom House when the Whigs won the presidency; he writes of that dismissal in "The Customhouse."

Publication and reception, then and now

Ticknor, Reed and Fields of Boston published The Scarlet Letter in March 1850, with "The Customhouse" as an introductory sketch. A second edition followed within weeks; Hawthorne's "Preface to the Second Edition" (dated 30 March 1850) refuses to change the sketch despite local anger. By Fields's own later account, he persuaded Hawthorne to publish the story as a separate volume rather than in a planned collection of tales.

Then: The book sold well quickly, and the first printing sold out within days. Reviewers praised its power and artistry; some religious critics, such as Arthur Cleveland Coxe, condemned it as an immoral book about adultery. Salem readers resented the satirical portraits of Custom House officers.

Now: The Scarlet Letter is among the most taught novels in American high schools and is usually called the first great American novel of psychological and moral analysis. It has been filmed several times (including a 1926 silent film with Lillian Gish and a 1995 film), retold and parodied, and the phrase "scarlet letter" has entered English for any public mark of shame. Modern readers discuss Hester as a feminist figure, the ethics of public shaming, and Hawthorne's own ambivalence toward his Puritan ancestors.

Overview (spoiler-free)

In seventeenth-century Boston, a young woman named Hester Prynne stands on a scaffold holding a baby, with a scarlet "A" embroidered on her dress. She refuses to name the baby's father. The novel follows Hester, her daughter Pearl, the community that judges her, and two men whose connection to her the town does not know.

Main themes

- sin and guilt: public sin (Hester) against hidden sin (Dimmesdale) and the sin of revenge (Chillingworth).
- public shame and private identity: the community's punishment and the self Hester makes inside and against it.
- hypocrisy and truth: "Be true! Be true! Be true!"
- nature and the individual against society: the forest's freedom against the town's law.
- women and independence: Hester's thoughts about the place of women, and her work as a counselor at the end.

Why it matters

The Scarlet Letter asks how a community should treat wrongdoing, what shame does to people, and whether hiding the truth is worse than the original wrong. Students practice tracing a symbol that changes meaning, reading an ironic narrator, and arguing about questions that remain live: public shaming, gender and judgment, guilt and forgiveness.

Spoilers · teacher only

The father is the young, revered minister Arthur Dimmesdale. Hester's long-absent husband arrives the day she is shamed, takes the name Roger Chillingworth, and as a physician attaches himself to Dimmesdale, whose guilt is wasting him, and torments him. Seven years later Hester meets Dimmesdale in the forest and they plan to flee to Europe; Chillingworth books passage on the same ship. After his Election Sermon, Dimmesdale mounts the scaffold with Hester and Pearl, confesses, reveals something on his breast, and dies. Chillingworth dies within a year and leaves his fortune to Pearl, who goes abroad and marries. Hester later returns to Boston, wears the letter of her own will, counsels women, and is buried near Dimmesdale under one tombstone with the words "On a field, sable, the letter A, gules."

Lesson plan (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Before we open The Scarlet Letter: Think of a time a group judged someone in public (online or in person). Was the judgment fair? What did it do to the person? Write for five minutes.*
> **Prompt:** Before we open The Scarlet Letter: Think of a time a group judged someone in public (online or in person). Was the judgment fair? What did it do to the person? Write for five minutes.

8–18 min · Key terms · I do (10 min)

Key literary terms for the unit.

Puritan (an English Protestant who wanted to "purify" the Church of England; the founders of Massachusetts Bay); theocracy (government in which religious and civil authority are joined); adultery (sexual relations between a married person and someone other than their spouse); scaffold or pillory (a raised platform for public punishment); romance (Hawthorne's term for fiction allowed to mix the actual and the imaginary); symbol (an object that stands for ideas beyond itself); allegory (a story whose characters and events stand for ideas).

18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)

Mini-lecture on the author, the historical context and the reception (read or adapt the script).

About the author. Nathaniel Hawthorne was born in Salem, Massachusetts, on 4 July 1804; his ancestor John Hathorne was a judge in the Salem witch trials of 1692, a family history Hawthorne felt as a burden. He later changed the spelling of his surname to Hawthorne; why is uncertain, though many link it to his discomfort with his ancestors. After graduating from Bowdoin College in 1825 he spent years writing in near-seclusion in Salem, publishing Twice-Told Tales in 1837. He lived briefly at the utopian Brook Farm community, worked at the Salem Custom House, and achieved fame with The Scarlet Letter (1850) and The House of the Seven Gables (1851). He served as U.S. consul in Liverpool and died on 19 May 1864 in Plymouth, New Hampshire. The world of the book. The novel is set in Puritan Boston in the 1640s, about twenty years after the founding of the Massachusetts Bay Colony (1630). The Puritan colony joined church and civil authority: magistrates punished moral offenses such as adultery publicly, and colonial laws allowed for punishments including whipping, the pillory and, in some periods, the wearing of letters. Real figures appear: Governor Richard Bellingham, the minister John Wilson, Mistress Ann Hibbins (executed for witchcraft in 1656) and Governor John Winthrop, whose death in 1649 coincides with the minister's vigil. Hawthorne wrote two centuries later, in 1849, after losing his post as surveyor of the Salem Custom House when the Whigs won the presidency; he writes of that dismissal in "The Customhouse." Publication and reception. Ticknor, Reed and Fields of Boston published The Scarlet Letter in March 1850, with "The Customhouse" as an introductory sketch. A second edition followed within weeks; Hawthorne's "Preface to the Second Edition" (dated 30 March 1850) refuses to change the sketch despite local anger. By Fields's own later account, he persuaded Hawthorne to publish the story as a separate volume rather than in a planned collection of tales. Then: The book sold well quickly, and the first printing sold out within days. Reviewers praised its power and artistry; some religious critics, such as Arthur Cleveland Coxe, condemned it as an immoral book about adultery. Salem readers resented the satirical portraits of Custom House officers. Now: The Scarlet Letter is among the most taught novels in American high schools and is usually called the first great American novel of psychological and moral analysis. It has been filmed several times (including a 1926 silent film with Lillian Gish and a 1995 film), retold and parodied, and the phrase "scarlet letter" has entered English for any public mark of shame. Modern readers discuss Hester as a feminist figure, the ethics of public shaming, and Hawthorne's own ambivalence toward his Puritan ancestors.

28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)
Model a close reading of one passage using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "On a field, sable, the letter A, gules" slowly and put it in my own words: The novel's last line describes the gravestone's emblem in the language of coats of arms: on a black field, the letter A in red. Next, craft. I notice Hawthorne uses heraldry, the formal code of noble family shields, for a mark that began as public shame. The strongest word is "sable": the heraldic word for black turns the darkness of her story into a noble color on a coat of arms. Then, effect. What does the heraldic description on the shared tombstone tell us about how Hester is remembered? My answer: The A has become a kind of family crest: the sign of disgrace now marks a life of endurance and dignity, so the ending leaves us with the letter transformed rather than erased.

> *On a field, sable, the letter A, gules (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 13)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "On a field, sable, the letter A, gules" slowly and put it in my own words: The novel's last line describes the gravestone's emblem in the language of coats of arms: on a black field, the letter A in red. Next, craft. I notice Hawthorne uses heraldry, the formal code of noble family shields, for a mark that began as public shame. The strongest word is "sable": the heraldic word for black turns the darkness of her story into a noble color on a coat of arms. Then, effect. What does the heraldic description on the shared tombstone tell us about how Hester is remembered? My answer: The A has become a kind of family crest: the sign of disgrace now marks a life of endurance and dignity, so the ending leaves us with the letter transformed rather than erased.

40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)
Read the spoiler-free overview together and name the themes to track.
What the book is about (no spoilers): In seventeenth-century Boston, a young woman named Hester Prynne stands on a scaffold holding a baby, with a scarlet "A" embroidered on her dress. She refuses to name the baby's father. The novel follows Hester, her daughter Pearl, the community that judges her, and two men whose connection to her the town does not know. Themes to track: sin and guilt: public sin (Hester) against hidden sin (Dimmesdale) and the sin of revenge (Chillingworth). public shame and private identity: the community's punishment and the self Hester makes inside and against it. hypocrisy and truth: "Be true! Be true! Be true!" nature and the individual against society: the forest's freedom against the town's law. women and independence: Hester's thoughts about the place of women, and her work as a counselor at the end.

55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme, with a prediction and a question (example given).
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question. Theme page "public shame and private identity": Prediction: the letter will change Hester more than the town expects. Question: who decides what the letter means?
Task: Set up a reading journal for The Scarlet Letter: one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.
Exemplar: Theme page "public shame and private identity": Prediction: the letter will change Hester more than the town expects. Question: who decides what the letter means?

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Whole-class discussion: why the book is still taught.

Why does The Scarlet Letter still matter? The Scarlet Letter asks how a community should treat wrongdoing, what shame does to people, and whether hiding the truth is worse than the original wrong. Students practice tracing a symbol that changes meaning, reading an ironic narrator, and arguing about questions that remain live: public shaming, gender and judgment, guilt and forgiveness.

Anchor question: Why might The Scarlet Letter still be taught today?

Facilitation: The Scarlet Letter asks how a community should treat wrongdoing, what shame does to people, and whether hiding the truth is worse than the original wrong. Students practice tracing a symbol that changes meaning, reading an ironic narrator, and arguing about questions that remain live: public shaming, gender and judgment, guilt and forgiveness.

80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)

Exit ticket on the author and context (answer given).

Hawthorne wrote the novel in 1849–50, just after losing his job at the Salem Custom House, and he set it in 1640s Puritan Boston, where his own ancestors had been judges. Why might he look back two hundred years to tell this story? Answer: Accept answers such as: to examine the harsh Puritan judgment his family took part in; to question public shaming and hypocrisy; his anger at losing his post shows in "The Custom-House" introduction.

Exit ticket: Hawthorne wrote the novel in 1849–50, just after losing his job at the Salem Custom House, and he set it in 1640s Puritan Boston, where his own ancestors had been judges. Why might he look back two hundred years to tell this story?

Answer: Accept answers such as: to examine the harsh Puritan judgment his family took part in; to question public shaming and hypocrisy; his anger at losing his post shows in "The Custom-House" introduction.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)

Preview the first reading.

Tomorrow we begin reading: Preface to the Second Edition.

Teacher notes · sources: Britannica, "Nathaniel Hawthorne" (https://www.britannica.com/biography/Nathaniel-Hawthorne); The House of the Seven Gables, "Nathaniel Hawthorne" (https://7gables.org/nathaniel-hawthorne/); Britannica, "The Scarlet Letter" (https://www.britannica.com/topic/The-Scarlet-Letter-novel); Library of America, Nathaniel Hawthorne, Collected Novels (notes and chronology) (https://www.loa.org/books/41-collected-novels/); The Hawthorne in Salem website (Salem State University / Peabody Essex Museum), "The Custom House" (https://www.hawthorneinsalem.org/); Massachusetts Historical Society, Winthrop Papers and colonial records (https://www.masshist.org/); Arthur Cleveland Coxe, "The Writings of Hawthorne," Church Review, January 1851 (https://www.worldcat.org/)

Flags (verify before teaching):

- First-edition details (2,500 copies sold out in about ten days) are widely reported; check exact numbers before citing them.
- Whether Massachusetts Bay actually sentenced adulterers to wear a letter in the 1640s is not certain; a 1694 Massachusetts law and a 1658 Plymouth law prescribed letters. Present the letter as Hawthorne's use of colonial practice, not as a documented 1640s sentence.

- The claim that Hawthorne added the "w" to his surname to distance himself from his ancestors is common but not documented in his own words; present it as a widely held view.
- Fields's role in persuading Hawthorne to publish the story alone comes from Fields's later memoir (Yesterdays with Authors, 1872); treat it as his account.

Critical voice: "There never surely was a powerful, active, continually effective mind less round, more lop-sided, than that of NATHANIEL HAWTHORNE." (Anthony Trollope, novelist, *"The Genius of Nathaniel Hawthorne," North American Review 129 (September 1879), pp. 203-22, opening sentence*; public domain). Bell-ringer: is "lop-sided" an insult or a compliment here? Trollope argues the lopsidedness makes the art possible. *Objective:* Intro lesson: Hawthorne's temperament and reputation. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.9, SL.11-12.1

Critical voice: "In this beautiful and touching romance Hawthorne has produced something really worthy of the fine and deep genius which lies within him." (Edwin Percy Whipple (attrib.; the review is unsigned), critic, *Review of The Scarlet Letter, Graham's Magazine 36:5 (May 1850), "Review of New Books", review, paragraph 1*; public domain). Pair with Coxe's attack (Ch. XVII entry): the same book in the same year, praised and condemned. *Objective:* Intro lesson: reception at publication ("then"). *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.9

Critical voice: "It is densely dark, with a single spot of vivid colour in it; and it will probably long remain the most consistently gloomy of English novels of the first order." (Henry James, novelist and critic, *Hawthorne (English Men of Letters, 1879), Chapter V, Ch. V*; public domain). Image hunt: what is the "single spot of vivid colour"? Track red through the first three chapters. *Objective:* Intro lesson: tone and mood across the novel. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.9

Lesson 2: Preface to the Second Edition

Focus: an author answering his critics

Objective: Students will identify at least 2 claims the author makes in “Preface to the Second Edition” and, in a 3-sentence warm-up response, predict how each frames the reading that follows.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

In a short preface to the second edition, Hawthorne notes with mock surprise that his introductory sketch of the Salem Custom House has angered his neighbors. He says he has reread it, found nothing to change, and will republish it without altering a word.

Background: The first edition sold quickly in March 1850; Salem readers objected to Hawthorne's satirical portraits of Custom House officers, some of them recognizable.

Significance: The preface shows the author standing firm against a judging community, a quiet parallel to Hester.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Have you ever refused to apologize for something others found offensive? Why? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to public shame and private identity because....
Prompt: Have you ever refused to apologize for something others found offensive? Why?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to public shame and private identity because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position.

8–16 min · Background and context · I do (8 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The first edition sold quickly in March 1850; Salem readers objected to Hawthorne's satirical portraits of Custom House officers, some of them recognizable. The preface shows the author standing firm against a judging community, a quiet parallel to Hester. Tone / mood: Hawthorne answers Salem's anger with mock surprise and amusement, refusing to apologize. Irony: He calls his satirical sketch harmless and the outrage "unprecedented excitement," exaggerating to mock his critics. Watch for the scarlet letter: The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: “finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community immediately” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1).

> **16–20 min · Closure · I do (4 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how tone / mood shapes an author answering his critics. Key takeaway: Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position.*

Total: 20 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Tone / mood:** Hawthorne answers Salem's anger with mock surprise and amusement, refusing to apologize.
- **Irony:** He calls his satirical sketch harmless and the outrage "unprecedented excitement," exaggerating to mock his critics.

Themes and how they develop

- **public shame and private identity:** Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position.

Symbols and motifs

- **the scarlet letter:** The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: “finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community immediately” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community immediately around him” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1) The author describes the local outrage at "The Customhouse."
- “It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1) Ironic exaggeration of the reaction.
- “The author is constrained, therefore, to republish his introductory sketch without the change of a word” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 2) Hawthorne refuses to revise.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The preface shows Hawthorne treating his community's judgment with ironic defiance.
Evidence: “It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1)
Reasoning: He says the reaction "could hardly have been more violent" if he had burned down the Customhouse, then announces he will republish "without the change of a word."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
republish (verb)	publish again	*The author is constrained, therefore, to republish his introductory sketch without the change of a word.*	
disclaims (verb)	denies having (a motive or intention)	*As to enmity, or ill-feeling of any kind, personal or political, he utterly disclaims such motives.*	"disclaims": Origin of "disclaim": Anglo-Norman disclaimer. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/disclaim#Etymology)
unprecedented (adjective)	never having happened before	*Much to the author's surprise, and (if he may say so without additional offence) considerably to his amusement, he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community immediately around him.*	
cherish (verb)	keep and nurse (a feeling) in one's heart	*It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse, and quenched its last smoking ember in the blood of a certain venerable personage, against whom he is supposed to cherish a peculiar malevolence.*	
introductory (adjective)	serving as an introduction to what follows	*Much to the author's surprise, and (if he may say so without additional offence) considerably to his amusement, he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community immediately around him.*	"introductory": Origin: Late Latin intrōductōrius; earlier Latin intrōductus. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/introductory#Etymology)
malevolence (noun)	the wish to do harm to others	*It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse, and quenched its last smoking ember in the blood of a certain venerable personage, against whom he is supposed to cherish a peculiar malevolence.*	"malevolence": Origin: Middle French malevolence; earlier Latin malevolentia ("malevolence"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/malevolence#Etymology)
quenched (verb)	put out (a fire)	*It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the*	"quenched": Origin of "quench": Old English cwenċan. (Liber et Libri origin

		Customhouse, and quenched its last smoking ember in the blood of a certain venerable personage, against whom he is supposed to cherish a peculiar malevolence.	note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/quench#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. Have you ever refused to apologize for something others found offensive? Why?
2. Where does tone / mood appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with sin and guilt?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does the author call the sketch? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: His sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter.
2. What has angered Salem readers? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The Customhouse sketch
3. How does Hawthorne respond? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He republishes the sketch unchanged
4. What tone does the preface take? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Ironic and amused
5. What does he jokingly compare the outrage to? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Burning down the Customhouse
6. Where and when is the preface signed? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Salem, March 30, 1850
7. Retell the three most important events of "Preface to the Second Edition" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: In a short preface to the second edition, Hawthorne notes with mock surprise that his introductory sketch of the Salem Custom House has angered his neighbors. He says he has reread it, found nothing to change, and will republish it without altering a word.
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Preface to the Second Edition"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Preface to the Second Edition" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.

10. Reread: “The author is constrained, therefore, to republish his introductory sketch without the change of a word.” What does “republish” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: republish: publish again.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does the preface exaggerate the town's anger? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: To make the critics look ridiculous.
2. What does “Preface to the Second Edition” suggest about an author answering his critics? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The preface shows the author standing firm against a judging community, a quiet parallel to Hester.
3. Find one example of tone / mood in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling.
4. How does the irony in this chapter shape what we understand about an author answering his critics? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The preface shows Hawthorne treating his community's judgment with ironic defiance. Useful evidence: “he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community immediately around him” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1): The author describes the local outrage at "The Customhouse." On irony: He calls his satirical sketch harmless and the outrage "unprecedented excitement," exaggerating to mock his critics. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Much to the author’s surprise, and (if he may say so without additional offence) considerably to his amusement, he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The…”, why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Preface to the Second Edition”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: In a short preface to the second edition, Hawthorne notes with mock surprise that his introductory sketch of the Salem Custom House has angered his neighbors. He says he has reread it, found nothing to change, and will republish it without altering a word.
7. As the opening chapter, what does “Preface to the Second Edition” set up that the rest of The Scarlet Letter will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The preface shows Hawthorne treating his community's judgment with ironic defiance. Useful evidence: “It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1): Ironic exaggeration of the reaction. Theme link: Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The preface shows Hawthorne treating his community's judgment with ironic defiance. Useful evidence: “The author is constrained, therefore, to republish his introductory sketch without the change of a word” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 2): Hawthorne refuses to revise. Theme link: Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “Have you ever refused to apologize for something others found offensive? Why?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does point of view appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with sin and guilt? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The preface shows Hawthorne treating his community's judgment with ironic defiance. Useful evidence: “he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community immediately around him” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1): The author describes the local outrage at "The Customhouse." Theme link: Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Hawthorne right not to change a word? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned position weighing satire against fairness to real people.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The preface shows Hawthorne treating his community's judgment with ironic defiance. Useful evidence: “It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1): Ironic exaggeration of the reaction. Theme link: Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The preface shows the author standing firm against a judging community, a quiet parallel to Hester.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The preface shows Hawthorne treating his community's judgment with ironic defiance. Useful evidence: “The author is constrained, therefore, to republish his introductory sketch without the change of a word” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 2): Hawthorne refuses to revise. Theme link: Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The preface shows Hawthorne treating his community's judgment with ironic defiance. Useful evidence: “he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community immediately around him” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1): The author describes the local outrage at "The Customhouse." Theme link: Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Rewrite one moment of “Preface to the Second Edition” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about an author answering his critics? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The preface shows Hawthorne treating his community's judgment with ironic defiance. Useful evidence: “It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1): Ironic exaggeration of the reaction. Theme link: Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Preface to the Second Edition”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The preface shows Hawthorne treating his community's judgment with ironic defiance. Useful evidence: “The author is constrained, therefore, to republish his introductory sketch without the change of a word” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 2): Hawthorne refuses to revise. Theme link: Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to public shame and private identity: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The preface shows Hawthorne treating his community's judgment with ironic defiance. Useful evidence: “he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community immediately around him” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1): The author describes the local outrage at "The Customhouse." Theme link: Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the tone / mood in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The preface shows Hawthorne treating his community's judgment with ironic defiance. Useful evidence: “It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1): Ironic exaggeration of the reaction. On tone / mood: Hawthorne answers Salem's anger with mock surprise and amusement, refusing

to apologize. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Preface to the Second Edition” treats an author answering his critics with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The preface shows Hawthorne treating his community's judgment with ironic defiance. Useful evidence: “The author is constrained, therefore, to republish his introductory sketch without the change of a word” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 2): Hawthorne refuses to revise. Theme link: Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “The Customhouse” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The preface shows Hawthorne treating his community's judgment with ironic defiance. Useful evidence: “he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community immediately around him” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1): The author describes the local outrage at "The Customhouse." Theme link: Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about an author answering his critics? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The preface shows Hawthorne treating his community's judgment with ironic defiance. Useful evidence: “It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1): Ironic exaggeration of the reaction. Theme link: Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Tone / mood:** look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Point of view**: who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 2: “The author is constrained, therefore, to republish his _____ sketch without the change of a word”
   Key: introductory

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Much to the author’s surprise, and (if he may say so without additional offence) considerably to his amusement, he finds that his sketch of official life, _____ to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community…” Word bank: unprecedented, introductory, disclaims, republish

   Key: introductory

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse, and quenched its last smoking ember in the blood of a certain venerable personage, against whom he is supposed to cherish a peculiar _____.” Word bank: disclaims, unprecedented, republish, malevolence

   Key: malevolence

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “As to enmity, or ill-feeling of any kind, personal or political, he utterly disclaims such motives.”, what does “disclaims” most nearly mean?

   A. denies having (a motive or intention)

   B. long spears with an axe blade, carried by guards

   C. in a way that cannot be held back

   D. pure; not mixed with anything weaker

   Key: A (denies having (a motive or intention))

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1: “he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an _____ excitement in the respectable community immediately around him”

   Key: unprecedented

6. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the author call the sketch?

   Sample answer: His sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter.

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Hawthorne respond?

   A. He rewrites the sketch

   B. He republishes the sketch unchanged

   C. He apologizes publicly

   D. He leaves Salem

   Key: B (He republishes the sketch unchanged)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What has angered Salem readers?

   A. The Customhouse sketch

   B. A sermon

   C. A newspaper article

   D. The novel's ending

   Key: A (The Customhouse sketch)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where and when is the preface signed?

   A. London, 1850

   B. Concord, 1849

   C. Salem, March 30, 1850

   D. Boston, 1640

Key: C (Salem, March 30, 1850)

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What tone does the preface take?

    A. Deeply sorrowful

    B. Angry and violent

    C. Ironic and amused

    D. Fearful

    Key: C (Ironic and amused)

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does he jokingly compare the outrage to?

    A. A witch trial

    B. A war

    C. A shipwreck

    D. Burning down the Customhouse

    Key: D (Burning down the Customhouse)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does the preface exaggerate the town's anger?

    Sample answer: To make the critics look ridiculous. The evidence is “he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable…” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1), which shows the author describes the local outrage at "The Customhouse.".

13. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Hawthorne himself has been judged by his ‘respectable community,’ a small echo of Hester's position.

    A. Hypocrisy and truth

    B. Nature and the individual against society

    C. Sin and guilt

    D. Public shame and private identity

    Key: D (Public shame and private identity)

14. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how public shame and private identity develops from the opening of “Preface to the Second Edition” to its ending. Use one quotation from each part.

    Sample answer: Near the start, “he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable…” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1), which shows the author describes the local outrage at "The Customhouse.". Later, “The author is constrained, therefore, to republish his introductory sketch without the change of a word” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 2) — Hawthorne refuses to revise. Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position.

15. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is Hawthorne right not to change a word? Argue.

    Sample answer: A reasoned position weighing satire against fairness to real people. The evidence is “The author is constrained, therefore, to republish his introductory sketch without the change of a word” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 2) — Hawthorne refuses to revise. This develops public shame and private identity: Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position. He says the reaction "could hardly have been more violent" if he had burned down the Customhouse, then announces he will republish "without the change of a word.".

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “The preface shows Hawthorne treating his community's judgment with ironic defiance.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with

evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1) supports it: He says the reaction "could hardly have been more violent" if he had burned down the Customhouse, then announces he will republish "without the change of a word.". But “The author is constrained, therefore, to republish his introductory sketch without the change of a word” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 2) complicates it: the line (Hawthorne refuses to revise) shows the same issue from another side, and its “without” marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. Weighing the two passages, the claim survives, but only once it admits the tension the second passage creates.

17. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “The author is constrained, therefore, to republish his introductory sketch without the change of a word” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 2). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Hawthorne refuses to revise. The evidence is “The author is constrained, therefore, to republish his introductory sketch without the change of a word” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 2). This develops public shame and private identity: Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position. The words “introductory” and “constrained” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse, and _____ its last smoking ember in the blood of a certain venerable personage, against whom he is supposed to cherish a peculiar malevolence.” Word bank: quenched, republish, disclaims, unprecedented

    Key: quenched

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community immediately around him” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The author describes the local outrage at "The Customhouse.". The evidence is “he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable…” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1).

20. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the quotation from Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1: “It could hardly have been more _____, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse”

    Key: violent

21. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community immediately around him” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The author describes the local outrage at "The Customhouse.". The evidence is “he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable…” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1). This develops public shame and private identity: Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position. The words “unprecedented” and “introductory” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He says the reaction "could hardly have been more violent" if he had burned down the Customhouse, then announces he will republish "without the change of a word.".

22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Which literary element does this describe in “Preface to the Second Edition”? Hawthorne answers Salem's anger with mock surprise and amusement, refusing to apologize.

    A. Theme

    B. Allusion

    C. Tone / mood

    D. Alliteration

    Key: C (Tone / mood)

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] In the line “Much to the author’s surprise, and (if he may say so without additional offence) considerably to his amusement, he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented…”, what does “unprecedented” most nearly mean?

    A. never having happened before

    B. publish again

    C. denies having (a motive or intention)

    D. keep and nurse (a feeling) in one's heart

    Key: A (never having happened before)

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “Preface to the Second Edition”? He calls his satirical sketch harmless and the outrage ‘unprecedented excitement,’ exaggerating to mock his critics.

    A. Theme

    B. Irony

    C. Imagery

    D. Point of view

    Key: B (Irony)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 11, inference 1, analysis 1, synthesis 3
HS Freshman	6, 4, 7, 5, 10, 9, 2, 3, 8, 11, 12, 17, 13, 16, 14, 15	recall 10, inference 1, analysis 2, synthesis 3
HS Sophomore	4, 2, 6, 9, 8, 1, 11, 7, 18, 10, 12, 19, 13, 15, 16, 14	recall 10, inference 2, analysis 1, synthesis 3
HS Junior	9, 1, 6, 11, 7, 10, 8, 4, 2, 20, 12, 13, 16, 15, 21, 14	recall 10, inference 1, analysis 1, synthesis 4
HS Senior	1, 5, 18, 9, 7, 4, 8, 10, 11, 6, 2, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 11, inference 1, analysis 1, synthesis 3
AP	2, 9, 11, 3, 8, 4, 6, 7, 10, 12, 19, 22, 17, 13, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 2
College Freshman	6, 11, 7, 1, 4, 9, 8, 5, 10, 18, 23, 12, 13, 15, 14, 16	recall 11, inference 1, analysis 1, synthesis 3
College Sophomore	1, 18, 8, 7, 10, 2, 11, 6, 4, 9, 19, 12, 22, 13, 16, 15	recall 10, inference 2, analysis 2, synthesis 2
College Junior	9, 8, 11, 20, 2, 7, 10, 6, 4, 19, 12, 17, 13, 22, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 2
College Senior	18, 6, 9, 10, 1, 11, 2, 8, 7, 4, 19, 12, 24, 13, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 2, analysis 2, synthesis 2
Graduate / PhD	5, 23, 11, 10, 6, 18, 4, 7, 8, 9, 12, 13, 17, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 1, analysis 2, synthesis 3

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Preface to the Second Edition,” how does Hawthorne show an author answering his critics? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the tone / mood you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Preface to the Second Edition, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of an author answering his critics? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the tone / mood in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Preface to the Second Edition develops the idea of an author answering his critics. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of tone / mood and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of Preface to the Second Edition (where it begins, turns and ends) and its tone / mood shape the reader's understanding of an author answering his critics. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what Preface to the Second Edition suggests about an author answering his critics. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's tone / mood and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses tone / mood in Preface to the Second Edition to complicate the reader's understanding of an author answering his critics. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Preface to the Second Edition within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of an author answering his critics responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Preface to the Second Edition alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of an author answering his critics follows or bends those conventions, using the tone / mood as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Preface to the Second Edition and its treatment of an author answering his critics. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's tone / mood and irony, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Preface to the Second Edition as evidence for a larger claim about an author answering his critics in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Preface to the Second Edition as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of an author answering his critics. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

SAT-style questions

1. *Much to the author's surprise, and (if he may say so without additional offence) considerably to his amusement, he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community immediately around him.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "unprecedented" most nearly mean?

   A. put out (a fire)

   B. the wish to do harm to others

   C. serving as an introduction to what follows

   D. never having happened before

2. *Much to the author's surprise, and (if he may say so without additional offence) considerably to his amusement, he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community immediately around him. It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse, and quenched its last smoking ember in the blood of a certain venerable personage, against whom he is supposed to cherish a peculiar malevolence. As the public disapprobation would weigh very heavily on him, were he conscious of deserving it, the author begs leave to say, that he has carefully read over the introductory pages, with a purpose to alter or expunge whatever might be found amiss, and to make the best reparation in his power for the atrocities of which he has been adjudged guilty. But it appears to him, that the only remarkable features of the sketch are its frank and genuine good-humor, and the general accuracy with which he has conveyed his sincere impressions of the characters therein described. As to enmity, or ill-feeling of any kind, personal or political, he utterly disclaims such motives. The sketch might, perhaps, have been wholly omitted, without loss to the public, or detriment to the book; but, having undertaken to write it, he conceives that it could not have been done in a better or a kindlier spirit, nor, so far as his abilities availed, with a livelier effect of truth.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Preface to the Second Edition"?

   A. The leech

   B. The revelation

   C. Hester and the physician

   D. An author answering his critics

SAT key: 1. D (never having happened before); 2. D (An author answering his critics)

Lesson 3: The Customhouse

Focus: the frame narrative and the found letter

Objective: Students will analyze how point of view develops in “The Customhouse” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Critical voice: “Lockhart was a dense, substantial Briton, with a taste for the concrete, and Hawthorne was a thin New Englander, with a miasmatic conscience.” (Henry James, novelist and critic, *Hawthorne (English Men of Letters, 1879), Chapter V, Ch. V*; public domain). Discussion: where does Hawthorne's guilt about his Puritan ancestors (the judge, the persecutor) show in "The Custom-House"? *Objective:* Analyze "The Custom-House" sketch and Hawthorne's Puritan inheritance. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.3, RL.11-12.9

Content note (suicide (figurative remark)): The narrator compares his good luck to that of someone who 'should entertain an idea of committing suicide' and survive; it is figurative. If students pick it up, use 'die by suicide' and point to support.
Student preview: Heads-up: this section includes suicide (figurative remark). Support is available if this is hard to read.
Suggested language: “What does this language show about the speaker?”
Safe messaging: Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this chapter is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

The narrator, close to Hawthorne himself, describes his three years as Surveyor of the Salem Custom House: the sleepy old officers, his Puritan ancestors who would scorn a 'writer of storybooks', and his discovery in an upper room of a faded scarlet cloth letter and the papers of a former surveyor, Jonathan Pue, telling Hester Prynne's story. When a change of administration costs him his post, he turns to writing the romance.

Background: Hawthorne was Surveyor of the Port of Salem from 1846 to 1849 and was removed after the Whig victory of 1848. Salem had been a great port; by the 1840s its trade had declined. His ancestor John Hathorne was a judge at the 1692 witch trials.

Significance: The frame presents the novel as edited history and defines romance as a meeting place of the Actual and the Imaginary.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why might a writer pretend that a story is based on a real document he found? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to public shame and private identity because.... Content note before we start: Heads-up: this section includes suicide (figurative remark). Support is available if this is hard to read. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.
Prompt: Why might a writer pretend that a story is based on a real document he found?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to public shame and private identity because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks."

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: affrighting — frightening; dutiable — on which a customs tax must be paid; recreating — bringing back to life in the imagination; esoteric — belonging to a small, inner circle; ruddiness — a reddish glow. "affrighting": Origin of "affright": an English formation from a- + fright. "recreating": Origin of "recreate": Latin recreāre ("to restore"). "esoteric": Origin: Ancient Greek ἐσωτερικός.
Words: affrighting: frightening · dutiable: on which a customs tax must be paid · recreating: bringing back to life in the imagination · esoteric: belonging to a small, inner circle · ruddiness: a reddish glow

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Hawthorne was Surveyor of the Port of Salem from 1846 to 1849 and was removed after the Whig victory of 1848. Salem had been a great port; by the 1840s its trade had declined. His ancestor John Hathorne was a judge at the 1692 witch trials. The frame presents the novel as edited history and defines romance as a meeting place of the Actual and the Imaginary. Point of view: A first-person narrator, close to Hawthorne himself, describes his years as surveyor and frames the novel as an edited old record. Characterization: Satirical sketches of the aged officers, especially the Inspector, whose only memories are of good dinners. Symbolism: The faded red cloth letter he "finds" in the upper story, which seems to burn when he lays it on his breast. Watch for the scarlet letter: Laid on his breast, the rag gives "a sensation not altogether physical, yet almost so, of burning heat."

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "It is a little remarkable, that—though disinclined to talk overmuch of myself and my affairs at the fireside" slowly and put it in my own words: The narrator admits it is odd that, though he dislikes talking about himself, he has twice felt the urge to write autobiography for the public. Next, craft. I notice the long, hesitating sentence full of qualifications and dashes, the voice of a shy man explaining himself. The strongest word is "disinclined": it shows a writer who claims reluctance even as he begins to talk about himself at length. Then, effect. What does the narrator's opening tell us about why he is writing this introduction? My answer: The narrator's opening tells us he is writing this introduction to explain why his earlier sketch upset Salem and to show how he "found" the scarlet letter, so the romance feels like discovered history.

> *It is a little remarkable, that—though disinclined to talk overmuch of myself and my affairs at the fireside* *(The Customhouse, paragraph 1)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "It is a little remarkable, that—though disinclined to talk overmuch of myself and my affairs at the fireside" slowly and put it in my own words: The narrator admits it is odd that, though he dislikes talking about himself, he has twice felt the urge to write autobiography for the public. Next, craft. I notice the long, hesitating sentence full of qualifications and dashes, the voice of a shy man explaining himself. The strongest word is "disinclined": it shows a writer who claims reluctance even as he begins to talk about himself at length. Then, effect. What does the narrator's opening tell us about why he is writing this introduction? My answer: The narrator's opening tells us he is writing this introduction to explain why his earlier sketch upset Salem and to show how he "found" the scarlet letter, so the romance feels like discovered history.

40–50 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (10 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Hawthorne imagines his Puritan ancestors sneering at "a writer of storybooks." Expected link: pointOfView; Hawthorne's guilt about and distance from his ancestors. Ask: How does this line connect to public shame and private identity? Expected: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks." (His imagined ancestors' contempt for him.)

> *A writer of storybooks! What kind of a business in life … may that be* *(The Customhouse, paragraph 9)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Hawthorne imagines his Puritan ancestors sneering at "a writer of storybooks." Expected link: pointOfView; Hawthorne's guilt about and distance from his ancestors.
Ask: How does this line connect to public shame and private identity?
Expected answer: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks." (His imagined ancestors' contempt for him.)

50–55 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (5 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for point of view, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the frame narrative and the found letter? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how The Customhouse develops the idea of the frame narrative and the found letter. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination. When the text says "a neutral territory, somewhere between the real world and fairyland, where the Actual and the Imaginary may meet" (The Customhouse, paragraph 44), it shows this directly. The narrator presents a real document and a real rag yet says the letter gave "a sensation not altogether physical," and defines his art as "a neutral territory" where "the Actual and the Imaginary may meet."

Task: Annotate the chapter for point of view, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the frame narrative and the found letter? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how The Customhouse develops the idea of the frame narrative and the found letter. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination. When the text says "a neutral territory, somewhere between the real world and fairyland, where the Actual and the Imaginary may meet" (The Customhouse, paragraph 44), it shows this directly. The narrator presents a real document and a real rag yet says the letter gave "a sensation not altogether physical," and defines his art as "a neutral territory" where "the Actual and the Imaginary may meet."

55–60 min · Discussion · We do (5 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Why might a writer pretend that a story is based on a real document he found? This is the longest and slowest section; assign excerpts (the ancestors, the discovery of the letter, the moonlight passage) rather than the whole.

Anchor question: Why might a writer pretend that a story is based on a real document he found?

Facilitation: This is the longest and slowest section; assign excerpts (the ancestors, the discovery of the letter, the moonlight passage) rather than the whole.

60–67 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the frame narrative and the found letter? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination. ("a neutral territory, somewhere between the real world and fairyland, where the Actual and the Imaginary may meet", The Customhouse, paragraph 44). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the frame narrative and the found letter? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination. ("a neutral territory, somewhere between the real world and fairyland, where the Actual and the Imaginary may meet", The Customhouse, paragraph 44). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

67–70 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how point of view shapes the frame narrative and the found letter. Key takeaway: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks."

Total: 70 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Point of view:** A first-person narrator, close to Hawthorne himself, describes his years as surveyor and frames the novel as an edited old record.
- **Characterization:** Satirical sketches of the aged officers, especially the Inspector, whose only memories are of good dinners.
- **Symbolism:** The faded red cloth letter he "finds" in the upper story, which seems to burn when he lays it on his breast.

Themes and how they develop

- **public shame and private identity:** Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks."

Symbols and motifs

- **the scarlet letter:** Laid on his breast, the rag gives "a sensation not altogether physical, yet almost so, of burning heat."

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "A writer of storybooks! What kind of a business in life … may that be" (The Customhouse, paragraph 9) His imagined ancestors' contempt for him.

- “It is a little remarkable, that—though disinclined to talk overmuch of myself and my affairs at the fireside” (The Customhouse, paragraph 1) The opening, with its ironic self-presentation.
- “I experienced a sensation not altogether physical, yet almost so, of burning heat” (The Customhouse, paragraph 39) The letter's mysterious power.
- “a neutral territory, somewhere between the real world and fairyland, where the Actual and the Imaginary may meet” (The Customhouse, paragraph 44) Hawthorne's definition of romance.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination.
Evidence: “a neutral territory, somewhere between the real world and fairyland, where the Actual and the Imaginary may meet” (The Customhouse, paragraph 44)
Reasoning: The narrator presents a real document and a real rag yet says the letter gave "a sensation not altogether physical," and defines his art as "a neutral territory" where "the Actual and the Imaginary may meet."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
affrighting (verb)	frightening	*Ghosts might enter here, without affrighting us.*	“affrighting”: Origin of “affright”: an English formation from a- + fright. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/affright#Etymology)
dutiable (adjective)	on which a customs tax must be paid	*The Customhouse marker imprinted it, with a stencil and black paint, on pepper-bags, and baskets of anatto, and cigar-boxes, and bales of all kinds of dutiable merchandise, in testimony that these commodities had paid the impost, and gone regularly through the office.*	
recreating (verb)	bringing back to life in the imagination	*There was one thing that much aided me in renewing and recreating the stalwart soldier of the Niagara frontier—the man of true and simple energy.*	“recreating”: Origin of “recreate”: Latin recreāre (“to restore”). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/recreate#Etymology)
esoteric (adjective)	belonging to a small, inner circle	*The merchants valued him not less than we, his esoteric friends.*	“esoteric”: Origin: Ancient Greek ἐσωτερικός. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/esoteric#Etymology)
ruddiness (noun)	a reddish glow	*It throws its unobtrusive tinge throughout the room, with a faint ruddiness upon the walls and ceiling, and a reflected gleam from the polish of the furniture.*	

lightsome (adjective)	cheerful and light	*So, with lightsome hearts, and the happy consciousness of being usefully employed—in their own behalf, at least, if not for our beloved country—these good old gentlemen went through the various formalities of office.*	"lightsome": Origin: an English formation from light + -some. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/lightsome#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. Why might a writer pretend that a story is based on a real document he found?
2. Where does point of view appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with public shame and private identity?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What happens when he lays the letter on his breast? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He feels something like burning heat.
2. Where did the narrator work? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The Salem Custom House
3. What did he find in the upper story? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A faded scarlet letter A and old papers
4. Whose papers tell the story? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Surveyor Pue's
5. What do his ancestors think a storyteller is? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Idle and worthless
6. Why does he leave the job? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A change of administration removes him
7. Retell the three most important events of "The Customhouse" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The narrator, close to Hawthorne himself, describes his three years as Surveyor of the Salem Custom House: the sleepy old officers, his Puritan ancestors who would scorn a 'writer of storybooks', and his discovery in an upper room of a faded scarlet cloth letter and the papers of a former surveyor, Jonathan Pue, telling Hester Prynne's story. When a change of administration costs him his post, he…
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "The Customhouse"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "The Customhouse" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.

10. Reread: “Ghosts might enter here, without affrighting us.” What does “affrighting” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: affrighting: frightening.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does the narrator call the moonlit room a neutral territory? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: It is a space where the real and imaginary meet, like romance itself.
2. What does “The Customhouse” suggest about the frame narrative and the found letter? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The frame presents the novel as edited history and defines romance as a meeting place of the Actual and the Imaginary.
3. Find one example of point of view in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know.
4. How does the symbolism in this chapter shape what we understand about the frame narrative and the found letter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination. Useful evidence: “A writer of storybooks! What kind of a business in life … may that be” (The Customhouse, paragraph 9): His imagined ancestors' contempt for him. On symbolism: The faded red cloth letter he "finds" in the upper story, which seems to burn when he lays it on his breast. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “There was one thing that much aided me in renewing and recreating the stalwart soldier of the Niagara frontier—the man of true and simple energy.”, why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “The Customhouse”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: The narrator, close to Hawthorne himself, describes his three years as Surveyor of the Salem Custom House: the sleepy old officers, his Puritan ancestors who would scorn a 'writer of storybooks', and his discovery in an upper room of a faded scarlet cloth letter and the papers of a former surveyor,…
7. How does “The Customhouse” build on “Preface to the Second Edition”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination. Useful evidence: “It is a little remarkable, that—though disinclined to talk overmuch of myself and my affairs at the fireside” (The Customhouse, paragraph 1): The opening, with its ironic self-presentation. Theme link: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination. Useful evidence: “I experienced a sensation not altogether physical, yet almost so, of burning heat” (The Customhouse, paragraph 39): The letter's mysterious power. On characterization: Satirical sketches of the aged officers, especially the Inspector, whose only memories are of good dinners. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “Why might a writer pretend that a story is based on a real document he found?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with public shame and private identity? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination. Useful evidence: “a neutral territory, somewhere between the real world and fairyland, where the Actual and the Imaginary may meet” (The Customhouse, paragraph 44): Hawthorne's definition of romance. On characterization: Satirical sketches of the aged officers, especially the Inspector, whose only memories are of good dinners. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Does 'The Customhouse' help or hurt the novel? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view about the frame's purpose and pace.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination. Useful evidence: “A writer of storybooks! What kind of a business in life … may that be” (The Customhouse, paragraph 9): His imagined ancestors' contempt for him. Theme link: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The frame presents the novel as edited history and defines romance as a meeting place of the Actual and the Imaginary.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination. Useful evidence: “It is a little remarkable, that—though disinclined to talk overmuch of myself and my affairs at the fireside” (The Customhouse, paragraph 1): The opening, with its ironic self-presentation. Theme link: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that

joins history and imagination. Useful evidence: “I experienced a sensation not altogether physical, yet almost so, of burning heat” (The Customhouse, paragraph 39): The letter's mysterious power. On characterization: Satirical sketches of the aged officers, especially the Inspector, whose only memories are of good dinners. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Rewrite one moment of “The Customhouse” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the frame narrative and the found letter? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination. Useful evidence: “a neutral territory, somewhere between the real world and fairyland, where the Actual and the Imaginary may meet” (The Customhouse, paragraph 44): Hawthorne's definition of romance. On point of view: A first-person narrator, close to Hawthorne himself, describes his years as surveyor and frames the novel as an edited old record. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “The Customhouse”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination. Useful evidence: “A writer of storybooks! What kind of a business in life … may that be” (The Customhouse, paragraph 9): His imagined ancestors' contempt for him. Theme link: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to hypocrisy and truth: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination. Useful evidence: “It is a little remarkable, that—though disinclined to talk overmuch of myself and my affairs at the fireside” (The Customhouse, paragraph 1): The opening, with its ironic self-presentation. Theme link: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the point of view in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination. Useful evidence: “I experienced a sensation not altogether physical, yet almost so, of burning heat” (The Customhouse, paragraph 39): The letter's mysterious power. On point of view: A first-person narrator, close to Hawthorne himself, describes his years as surveyor and frames the novel as an edited old record. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “The Customhouse” treats the frame narrative and the found letter with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK

4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination. Useful evidence: “a neutral territory, somewhere between the real world and fairyland, where the Actual and the Imaginary may meet” (The Customhouse, paragraph 44): Hawthorne's definition of romance. Theme link: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “I: The Prison-Door” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination. Useful evidence: “A writer of storybooks! What kind of a business in life … may that be” (The Customhouse, paragraph 9): His imagined ancestors' contempt for him. Theme link: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the frame narrative and the found letter? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination. Useful evidence: “It is a little remarkable, that—though disinclined to talk overmuch of myself and my affairs at the fireside” (The Customhouse, paragraph 1): The opening, with its ironic self-presentation. Theme link: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Point of view:** look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “It throws its unobtrusive tinge throughout the room, with a faint _____ upon the walls and ceiling, and a reflected gleam from the polish of the furniture.” Word bank: dutiable, ruddiness, affrighting, recreating
   Key: ruddiness
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “There was one thing that much aided me in renewing and recreating the stalwart soldier of the Niagara frontier—the man of true and simple energy.”, what does “recreating” most nearly mean?

   A. bringing back to life in the imagination

   B. strengthened; given new energy

C. shut out from society and its protection

D. splash (with water or mud)

Key: A (bringing back to life in the imagination)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What do his ancestors think a storyteller is?

   A. Idle and worthless

   B. Heroic

   C. Holy

   D. Wealthy

   Key: A (Idle and worthless)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "The merchants valued him not less than we, his esoteric friends.", what does "esoteric" most nearly mean?

   A. a shield bearing a coat of arms

   B. based on guesswork

   C. belonging to a small, inner circle

   D. coldness

   Key: C (belonging to a small, inner circle)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "The Customhouse marker imprinted it, with a stencil and black paint, on pepper-bags, and baskets of anatto, and cigar-boxes, and bales of all kinds of dutiable merchandise, in testimony that these commodities had paid…", what does "dutiable" most nearly mean?

   A. on which a customs tax must be paid

   B. a slave; one bound to serve

   C. prying and suspicious, like an investigator

   D. making glad

   Key: A (on which a customs tax must be paid)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "So, with _____ hearts, and the happy consciousness of being usefully employed—in their own behalf, at least, if not for our beloved country—these good old gentlemen went through the various formalities of office." Word bank: lightsome, recreating, dutiable, affrighting

   Key: lightsome

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from The Customhouse, paragraph 9: "A writer of _____! What kind of a business in life … may that be"

   Key: storybooks

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from The Customhouse, paragraph 1: "It is a little remarkable, that—though _____ to talk overmuch of myself and my affairs at the fireside"

   Key: disinclined

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where did the narrator work?

   A. A Harvard library

   B. A newspaper office

   C. A Boston church

   D. The Salem Custom House

Key: D (The Salem Custom House)

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Ghosts might enter here, without affrighting us.”, what does “affrighting” most nearly mean?

    A. a decorated panel on the front of a woman's bodice

    B. harmful

    C. focused together on one point

    D. frightening

    Key: D (frightening)

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whose papers tell the story?

    A. Governor Winthrop's

    B. Pearl's

    C. Dimmesdale's

    D. Surveyor Pue's

    Key: D (Surveyor Pue's)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “A writer of storybooks! What kind of a business in life … may that be” (The Customhouse, paragraph 9) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: His imagined ancestors' contempt for him. The evidence is “A writer of storybooks! What kind of a business in life … may that be” (The Customhouse, paragraph 9). This develops public shame and private identity: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks.".

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does the narrator call the moonlit room a neutral territory?

    Sample answer: It is a space where the real and imaginary meet, like romance itself. The evidence is “a neutral territory, somewhere between the real world and fairyland, where the Actual and the Imaginary may meet” (The Customhouse, paragraph 44) — Hawthorne's definition of romance.

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “I experienced a sensation not altogether physical, yet almost so, of burning heat” (The Customhouse, paragraph 39). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: The letter's mysterious power. The evidence is “I experienced a sensation not altogether physical, yet almost so, of burning heat” (The Customhouse, paragraph 39). This develops public shame and private identity: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks.". The words “experienced” and “altogether” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “a neutral territory, somewhere between the real world and fairyland, where the Actual and the Imaginary may meet” (The Customhouse, paragraph 44).

    Sample answer: The narrator presents a real document and a real rag yet says the letter gave "a sensation not altogether physical," and defines his art as "a neutral territory" where "the Actual and the Imaginary may meet.". The evidence is “a neutral territory, somewhere between the real world and fairyland, where the Actual and the Imaginary may meet” (The Customhouse, paragraph 44) — Hawthorne's definition of romance. This develops public shame and private identity: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks.".

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how public shame and private identity develops from Preface to the Second Edition to The Customhouse. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Earlier, in Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1, the text reads “he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable…”, which shows the author describes the local outrage at "The Customhouse.". In The Customhouse, “A writer of storybooks! What kind of a business in life … may that be” (The Customhouse, paragraph 9), which shows his imagined ancestors' contempt for him. Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks.".

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from The Customhouse, paragraph 39: “I _____ a sensation not altogether physical, yet almost so, of burning heat”
    Key: experienced

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What did he find in the upper story?
    A. A faded scarlet letter A and old papers
    B. A portrait of Hester
    C. A sermon
    D. A treasure chest

    Key: A (A faded scarlet letter A and old papers)

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why does he leave the job?
    A. A change of administration removes him
    B. He moves to England
    C. He is promoted
    D. He retires to farm

    Key: A (A change of administration removes him)

20. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as ‘a writer of storybooks.’
    A. Sin and guilt
    B. Nature and the individual against society
    C. Hypocrisy and truth
    D. Public shame and private identity

    Key: D (Public shame and private identity)

21. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “‘The Customhouse’ frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “a neutral territory, somewhere between the real world and fairyland, where the Actual and the Imaginary may meet” (The Customhouse, paragraph 44) supports it: The narrator presents a real document and a real rag yet says the letter gave "a sensation not altogether physical," and defines his art as "a neutral territory" where "the Actual and the Imaginary may meet.". But “I experienced a sensation not altogether physical, yet almost so, of burning heat” (The Customhouse, paragraph 39) complicates it: the line (the letter's mysterious power) shows the same issue from another side, and its “not” marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. So the claim stands only in a qualified form: true of the chapter's main pattern, but not of every moment in it.

22. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from The Customhouse, paragraph 13? “It was plain enough to discern, that the old fellows dreaded some such _____ at my hands.”

    A. contributing

    B. gourmandism

    C. assistance

    D. discourtesy

    Key: D (discourtesy)

23. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from The Customhouse, paragraph 44: “a neutral _____, somewhere between the real world and fairyland, where the Actual and the Imaginary may meet”

    Key: territory

24. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from The Customhouse, paragraph 17: “Here, one would suppose, might have been sorrow enough to imbue the sunniest _____, through and through, with a sable tinge.” Word bank: disposition, attachment, abbreviating, discourtesy

    Key: disposition

25. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from The Customhouse, paragraph 3 reveal about the character or situation? “Over the entrance hovers an enormous specimen of the American eagle, with outspread wings, a shield before her breast, and, if I recollect aright, a bunch of intermingled thunderbolts and barbed arrows in each claw.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (The Customhouse, paragraph 3) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks.". The words “intermingled” and “thunderbolts” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

26. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from The Customhouse, paragraph 21 reveal about the character or situation? “When no longer called upon to speak, or listen, either of which operations cost him an evident effort, his face would briefly subside into its former not uncheerful quietude.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (The Customhouse, paragraph 21) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks.". The words “uncheerful” and “operations” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from The Customhouse, paragraph 7 shapes its tone: “The sentiment is probably assignable to the deep and aged roots which my family has struck into the soil.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “assignable” and “sentiment” (The Customhouse, paragraph 7) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from The Customhouse, paragraph 11 shapes its tone: “On emerging from the Old Manse, it was chiefly this strange, indolent, unjoyous attachment for my native town, that brought me to fill a place in Uncle Sam’s brick edifice, when I might as well, or better, have gone somewhere else.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “attachment” and “somewhere” (The Customhouse, paragraph 11) make the tone heavy and

deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from The Customhouse, paragraph 37 to the story's treatment of women and independence: “Meanwhile, they shall be at the command of any gentleman, inclined, and competent, to take the unprofitable labor off my hands.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (The Customhouse, paragraph 37) develops women and independence: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks.". Its words “unprofitable” and “gentleman” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “My eyes fastened themselves upon the old scarlet letter, and would not be turned aside.” (The Customhouse, paragraph 38), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from The Customhouse, paragraph 18 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: “I used to watch and study this patriarchal personage with, I think, livelier curiosity, than any other form of humanity there presented to my notice.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (The Customhouse, paragraph 18) develops hypocrisy and truth: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks.". Its words “patriarchal” and “curiosity” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “I have heard him smack his lips over dinners, every guest at which, except himself, had long been food for worms.” (The Customhouse, paragraph 19), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

31. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from The Customhouse, paragraph 21? “It was only with the _____ of a servant, and by leaning his hand heavily on the iron balustrade, that he could slowly and painfully ascend the Customhouse steps, and, with a toilsome progress across the floor, attain his customary chair beside the fireplace.”

    A. attachment
    B. disposition
    C. assistance
    D. functionary

    Key: C (assistance)

32. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from The Customhouse, paragraph 32 shapes its tone: “Once in a great while the thoughts that had seemed so vital and so active, yet had been put to rest so quietly, revived again.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “thoughts” and “quietly” (The Customhouse, paragraph 32) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from The Customhouse, paragraph 41 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: “How unlike, alas! the hangdog look of a republican official, who, as the servant of the people, feels himself less than the least, and below the lowest, of his masters.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (The Customhouse, paragraph 41) develops hypocrisy and truth: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks.". Its words “republican” and “official” carry that idea into this

moment. The same concern returns in “It was the subject of my meditations for many an hour, while pacing to and fro across my room, or traversing, with a…” (The Customhouse, paragraph 42), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

34. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Does 'The Customhouse' help or hurt the novel? Argue.
Sample answer: A reasoned view about the frame's purpose and pace. The evidence is “It is a little remarkable, that—though disinclined to talk overmuch of myself and my affairs at the fireside” (The Customhouse, paragraph 1), which shows the opening, with its ironic self-presentation. This develops public shame and private identity: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks.". The narrator presents a real document and a real rag yet says the letter gave "a sensation not altogether physical," and defines his art as "a neutral territory" where "the Actual and the Imaginary may meet.".

35. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from The Customhouse, paragraph 10: “Nevertheless, this very sentiment is an evidence that the _____, which has become an unhealthy one, should at last be severed.” Word bank: functionary, connection, abbreviating, discourtesy
Key: connection

36. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What happens when he lays the letter on his breast?
Sample answer: He feels something like burning heat.

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from The Customhouse, paragraph 25 shapes its tone: “He seemed away from us, although we saw him but a few yards off; remote, though we passed close beside his chair; unattainable, though we might have stretched forth our hands and touched his own.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words “unattainable” and “stretched” (The Customhouse, paragraph 25) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “A writer of storybooks! What kind of a business in life … may that be” (The Customhouse, paragraph 9) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: His imagined ancestors' contempt for him. The evidence is “A writer of storybooks! What kind of a business in life … may that be” (The Customhouse, paragraph 9). This develops public shame and private identity: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks.". The words “storybooks” and “business” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The narrator presents a real document and a real rag yet says the letter gave "a sensation not altogether physical," and defines his art as "a neutral territory" where "the Actual and the Imaginary may meet.".

39. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “A writer of storybooks! What kind of a business in life … may that be” (The Customhouse, paragraph 9)
    A. Pearl links the minister to the letter.
    B. Chillingworth's verdict on concealed sinners.
    C. The harshest woman in the crowd.
    D. His imagined ancestors' contempt for him.

    Key: D (His imagined ancestors' contempt for him.)

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “It is a little remarkable, that—though disinclined to talk overmuch of myself and my affairs at the fireside” (The

Customhouse, paragraph 1) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: The opening, with its ironic self-presentation. The evidence is “It is a little remarkable, that—though disinclined to talk overmuch of myself and my affairs at the fireside” (The Customhouse, paragraph 1). This develops public shame and private identity: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks.". The words “disinclined” and “remarkable” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The narrator presents a real document and a real rag yet says the letter gave "a sensation not altogether physical," and defines his art as "a neutral territory" where "the Actual and the Imaginary may meet.".

41. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from The Customhouse, paragraph 15 to the story's treatment of women and independence: “Unless people are more than commonly disagreeable, it is my foolish habit to contract a kindness for them.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (The Customhouse, paragraph 15) develops women and independence: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks.". Its words “disagreeable” and “kindness” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Then, moreover, the white locks of age were sometimes found to be the thatch of an intellectual tenement in good repair.” (The Customhouse, paragraph 16), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

42. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Which choice best states a central concern of “The Customhouse”?

    A. The prison door and the rose
    B. The interview in prison
    C. The frame narrative and the found letter
    D. The minister's vigil

    Key: C (The frame narrative and the found letter)

43. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] What does this passage most clearly show? “a neutral territory, somewhere between the real world and fairyland, where the Actual and the Imaginary may meet” (The Customhouse, paragraph 44)

    A. Hawthorne's definition of romance.
    B. The core of his hypocrisy.
    C. Hester's appearance on the holiday.
    D. The prison as an image.

    Key: A (Hawthorne's definition of romance.)

44. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] What does this passage most clearly show? “I experienced a sensation not altogether physical, yet almost so, of burning heat” (The Customhouse, paragraph 39)

    A. The prison as an image.
    B. Hester's fear of him.
    C. The mirror in the armor.
    D. The letter's mysterious power.

    Key: D (The letter's mysterious power.)

45. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in "The Customhouse"? A first-person narrator, close to Hawthorne himself, describes his years as surveyor and frames the novel as an edited old record.

    A. Theme

    B. Point of view

    C. Irony

    D. Setting

    Key: B (Point of view)

46. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in "The Customhouse"? Satirical sketches of the aged officers, especially the Inspector, whose only memories are of good dinners.

    A. Irony

    B. Hyperbole

    C. Diction / vocabulary

    D. Characterization

    Key: D (Characterization)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 11, inference 2, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	6, 11, 17, 8, 3, 4, 18, 19, 7, 2, 12, 13, 20, 15, 14, 21	recall 10, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	22, 11, 6, 18, 23, 19, 24, 8, 13, 25, 26, 27, 14, 28, 29, 30	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	31, 18, 1, 23, 6, 9, 25, 12, 26, 13, 20, 32, 15, 14, 33, 34	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	24, 35, 3, 36, 2, 10, 26, 13, 25, 20, 37, 27, 32, 33, 21, 38	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	24, 7, 10, 9, 26, 13, 39, 37, 27, 32, 20, 14, 29, 33, 40, 41	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	6, 2, 1, 9, 42, 26, 13, 14, 37, 27, 28, 20, 29, 41, 34, 16	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	1, 6, 43, 44, 25, 26, 28, 27, 20, 37, 45, 16, 40, 41, 33, 30	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	22, 23, 1, 9, 18, 11, 27, 15, 37, 14, 34, 30, 33, 29, 41, 38	recall 6, inference 0, analysis 4, synthesis 6
College Senior	18, 1, 6, 9, 44, 28, 20, 32, 37, 34, 29, 16, 41, 30, 33, 40	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 4, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	9, 1, 6, 18, 14, 28, 27, 32, 20, 46, 41, 29, 34, 30, 16, 33	recall 4, inference 0, analysis 6, synthesis 6

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "The Customhouse," how does Hawthorne show the frame narrative and the

found letter? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the point of view you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1, W.9-10.1): In The Customhouse, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of the frame narrative and the found letter? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the point of view in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1, W.9-10.1): Analyze how The Customhouse develops the idea of the frame narrative and the found letter. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of The Customhouse (where it begins, turns and ends) and its point of view shape the reader's understanding of the frame narrative and the found letter. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what The Customhouse suggests about the frame narrative and the found letter. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's point of view and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses point of view in The Customhouse to complicate the reader's understanding of the frame narrative and the found letter. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate The Customhouse within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the frame narrative and the found letter responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read The Customhouse alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the frame narrative and the found letter follows or bends those conventions, using the point of view as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to The Customhouse and its treatment of the frame narrative and the found letter. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's point of view and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads The Customhouse as evidence for a larger claim about the frame narrative and the found letter in The Scarlet

Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads The Customhouse as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the frame narrative and the found letter. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

SAT-style questions

1. *There was one thing that much aided me in renewing and recreating the stalwart soldier of the Niagara frontier—the man of true and simple energy.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “recreating” most nearly mean?

   A. belonging to a small, inner circle

   B. bringing back to life in the imagination

   C. a reddish glow

   D. cheerful and light

2. *There was one thing that much aided me in renewing and recreating the stalwart soldier of the Niagara frontier—the man of true and simple energy. It was the recollection of those memorable words of his—“I’ll try, Sir!”—spoken on the very verge of a desperate and heroic enterprise, and breathing the soul and spirit of New England hardihood, comprehending all perils, and encountering all. If, in our country, valor were rewarded by heraldic honor, this phrase—which it seems so easy to speak, but which only he, with such a task of danger and glory before him, has ever spoken—would be the best and fittest of all mottoes for the General’s shield of arms.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “The Customhouse”?

   A. The frame narrative and the found letter

   B. The recognition

   C. The procession

   D. Hester on the scaffold

SAT key: 1. B (bringing back to life in the imagination); 2. A (The frame narrative and the found letter)

Lesson 4: I: The Prison-Door

Focus: the prison door and the rose

Objective: Students will analyze how setting develops in “I: The Prison-Door” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Critical voice: “_The Scarlet Letter_ isn't a pleasant, pretty romance. It is a sort of parable, an earthly story with a hellish meaning.” (D. H. Lawrence, novelist and poet, *Studies in Classic American Literature (1923), Ch. VII, "Nathaniel Hawthorne and 'The Scarlet Letter'", Ch. VII, opening*; public domain). Genre lens: test "parable" against the rose bush at the prison door. *Objective:* Analyze genre (romance vs. parable) from the opening chapter. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.5

Teacher only · spoilers

A crowd of bearded men and hooded women waits before the heavy, iron-studded door of the Boston prison. The narrator notes that every new colony soon needs a cemetery and a prison. Beside the door grows a wild rose-bush, which he offers to the reader as a symbol of some sweet moral blossom in a dark tale.

Background: Boston was founded in 1630; the story begins in the 1640s, when the prison was already one of the oldest buildings. Some legends linked the rose-bush to Anne Hutchinson, a religious dissenter banished in 1638.

Significance: The brief chapter frames the novel as a struggle between punishment and mercy.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Can any society be perfect? What does even an ideal community need? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to sin and guilt because....*
> **Prompt:** Can any society be perfect? What does even an ideal community need?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to sin and guilt because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: ironwork — iron parts or fittings; symbolize — stand as a sign or symbol of; intermixed — mixed together; timbered — built or reinforced with heavy wooden beams; inauspicious — suggesting bad luck to come; unpromising. "ironwork": Origin: an English formation from iron + -work. "symbolize": Origin: Middle French symboliser.
Words: ironwork: iron parts or fittings · symbolize: stand as a sign or symbol of · intermixed: mixed together · timbered: built or reinforced with heavy wooden beams · inauspicious: suggesting bad luck to come; unpromising

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Boston was founded in 1630; the story begins in the 1640s, when the prison was already one of the oldest buildings. Some legends linked the rose-bush to Anne Hutchinson, a religious dissenter banished in 1638. The brief chapter frames the novel as a struggle between punishment and mercy. Setting: The prison door, "heavy oak," studded with iron, and the grass-plot of weeds before it in early Boston. Symbolism: The wild rose-bush beside the door, offered as "some sweet moral blossom." Foreshadowing: The narrator says the founders of every utopia soon need a cemetery and a prison. Watch for the rose-bush: Nature's possible kindness to the condemned.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "The founders of a new colony, whatever Utopia of human virtue and happiness they might originally project, have invariably recognized it..." slowly and put it in my own words: The narrator says that whatever ideal society the founders imagined, they soon set aside land for a graveyard and a prison. Next, craft. I notice the irony of setting "Utopia of human virtue and happiness" against "cemetery" and "prison" in one sentence. The strongest word is "Utopia": it names the perfect society the Puritans hoped for, and the rest of the sentence undercuts it. Then, effect. Why does the narrator say every new colony first builds a cemetery and a prison? My answer: The narrator says every new colony first builds a cemetery and a prison because even a community built on virtue must deal with death and sin; this sets up the prison door Hester walks out of.

> *The founders of a new colony, whatever Utopia of human virtue and happiness they might originally project, have invariably recognized it among their earliest practical necessities to allot a portion of the virgin soil as a cemetery, and another portion as the site of a prison (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "The founders of a new colony, whatever Utopia of human virtue and happiness they might originally project, have invariably recognized it…" slowly and put it in my own words: The narrator says that whatever ideal society the founders imagined, they soon set aside land for a graveyard and a prison. Next, craft. I notice the irony of setting "Utopia of human virtue and happiness" against "cemetery" and "prison" in one sentence. The strongest word is "Utopia": it names the perfect society the Puritans hoped for, and the rest of the sentence undercuts it. Then, effect. Why does the narrator say every new colony first builds a cemetery and a prison? My answer: The narrator says every new colony first builds a cemetery and a prison because even a community built on virtue must deal with death and sin; this sets up the prison door Hester walks out of.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Even an ideal society plans for death and crime at once. Expected link: irony; the Puritans' utopia. Ask: How does this line connect to sin and guilt? Expected: The colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail. (The prison as an image.)

> *the black flower of civilized society, a prison (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Even an ideal society plans for death and crime at once. Expected link: irony; the Puritans' utopia.
Ask: How does this line connect to sin and guilt?
Expected answer: The colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail. (The prison as an image.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for setting, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the prison door and the rose? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how I: The Prison-Door develops the idea of the prison door and the rose. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment. When the text says "the black flower of civilized society, a prison" (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2), it shows this directly. The prison is "the black flower of civilized society," but beside it grows a rose-bush that may "symbolize some sweet moral blossom."
Task: Annotate the chapter for setting, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the prison door and the rose? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how I: The Prison-Door develops the idea of the prison door and the rose. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment. When the text says "the black flower of civilized society, a prison" (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2), it shows this directly. The prison is "the black flower of civilized society," but beside it grows a rose-bush that may "symbolize some sweet moral blossom."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Can any society be perfect? What does even an ideal community need? Ask: is the narrator on the side of the prison or the rose? How can you tell?
Anchor question: Can any society be perfect? What does even an ideal community need?
Facilitation: Ask: is the narrator on the side of the prison or the rose? How can you tell?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the prison door and the rose? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment. (“the black flower of civilized society, a prison”, I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the prison door and the rose? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment. (“the black flower of civilized society, a prison”, I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how setting shapes the prison door and the rose. Key takeaway: the colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Setting:** The prison door, "heavy oak," studded with iron, and the grass-plot of weeds before it in early Boston.
- **Symbolism:** The wild rose-bush beside the door, offered as "some sweet moral blossom."
- **Foreshadowing:** The narrator says the founders of every utopia soon need a cemetery and a prison.

Themes and how they develop

- **sin and guilt:** the colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail.

Symbols and motifs

- **the rose-bush:** Nature's possible kindness to the condemned.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “The founders of a new colony, whatever Utopia of human virtue and happiness they might originally project, have invariably recognized it among their earliest practical necessities to allot a portion of the virgin soil as a cemetery, and another portion as the site of a prison” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2) The opening irony about utopias.
- “the black flower of civilized society, a prison” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2) The prison as an image.
- “It may serve, let us hope, to symbolize some sweet moral blossom, that may be found along the track, or relieve the darkening close of a tale of human frailty and sorrow” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 3) The rose-bush as hope.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment.
Evidence: "the black flower of civilized society, a prison" (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2)
Reasoning: The prison is "the black flower of civilized society," but beside it grows a rose-bush that may "symbolize some sweet moral blossom."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
ironwork (noun)	iron parts or fittings	*The rust on the ponderous ironwork of its oaken door looked more antique than anything else in the New World.*	"ironwork": Origin: an English formation from iron + -work. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/ironwork#Etymology)
symbolize (verb)	stand as a sign or symbol of	*It may serve, let us hope, to symbolize some sweet moral blossom, that may be found along the track, or relieve the darkening close of a tale of human frailty and sorrow.*	"symbolize": Origin: Middle French symboliser. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/symbolize#Etymology)
intermixed (adjective)	mixed together	*A throng of bearded men, in sad-colored garments, and gray, steeple-crowned hats, intermixed with women, some wearing hoods and others bareheaded, was assembled in front of a wooden edifice, the door of which was heavily timbered with oak, and studded with iron spikes.*	
timbered (adjective)	built or reinforced with heavy wooden beams	*A throng of bearded men, in sad-colored garments, and gray, steeple-crowned hats, intermixed with women, some wearing hoods and others bareheaded, was assembled in front of a wooden edifice, the door of which was heavily timbered with oak, and studded with iron spikes.*	
inauspicious (adjective)	suggesting bad luck to come; unpromising	*Finding it so directly on the threshold of our narrative, which is now about to issue from that inauspicious portal, we could hardly do otherwise than pluck one of its flowers, and present it to the reader.*	
pertains (verb)	belongs or relates (to)	*Like all that pertains to crime, it seemed never to have known a youthful era.*	
frailty (noun)	moral weakness	*It may serve, let us hope, to symbolize some sweet moral blossom, that may be found*	

		along the track, or relieve the darkening close of a tale of human frailty and sorrow.	

Discussion questions

1. Can any society be perfect? What does even an ideal community need?
2. Where does setting appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with hypocrisy and truth?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. How is the prison door described? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Heavy oak, studded with iron spikes.
2. What stands before the crowd? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The prison door
3. What grows beside the door? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A wild rose-bush
4. According to the narrator, what do new colonies soon need? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A cemetery and a prison
5. Whose footsteps may the rose-bush have sprung from, the narrator says? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Anne Hutchinson's
6. What does the narrator hope the rose may symbolize? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Some sweet moral blossom
7. Retell the three most important events of "I: The Prison-Door" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A crowd of bearded men and hooded women waits before the heavy, iron-studded door of the Boston prison. The narrator notes that every new colony soon needs a cemetery and a prison. Beside the door grows a wild rose-bush, which he offers to the reader as a symbol of some sweet moral blossom in a dark tale.
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "I: The Prison-Door"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "I: The Prison-Door" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: "The rust on the ponderous ironwork of its oaken door looked more antique than anything else in the New World." What does "ironwork" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: ironwork: iron parts or fittings.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why mention Anne Hutchinson? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: She was a woman who defied Puritan authority, like Hester.
2. What does “I: The Prison-Door” suggest about the prison door and the rose? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The brief chapter frames the novel as a struggle between punishment and mercy.
3. Find one example of setting in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
4. How does the symbolism in this chapter shape what we understand about the prison door and the rose? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment. Useful evidence: “The founders of a new colony, whatever Utopia of human virtue and happiness they might originally project, have invariably recognized it among their earliest practical necessities to allot a portion o” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2): The opening irony about utopias. On symbolism: The wild rose-bush beside the door, offered as "some sweet moral blossom." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “A throng of bearded men, in sad-colored garments, and gray, steeple-crowned hats, intermixed with women, some wearing hoods and others bareheaded, was assembled in front of a…”, why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “I: The Prison-Door”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: A crowd of bearded men and hooded women waits before the heavy, iron-studded door of the Boston prison. The narrator notes that every new colony soon needs a cemetery and a prison. Beside the door grows a wild rose-bush, which he offers to the reader as a symbol of some sweet moral blossom in a…
7. How does “I: The Prison-Door” build on “The Customhouse”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment. Useful evidence: “the black flower of civilized society, a prison” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2): The prison as an image. Theme link: the colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment. Useful evidence: “It may serve, let us hope, to symbolize some sweet moral blossom, that may be found along the track, or relieve the darkening close of a tale of human frailty and sorrow” (I: The

Prison-Door, paragraph 3): The rose-bush as hope. Theme link: the colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: "Can any society be perfect? What does even an ideal community need?" Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does foreshadowing appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with hypocrisy and truth? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment. Useful evidence: "The founders of a new colony, whatever Utopia of human virtue and happiness they might originally project, have invariably recognized it among their earliest practical necessities to allot a portion o" (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2): The opening irony about utopias. On foreshadowing: The narrator says the founders of every utopia soon need a cemetery and a prison. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is the narrator on the side of the prison or the rose? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned reading with evidence from tone.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment. Useful evidence: "the black flower of civilized society, a prison" (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2): The prison as an image. Theme link: the colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: "The brief chapter frames the novel as a struggle between punishment and mercy." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment. Useful evidence: "It may serve, let us hope, to symbolize some sweet moral blossom, that may be found along the track, or relieve the darkening close of a tale of human frailty and sorrow" (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 3): The rose-bush as hope. Theme link: the colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment. Useful evidence: "The founders of a new colony, whatever Utopia of human virtue and happiness they might originally project, have invariably recognized it among their earliest practical necessities to allot a portion o" (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2): The opening irony about utopias. Theme link: the colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Rewrite one moment of “I: The Prison-Door” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the prison door and the rose? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment. Useful evidence: “the black flower of civilized society, a prison” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2): The prison as an image. Theme link: the colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “I: The Prison-Door”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment. Useful evidence: “It may serve, let us hope, to symbolize some sweet moral blossom, that may be found along the track, or relieve the darkening close of a tale of human frailty and sorrow” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 3): The rose-bush as hope. Theme link: the colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to nature and the individual against society: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment. Useful evidence: “The founders of a new colony, whatever Utopia of human virtue and happiness they might originally project, have invariably recognized it among their earliest practical necessities to allot a portion o” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2): The opening irony about utopias. Theme link: the colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the setting in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment. Useful evidence: “the black flower of civilized society, a prison” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2): The prison as an image. On setting: The prison door, "heavy oak," studded with iron, and the grass-plot of weeds before it in early Boston. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “I: The Prison-Door” treats the prison door and the rose with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment. Useful evidence: “It may serve, let us hope, to symbolize some sweet moral blossom, that may be found along the track, or relieve the darkening close of a tale of human frailty and sorrow” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 3): The rose-bush as hope. Theme link: the colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what "II: The Marketplace" will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment. Useful evidence: "The founders of a new colony, whatever Utopia of human virtue and happiness they might originally project, have invariably recognized it among their earliest practical necessities to allot a portion o" (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2): The opening irony about utopias. On foreshadowing: The narrator says the founders of every utopia soon need a cemetery and a prison. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the prison door and the rose? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment. Useful evidence: "the black flower of civilized society, a prison" (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2): The prison as an image. Theme link: the colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from The Customhouse, paragraph 10: "Nevertheless, this very sentiment is an evidence that the _____, which has become an unhealthy one, should at last be severed." Word bank: functionary, connection, abbreviating, discourtesy
   Key: connection
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from The Customhouse, paragraph 21? "It was only with the _____ of a servant, and by leaning his hand heavily on the iron balustrade, that he could slowly and painfully ascend the Customhouse steps, and, with a toilsome progress across the floor, attain his customary chair beside the fireplace."

   A. attachment
   B. disposition
   C. assistance
   D. functionary

   Key: C (assistance)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from The Customhouse, paragraph 6? “The besom of reform has swept him out of office; and a worthier successor wears his dignity, and pockets his _____.”

   A. disposition

   B. attachment

   C. phosphorescent

   D. emoluments

   Key: D (emoluments)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from The Customhouse, paragraph 17: “Here, one would suppose, might have been sorrow enough to imbue the sunniest _____, through and through, with a sable tinge.” Word bank: disposition, attachment, abbreviating, discourtesy

   Key: disposition

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What grows beside the door?

   A. A lily

   B. Black weeds

   C. A wild rose-bush

   D. An oak tree

   Key: C (A wild rose-bush)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] According to the narrator, what do new colonies soon need?

   A. A school and a church

   B. A cemetery and a prison

   C. A market

   D. A fort

   Key: B (A cemetery and a prison)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What stands before the crowd?

   A. The governor's house

   B. The forest

   C. The prison door

   D. A church

   Key: C (The prison door)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whose footsteps may the rose-bush have sprung from, the narrator says?

   A. Winthrop's

   B. Anne Hutchinson's

   C. Pearl's

   D. Hester's

   Key: B (Anne Hutchinson's)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “A throng of bearded men, in sad-colored garments, and gray, steeple-crowned hats, intermixed with women, some wearing hoods and others bareheaded, was

assembled in front of a wooden edifice, the door of which was…", what does "intermixed" most nearly mean?

A. unpredictable and odd

B. gripping tightly

C. mixed together

D. an unhealthy gloominess of mind

Key: C (mixed together)

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from The Customhouse, paragraph 21 reveal about the character or situation? "When no longer called upon to speak, or listen, either of which operations cost him an evident effort, his face would briefly subside into its former not uncheerful quietude." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The passage (The Customhouse, paragraph 21) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks.". The words "uncheerful" and "operations" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from The Customhouse, paragraph 3 reveal about the character or situation? "Over the entrance hovers an enormous specimen of the American eagle, with outspread wings, a shield before her breast, and, if I recollect aright, a bunch of intermingled thunderbolts and barbed arrows in each claw." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The passage (The Customhouse, paragraph 3) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks.". The words "intermingled" and "thunderbolts" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "the black flower of civilized society, a prison" (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The prison as an image. The evidence is "the black flower of civilized society, a prison" (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2). This develops sin and guilt: the colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why mention Anne Hutchinson?

Sample answer: She was a woman who defied Puritan authority, like Hester. The evidence is "The founders of a new colony, whatever Utopia of human virtue and happiness they might originally project, have invariably recognized it…" (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2), which shows the opening irony about utopias.

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from The Customhouse, paragraph 11 shapes its tone: "On emerging from the Old Manse, it was chiefly this strange, indolent, unjoyous attachment for my native town, that brought me to fill a place in Uncle Sam's brick edifice, when I might as well, or better, have gone somewhere else." Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words "attachment" and "somewhere" (The Customhouse, paragraph 11) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “I: The Prison-Door”? The prison door, ‘heavy oak,’ studded with iron, and the grass-plot of weeds before it in early Boston.

    A. Setting

    B. Theme

    C. Alliteration

    D. Metaphor

    Key: A (Setting)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is the narrator on the side of the prison or the rose? Argue.
    Sample answer: A reasoned reading with evidence from tone. The evidence is “It may serve, let us hope, to symbolize some sweet moral blossom, that may be found along the track, or relieve the darkening close of a…” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 3), which shows the rose-bush as hope. This develops sin and guilt: the colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail. The prison is "the black flower of civilized society," but beside it grows a rose-bush that may "symbolize some sweet moral blossom.".

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from The Customhouse, paragraph 13? “It was plain enough to discern, that the old fellows dreaded some such _____ at my hands.”

    A. contributing

    B. gourmandism

    C. assistance

    D. discourtesy

    Key: D (discourtesy)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “A throng of bearded men, in sad-colored garments, and gray, steeple-crowned hats, intermixed with women, some wearing hoods and others bareheaded, was assembled in front of a wooden edifice, the door of which was…”, what does “timbered” most nearly mean?

    A. an unhealthy gloominess of mind

    B. built or reinforced with heavy wooden beams

    C. nearness; closeness

    D. returned (a feeling or gesture)

    Key: B (built or reinforced with heavy wooden beams)

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2: “The founders of a new colony, whatever Utopia of human virtue and happiness they might originally project, have invariably recognized it among their earliest practical _____ to allot a portion of the virgin soil as a cemetery, and another portion as the site of a prison”
    Key: necessities

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “The rust on the ponderous ironwork of its oaken door looked more antique than anything else in the New World.”, what does “ironwork” most nearly mean?

    A. lacking curiosity (here 'not incurious' means quite curious)

    B. too deep to be explored or understood

    C. iron parts or fittings

    D. the state of being guilty

    Key: C (iron parts or fittings)

21. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How is the prison door described?
    Sample answer: Heavy oak, studded with iron spikes.

22. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from The Customhouse, paragraph 25 shapes its tone: “He seemed away from us, although we saw him but a few yards off; remote, though we passed close beside his chair; unattainable, though we might have stretched forth our hands and touched his own.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “unattainable” and “stretched” (The Customhouse, paragraph 25) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from The Customhouse, paragraph 32 shapes its tone: “Once in a great while the thoughts that had seemed so vital and so active, yet had been put to rest so quietly, revived again.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “thoughts” and “quietly” (The Customhouse, paragraph 32) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? The colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail.

    A. Hypocrisy and truth
    B. Public shame and private identity
    C. Sin and guilt
    D. Nature and the individual against society

    Key: C (Sin and guilt)

25. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from The Customhouse, paragraph 2: “This, in fact—a desire to put myself in my true _____ as editor, or very little more, of the most prolix among the tales that make up my volume—this, and no other, is my true reason for assuming a personal relation with the public.” Word bank: phosphorescent, discourtesy, position, emoluments
    Key: position

26. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Finding it so directly on the threshold of our narrative, which is now about to issue from that _____ portal, we could hardly do otherwise than pluck one of its flowers, and present it to the reader.” Word bank: ironwork, intermixed, inauspicious, symbolize
    Key: inauspicious

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from The Customhouse, paragraph 7 shapes its tone: “The sentiment is probably assignable to the deep and aged roots which my family has struck into the soil.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “assignable” and “sentiment” (The Customhouse, paragraph 7) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Which literary element does this describe in “I: The Prison-Door”? The wild rose-bush beside the door, offered as ‘some sweet moral blossom.’

    A. Allusion

    B. Point of view

    C. Hyperbole

    D. Symbolism

    Key: D (Symbolism)

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from The Customhouse, paragraph 37 to the story's treatment of women and independence: “Meanwhile, they shall be at the command of any gentleman, inclined, and competent, to take the unprofitable labor off my hands.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (The Customhouse, paragraph 37) develops women and independence: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks.". Its words “unprofitable” and “gentleman” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “My eyes fastened themselves upon the old scarlet letter, and would not be turned aside.” (The Customhouse, paragraph 38), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

30. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “I: The Prison-Door”?

    A. The revelation

    B. The frame narrative and the found letter

    C. The minister's vigil

    D. The prison door and the rose

    Key: D (The prison door and the rose)

31. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “the black flower of civilized society, a prison” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2).

    Sample answer: The prison is "the black flower of civilized society," but beside it grows a rose-bush that may "symbolize some sweet moral blossom.". The evidence is “the black flower of civilized society, a prison” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2), which shows the prison as an image. This develops sin and guilt: the colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail.

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from The Customhouse, paragraph 41 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: “How unlike, alas! the hangdog look of a republican official, who, as the servant of the people, feels himself less than the least, and below the lowest, of his masters.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (The Customhouse, paragraph 41) develops hypocrisy and truth: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks.". Its words “republican” and “official” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “It was the subject of my meditations for many an hour, while pacing to and fro across my room, or traversing, with a…” (The Customhouse, paragraph 42), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

33. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does the narrator hope the rose may symbolize?

    A. Wealth

    B. Some sweet moral blossom

C. Death

D. War

Key: B (Some sweet moral blossom)

34. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from The Customhouse, paragraph 18 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: “I used to watch and study this patriarchal personage with, I think, livelier curiosity, than any other form of humanity there presented to my notice.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (The Customhouse, paragraph 18) develops hypocrisy and truth: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks.". Its words “patriarchal” and “curiosity” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “I have heard him smack his lips over dinners, every guest at which, except himself, had long been food for worms.” (The Customhouse, paragraph 19), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

35. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Like all that _____ to crime, it seemed never to have known a youthful era.” Word bank: ironwork, symbolize, pertains, intermixed

Key: pertains

36. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Complete the quotation from I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2: “the black flower of _____ society, a prison”

Key: civilized

37. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What does this passage most clearly show? “the black flower of civilized society, a prison” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2)

A. The prison as an image.

B. The biblical allusion: Hester's mark is worse than Cain's.

C. The mirror in the armor.

D. His imagined ancestors' contempt for him.

Key: A (The prison as an image.)

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Connect this passage from The Customhouse, paragraph 15 to the story's treatment of women and independence: “Unless people are more than commonly disagreeable, it is my foolish habit to contract a kindness for them.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (The Customhouse, paragraph 15) develops women and independence: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks.". Its words “disagreeable” and “kindness” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Then, moreover, the white locks of age were sometimes found to be the thatch of an intellectual tenement in good repair.” (The Customhouse, paragraph 16), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

39. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] What does this passage most clearly show? “It may serve, let us hope, to symbolize some sweet moral blossom, that may be found along the track, or relieve the darkening close of a tale of human frailty and sorrow” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 3)

A. The rose-bush as hope.

B. The biblical allusion: Hester's mark is worse than Cain's.

C. Hester's answer, full of irony for the reader who will learn the truth.

D. The novel's best-known statement on hypocrisy.

Key: A (The rose-bush as hope.)

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Synthesis: trace how sin and guilt develops from The Customhouse to I: The Prison-Door. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Earlier, in The Customhouse, paragraph 9, the text reads “A writer of storybooks! What kind of a business in life … may that be”, which shows his imagined ancestors' contempt for him. In I: The Prison-Door, “The founders of a new colony, whatever Utopia of human virtue and happiness they might originally project, have invariably recognized it…” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2), which shows the opening irony about utopias. The colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail.

41. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “The founders of a new colony, whatever Utopia of human virtue and happiness they might originally project, have invariably recognized it among their earliest practical necessities to allot a portion of the virgin soil as a cemetery, and…” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The opening irony about utopias. The evidence is “The founders of a new colony, whatever Utopia of human virtue and happiness they might originally project, have invariably recognized it…” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2). This develops sin and guilt: the colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail. The words “necessities” and “originally” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The prison is "the black flower of civilized society," but beside it grows a rose-bush that may "symbolize some sweet moral blossom.".

42. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “the black flower of civilized society, a prison” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The prison as an image. The evidence is “the black flower of civilized society, a prison” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2). This develops sin and guilt: the colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail. The words “civilized” and “society” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The prison is "the black flower of civilized society," but beside it grows a rose-bush that may "symbolize some sweet moral blossom.".

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	1, 4, 17, 18, 8, 19, 20, 21, 10, 11, 12, 13, 22, 23, 24, 16	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	25, 1, 3, 4, 8, 26, 19, 6, 11, 10, 13, 27, 24, 28, 29, 16	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	4, 1, 7, 20, 5, 26, 10, 11, 13, 30, 27, 23, 22, 31, 32, 16	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	17, 4, 1, 33, 18, 19, 10, 11, 13, 22, 27, 14, 15, 34, 32, 16	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	3, 17, 35, 26, 11, 10, 13, 27, 22, 23, 28, 24, 29, 34, 32, 16	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	26, 36, 7, 11, 10, 37, 13, 22, 14, 23, 15, 24, 34, 32, 38, 16	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	26, 6, 35, 7, 11, 39, 22, 27, 14, 23, 28, 34, 38, 32, 16, 40	recall 4, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 5

College Junior	3, 20, 26, 35, 7, 23, 27, 14, 24, 31, 32, 34, 29, 41, 40, 16	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	26, 35, 7, 5, 30, 23, 27, 14, 24, 32, 34, 38, 42, 41, 16, 40	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 4, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	26, 35, 7, 5, 30, 22, 27, 24, 32, 38, 29, 34, 40, 16, 41, 42	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 3, synthesis 8

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "I: The Prison-Door," how does Hawthorne show the prison door and the rose? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In I: The Prison-Door, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of the prison door and the rose? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how I: The Prison-Door develops the idea of the prison door and the rose. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of I: The Prison-Door (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of the prison door and the rose. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what I: The Prison-Door suggests about the prison door and the rose. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's setting and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses setting in I: The Prison-Door to complicate the reader's understanding of the prison door and the rose. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate I: The Prison-Door within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the prison door and the rose responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read I: The Prison-Door alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the prison door and the rose follows

or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to I: The Prison-Door and its treatment of the prison door and the rose. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's setting and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads I: The Prison-Door as evidence for a larger claim about the prison door and the rose in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads I: The Prison-Door as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the prison door and the rose. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

SAT-style questions

1. *A throng of bearded men, in sad-colored garments, and gray, steeple-crowned hats, intermixed with women, some wearing hoods and others bareheaded, was assembled in front of a wooden edifice, the door of which was heavily timbered with oak, and studded with iron spikes.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “intermixed” most nearly mean?

   A. mixed together

   B. suggesting bad luck to come; unpromising

   C. belongs or relates (to)

   D. moral weakness

2. *A throng of bearded men, in sad-colored garments, and gray, steeple-crowned hats, intermixed with women, some wearing hoods and others bareheaded, was assembled in front of a wooden edifice, the door of which was heavily timbered with oak, and studded with iron spikes.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “I: The Prison-Door”?

   A. The prison door and the rose

   B. The frame narrative and the found letter

   C. The interior of a heart

   D. The child at the brook-side

SAT key: 1. A (mixed together); 2. A (The prison door and the rose)

Lesson 5: II: The Marketplace

Focus: Hester on the scaffold

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in “II: The Marketplace” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Critical voice: “You _must_ look through the surface of American art, and see the inner diabolism of the symbolic meaning. Otherwise it is all mere childishness.” (D. H. Lawrence, novelist and poet, *Studies in Classic American Literature (1923), Ch. VII, "Nathaniel Hawthorne and 'The Scarlet Letter'", Ch. VII*; public domain). Two-column notes: surface meaning / "inner" meaning of the A in Chapter II. *Objective:* Analyze symbolism on the scaffold in the market-place. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.4

Content note (public shaming, adultery (implied), alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): Hester is publicly shamed for adultery while holding her baby; women in the crowd call for branding or death. Keep focus on judgment and community; some students may have experienced public shaming online. This section mentions drinking or a drug (“…sex. They were her countrywomen; and the beef and ale of their native land, with a moral diet…”). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: A woman is publicly shamed by a crowd in this chapter.
Suggested language: “Is the crowd's judgment justice or cruelty?”

Teacher only · spoilers

Hester Prynne leaves the prison carrying her three-month-old baby, with a scarlet A elaborately embroidered in gold thread on her dress. Harsh women in the crowd say she deserves branding or death. She stands on the scaffold for three hours, remembering her past in England and her marriage to an older scholar, and clutches the baby to her breast.

Background: Puritan Massachusetts punished moral offenses in public: whipping, the stocks and the pillory, sometimes letters sewn to clothing. Shame was meant to reform the sinner and warn the community.

Significance: Hester turns her badge of shame into a work of art and meets the crowd with dignity.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What does it feel like to be stared at by a crowd that has already judged you? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to public shame and private identity because.... Content note before we start: A woman is publicly shamed by a crowd in this chapter.
Prompt: What does it feel like to be stared at by a crowd that has already judged you?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to public shame and private identity because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: farthingale — a hooped frame worn under a skirt to make it stand out; goodwife — a title for a married woman of ordinary rank (Mrs.); rankles — keeps causing bitter pain; phantasmagoric — like a shifting series of dreamlike images; rotundity — fullness and roundness (here, of bold, loud speech). "rankles": Origin of "rankle": Old French rancler; earlier Latin dracunculus ("little serpent"). "rotundity": Origin: Latin rotunditas.
Words: farthingale: a hooped frame worn under a skirt to make it stand out · goodwife: a title for a married woman of ordinary rank (Mrs.) · rankles: keeps causing bitter pain · phantasmagoric: like a shifting series of dreamlike images · rotundity: fullness and roundness (here, of bold, loud speech)

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Puritan Massachusetts punished moral offenses in public: whipping, the stocks and the pillory, sometimes letters sewn to clothing. Shame was meant to reform the sinner and warn the community. Hester turns her badge of shame into a work of art and meets the crowd with dignity. Characterization: Hester emerges with dignity, the letter "fantastically embroidered," refusing to shrink. Imagery: The crowd of hard-featured women, the scaffold, the baby blinking in the sunlight. Allusion: The narrator compares Hester with a picture of the Madonna, then reverses the comparison. Watch for the scarlet letter: "On the breast of her gown, in fine red cloth, surrounded with an elaborate embroidery and fantastic flourishes of gold thread, appeared the letter A."

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "On the breast of her gown, in fine red cloth, surrounded with an elaborate embroidery and fantastic flourishes of gold-thread, appeared..." slowly and put it in my own words: On Hester's dress appears the letter A in fine red cloth, surrounded by elaborate embroidery and gold flourishes. Next, craft. I notice the long list of rich decorative details, which make the badge of shame look beautiful. The strongest word is "elaborate": it shows Hester has made her punishment into an artwork. Then, effect. Why is the letter described in such loving detail? My answer: The letter is described in such loving detail because Hester has turned the sign meant to shame her into a display of skill and defiance; the crowd is shocked that she will not look humbled.

> *On the breast of her gown, in fine red cloth, surrounded with an elaborate embroidery and fantastic flourishes of gold-thread, appeared the letter A (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 10)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "On the breast of her gown, in fine red cloth, surrounded with an elaborate embroidery and fantastic flourishes of gold-thread, appeared…" slowly and put it in my own words: On Hester's dress appears the letter A in fine red cloth, surrounded by elaborate embroidery and gold flourishes. Next, craft. I notice the long list of rich decorative details, which make the badge of shame look beautiful. The strongest word is "elaborate": it shows Hester has made her punishment into an artwork. Then, effect. Why is the letter described in such loving detail? My answer: The letter is described in such loving detail because Hester has turned the sign meant to shame her into a display of skill and defiance; the crowd is shocked that she will not look humbled.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The harshest woman in the crowd. Look at the craft: The crowd of hard-featured women, the scaffold, the baby blinking in the sunlight. Ask: How does this line connect to public shame and private identity? Expected: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art. (The harshest woman in the crowd.)

> *This woman has brought shame upon us all, and ought to die. Is there not law for it (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 7)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The harshest woman in the crowd. Look at the craft: The crowd of hard-featured women, the scaffold, the baby blinking in the sunlight.
Ask: How does this line connect to public shame and private identity?
Expected answer: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art. (The harshest woman in the crowd.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for characterization, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about Hester on the scaffold? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how II: The Marketplace develops the idea of Hester on the scaffold. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Hester turns her punishment into a statement of identity. When the text says “It had the effect of a spell, taking her out of the ordinary relations with humanity, and enclosing her in a sphere by herself” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 11), it shows this directly. Instead of a plain badge she wears a letter with "fantastic flourishes of gold thread," and it has "the effect of a spell" that sets her "in a sphere by herself."
Task: Annotate the chapter for characterization, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about Hester on the scaffold? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how II: The Marketplace develops the idea of Hester on the scaffold. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Hester turns her punishment into a statement of identity. When the text says “It had the effect of a spell, taking her out of the ordinary relations with humanity, and enclosing her in a sphere by herself” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 11), it shows this directly. Instead of a plain badge she wears a letter with "fantastic flourishes of gold thread," and it has "the effect of a spell" that sets her "in a sphere by herself."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What does it feel like to be stared at by a crowd that has already judged you? Compare the women in the crowd: the harsh "matrons" and the young wife who shows pity. Who is the narrator's voice closest to?
Anchor question: What does it feel like to be stared at by a crowd that has already judged you?
Facilitation: Compare the women in the crowd: the harsh "matrons" and the young wife who shows pity. Who is the narrator's voice closest to?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about Hester on the scaffold? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Hester turns her punishment into a statement of identity. ("It had the effect of a spell, taking her out of the ordinary relations with humanity, and enclosing her in a sphere by herself", II: The Marketplace, paragraph 11). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about Hester on the scaffold? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Hester turns her punishment into a statement of identity. ("It had the effect of a spell, taking her out of the ordinary relations with humanity, and enclosing her in a sphere by herself", II: The Marketplace, paragraph 11). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes Hester on the scaffold. Key takeaway: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Hester emerges with dignity, the letter "fantastically embroidered," refusing to shrink.
- **Imagery:** The crowd of hard-featured women, the scaffold, the baby blinking in the sunlight.
- **Allusion:** The narrator compares Hester with a picture of the Madonna, then reverses the comparison.

Themes and how they develop

- **public shame and private identity:** Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art.

Symbols and motifs

- **the scarlet letter:** "On the breast of her gown, in fine red cloth, surrounded with an elaborate embroidery and fantastic flourishes of gold thread, appeared the letter A."

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "On the breast of her gown, in fine red cloth, surrounded with an elaborate embroidery and fantastic flourishes of gold-thread, appeared the letter A" (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 10) First description of the letter.
- "This woman has brought shame upon us all, and ought to die. Is there not law for it" (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 7) The harshest woman in the crowd.
- "It had the effect of a spell, taking her out of the ordinary relations with humanity, and enclosing her in a sphere by herself" (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 11) The letter isolates Hester.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Hester turns her punishment into a statement of identity.
Evidence: "It had the effect of a spell, taking her out of the ordinary relations with humanity, and enclosing her in a sphere by herself" (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 11)
Reasoning: Instead of a plain badge she wears a letter with "fantastic flourishes of gold thread," and it has "the effect of a spell" that sets her "in a sphere by herself."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
farthingale (noun)	a hooped frame worn under a skirt to make it stand out	*The age had not so much refinement, that any sense of impropriety restrained the wearers of petticoat and farthingale from stepping forth into the public ways, and wedging their not unsubstantial persons, if occasion were, into the throng nearest to the scaffold at an execution.*	
goodwife (noun)	a title for a married woman of ordinary rank (Mrs.)	*"Mercy on us, goodwife," exclaimed a man in the crowd, "is there no virtue in woman, save what springs from a wholesome fear of the gallows?*	
rankles (verb)	keeps causing bitter pain	*In our nature, however, there is a provision, alike marvellous and merciful, that the sufferer should never know the intensity of what he endures by its present torture, but chiefly by the pang that rankles after it.*	"rankles": Origin of "rankle": Old French rancler; earlier Latin dracunculus ("little serpent"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/rankle#Etymology)
phantasmagoric (adjective)	like a shifting series of dreamlike images	*Possibly, it was an instinctive device of her spirit, to relieve itself, by the exhibition of these phantasmagoric forms, from the cruel weight and hardness of the reality.*	

rotundity (noun)	fullness and roundness (here, of bold, loud speech)	*There was, moreover, a boldness and rotundity of speech among these matrons, as most of them seemed to be, that would startle us at the present day, whether in respect to its purport or its volume of tone.*	"rotundity": Origin: Latin rotunditas. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/rotundity#Etymology)
transgressor (noun)	a person who breaks a law or moral rule	*Meagre, indeed, and cold was the sympathy that a transgressor might look for, from such bystanders, at the scaffold.*	"transgressor": Origin: Anglo-Norman transgressour; earlier Latin transgressor. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/transgressor#Etymology)
visaged (adjective)	having a face of a certain kind	*Preceded by the beadle, and attended by an irregular procession of stern-browed men and unkindly visaged women, Hester Prynne set forth towards the place appointed for her punishment.*	"visaged": Origin: an English formation from visage + -ed. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/visaged#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. What does it feel like to be stared at by a crowd that has already judged you?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with nature and the individual against society?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Where did Hester live before Boston? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: In England and then Amsterdam, with her older husband.
2. What letter does Hester wear? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A
3. What does Hester carry? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Her baby
4. How is the letter made? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Embroidered in red with gold thread
5. What do the harshest women want? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A heavier punishment, even death
6. How long must Hester stand on the scaffold? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Three hours

7. Retell the three most important events of "II: The Marketplace" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Hester Prynne leaves the prison carrying her three-month-old baby, with a scarlet A elaborately embroidered in gold thread on her dress. Harsh women in the crowd say she deserves branding or death. She stands on the scaffold for three hours, remembering her past in England and her marriage to an older scholar, and clutches the baby to her breast.
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "II: The Marketplace"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "II: The Marketplace" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: "The age had not so much refinement, that any sense of impropriety restrained the wearers of petticoat and farthingale from stepping forth into the public ways, and wedging their not unsubstantial persons, if occasion…" What does "farthingale" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: farthingale: a hooped frame worn under a skirt to make it stand out.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does the narrator compare Hester with the Madonna? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: To contrast a sacred image of motherhood with a sinner, and to stir sympathy.
2. What does "II: The Marketplace" suggest about Hester on the scaffold? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Hester turns her badge of shame into a work of art and meets the crowd with dignity.
3. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the imagery in this chapter shape what we understand about Hester on the scaffold? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester turns her punishment into a statement of identity. Useful evidence: "On the breast of her gown, in fine red cloth, surrounded with an elaborate embroidery and fantastic flourishes of gold-thread, appeared the letter A" (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 10): First description of the letter. On imagery: The crowd of hard-featured women, the scaffold, the baby blinking in the sunlight. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins ""Mercy on us, goodwife,"", why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "II: The Marketplace", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Hester Prynne leaves the prison carrying her three-month-old baby, with a scarlet A elaborately embroidered in gold thread on her dress. Harsh women in the crowd say she deserves branding or death. She stands on the scaffold for three hours, remembering her past in England and her marriage to an…

7. How does “II: The Marketplace” build on “I: The Prison-Door”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester turns her punishment into a statement of identity. Useful evidence: “This woman has brought shame upon us all, and ought to die. Is there not law for it” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 7): The harshest woman in the crowd. Theme link: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester turns her punishment into a statement of identity. Useful evidence: “It had the effect of a spell, taking her out of the ordinary relations with humanity, and enclosing her in a sphere by herself” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 11): The letter isolates Hester. On characterization: Hester emerges with dignity, the letter "fantastically embroidered," refusing to shrink. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “What does it feel like to be stared at by a crowd that has already judged you?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does conflict appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with nature and the individual against society? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester turns her punishment into a statement of identity. Useful evidence: “On the breast of her gown, in fine red cloth, surrounded with an elaborate embroidery and fantastic flourishes of gold-thread, appeared the letter A” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 10): First description of the letter. Theme link: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is the crowd's judgment justice or cruelty? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned position using the women's speeches and the narrator's comments.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester turns her punishment into a statement of identity. Useful evidence: “This woman has brought shame upon us all, and ought to die. Is there not law for it” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 7): The harshest woman in the crowd. Theme link: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Hester turns her badge of shame into a work of art and meets the crowd with dignity.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester turns her punishment into a statement of

identity. Useful evidence: “It had the effect of a spell, taking her out of the ordinary relations with humanity, and enclosing her in a sphere by herself” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 11): The letter isolates Hester. Theme link: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester turns her punishment into a statement of identity. Useful evidence: “On the breast of her gown, in fine red cloth, surrounded with an elaborate embroidery and fantastic flourishes of gold-thread, appeared the letter A” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 10): First description of the letter. On characterization: Hester emerges with dignity, the letter "fantastically embroidered," refusing to shrink. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Rewrite one moment of “II: The Marketplace” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about Hester on the scaffold? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester turns her punishment into a statement of identity. Useful evidence: “This woman has brought shame upon us all, and ought to die. Is there not law for it” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 7): The harshest woman in the crowd. Theme link: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “II: The Marketplace”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester turns her punishment into a statement of identity. Useful evidence: “It had the effect of a spell, taking her out of the ordinary relations with humanity, and enclosing her in a sphere by herself” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 11): The letter isolates Hester. Theme link: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to women and independence: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester turns her punishment into a statement of identity. Useful evidence: “On the breast of her gown, in fine red cloth, surrounded with an elaborate embroidery and fantastic flourishes of gold-thread, appeared the letter A” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 10): First description of the letter. Theme link: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester turns her punishment into a statement of identity. Useful evidence: “This woman has brought shame upon us all, and ought to die. Is there not law for it” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 7): The harshest woman in the crowd. On characterization: Hester emerges with dignity, the letter "fantastically embroidered," refusing to shrink. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “II: The Marketplace” treats Hester on the scaffold with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester turns her punishment into a statement of identity. Useful evidence: “It had the effect of a spell, taking her out of the ordinary relations with humanity, and enclosing her in a sphere by herself” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 11): The letter isolates Hester. Theme link: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “III: The Recognition” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester turns her punishment into a statement of identity. Useful evidence: “On the breast of her gown, in fine red cloth, surrounded with an elaborate embroidery and fantastic flourishes of gold-thread, appeared the letter A” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 10): First description of the letter. Theme link: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Hester on the scaffold? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester turns her punishment into a statement of identity. Useful evidence: “This woman has brought shame upon us all, and ought to die. Is there not law for it” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 7): The harshest woman in the crowd. Theme link: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What do the harshest women want?

   A. Her freedom

   B. Mercy

C. A trial

D. A heavier punishment, even death

Key: D (A heavier punishment, even death)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Preceded by the beadle, and attended by an irregular procession of stern-browed men and unkindly _____ women, Hester Prynne set forth towards the place appointed for her punishment." Word bank: farthingale, visaged, rankles, goodwife

   Key: visaged

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Meagre, indeed, and cold was the sympathy that a _____ might look for, from such bystanders, at the scaffold." Word bank: goodwife, farthingale, transgressor, rankles

   Key: transgressor

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How long must Hester stand on the scaffold?

   A. A week

   B. Three hours

   C. Ten minutes

   D. One day

   Key: B (Three hours)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "There was, moreover, a boldness and _____ of speech among these matrons, as most of them seemed to be, that would startle us at the present day, whether in respect to its purport or its volume of tone." Word bank: rotundity, farthingale, goodwife, rankles

   Key: rotundity

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from II: The Marketplace, paragraph 7: "This woman has _____ shame upon us all, and ought to die. Is there not law for it"

   Key: brought

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How is the letter made?

   A. Branded on her skin

   B. Carved in wood

   C. Painted on her door

   D. Embroidered in red with gold thread

   Key: D (Embroidered in red with gold thread)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What letter does Hester wear?

   A. H

   B. S

   C. P

   D. A

   Key: D (A)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Possibly, it was an instinctive device of her spirit, to relieve itself, by the exhibition of these phantasmagoric forms, from the cruel weight and hardness of the reality.", what does "phantasmagoric" most nearly mean?

    A. serving as a symbol

    B. the act of committing (a crime)

    C. a slave; one bound to serve

    D. like a shifting series of dreamlike images

    Key: D (like a shifting series of dreamlike images)

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Mercy on us, goodwife,' exclaimed a man in the crowd, 'is there no virtue in woman, save what springs from a wholesome fear of the gallows?", what does "goodwife" most nearly mean?

    A. promising solemnly

    B. coldness

    C. a title for a married woman of ordinary rank (Mrs.)

    D. not valued or loved

    Key: C (a title for a married woman of ordinary rank (Mrs.))

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "In our nature, however, there is a provision, alike marvellous and merciful, that the sufferer should never know the intensity of what he endures by its present torture, but chiefly by the pang that rankles after it.", what does "rankles" most nearly mean?

    A. keeps causing bitter pain

    B. able to be measured or predicted

    C. lights up

    D. built or reinforced with heavy wooden beams

    Key: A (keeps causing bitter pain)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "This woman has brought shame upon us all, and ought to die. Is there not law for it" (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 7) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The harshest woman in the crowd. The evidence is "This woman has brought shame upon us all, and ought to die. Is there not law for it" (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 7).

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does the narrator compare Hester with the Madonna?

    Sample answer: To contrast a sacred image of motherhood with a sinner, and to stir sympathy. The evidence is "It had the effect of a spell, taking her out of the ordinary relations with humanity, and enclosing her in a sphere by herself" (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 11), which shows the letter isolates Hester.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Which literary element does this describe in "II: The Marketplace"? The crowd of hard-featured women, the scaffold, the baby blinking in the sunlight.

    A. Irony

    B. Theme

    C. Imagery

    D. Point of view

    Key: C (Imagery)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art.

    A. Public shame and private identity

    B. Hypocrisy and truth

    C. Nature and the individual against society

    D. Sin and guilt

    Key: A (Public shame and private identity)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "On the breast of her gown, in fine red cloth, surrounded with an elaborate embroidery and fantastic flourishes of gold-thread, appeared the letter A" (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 10) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: First description of the letter. The evidence is "On the breast of her gown, in fine red cloth, surrounded with an elaborate embroidery and fantastic flourishes of gold-thread, appeared the…" (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 10). This develops public shame and private identity: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art. The words "embroidery" and "surrounded" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Instead of a plain badge she wears a letter with "fantastic flourishes of gold thread," and it has "the effect of a spell" that sets her "in a sphere by herself.".

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from II: The Marketplace, paragraph 10? "It was so _____ done, and with so much fertility and gorgeous luxuriance of fancy, that it had all the effect of a last and fitting decoration to the apparel which she wore"

    A. representative

    B. inhabitants

    C. artistically

    D. atmosphere

    Key: C (artistically)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from II: The Marketplace, paragraph 10: "On the breast of her gown, in fine red cloth, _____ with an elaborate embroidery and fantastic flourishes of gold-thread, appeared the letter A"

    Key: surrounded

19. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where did Hester live before Boston?

    Sample answer: In England and then Amsterdam, with her older husband.

20. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from II: The Marketplace, paragraph 8: "Hush, now, _____! for the lock is turning in the prison-door, and here comes Mistress Prynne herself."

    Word bank: inhabitants, gossips, months, warrant

    Key: gossips

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from II: The Marketplace, paragraph 5? "Madam Hester would have winced at that, I _____ me."

    A. heathenish

    B. warrant

    C. anticipated

    D. statute

Key: B (warrant)

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from II: The Marketplace, paragraph 11: "It had the effect of a spell, taking her out of the ordinary _____ with humanity, and enclosing her in a sphere by herself"

    Key: relations

23. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from II: The Marketplace, paragraph 1 reveal about the character or situation? "Amongst any other population, or at a later period in the history of New England, the grim rigidity that petrified the bearded physiognomies of these good people would have augured some awful business in hand." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 1) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art. The words "physiognomies" and "population" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

24. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from II: The Marketplace, paragraph 11 reveal about the character or situation? "The young woman was tall, with a figure of perfect elegance on a large scale." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 11) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art. The words "elegance" and "perfect" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in "II: The Marketplace"? Hester emerges with dignity, the letter 'fantastically embroidered,' refusing to shrink.

    A. Symbolism
    B. Characterization
    C. Alliteration
    D. Simile

    Key: B (Characterization)

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from II: The Marketplace, paragraph 3 shapes its tone: "Goodwives,' said a hard-featured dame of fifty, 'I'll tell ye a piece of my mind." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "featured" (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 3) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from II: The Marketplace, paragraph 9 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: "The door of the jail being flung open from within, there appeared, in the first place, like a black shadow emerging into sunshine, the grim and grisly presence of the town-beadle, with a sword by his side, and his staff of office in his…" Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 9) develops hypocrisy and truth: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art. Its words "emerging" and "presence" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Stretching forth the official staff in his left hand, he laid his right upon the shoulder of a young woman, whom he…" (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 9), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

28. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Hester carry?

    A. A rose

    B. A candle

    C. A Bible

    D. Her baby

    Key: D (Her baby)

29. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from II: The Marketplace, paragraph 2: "The bright morning sun, therefore, shone on broad shoulders and well-developed busts, and on round and ruddy cheeks, that had ripened in the far-off island, and had hardly yet grown paler or thinner in the _____ of New England." Word bank: warrant, atmosphere, anticipated, spectators

    Key: atmosphere

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from II: The Marketplace, paragraph 11 shapes its tone: "Her attire, which, indeed, she had wrought for the occasion, in prison, and had modelled much after her own fancy, seemed to express the attitude of her spirit, the desperate recklessness of her mood, by its wild and picturesque…" Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "recklessness" and "picturesque" (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 11) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

31. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from II: The Marketplace, paragraph 1 shapes its tone: "On the other hand, a penalty, which, in our days, would infer a degree of mocking infamy and ridicule, might then be invested with almost as stern a dignity as the punishment of death itself." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "punishment" and "invested" (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 1) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how public shame and private identity develops from The Customhouse to II: The Marketplace. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Earlier, in The Customhouse, paragraph 9, the text reads "A writer of storybooks! What kind of a business in life … may that be", which shows his imagined ancestors' contempt for him. In II: The Marketplace, "On the breast of her gown, in fine red cloth, surrounded with an elaborate embroidery and fantastic flourishes of gold-thread, appeared the…" (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 10) — First description of the letter. Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art.

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from II: The Marketplace, paragraph 17 to the story's treatment of women and independence: "Measured by the prisoner's experience, however, it might be reckoned a journey of some length" Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 17) develops women and independence: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art. Its words "experience" and "prisoner" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "It stood nearly beneath the eaves of Boston's earliest church, and appeared to be a fixture there." (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 17), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

34. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "II: The Marketplace"?

    A. The frame narrative and the found letter

    B. The interview in prison

    C. Hester on the scaffold

    D. The forest walk

    Key: C (Hester on the scaffold)

35. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from II: The Marketplace, paragraph 15 shapes its tone: "The grim beadle now made a gesture with his staff." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "gesture" and "beadle" (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 15) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

36. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Is the crowd's judgment justice or cruelty? Argue.

    Sample answer: A reasoned position using the women's speeches and the narrator's comments. The evidence is "On the breast of her gown, in fine red cloth, surrounded with an elaborate embroidery and fantastic flourishes of gold-thread, appeared the…" (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 10) — First description of the letter. This develops public shame and private identity: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art. Instead of a plain badge she wears a letter with "fantastic flourishes of gold thread," and it has "the effect of a spell" that sets her "in a sphere by herself.".

37. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from II: The Marketplace, paragraph 1? "In either case, there was very much the same solemnity of demeanor on the part of the _____"

    A. spectators

    B. statute

    C. heathenish

    D. inhabitants

    Key: A (spectators)

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from II: The Marketplace, paragraph 18 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: "Knowing well her part, she ascended a flight of wooden steps, and was thus displayed to the surrounding multitude, at about the height of a man's shoulders above the street." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 18) develops hypocrisy and truth: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art. Its words "surrounding" and "multitude" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "The scene was not without a mixture of awe, such as must always invest the spectacle of guilt and shame in a…" (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 20), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

39. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] In the line "The age had not so much refinement, that any sense of impropriety restrained the wearers of petticoat and farthingale from stepping forth into the public ways, and wedging their not unsubstantial persons, if occasion…", what does "farthingale" most nearly mean?

    A. a hooped frame worn under a skirt to make it stand out

    B. keeps causing bitter pain

    C. a title for a married woman of ordinary rank (Mrs.)

D. like a shifting series of dreamlike images

Key: A (a hooped frame worn under a skirt to make it stand out)

40. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “On the breast of her gown, in fine red cloth, surrounded with an elaborate embroidery and fantastic flourishes of gold-thread, appeared the letter A” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 10)

    A. The question the letter's "new sense" raises.

    B. First description of the letter.

    C. Why Hester names her Pearl.

    D. Hester's fear of him.

    Key: B (First description of the letter.)

41. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: Hester turns her punishment into a statement of identity. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “It had the effect of a spell, taking her out of the ordinary relations with humanity, and enclosing her in a sphere by herself” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 11).

    Sample answer: Instead of a plain badge she wears a letter with "fantastic flourishes of gold thread," and it has "the effect of a spell" that sets her "in a sphere by herself.". The evidence is “It had the effect of a spell, taking her out of the ordinary relations with humanity, and enclosing her in a sphere by herself” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 11), which shows the letter isolates Hester. This develops public shame and private identity: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art.

42. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Connect this passage from II: The Marketplace, paragraph 5 to the story's treatment of women and independence: “But she—the naughty baggage—little will she care what they put upon the bodice of her gown!” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 5) develops women and independence: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art. Its words “baggage” and “naughty” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Ah, but,’ interposed, more softly, a young wife, holding a child by the hand, ‘let her cover the mark as she will, the…” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 6), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

43. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Analyze the word choice in “It had the effect of a spell, taking her out of the ordinary relations with humanity, and enclosing her in a sphere by herself” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 11). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: The letter isolates Hester. The evidence is “It had the effect of a spell, taking her out of the ordinary relations with humanity, and enclosing her in a sphere by herself” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 11). This develops public shame and private identity: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art. The words “enclosing” and “relations” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 11, inference 2, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 18, 19, 4, 6, 20, 21, 22, 23, 13, 12, 24, 15, 25, 26, 27	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	8, 7, 20, 19, 28, 29, 17, 18, 24, 13, 23, 30, 31, 26, 32, 33	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2

HS Junior	6, 20, 28, 21, 10, 2, 34, 23, 24, 13, 35, 15, 30, 26, 36, 33	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	18, 4, 5, 7, 37, 22, 23, 13, 24, 30, 31, 15, 35, 33, 27, 38	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	29, 5, 39, 13, 23, 24, 40, 35, 25, 41, 30, 15, 32, 27, 33, 36	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	5, 20, 28, 23, 34, 13, 40, 31, 15, 30, 26, 35, 32, 33, 38, 42	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	5, 37, 3, 40, 13, 24, 35, 31, 14, 30, 15, 36, 42, 33, 27, 38	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	17, 5, 3, 8, 23, 26, 31, 15, 14, 30, 32, 38, 33, 36, 42, 27	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	5, 3, 8, 28, 14, 30, 35, 31, 26, 15, 38, 36, 32, 42, 27, 33	recall 4, inference 0, analysis 6, synthesis 6
Graduate / PhD	11, 5, 3, 8, 34, 23, 15, 43, 26, 31, 27, 32, 42, 38, 33, 36	recall 4, inference 2, analysis 4, synthesis 6

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “II: The Marketplace,” how does Hawthorne show Hester on the scaffold? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In II: The Marketplace, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of Hester on the scaffold? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how II: The Marketplace develops the idea of Hester on the scaffold. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of II: The Marketplace (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Hester on the scaffold. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what II: The Marketplace suggests about Hester on the scaffold. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses characterization in II: The Marketplace to complicate the reader's understanding of

Hester on the scaffold. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate II: The Marketplace within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of Hester on the scaffold responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read II: The Marketplace alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of Hester on the scaffold follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to II: The Marketplace and its treatment of Hester on the scaffold. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and imagery, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads II: The Marketplace as evidence for a larger claim about Hester on the scaffold in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads II: The Marketplace as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of Hester on the scaffold. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

SAT-style questions

1. *In our nature, however, there is a provision, alike marvellous and merciful, that the sufferer should never know the intensity of what he endures by its present torture, but chiefly by the pang that rankles after it.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “rankles” most nearly mean?

   A. fullness and roundness (here, of bold, loud speech)

   B. keeps causing bitter pain

   C. having a face of a certain kind

   D. a person who breaks a law or moral rule

2. *“Mercy on us, goodwife,” exclaimed a man in the crowd, “is there no virtue in woman, save what springs from a wholesome fear of the gallows? That is the hardest word yet! Hush, now, gossips! for the lock is turning in the prison-door, and here comes Mistress Prynne herself.”*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “II: The Marketplace”?

   A. The prison door and the rose

   B. The minister in a maze

   C. Hester at her needle

D. Hester on the scaffold

SAT key: 1. B (keeps causing bitter pain); 2. D (Hester on the scaffold)

Lesson 6: III: The Recognition

Focus: the recognition

Objective: Students will analyze how irony develops in “III: The Recognition” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

Hester sees a small, deformed stranger at the edge of the crowd, dressed partly in Native clothing; he recognizes her and signals her to be silent. He learns her story from a townsman. The Reverend John Wilson and the young minister Arthur Dimmesdale urge Hester to name the child's father. Dimmesdale pleads with emotion, but Hester refuses, and Wilson preaches on sin while she endures.

Background: Ministers and magistrates shared authority in the colony; Governor Bellingham presided, and John Wilson was a real minister of the First Church of Boston.

Significance: Dramatic irony runs through Dimmesdale's plea once the reader knows the truth.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why might someone protect a person who has wronged them? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to hypocrisy and truth because....
Prompt: Why might someone protect a person who has wronged them?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to hypocrisy and truth because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: behooves — is right or necessary for; meetinghouse — a Puritan building used for worship and town meetings; disarray — untidy mixture or confusion; skullcap — a small, close-fitting cap; halberds — long spears with an axe blade, carried by guards. “disarray”: Origin: Middle English disareyen (“to disarray”); earlier Old French desareer.
Words: behooves: is right or necessary for · meetinghouse: a Puritan building used for worship and town meetings · disarray: untidy mixture or confusion · skullcap: a small, close-fitting cap · halberds: long spears with an axe blade, carried by guards

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Ministers and magistrates shared authority in the colony; Governor Bellingham presided, and John Wilson was a real minister of the First Church of Boston. Dramatic irony runs through Dimmesdale's plea once the reader knows the truth. Characterization: A deformed, learned stranger in the crowd recognizes Hester and signals her to be silent. Irony: Dimmesdale, urged to make Hester name her partner, pleads with her to do it. Conflict: Hester refuses: "I will not speak!" Watch for the scarlet letter: The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "object of severe and universal observation, the wearer of the scarlet letter was at length relieved, by discerning, on the outskirts of" (III: The Recognition, paragraph 1).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Speak, woman ... Speak; and give your child a father" slowly and put it in my own words: Dimmesdale urges Hester to speak and name the father of her child. Next, craft. I notice the repeated command "Speak," spoken by the very man who is the father. The strongest word is "father": it is the word that names his own secret. Then, effect. What is Dimmesdale asking of Hester in public, and why is it ironic? My answer: In public, Dimmesdale asks Hester to name her partner, and it is ironic because he is that partner; he asks her to reveal what he is too weak to confess, and her silence protects him.

> *Speak, woman ... Speak; and give your child a father* (III: The Recognition, paragraph 31)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Speak, woman … Speak; and give your child a father" slowly and put it in my own words: Dimmesdale urges Hester to speak and name the father of her child. Next, craft. I notice the repeated command "Speak," spoken by the very man who is the father. The strongest word is "father": it is the word that names his own secret. Then, effect. What is Dimmesdale asking of Hester in public, and why is it ironic? My answer: In public, Dimmesdale asks Hester to name her partner, and it is ironic because he is that partner; he asks her to reveal what he is too weak to confess, and her silence protects him.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Hester wishes she could bear "his agony, as well as mine," showing she protects the father. Expected link: dramatic irony and hypocrisy and truth. Ask: How does this line connect to hypocrisy and truth? Expected: The man who begs her to speak is the man she protects. (Hester's answer, full of irony for the reader who will learn the truth.)

> *Never… It is too deeply branded. Ye cannot take it off. And would that I might endure his agony, as well as mine (III: The Recognition, paragraph 30)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Hester wishes she could bear "his agony, as well as mine," showing she protects the father. Expected link: dramatic irony and hypocrisy and truth.
Ask: How does this line connect to hypocrisy and truth?
Expected answer: The man who begs her to speak is the man she protects. (Hester's answer, full of irony for the reader who will learn the truth.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the recognition? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how III: The Recognition develops the idea of the recognition. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment. When the text says “for, believe me, Hester, though he were to step down from a high place, and stand there beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame, yet better were it so than to hide a guilty heart through life” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 26), it shows this directly. He says it is better to stand "beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame" than "to hide a guilty heart through life," and Hester answers "I will not speak!"
Task: Annotate the chapter for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the recognition? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how III: The Recognition develops the idea of the recognition. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment. When the text says “for, believe me, Hester, though he were to step down from a high place, and stand there beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame, yet better were it so than to hide a guilty heart through life” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 26), it shows this directly. He says it is better to stand "beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame" than "to hide a guilty heart through life," and Hester answers "I will not speak!"

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Why might someone protect a person who has wronged them? On a second reading, which lines change meaning once you know who the father is?
Anchor question: Why might someone protect a person who has wronged them?
Facilitation: On a second reading, which lines change meaning once you know who the father is?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the recognition? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment. ("for, believe me, Hester, though he were to step down from a high place, and stand there beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame, yet better were it so than to hid", III: The Recognition, paragraph 26). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the recognition? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment. ("for, believe me, Hester, though he were to step down from a high place, and stand there beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame, yet better were it so than to hid", III: The Recognition, paragraph 26). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes the recognition. Key takeaway: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** A deformed, learned stranger in the crowd recognizes Hester and signals her to be silent.
- **Irony:** Dimmesdale, urged to make Hester name her partner, pleads with her to do it.
- **Conflict:** Hester refuses: "I will not speak!"

Themes and how they develop

- **hypocrisy and truth:** the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects.

Symbols and motifs

- **the scarlet letter:** The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter:

"object of severe and universal observation, the wearer of the scarlet letter was at length relieved, by discerning, on the outskirts of" (III: The Recognition, paragraph 1).

- **light and darkness:** Sunshine avoids Hester but plays around Pearl; the forest is dim; the minister's vigil happens at midnight under a meteor. In this chapter: "in the quiet gleam of the fireside, in the happy shadow of a home, or beneath a matronly veil, at church. Dreadful" (III: The Recognition, paragraph 15).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Speak, woman … Speak; and give your child a father" (III: The Recognition, paragraph 31) Mr. Wilson presses Hester.
- "I will not speak" (III: The Recognition, paragraph 32) Hester's refusal.
- "Never … It is too deeply branded. Ye cannot take it off. And would that I might endure his agony, as well as mine" (III: The Recognition, paragraph 30) Hester's answer, full of irony for the reader who will learn the truth.
- "for, believe me, Hester, though he were to step down from a high place, and stand there beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame, yet better were it so than to hide a guilty heart through life" (III: The Recognition, paragraph 26) Dimmesdale's double-edged plea.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment.
Evidence: "for, believe me, Hester, though he were to step down from a high place, and stand there beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame, yet better were it so than to hide a guilty heart through life" (III: The Recognition, paragraph 26)
Reasoning: He says it is better to stand "beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame" than "to hide a guilty heart through life," and Hester answers "I will not speak!"

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
behooves (verb)	is right or necessary for	*"It behooves him well, if he be still in life," responded the townsman.*	
meetinghouse (noun)	a Puritan building used for worship and town meetings	*It has already been noticed, that directly over the platform on which Hester Prynne stood was a kind of balcony, or open gallery, appended to the meetinghouse.*	
disarray (noun)	untidy mixture or confusion	*By the Indian's side, and evidently sustaining a companionship with him, stood a white man, clad in a strange disarray of civilized and savage costume.*	"disarray": Origin: Middle English disareyen ("to disarray"); earlier Old French desareer. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/disarray#Etymology)

skullcap (noun)	a small, close-fitting cap	*There he stood, with a border of grizzled locks beneath his skullcap; while his gray eyes, accustomed to the shaded light of his study, were winking, like those of Hester's infant, in the unadulterated sunshine.*	
halberds (noun)	long spears with an axe blade, carried by guards	*Here, to witness the scene which we are describing, sat Governor Bellingham himself, with four sergeants about his chair, bearing halberds, as a guard of honor.*	
remorselessly (adverb)	without pity, without stopping	*In this state, the voice of the preacher thundered remorselessly, but unavailingly, upon her ears.*	
unadulterated (adjective)	pure; not mixed with anything weaker	*There he stood, with a border of grizzled locks beneath his skullcap; while his gray eyes, accustomed to the shaded light of his study, were winking, like those of Hester's infant, in the unadulterated sunshine.*	
tremulously (adverb)	shakily, nervously	*The young pastor's voice was tremulously sweet, rich, deep, and broken.*	

Discussion questions

1. Why might someone protect a person who has wronged them?
2. Where does irony appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with women and independence?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does the townsman say about Hester's husband? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He was a learned man who sent her ahead and never arrived; he may be lost at sea.
2. Who recognizes Hester from the crowd? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A deformed stranger

3. What does the stranger signal? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Silence
4. Who pleads with Hester to name the father? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Dimmesdale
5. What is Hester's answer? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: She will not speak
6. Where has the stranger been held? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: In captivity among Native people
7. Retell the three most important events of "III: The Recognition" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Hester sees a small, deformed stranger at the edge of the crowd, dressed partly in Native clothing; he recognizes her and signals her to be silent. He learns her story from a townsman. The Reverend John Wilson and the young minister Arthur Dimmesdale urge Hester to name the child's father. Dimmesdale pleads with emotion, but Hester refuses, and Wilson preaches on sin while she endures.
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "III: The Recognition"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "III: The Recognition" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: ""It behooves him well, if he be still in life," responded the townsman." What does "behooves" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: behooves: is right or necessary for.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why is Dimmesdale's plea ironic? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: He is the father, urging her to name him while he hides.
2. What does "III: The Recognition" suggest about the recognition? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Dramatic irony runs through Dimmesdale's plea once the reader knows the truth.
3. Find one example of irony in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
4. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about the recognition? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment. Useful evidence: "Speak, woman … Speak; and give your child a father" (III: The Recognition, paragraph 31): Mr. Wilson presses Hester. On characterization: A deformed, learned stranger in the crowd recognizes Hester and signals her to be silent. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "From this intense consciousness of being the object of severe and universal observation, the wearer of the scarlet letter was at length relieved, by discerning, on the outskirts…", why

might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

6. What causes the main turn in “III: The Recognition”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Hester sees a small, deformed stranger at the edge of the crowd, dressed partly in Native clothing; he recognizes her and signals her to be silent. He learns her story from a townsman. The Reverend John Wilson and the young minister Arthur Dimmesdale urge Hester to name the child's father.…
7. How does “III: The Recognition” build on “II: The Marketplace”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment. Useful evidence: “I will not speak” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 32): Hester's refusal. Theme link: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment. Useful evidence: “Never … It is too deeply branded. Ye cannot take it off. And would that I might endure his agony, as well as mine” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 30): Hester's answer, full of irony for the reader who will learn the truth. On characterization: A deformed, learned stranger in the crowd recognizes Hester and signals her to be silent. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Why might someone protect a person who has wronged them?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does conflict appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with women and independence? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment. Useful evidence: “for, believe me, Hester, though he were to step down from a high place, and stand there beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame, yet better were it so than to hide a guilty heart through life” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 26): Dimmesdale's double-edged plea. On conflict: Hester refuses: "I will not speak!" Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Hester's silence admirable or harmful? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view weighing loyalty against truth.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment. Useful evidence: “Speak, woman … Speak; and give your child a father” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 31): Mr. Wilson presses Hester. Theme link: the man who begs her to speak is the

man she protects. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “Dramatic irony runs through Dimmesdale's plea once the reader knows the truth.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment. Useful evidence: “I will not speak” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 32): Hester's refusal. Theme link: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment. Useful evidence: “Never … It is too deeply branded. Ye cannot take it off. And would that I might endure his agony, as well as mine” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 30): Hester's answer, full of irony for the reader who will learn the truth. On characterization: A deformed, learned stranger in the crowd recognizes Hester and signals her to be silent. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Rewrite one moment of “III: The Recognition” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the recognition? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment. Useful evidence: “for, believe me, Hester, though he were to step down from a high place, and stand there beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame, yet better were it so than to hide a guilty heart through life” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 26): Dimmesdale's double-edged plea. Theme link: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “III: The Recognition”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment. Useful evidence: “Speak, woman … Speak; and give your child a father” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 31): Mr. Wilson presses Hester. Theme link: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to sin and guilt: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment. Useful evidence: “I will not speak” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 32): Hester's refusal. Theme link: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the irony in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment. Useful evidence: “Never … It is too deeply branded. Ye cannot take it off. And would that I might endure his agony, as well as mine” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 30): Hester's answer, full of irony for the reader who will learn the truth. On irony: Dimmesdale, urged to make Hester name her partner, pleads with her to do it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “III: The Recognition” treats the recognition with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment. Useful evidence: “for, believe me, Hester, though he were to step down from a high place, and stand there beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame, yet better were it so than to hide a guilty heart through life” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 26): Dimmesdale's double-edged plea. Theme link: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “IV: The Interview” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment. Useful evidence: “Speak, woman … Speak; and give your child a father” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 31): Mr. Wilson presses Hester. Theme link: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the recognition? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment. Useful evidence: “I will not speak” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 32): Hester's refusal. Theme link: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who recognizes Hester from the crowd?

   A. Mistress Hibbins

B. Pearl

C. Governor Bellingham

D. A deformed stranger

Key: D (A deformed stranger)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where has the stranger been held?

A. In England

B. At sea only

C. In prison

D. In captivity among Native people

Key: D (In captivity among Native people)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "In this state, the voice of the preacher thundered _____, but unavailingly, upon her ears." Word bank: remorselessly, disarray, meetinghouse, behooves

Key: remorselessly

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from III: The Recognition, paragraph 31: "Speak, woman … Speak; and give your child a _____"

Key: father

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "'It behooves him well, if he be still in life,' responded the townsman.", what does "behooves" most nearly mean?

A. belonging to a small, inner circle

B. is right or necessary for

C. keeps causing bitter pain

D. moral weakness

Key: B (is right or necessary for)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from III: The Recognition, paragraph 30: "Never … It is too deeply _____. Ye cannot take it off. And would that I might endure his agony, as well as mine"

Key: branded

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "It has already been noticed, that directly over the platform on which Hester Prynne stood was a kind of balcony, or open gallery, appended to the meetinghouse.", what does "meetinghouse" most nearly mean?

A. put out (a fire)

B. a poisonous plant

C. holy, like a saint

D. a Puritan building used for worship and town meetings

Key: D (a Puritan building used for worship and town meetings)

8. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the townsman say about Hester's husband?

Sample answer: He was a learned man who sent her ahead and never arrived; he may be lost at sea.

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “By the Indian’s side, and evidently sustaining a companionship with him, stood a white man, clad in a strange disarray of civilized and savage costume.”, what does “disarray” most nearly mean?

   A. ran and skipped playfully

   B. a person who speaks for someone else

   C. untidy mixture or confusion

   D. a reddish glow

   Key: C (untidy mixture or confusion)

10. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from III: The Recognition, paragraph 26: “for, believe me, Hester, though he were to step down from a high place, and stand there beside thee, on thy _____ of shame, yet better were it so than to hide a guilty heart through life”

    Key: pedestal

11. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “There he stood, with a border of grizzled locks beneath his skullcap; while his gray eyes, accustomed to the shaded light of his study, were winking, like those of Hester’s infant, in the _____ sunshine.” Word bank: meetinghouse, behooves, disarray, unadulterated

    Key: unadulterated

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why is Dimmesdale's plea ironic?

    Sample answer: He is the father, urging her to name him while he hides. The evidence is “for, believe me, Hester, though he were to step down from a high place, and stand there beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame, yet better…” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 26) — Dimmesdale's double-edged plea.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “I will not speak” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 32) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Hester's refusal. The evidence is “I will not speak” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 32). This develops hypocrisy and truth: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? The man who begs her to speak is the man she protects.

    A. Sin and guilt

    B. Hypocrisy and truth

    C. Public shame and private identity

    D. Nature and the individual against society

    Key: B (Hypocrisy and truth)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which literary element does this describe in “III: The Recognition”? Dimmesdale, urged to make Hester name her partner, pleads with her to do it.

    A. Structure

    B. Tone / mood

    C. Setting

    D. Irony

    Key: D (Irony)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how hypocrisy and truth develops from II: The Marketplace to III: The Recognition. Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: Earlier, in II: The Marketplace, paragraph 10, the text reads "On the breast of her gown, in fine red cloth, surrounded with an elaborate embroidery and fantastic flourishes of gold-thread, appeared the…" — First description of the letter. In III: The Recognition, "Speak, woman … Speak; and give your child a father" (III: The Recognition, paragraph 31) — Mr. Wilson presses Hester. The man who begs her to speak is the man she protects.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Here, to witness the scene which we are describing, sat Governor Bellingham himself, with four sergeants about his chair, bearing _____, as a guard of honor." Word bank: disarray, meetinghouse, halberds, behooves
    Key: halberds

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from III: The Recognition, paragraph 3? "At his arrival in the _____, and some time before she saw him, the stranger had bent his eyes on Hester Prynne."
    A. marketplace
    B. southward
    C. intelligence
    D. wherefore

    Key: A (marketplace)

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from III: The Recognition, paragraph 3: "When he found the eyes of Hester Prynne fastened on his own, and saw that she appeared to _____ him, he slowly and calmly raised his finger, made a gesture with it in the air, and laid it on his lips." Word bank: misguidance, intelligence, perceiving, recognize
    Key: recognize

20. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from III: The Recognition, paragraph 1: "From this intense _____ of being the object of severe and universal observation, the wearer of the scarlet letter was at length relieved, by discerning, on the outskirts of the crowd, a figure which irresistibly took possession of her thoughts." Word bank: ignominious, consciousness, marketplace, scandal
    Key: consciousness

21. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from III: The Recognition, paragraph 9: "And who, by your favor, Sir, may be the father of yonder babe—it is some three or four months old, I should judge—which Mistress Prynne is _____ in her arms?" Word bank: scandal, ignominious, holding, perceiving
    Key: holding

22. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in III: The Recognition?
    A. "He was small in stature, with a furrowed visage, which, as yet, could hardly be termed aged."
    B. "Although, by a seemingly careless arrangement of his heterogeneous garb, he had endeavored to conceal or abate the peculiarity, it was…"
    C. "There was a remarkable intelligence in his features, as of a person who had so cultivated his mental part that it could not fail to mould…"
    D. "From this intense consciousness of being the object of severe and universal observation, the wearer of the scarlet letter was at length…"

    Key: D ("From this intense consciousness of being the object of severe and universal observation, the wearer of the scarlet letter was at length…")

23. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from III: The Recognition, paragraph 20 reveal about the character or situation? “There was a murmur among the dignified and reverend occupants of the balcony; and Governor Bellingham gave expression to its purport, speaking in an authoritative voice, although tempered with respect towards the youthful clergyman whom he…” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The passage (III: The Recognition, paragraph 20) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects. The words “authoritative” and “expression” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

24. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from III: The Recognition, paragraph 15 shapes its tone: “Such an interview, perhaps, would have been more terrible than even to meet him as she now did, with the hot, midday sun burning down upon her face, and lighting up its shame” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “interview” and “terrible” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 15) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

25. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “Never … It is too deeply branded. Ye cannot take it off. And would that I might endure his agony, as well as mine” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 30). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Hester's answer, full of irony for the reader who will learn the truth. The evidence is “Never … It is too deeply branded. Ye cannot take it off. And would that I might endure his agony, as well as mine” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 30). This develops hypocrisy and truth: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects. The words “branded” and “cannot” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is Hester's silence admirable or harmful? Argue.
    Sample answer: A reasoned view weighing loyalty against truth. The evidence is “Never … It is too deeply branded. Ye cannot take it off. And would that I might endure his agony, as well as mine” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 30) — Hester's answer, full of irony for the reader who will learn the truth. This develops hypocrisy and truth: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects. He says it is better to stand "beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame" than "to hide a guilty heart through life," and Hester answers "I will not speak!".

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is Hester's answer?

    A. She confesses everything

    B. She will not speak

    C. She faints

    D. She names him

    Key: B (She will not speak)

28. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from III: The Recognition, paragraph 7? “I have met with grievous mishaps by sea and land, and have been long held in bonds among the heathen-folk, to the _____; and am now brought hither by this Indian, to be redeemed out of my captivity.”

    A. wherefore

    B. consciousness

    C. forgetting

D. southward

Key: D (southward)

29. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from III: The Recognition, paragraph 8 reveal about the character or situation? “To this purpose, he sent his wife before him, remaining himself to look after some necessary affairs.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: The passage (III: The Recognition, paragraph 8) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects. The words “necessary” and “remaining” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

30. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Speak, woman … Speak; and give your child a father” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 31) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: Mr. Wilson presses Hester. The evidence is “Speak, woman … Speak; and give your child a father” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 31). This develops hypocrisy and truth: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects.

31. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from III: The Recognition, paragraph 11 shapes its tone: “The learned man,’ observed the stranger, with another smile, ‘should come himself, to look into the mystery.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words “stranger” and “observed” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 11) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

32. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from III: The Recognition, paragraph 22 shapes its tone: “Therefore, so far as his duties would permit, he trod in the shadowy bypaths, and thus kept himself simple and childlike” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words “childlike” and “bypaths” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 22) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I will not speak” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 32) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: Hester's refusal. The evidence is “I will not speak” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 32). This develops hypocrisy and truth: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects. The words “speak” and “will” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He says it is better to stand "beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame" than "to hide a guilty heart through life," and Hester answers "I will not speak!".

34. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “The young pastor’s voice was _____ sweet, rich, deep, and broken.” Word bank: tremulously, meetinghouse, behooves, disarray
Key: tremulously

35. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from III: The Recognition, paragraph 2 shapes its tone: “Although, by a seemingly careless arrangement of his heterogeneous garb, he had endeavored to conceal or abate the peculiarity, it was sufficiently evident to Hester Prynne, that one of this man’s shoulders rose higher than the other.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words “heterogeneous” and “sufficiently” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 2) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

36. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Speak, woman … Speak; and give your child a father” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 31) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Mr. Wilson presses Hester. The evidence is “Speak, woman … Speak; and give your child a father” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 31). This develops hypocrisy and truth: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects. The words “father” and “child” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He says it is better to stand "beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame" than "to hide a guilty heart through life," and Hester answers "I will not speak!".

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “for, believe me, Hester, though he were to step down from a high place, and stand there beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame, yet better were it so than to…” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 26) supports it: He says it is better to stand "beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame" than "to hide a guilty heart through life," and Hester answers "I will not speak!". But “Never … It is too deeply branded. Ye cannot take it off. And would that I might endure his agony, as well as mine” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 30) complicates it: Hester's answer, full of irony for the reader who will learn the truth, and its “Never” marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. Weighing the two passages, the claim survives, but only once it admits the tension the second passage creates.

38. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Never … It is too deeply branded. Ye cannot take it off. And would that I might endure his agony, as well as mine” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 30)

    A. Hester's answer, full of irony for the reader who will learn the truth.

    B. The cost of falseness.

    C. Dimmesdale after meeting Mistress Hibbins.

    D. The letter's failure as a punishment.

    Key: A (Hester's answer, full of irony for the reader who will learn the truth.)

39. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “for, believe me, Hester, though he were to step down from a high place, and stand there beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame, yet better were it so than to hide a guilty heart through life” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 26).

    Sample answer: He says it is better to stand "beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame" than "to hide a guilty heart through life," and Hester answers "I will not speak!". The evidence is “for, believe me, Hester, though he were to step down from a high place, and stand there beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame, yet better…” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 26) — Dimmesdale's double-edged plea. This develops hypocrisy and truth: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from III: The Recognition, paragraph 3 to the story's treatment of women and independence: “A writhing horror twisted itself across his features, like a snake gliding swiftly over them, and making one little pause, with all its wreathed intervolutions in open sight.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (III: The Recognition, paragraph 3) develops women and independence: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects. Its words “intervolutions” and “writhing” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “After a brief space, the convulsion grew almost imperceptible, and finally subsided into the depths of his nature.” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 3), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

41. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from III: The Recognition, paragraph 17 to the story's treatment of women and independence: “He wore a dark feather in his hat, a border of embroidery on his cloak, and a black velvet tunic beneath; a gentleman advanced in years, with a hard experience written in his wrinkles.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (III: The Recognition, paragraph 17) develops women and independence: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects. Its words “embroidery” and “experience” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “They were, doubtless, good men, just and sage.” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 17), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

42. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Connect this passage from III: The Recognition, paragraph 6 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: “You must needs be a stranger in this region, friend,’ answered the townsman, looking curiously at the questioner and his savage companion, ‘else you would surely have heard of Mistress Hester Prynne, and her evil doings.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (III: The Recognition, paragraph 6) develops hypocrisy and truth: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects. Its words “questioner” and “companion” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “I am a stranger, and have been a wanderer, sorely against my will.” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 7), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

43. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Connect this passage from III: The Recognition, paragraph 18 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: “He looked like the darkly engraved portraits which we see prefixed to old volumes of sermons” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (III: The Recognition, paragraph 18) develops hypocrisy and truth: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects. Its words “portraits” and “prefixed” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “But he opposes to me (with a young man’s over-softness, albeit wise beyond his years), that it were wronging the very…” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 19), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

44. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] What does the stranger signal?

    A. Danger
    B. Escape
    C. Silence
    D. Love

    Key: C (Silence)

45. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “III: The Recognition”? A deformed, learned stranger in the crowd recognizes Hester and signals her to be silent.

    A. Theme
    B. Characterization
    C. Setting
    D. Metaphor

    Key: B (Characterization)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	

		recall 11, inference 2, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 18, 3, 19, 20, 7, 21, 1, 12, 22, 13, 23, 24, 15, 25, 26	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	27, 28, 1, 21, 8, 3, 29, 23, 30, 12, 22, 31, 25, 32, 33, 16	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	27, 34, 10, 11, 28, 18, 29, 12, 22, 23, 15, 24, 32, 35, 33, 16	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	21, 28, 19, 20, 9, 23, 29, 22, 12, 14, 24, 15, 35, 36, 33, 37	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	3, 17, 7, 38, 12, 29, 13, 35, 31, 39, 14, 15, 40, 41, 37, 26	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	17, 4, 1, 13, 38, 22, 29, 39, 35, 15, 31, 14, 40, 42, 41, 43	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	3, 44, 17, 38, 23, 12, 14, 39, 35, 15, 32, 16, 40, 26, 37, 43	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	1, 27, 17, 3, 22, 39, 24, 25, 35, 14, 42, 40, 33, 37, 41, 16	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	20, 17, 1, 38, 14, 24, 45, 31, 39, 40, 41, 43, 16, 26, 37, 42	recall 3, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	28, 17, 3, 1, 15, 31, 32, 14, 35, 16, 37, 26, 42, 43, 41, 40	recall 4, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 7

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “III: The Recognition,” how does Hawthorne show the recognition? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1, W.9-10.1): In III: The Recognition, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of the recognition? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1, W.9-10.1): Analyze how III: The Recognition develops the idea of the recognition. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of III: The Recognition (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of the recognition. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what III: The Recognition suggests about the recognition. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's irony and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses irony in III: The Recognition to complicate the reader's understanding of the recognition. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate III: The Recognition within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the recognition responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read III: The Recognition alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the recognition follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to III: The Recognition and its treatment of the recognition. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's irony and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads III: The Recognition as evidence for a larger claim about the recognition in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads III: The Recognition as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the recognition. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

SAT-style questions

1. *By the Indian's side, and evidently sustaining a companionship with him, stood a white man, clad in a strange disarray of civilized and savage costume.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "disarray" most nearly mean?

   A. shakily, nervously

   B. without pity, without stopping

   C. pure; not mixed with anything weaker

   D. untidy mixture or confusion

2. *From this intense consciousness of being the object of severe and universal observation, the wearer of the scarlet letter was at length relieved, by discerning, on the outskirts of the crowd, a figure which irresistibly took possession of her thoughts. An Indian, in his native garb, was standing there; but the red men were not so infrequent visitors of the English settlements, that one of them would have attracted any notice from Hester Prynne, at such a time; much less would he have excluded all other objects and ideas from her mind. By the Indian's side, and evidently sustaining a companionship with him, stood a white man, clad in a strange disarray of civilized and savage costume.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "III: The Recognition"?

A. The child at the brook-side
B. The interior of a heart
C. The interview in prison
D. The recognition

SAT key: 1. D (untidy mixture or confusion); 2. D (The recognition)

Lesson 7: IV: The Interview

Focus: the interview in prison

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in "IV: The Interview" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): This section mentions drinking or a drug ("…essons of my own, that were as old as Paracelsus. Drink it! It may be less soothing than a sinl…"). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: This section mentions drinking or a drug.
Suggested language: "What does this detail add to the scene?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Back in prison Hester is frantic. The stranger, now calling himself Roger Chillingworth, a physician, calms the baby and Hester with medicines. He admits he wronged her by marrying her young, but vows to discover her lover. He makes her swear to keep his identity secret.

Background: Physicians were scarce in early Massachusetts; knowledge of herbs, including Native remedies, gave Chillingworth authority.

Significance: Chillingworth's calm, rational revenge begins here and will make him the novel's worst sinner.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Is revenge ever justified when you have also done wrong? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to sin and guilt because.... Content note before we start: This section mentions drinking or a drug.
Prompt: Is revenge ever justified when you have also done wrong?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to sin and guilt because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: tossings — restless turning movements; trundle — (trundle-bed) a low bed on wheels kept under another bed; ligaments — bonds or ties connecting people; outskirt — outer edge or border; unclasp — open the fastening of. "ligaments": Origin of "ligament": Latin ligāmentum. "unclasp": Origin: an English formation from un- + clasp.
Words: tossings: restless turning movements · trundle: (trundle-bed) a low bed on wheels kept under another bed · ligaments: bonds or ties connecting people · outskirt: outer edge or border · unclasp: open the fastening of

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Physicians were scarce in early Massachusetts; knowledge of herbs, including Native remedies, gave Chillingworth authority. Chillingworth's calm, rational revenge begins here and will make him the novel's worst sinner. Characterization: Chillingworth, now a physician, visits Hester in prison and calms Pearl with a draught. Foreshadowing: He vows to find the father: "Sooner or later, he must needs be mine!" Conflict: Husband and wife admit their mutual wrong; he extracts her promise of secrecy about his identity. Watch for the scarlet letter: The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "to the prison, Hester Prynne was found to be in a state of nervous excitement that demanded constant watchfulness, lest she should" (IV: The Interview, paragraph 1).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Mine was the first wrong, when I betrayed thy budding youth into a false and unnatural relation with my decay" slowly and put it in my own words: Chillingworth tells Hester that he wronged her first by marrying her youth to his old age. Next, craft. I notice he contrasts "budding youth" with "my decay," images of spring and rot. The strongest word is "decay": it shows how he sees himself, old and withered beside her. Then, effect. What does Chillingworth admit about his own guilt? My answer: Chillingworth admits his own guilt in marrying Hester, young and unloving, when he was old and misshapen; the admission makes him seem reasonable but sets up his cold plan to punish her partner.

> *Mine was the first wrong, when I betrayed thy budding youth into a false and unnatural relation with my decay (IV: The Interview, paragraph 20)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Mine was the first wrong, when I betrayed thy budding youth into a false and unnatural relation with my decay" slowly and put it in my own words: Chillingworth tells Hester that he wronged her first by marrying her youth to his old age. Next, craft. I notice he contrasts "budding youth" with "my decay," images of spring and rot. The strongest word is "decay": it shows how he sees himself, old and withered beside her. Then, effect. What does Chillingworth admit about his own guilt? My answer: Chillingworth admits his own guilt in marrying Hester, young and unloving, when he was old and misshapen; the admission makes him seem reasonable but sets up his cold plan to punish her partner.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: His vow. Look at the craft: He vows to find the father: "Sooner or later, he must needs be mine!" Ask: How does this line connect to sin and guilt? Expected: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins. (His vow.)

> *Sooner or later, he must needs be mine (IV: The Interview, paragraph 22)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: His vow. Look at the craft: He vows to find the father: "Sooner or later, he must needs be mine!"
Ask: How does this line connect to sin and guilt?
Expected answer: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins. (His vow.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for characterization, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the interview in prison? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how IV: The Interview develops the idea of the interview in prison. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his revenge more chilling. When the text says “Art thou like the Black Man that haunts the forest round about us” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 33), it shows this directly. He admits "Mine was the first wrong," yet vows that the unknown father "must needs be mine," and Hester can only ask whether he is "the Black Man that haunts the forest."
Task: Annotate the chapter for characterization, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the interview in prison? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how IV: The Interview develops the idea of the interview in prison. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his revenge more chilling. When the text says “Art thou like the Black Man that haunts the forest round about us” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 33), it shows this directly. He admits "Mine was the first wrong," yet vows that the unknown father "must needs be mine," and Hester can only ask whether he is "the Black Man that haunts the forest."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Is revenge ever justified when you have also done wrong? Ask: is Chillingworth a wronged husband with a right to anger, or a villain from the start?
Anchor question: Is revenge ever justified when you have also done wrong?
Facilitation: Ask: is Chillingworth a wronged husband with a right to anger, or a villain from the start?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the interview in prison? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his revenge more chilling. (“Art thou like the Black Man that haunts the forest round about us”, IV: The Interview, paragraph 33). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the interview in prison? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his revenge more chilling. (“Art thou like the Black Man that haunts the forest round about us”, IV: The Interview, paragraph 33). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes the interview in prison. Key takeaway: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Chillingworth, now a physician, visits Hester in prison and calms Pearl with a draught.
- **Foreshadowing:** He vows to find the father: "Sooner or later, he must needs be mine!"
- **Conflict:** Husband and wife admit their mutual wrong; he extracts her promise of secrecy about his identity.

Themes and how they develop

- **sin and guilt:** Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins.

Symbols and motifs

- **the scarlet letter:** The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: “to the prison, Hester Prynne was found to be in a state of nervous excitement that demanded constant watchfulness, lest she should” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 1).
- **light and darkness:** Sunshine avoids Hester but plays around Pearl; the forest is dim; the minister's vigil happens at midnight under a meteor. In this chapter: “Never, sayest thou?” rejoined he, with a smile of dark and self-relying intelligence. “Never know him! Believe me, Hester, there are” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 22).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Mine was the first wrong, when I betrayed thy budding youth into a false and unnatural relation with my decay" (IV: The Interview, paragraph 20) Chillingworth admits his part.
- "Sooner or later, he must needs be mine" (IV: The Interview, paragraph 22) His vow.
- "Art thou like the Black Man that haunts the forest round about us" (IV: The Interview, paragraph 33) Hester's fear of him.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his revenge more chilling.
Evidence: "Art thou like the Black Man that haunts the forest round about us" (IV: The Interview, paragraph 33)
Reasoning: He admits "Mine was the first wrong," yet vows that the unknown father "must needs be mine," and Hester can only ask whether he is "the Black Man that haunts the forest."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
tossings (noun)	restless turning movements	*The moans of the little patient subsided; its convulsive tossings gradually ceased; and, in a few moments, as is the custom of young children after relief from pain, it sank into a profound and dewy slumber.*	
trundle (adjective)	(trundle-bed) a low bed on wheels kept under another bed	*His first care was given to the child; whose cries, indeed, as she lay writhing on the trundle-bed, made it of peremptory necessity to postpone all other business to the task of soothing her.*	
ligaments (noun)	bonds or ties connecting people	*Here, on this wild outskirt of the earth, I shall pitch my tent; for, elsewhere a wanderer, and isolated from human interests, I find here a woman, a man, a child, amongst whom and myself there exist the closest ligaments.*	"ligaments": Origin of "ligament": Latin ligāmentum. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/ligament#Etymology)
outskirt (noun)	outer edge or border	*Here, on this wild outskirt of the earth, I shall pitch my tent; for, elsewhere a wanderer, and isolated from human interests, I find here a woman, a man, a child, amongst whom and myself there exist the closest ligaments.*	
unclasp (verb)	open the fastening of		"unclasp": Origin: an English formation from un- + clasp. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://

		He examined the infant carefully, and then proceeded to unclasp a leathern case, which he took from beneath his dress.	en.wiktionary.org/wiki/unclasp#Etymology)
philosophized (verb)	reasoned about life in a thoughtful, abstract way	*Therefore, as a man who has not thought and philosophized in vain, I seek no vengeance, plot no evil against thee.*	
sagamores (noun)	chiefs of some Algonquian peoples of New England	*He was lodged in the prison, not as suspected of any offence, but as the most convenient and suitable mode of disposing of him, until the magistrates should have conferred with the Indian sagamores respecting his ransom.*	

Discussion questions

1. Is revenge ever justified when you have also done wrong?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with sin and guilt?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Chillingworth admit? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: That he wronged her first by marrying her youth to his decay.
2. Who is the stranger? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Hester's husband
3. What name does he take? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Roger Chillingworth
4. What does he give the baby? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A soothing draught
5. What does he make Hester promise? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: To keep his identity secret
6. What does he vow? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: To find her lover
7. Retell the three most important events of "IV: The Interview" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Back in prison Hester is frantic. The stranger, now calling himself Roger Chillingworth, a physician, calms the baby and Hester with medicines. He admits he wronged her by marrying her young, but vows to discover her lover. He makes her swear to keep his identity secret.

8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “IV: The Interview”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “IV: The Interview” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: “The moans of the little patient subsided; its convulsive tossings gradually ceased; and, in a few moments, as is the custom of young children after relief from pain, it sank into a profound and dewy slumber.” What does “tossings” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: tossings: restless turning movements.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Hester fear his drink at first? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: She thinks he may poison her or the child.
2. What does “IV: The Interview” suggest about the interview in prison? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Chillingworth's calm, rational revenge begins here and will make him the novel's worst sinner.
3. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the foreshadowing in this chapter shape what we understand about the interview in prison? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his revenge more chilling. Useful evidence: “Mine was the first wrong, when I betrayed thy budding youth into a false and unnatural relation with my decay” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 20): Chillingworth admits his part. On foreshadowing: He vows to find the father: "Sooner or later, he must needs be mine!" Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Closely following the jailer into the dismal apartment appeared that individual, of singular aspect, whose presence in the crowd had been of such deep interest to the wearer of…”, why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “IV: The Interview”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Back in prison Hester is frantic. The stranger, now calling himself Roger Chillingworth, a physician, calms the baby and Hester with medicines. He admits he wronged her by marrying her young, but vows to discover her lover. He makes her swear to keep his identity secret.
7. How does “IV: The Interview” build on “III: The Recognition”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his revenge more chilling. Useful evidence: “Sooner or later, he must needs be mine” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 22): His vow. Theme link: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his

revenge begins. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his revenge more chilling. Useful evidence: “Art thou like the Black Man that haunts the forest round about us” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 33): Hester's fear of him. On characterization: Chillingworth, now a physician, visits Hester in prison and calms Pearl with a draught. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Is revenge ever justified when you have also done wrong?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does conflict appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with sin and guilt? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his revenge more chilling. Useful evidence: “Mine was the first wrong, when I betrayed thy budding youth into a false and unnatural relation with my decay” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 20): Chillingworth admits his part. On conflict: Husband and wife admit their mutual wrong; he extracts her promise of secrecy about his identity. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Who is more to blame for the broken marriage? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view using both speeches.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his revenge more chilling. Useful evidence: “Sooner or later, he must needs be mine” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 22): His vow. Theme link: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Chillingworth's calm, rational revenge begins here and will make him the novel's worst sinner.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his revenge more chilling. Useful evidence: “Art thou like the Black Man that haunts the forest round about us” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 33): Hester's fear of him. Theme link: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his revenge more chilling. Useful evidence: “Mine was the first wrong, when I betrayed thy budding youth into a false and unnatural relation with my decay” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 20): Chillingworth admits his part. On characterization: Chillingworth, now a physician, visits Hester in prison and calms Pearl with a draught. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Rewrite one moment of “IV: The Interview” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the interview in prison? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his revenge more chilling. Useful evidence: “Sooner or later, he must needs be mine” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 22): His vow. Theme link: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “IV: The Interview”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his revenge more chilling. Useful evidence: “Art thou like the Black Man that haunts the forest round about us” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 33): Hester's fear of him. Theme link: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to public shame and private identity: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his revenge more chilling. Useful evidence: “Mine was the first wrong, when I betrayed thy budding youth into a false and unnatural relation with my decay” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 20): Chillingworth admits his part. Theme link: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his revenge more chilling. Useful evidence: “Sooner or later, he must needs be mine” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 22): His vow. On characterization: Chillingworth, now a physician, visits Hester in prison and calms Pearl with a draught. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “IV: The Interview” treats the interview in prison with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his

revenge more chilling. Useful evidence: “Art thou like the Black Man that haunts the forest round about us” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 33): Hester's fear of him. Theme link: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “V: Hester at Her Needle” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his revenge more chilling. Useful evidence: “Mine was the first wrong, when I betrayed thy budding youth into a false and unnatural relation with my decay” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 20): Chillingworth admits his part. On foreshadowing: He vows to find the father: "Sooner or later, he must needs be mine!" Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the interview in prison? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his revenge more chilling. Useful evidence: “Sooner or later, he must needs be mine” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 22): His vow. Theme link: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from IV: The Interview, paragraph 5: “It appeared to contain medical _____, one of which he mingled with a cup of water.” Word bank: questioning, medicine, preparations, conscience

   Key: preparations

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Therefore, as a man who has not thought and _____ in vain, I seek no vengeance, plot no evil against thee.” Word bank: philosophized, ligaments, tossings, trundle

   Key: philosophized

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “The moans of the little patient subsided; its convulsive tossings gradually ceased; and, in a few moments, as is the custom of young children after relief from pain, it sank into a profound and dewy slumber.”, what does “tossings” most nearly mean?

   A. fully satisfying

   B. raised to the level of a god; idolized

C. restless turning movements

D. open metal helmets worn by soldiers

Key: C (restless turning movements)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What name does he take?

   A. John Wilson

   B. Richard Bellingham

   C. Arthur Dimmesdale

   D. Roger Chillingworth

   Key: D (Roger Chillingworth)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does he give the baby?

   A. A blessing

   B. A rose

   C. A soothing draught

   D. A toy

   Key: C (A soothing draught)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who is the stranger?

   A. Dimmesdale's father

   B. Hester's husband

   C. A sailor

   D. The governor

   Key: B (Hester's husband)

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from IV: The Interview, paragraph 20: “Mine was the first wrong, when I betrayed thy budding youth into a false and _____ relation with my decay”

   Key: unnatural

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from IV: The Interview, paragraph 1: “After her return to the prison, Hester Prynne was found to be in a state of nervous excitement that demanded constant _____, lest she should perpetrate violence on herself, or do some half-frenzied mischief to the poor babe.” Word bank: watchfulness, recognize, comparative, convulsions

   Key: watchfulness

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “He examined the infant carefully, and then proceeded to _____ a leathern case, which he took from beneath his dress.”

   Word bank: tossings, trundle, ligaments, unclasp

   Key: unclasp

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from IV: The Interview, paragraph 14 reveal about the character or situation? “Live, therefore, and bear about thy doom with thee, in the eyes of men and women—in the eyes of him whom thou didst call thy husband—in the eyes of yonder child!” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (IV: The Interview, paragraph 14) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins. The words “therefore” and “husband” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from IV: The Interview, paragraph 1 reveal about the character or situation? “As night approached, it proving impossible to quell her insubordination by rebuke or threats of punishment, Master Brackett, the jailer, thought fit to introduce a physician.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The passage (IV: The Interview, paragraph 1) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins. The words “insubordination” and “approached” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.
12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Sooner or later, he must needs be mine” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 22) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: His vow. The evidence is “Sooner or later, he must needs be mine” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 22). This develops sin and guilt: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins.
13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Hester fear his drink at first?
    Sample answer: She thinks he may poison her or the child. The evidence is “Mine was the first wrong, when I betrayed thy budding youth into a false and unnatural relation with my decay” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 20) — Chillingworth admits his part.
14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from IV: The Interview, paragraph 16 shapes its tone: “If sages were ever wise in their own behoof, I might have foreseen all this.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “foreseen” and “behoof” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 16) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.
15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “Art thou like the Black Man that haunts the forest round about us” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 33). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Hester's fear of him. The evidence is “Art thou like the Black Man that haunts the forest round about us” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 33). This develops sin and guilt: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins. The words “haunts” and “forest” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from IV: The Interview, paragraph 10 to the story's treatment of women and independence: “As she still hesitated, being, in fact, in no reasonable state of mind, he took the infant in his arms, and himself administered the draught.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (IV: The Interview, paragraph 10) develops women and independence: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins. Its words “administered” and “reasonable” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “The physician, as he had a fair right to be termed, next bestowed his attention on the mother.” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 10), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.
17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Here, on this wild outskirt of the earth, I shall pitch my tent; for, elsewhere a wanderer, and isolated from human interests, I find here a woman, a man, a child, amongst whom and myself there exist the closest…”, what does “ligaments” most nearly mean?

    A. setting aside; declining to pursue

B. a member of a minister's congregation

C. bonds or ties connecting people

D. harmful

Key: C (bonds or ties connecting people)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from IV: The Interview, paragraph 14? “Are my _____ wont to be so shallow?”

A. purposes

B. medicine

C. described

D. watchfulness

Key: A (purposes)

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does he vow?

A. To become a minister

B. To leave forever

C. To find her lover

D. To forgive everyone

Key: C (To find her lover)

20. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Chillingworth admit?

Sample answer: That he wronged her first by marrying her youth to his decay.

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “IV: The Interview”?

A. The Governor's hall

B. The interview in prison

C. The prison door and the rose

D. An author answering his critics

Key: B (The interview in prison)

22. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from IV: The Interview, paragraph 18 shapes its tone: “It seemed not so wild a dream—old as I was, and sombre as I was, and misshapen as I was—that the simple bliss, which is scattered far and wide, for all mankind to gather up, might yet be mine.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “misshapen” and “scattered” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 18) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from IV: The Interview, paragraph 6 shapes its tone: “My old studies in alchemy,’ observed he, ‘and my sojourn, for above a year past, among a people well versed in the kindly properties of simples, have made a better physician of me than many that claim the medical degree.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “properties” and “physician” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 6) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: Chillingworth admits he

wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how sin and guilt develops from I: The Prison-Door to IV: The Interview. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Earlier, in I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2, the text reads “The founders of a new colony, whatever Utopia of human virtue and happiness they might originally project, have invariably recognized it…”, which shows the opening irony about utopias. In IV: The Interview, “Mine was the first wrong, when I betrayed thy budding youth into a false and unnatural relation with my decay” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 20) — Chillingworth admits his part. Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins.

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from IV: The Interview, paragraph 9? “The _____ is potent for good; and were it my child—yea, mine own, as well as thine!—I could do no better for it.”
    A. beholdest
    B. investigation
    C. medicine
    D. recognize

    Key: C (medicine)

26. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does he make Hester promise?
    A. To name the father
    B. To marry him again
    C. To leave Boston
    D. To keep his identity secret

    Key: D (To keep his identity secret)

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Here, on this wild outskirt of the earth, I shall pitch my tent; for, elsewhere a wanderer, and isolated from human interests, I find here a woman, a man, a child, amongst whom and myself there exist the closest…”, what does “outskirt” most nearly mean?
    A. lacking curiosity (here 'not incurious' means quite curious)
    B. outer edge or border
    C. serving as an introduction to what follows
    D. lights up

    Key: B (outer edge or border)

28. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “He was lodged in the prison, not as suspected of any offence, but as the most convenient and suitable mode of disposing of him, until the magistrates should have conferred with the Indian _____ respecting his ransom.” Word bank: sagamores, ligaments, tossings, trundle
    Key: sagamores

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: Chillingworth's confession of his own wrong makes his revenge more chilling. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Art thou like the Black Man that haunts the forest round about us” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 33).
    Sample answer: He admits "Mine was the first wrong," yet vows that the unknown father "must needs be mine," and Hester can only ask whether he is "the Black Man that haunts the forest.". The evidence is “Art thou like the Black Man that haunts

the forest round about us" (IV: The Interview, paragraph 33) — Hester's fear of him. This develops sin and guilt: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins.

30. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in "IV: The Interview"? Chillingworth, now a physician, visits Hester in prison and calms Pearl with a draught.

    A. Theme

    B. Imagery

    C. Hyperbole

    D. Characterization

    Key: D (Characterization)

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from IV: The Interview, paragraph 24 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: "He bears no letter of infamy wrought into his garment, as thou dost; but I shall read it on his heart." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (IV: The Interview, paragraph 24) develops hypocrisy and truth: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins. Its words "wrought" and "garment" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Neither do thou imagine that I shall contrive aught against his life; no, nor against his fame, if, as I judge, he be a…" (IV: The Interview, paragraph 24), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

32. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from IV: The Interview, paragraph 2? "The jailer, after ushering him into the room, remained a moment, marvelling at the _____ quiet that followed his entrance; for Hester Prynne had immediately become as still as death, although the child continued to moan."

    A. accomplish

    B. comparative

    C. medicine

    D. watchfulness

    Key: B (comparative)

33. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins.

    A. Nature and the individual against society

    B. Public shame and private identity

    C. Hypocrisy and truth

    D. Sin and guilt

    Key: D (Sin and guilt)

34. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from IV: The Interview, paragraph 3 shapes its tone: "Trust me, good jailer, you shall briefly have peace in your house; and, I promise you, Mistress Prynne shall hereafter be more amenable to just authority than you may have found her heretofore." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "heretofore" and "authority" (IV: The Interview, paragraph 3) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

35. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from IV: The Interview, paragraph 22 to the story's treatment of women and independence: “Thou mayest conceal it, too, from the ministers and magistrates, even as thou didst this day, when they sought to wrench the name out of thy heart, and give thee a partner on thy pedestal.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (IV: The Interview, paragraph 22) develops women and independence: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins. Its words “magistrates” and “ministers” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “I shall seek this man, as I have sought truth in books; as I have sought gold in alchemy.” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 22), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

36. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Sooner or later, he must needs be mine” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 22) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: His vow. The evidence is “Sooner or later, he must needs be mine” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 22). This develops sin and guilt: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins. The words “needs” and “later” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He admits "Mine was the first wrong," yet vows that the unknown father "must needs be mine," and Hester can only ask whether he is "the Black Man that haunts the forest.".

37. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Mine was the first wrong, when I betrayed thy budding youth into a false and unnatural relation with my decay” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 20)
    A. Dimmesdale on Pearl's nature.
    B. Chillingworth admits his part.
    C. Pearl links the minister to the letter.
    D. Pearl on the sunshine.

    Key: B (Chillingworth admits his part.)

38. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Which literary element does this describe in “IV: The Interview”? He vows to find the father: ‘Sooner or later, he must needs be mine!’
    A. Point of view
    B. Diction / vocabulary
    C. Foreshadowing
    D. Theme

    Key: C (Foreshadowing)

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Who is more to blame for the broken marriage? Argue.
    Sample answer: A reasoned view using both speeches. The evidence is “Mine was the first wrong, when I betrayed thy budding youth into a false and unnatural relation with my decay” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 20) — Chillingworth admits his part. This develops sin and guilt: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins. He admits "Mine was the first wrong," yet vows that the unknown father "must needs be mine," and Hester can only ask whether he is "the Black Man that haunts the forest.".

40. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What can you infer from this line? “Mine was the first wrong, when I betrayed thy budding youth into a false and unnatural relation with my decay” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 20) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Chillingworth admits his part. The evidence is “Mine was the first wrong, when I betrayed thy budding youth into a false and unnatural relation with my decay” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 20).

41. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Connect this passage from IV: The Interview, paragraph 11 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: “But it will calm the swell and heaving of thy passion, like oil thrown on the waves of a tempestuous sea.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (IV: The Interview, paragraph 11) develops hypocrisy and truth: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins. Its words “tempestuous” and “passion” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “I have thought of death,’ said she—‘have wished for it—would even have prayed for it, were it fit that such as I should…” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 13), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

42. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] In the line “His first care was given to the child; whose cries, indeed, as she lay writhing on the trundle-bed, made it of peremptory necessity to postpone all other business to the task of soothing her.”, what does “trundle” most nearly mean?

    A. restless turning movements

    B. outer edge or border

    C. (trundle-bed) a low bed on wheels kept under another bed

    D. bonds or ties connecting people

    Key: C ((trundle-bed) a low bed on wheels kept under another bed)

43. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Complete the quotation from IV: The Interview, paragraph 33: “Art thou like the Black Man that _____ the forest round about us”

    Key: haunts

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	6, 17, 18, 19, 7, 20, 1, 5, 11, 13, 21, 10, 22, 23, 14, 24	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	25, 5, 4, 26, 27, 8, 28, 12, 11, 13, 10, 29, 30, 23, 24, 31	recall 7, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	7, 9, 32, 25, 6, 12, 21, 11, 13, 10, 33, 23, 14, 34, 31, 35	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	1, 28, 20, 6, 26, 13, 10, 21, 11, 34, 22, 33, 15, 35, 31, 36	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	8, 26, 32, 9, 37, 13, 11, 38, 34, 22, 14, 23, 39, 35, 24, 16	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	28, 2, 6, 4, 5, 40, 10, 38, 22, 23, 15, 34, 35, 16, 41, 36	recall 5, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	42, 1, 9, 6, 4, 12, 29, 14, 33, 34, 23, 16, 24, 31, 35, 39	recall 5, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	25, 43, 9, 6, 11, 14, 22, 33, 34, 38, 24, 35, 31, 39, 41, 16	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	9, 2, 6, 4, 22, 34, 23, 38, 33, 14, 31, 35, 24, 39, 41, 16	recall 4, inference 0, analysis 6, synthesis 6
Graduate / PhD	1, 9, 6, 4, 10, 14, 22, 33, 23, 38, 35, 39, 24, 41, 16, 31	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 6

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “IV: The Interview,” how does Hawthorne show the interview in prison?

Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In IV: The Interview, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of the interview in prison? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how IV: The Interview develops the idea of the interview in prison. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of IV: The Interview (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of the interview in prison. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what IV: The Interview suggests about the interview in prison. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and foreshadowing), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses characterization in IV: The Interview to complicate the reader's understanding of the interview in prison. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate IV: The Interview within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the interview in prison responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read IV: The Interview alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the interview in prison follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to IV: The Interview and its treatment of the interview in prison. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and foreshadowing, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads IV: The Interview as evidence for a larger claim about the interview in prison in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads IV: The Interview as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the interview in prison. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

SAT-style questions

1. *Here, on this wild outskirt of the earth, I shall pitch my tent; for, elsewhere a wanderer, and isolated from human interests, I find here a woman, a man, a child, amongst whom and myself there exist the closest ligaments.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “ligaments” most nearly mean?

   A. open the fastening of

   B. bonds or ties connecting people

   C. chiefs of some Algonquian peoples of New England

   D. reasoned about life in a thoughtful, abstract way

2. *Closely following the jailer into the dismal apartment appeared that individual, of singular aspect, whose presence in the crowd had been of such deep interest to the wearer of the scarlet letter. He was lodged in the prison, not as suspected of any offence, but as the most convenient and suitable mode of disposing of him, until the magistrates should have conferred with the Indian sagamores respecting his ransom. His name was announced as Roger Chillingworth. The jailer, after ushering him into the room, remained a moment, marvelling at the comparative quiet that followed his entrance; for Hester Prynne had immediately become as still as death, although the child continued to moan.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “IV: The Interview”?

   A. Hester and Pearl

   B. The elf-child and the minister

   C. The interview in prison

   D. A flood of sunshine

SAT key: 1. B (bonds or ties connecting people); 2. C (The interview in prison)

Lesson 8: V: Hester at Her Needle

Focus: Hester at her needle

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in "V: Hester at Her Needle" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

Released, Hester chooses to stay. She lives in a lonely cottage on the edge of town and supports herself and Pearl by needlework, which becomes fashionable for everything except wedding veils. She gives to the poor, who insult her. She feels the letter gives her a strange sense of hidden sin in others.

Background: Needlework was one of the few trades open to women. Puritan sumptuary laws limited fine dress, but officials wore rich ceremonial clothing.

Significance: Hester's penance is lonely and endless, yet the letter also gives her insight.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why would someone stay in the place where they were shamed? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to public shame and private identity because....
Prompt: Why would someone stay in the place where they were shamed?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to public shame and private identity because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: emolument — payment for work; earnings; irrepressibly — in a way that cannot be held back; moulder — slowly decay into dust; contumaciously — stubbornly defying authority; emblematic — serving as a symbol. "emolument": Origin: Old French emolument; earlier Latin ēmolumentum. "emblematic": Origin: French emblématique.
Words: emolument: payment for work; earnings · irrepressibly: in a way that cannot be held back · moulder: slowly decay into dust · contumaciously: stubbornly defying authority · emblematic: serving as a symbol

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Needlework was one of the few trades open to women. Puritan sumptuary laws limited fine dress, but officials wore rich ceremonial clothing. Hester's penance is lonely and endless, yet the letter also gives her insight. Characterization: Released, Hester lives on the edge of town, earns her living by needlework and gives to the poor who insult her. Setting: The cottage on the shore, between town and forest. Imagery: The letter as a brand that gives her a "sympathetic knowledge of the hidden sin in other hearts." Watch for the scarlet letter: The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "if meant for no other purpose than to reveal the scarlet letter on her breast. Perhaps there was a more real torture" (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 1).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Here, she said to herself, had been the scene of her guilt, and here should be the scene of her earthly punishment" slowly and put it in my own words: Hester tells herself that the place of her sin should be the place of her punishment. Next, craft. I notice the parallel "here... had been... here should be," which links crime and penance. The strongest word is "punishment": it shows she accepts suffering as a kind of duty. Then, effect. Why does Hester choose to stay in Boston? My answer: Hester stays to face her shame and, the narrator hints, to stay near Dimmesdale; her penance becomes a way of claiming her own life.

> *Here, she said to herself, had been the scene of her guilt, and here should be the scene of her earthly punishment (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 3)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Here, she said to herself, had been the scene of her guilt, and here should be the scene of her earthly punishment" slowly and put it in my own words: Hester tells herself that the place of her sin should be the place of her punishment. Next, craft. I notice the parallel "here... had been... here should be," which links crime and penance. The strongest word is "punishment": it shows she accepts suffering as a kind of duty. Then, effect. Why does Hester choose to stay in Boston? My answer: Hester stays to face her shame and, the narrator hints, to stay near Dimmesdale; her penance becomes a way of claiming her own life.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Hester's needlework is wanted everywhere except for bridal veils. Expected link: irony; the community uses her talent while shunning her. Ask: How does this line connect to public shame and private identity? Expected: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance. (The question the letter's "new sense" raises.)

> *Had Hester sinned alone (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 10)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Hester's needlework is wanted everywhere except for bridal veils. Expected link: irony; the community uses her talent while shunning her.
Ask: How does this line connect to public shame and private identity?
Expected answer: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance. (The question the letter's "new sense" raises.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for characterization, setting (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about Hester at her needle? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how V: Hester at Her Needle develops the idea of Hester at her needle. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others. When the text says “Here, she said to herself, had been the scene of her guilt, and here should be the scene of her earthly punishment” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 3), it shows this directly. She stays because "here should be the scene of her earthly punishment," and feels the letter "had endowed her with a new sense" of hidden sin.
Task: Annotate the chapter for characterization, setting (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about Hester at her needle? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how V: Hester at Her Needle develops the idea of Hester at her needle. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others. When the text says “Here, she said to herself, had been the scene of her guilt, and here should be the scene of her earthly punishment” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 3), it shows this directly. She stays because "here should be the scene of her earthly punishment," and feels the letter "had endowed her with a new sense" of hidden sin.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Why would someone stay in the place where they were shamed? Ask: why doesn't Hester leave? List reasons the narrator gives and reasons he hints at.
Anchor question: Why would someone stay in the place where they were shamed?
Facilitation: Ask: why doesn't Hester leave? List reasons the narrator gives and reasons he hints at.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about Hester at her needle? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others. ("Here, she said to herself, had been the scene of her guilt, and here should be the scene of her earthly punishment", V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 3). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about Hester at her needle? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others. ("Here, she said to herself, had been the scene of her guilt, and here should be the scene of her earthly punishment", V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 3). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes Hester at her needle. Key takeaway: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Released, Hester lives on the edge of town, earns her living by needlework and gives to the poor who insult her.
- **Setting:** The cottage on the shore, between town and forest.
- **Imagery:** The letter as a brand that gives her a "sympathetic knowledge of the hidden sin in other hearts."

Themes and how they develop

- **public shame and private identity:** Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance.

Symbols and motifs

- **the scarlet letter:** The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "if meant for no other purpose than to reveal the scarlet letter on her breast. Perhaps there was a more real torture" (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 1).
- **light and darkness:** Sunshine avoids Hester but plays around Pearl; the forest is dim; the minister's vigil happens at midnight under a meteor. In this chapter: "prison-door was thrown open, and she came

forth into the sunshine, which, falling on all alike, seemed, to her sick and morbid" (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 1).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Here, she said to herself, had been the scene of her guilt, and here should be the scene of her earthly punishment" (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 3) Why she stays.
- "she felt or fancied, then, that the scarlet letter had endowed her with a new sense" (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 11) The letter's "new sense."
- "more intolerable to a woman's heart than that which branded the brow of Cain" (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 8) The biblical allusion: Hester's mark is worse than Cain's.
- "Had Hester sinned alone" (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 10) The question the letter's "new sense" raises.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others.
Evidence: "Here, she said to herself, had been the scene of her guilt, and here should be the scene of her earthly punishment" (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 3)
Reasoning: She stays because "here should be the scene of her earthly punishment," and feels the letter "had endowed her with a new sense" of hidden sin.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
emolument (noun)	payment for work; earnings	*Baby-linen—for babies then wore robes of state—afforded still another possibility of toil and emolument.*	"emolument": Origin: Old French emolument; earlier Latin ēmolumentum. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/emolument#Etymology)
irrepressibly (adverb)	in a way that cannot be held back	*Hester had schooled herself long and well; she never responded to these attacks, save by a flush of crimson that rose irrepressibly over her pale cheek, and again subsided into the depths of her bosom.*	
moulder (verb)	slowly decay into dust	*Her needlework was seen on the ruff of the Governor; military men wore it on their scarfs, and the minister on his band; it decked the baby's little cap; it was shut up, to be mildewed and moulder away, in the coffins of the dead.*	

contumaciously (adverb)	stubbornly defying authority	*Again, a mystic sisterhood would contumaciously assert itself, as she met the sanctified frown of some matron, who, according to the rumor of all tongues, had kept cold snow within her bosom throughout life.*	
emblematic (adjective)	serving as a symbol	*In the array of funerals, too—whether for the apparel of the dead body, or to typify, by manifold emblematic devices of sable cloth and snowy lawn, the sorrow of the survivors—there was a frequent and characteristic demand for such labor as Hester Prynne could supply.*	"emblematic": Origin: French emblématique. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/emblematic#Etymology)
ceremonials (noun)	formal ceremonies	*Vanity, it may be, chose to mortify itself, by putting on, for ceremonials of pomp and state, the garments that had been wrought by her sinful hands.*	"ceremonials": Origin of "ceremonial": Latin caerimōniālis. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/ceremonial#Etymology)
inquisitorial (adjective)	prying and suspicious, like an investigator	*In this little, lonesome dwelling, with some slender means that she possessed, and by the license of the magistrates, who still kept an inquisitorial watch over her, Hester established herself, with her infant child.*	

Discussion questions

1. Why would someone stay in the place where they were shamed?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with public shame and private identity?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Hester dress herself in? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Coarse, plain clothing, with only the letter as ornament.
2. Where does Hester live? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A cottage on the edge of town

3. How does she earn a living? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Needlework
4. For what is her work never used? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Bridal veils
5. How do the poor treat her? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: They insult her
6. What new sense does the letter seem to give her? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Knowledge of hidden sin in others
7. Retell the three most important events of "V: Hester at Her Needle" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Released, Hester chooses to stay. She lives in a lonely cottage on the edge of town and supports herself and Pearl by needlework, which becomes fashionable for everything except wedding veils. She gives to the poor, who insult her. She feels the letter gives her a strange sense of hidden sin in others.
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "V: Hester at Her Needle"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "V: Hester at Her Needle" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: "Baby-linen—for babies then wore robes of state—afforded still another possibility of toil and emolument." What does "emolument" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: emolument: payment for work; earnings.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Hester stay in Boston? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: To make it the scene of her penance, and because her lover is there.
2. What does "V: Hester at Her Needle" suggest about Hester at her needle? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Hester's penance is lonely and endless, yet the letter also gives her insight.
3. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the setting in this chapter shape what we understand about Hester at her needle? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others. Useful evidence: "Here, she said to herself, had been the scene of her guilt, and here should be the scene of her earthly punishment" (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 3): Why she stays. On setting: The cottage on the shore, between town and forest. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "But sometimes, once in many days, or perchance in many months, she felt an eye—a human eye—upon the ignominious brand, that seemed to give a momentary relief, as if half of her…", why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their

connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

6. What causes the main turn in "V: Hester at Her Needle", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Released, Hester chooses to stay. She lives in a lonely cottage on the edge of town and supports herself and Pearl by needlework, which becomes fashionable for everything except wedding veils. She gives to the poor, who insult her. She feels the letter gives her a strange sense of hidden sin in…
7. How does "V: Hester at Her Needle" build on "IV: The Interview"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others. Useful evidence: "she felt or fancied, then, that the scarlet letter had endowed her with a new sense" (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 11): The letter's "new sense." Theme link: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others. Useful evidence: "more intolerable to a woman's heart than that which branded the brow of Cain" (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 8): The biblical allusion: Hester's mark is worse than Cain's. On characterization: Released, Hester lives on the edge of town, earns her living by needlework and gives to the poor who insult her. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: "Why would someone stay in the place where they were shamed?" Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does symbolism appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with public shame and private identity? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others. Useful evidence: "Had Hester sinned alone" (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 10): The question the letter's "new sense" raises. Theme link: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is the letter working as the magistrates intended? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view with evidence from the chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others. Useful evidence: "Here, she said to herself, had been the scene of her guilt, and here should be the scene of her earthly punishment" (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 3): Why she stays. Theme link:

Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “Hester's penance is lonely and endless, yet the letter also gives her insight.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others. Useful evidence: “she felt or fancied, then, that the scarlet letter had endowed her with a new sense” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 11): The letter's "new sense." Theme link: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others. Useful evidence: “more intolerable to a woman’s heart than that which branded the brow of Cain” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 8): The biblical allusion: Hester's mark is worse than Cain's. On characterization: Released, Hester lives on the edge of town, earns her living by needlework and gives to the poor who insult her. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Rewrite one moment of “V: Hester at Her Needle” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about Hester at her needle? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others. Useful evidence: “Had Hester sinned alone” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 10): The question the letter's "new sense" raises. Theme link: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “V: Hester at Her Needle”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others. Useful evidence: “Here, she said to herself, had been the scene of her guilt, and here should be the scene of her earthly punishment” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 3): Why she stays. Theme link: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to hypocrisy and truth: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others. Useful evidence: “she felt or fancied, then, that the scarlet letter had endowed her with a new sense” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 11): The letter's "new sense." Theme link: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others. Useful evidence: “more intolerable to a woman’s heart than that which branded the brow of Cain” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 8): The biblical allusion: Hester's mark is worse than Cain's. On characterization: Released, Hester lives on the edge of town, earns her living by needlework and gives to the poor who insult her. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “V: Hester at Her Needle” treats Hester at her needle with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others. Useful evidence: “Had Hester sinned alone” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 10): The question the letter's "new sense" raises. Theme link: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “VI: Pearl” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others. Useful evidence: “Here, she said to herself, had been the scene of her guilt, and here should be the scene of her earthly punishment” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 3): Why she stays. Theme link: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Hester at her needle? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The letter isolates Hester but also gives her insight into others. Useful evidence: “she felt or fancied, then, that the scarlet letter had endowed her with a new sense” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 11): The letter's "new sense." Theme link: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Hester dress herself in?
   Sample answer: Coarse, plain clothing, with only the letter as ornament.

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Her needlework was seen on the ruff of the Governor; military men wore it on their scarfs, and the minister on his band; it decked the baby’s little cap; it was shut up, to be mildewed and moulder away, in the coffins…”, what does “moulder” most nearly mean?

   A. a complete change of appearance

   B. close, focused attention

   C. never having happened before

   D. slowly decay into dust

   Key: D (slowly decay into dust)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where does Hester live?

   A. In the forest

   B. On a ship

   C. A cottage on the edge of town

   D. The governor's mansion

   Key: C (A cottage on the edge of town)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] For what is her work never used?

   A. Governors' robes

   B. Baby clothes

   C. Bridal veils

   D. Funerals

   Key: C (Bridal veils)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 11: “she felt or _____, then, that the scarlet letter had endowed her with a new sense”

   Key: fancied

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Hester had schooled herself long and well; she never responded to these attacks, save by a flush of crimson that rose irrepressibly over her pale cheek, and again subsided into the depths of her bosom.”, what does “irrepressibly” most nearly mean?

   A. a feeling of awe and dread

   B. in a way that cannot be held back

   C. carrying too heavy a load

   D. cheerful and light

   Key: B (in a way that cannot be held back)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What new sense does the letter seem to give her?

   A. Second sight of the future

   B. A love of crowds

   C. The power to heal

   D. Knowledge of hidden sin in others

   Key: D (Knowledge of hidden sin in others)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “In this little, lonesome dwelling, with some slender means that she possessed, and by the license of the magistrates, who still kept an _____ watch over her, Hester established herself, with her infant child.” Word bank: irrepressibly,

inquisitorial, moulder, emolument

Key: inquisitorial

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 8: “more _____ to a woman’s heart than that which branded the brow of Cain”

   Key: intolerable

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Again, a mystic sisterhood would contumaciously assert itself, as she met the sanctified frown of some matron, who, according to the rumor of all tongues, had kept cold snow within her bosom throughout life.”, what does “contumaciously” most nearly mean?

    A. taking a place or power wrongfully

    B. stubbornly defying authority

    C. sparkling

    D. keeps causing bitter pain

    Key: B (stubbornly defying authority)

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How do the poor treat her?

    A. They thank her

    B. They insult her

    C. They avoid her gifts

    D. They protect her

    Key: B (They insult her)

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Had Hester sinned alone” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 10)

    A. Dimmesdale's argument that Pearl is a blessing.

    B. Pearl on the sunshine.

    C. The question the letter's "new sense" raises.

    D. The cost of falseness.

    Key: C (The question the letter's "new sense" raises.)

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Hester stay in Boston?

    Sample answer: To make it the scene of her penance, and because her lover is there. The evidence is “Here, she said to herself, had been the scene of her guilt, and here should be the scene of her earthly punishment” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 3) — Why she stays.

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “more intolerable to a woman’s heart than that which branded the brow of Cain” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 8). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: The biblical allusion: Hester's mark is worse than Cain's. The evidence is “more intolerable to a woman’s heart than that which branded the brow of Cain” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 8). This develops public shame and private identity: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance. The words “intolerable” and “branded” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “V: Hester at Her Needle”? The cottage on the shore, between town and forest.

    A. Setting

    B. Diction / vocabulary

C. Irony

D. Simile

Key: A (Setting)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “she felt or fancied, then, that the scarlet letter had endowed her with a new sense” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 11) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: The letter's "new sense.". The evidence is “she felt or fancied, then, that the scarlet letter had endowed her with a new sense” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 11). This develops public shame and private identity: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance. The words “scarlet” and “endowed” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. She stays because "here should be the scene of her earthly punishment," and feels the letter "had endowed her with a new sense" of hidden sin.
17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 3: “Here, she said to herself, had been the scene of her guilt, and here should be the scene of her earthly _____”
    Key: punishment
18. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “she felt or fancied, then, that the scarlet letter had endowed her with a new sense” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 11) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The letter's "new sense.". The evidence is “she felt or fancied, then, that the scarlet letter had endowed her with a new sense” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 11).
19. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “V: Hester at Her Needle”? Released, Hester lives on the edge of town, earns her living by needlework and gives to the poor who insult her.
    A. Symbolism
    B. Alliteration
    C. Tone / mood
    D. Characterization

    Key: D (Characterization)
20. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance.
    A. Public shame and private identity
    B. Nature and the individual against society
    C. Hypocrisy and truth
    D. Sin and guilt

    Key: A (Public shame and private identity)
21. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is the letter working as the magistrates intended? Argue.
    Sample answer: A reasoned view with evidence from the chapter. The evidence is “she felt or fancied, then, that the scarlet letter had endowed her with a new sense” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 11), which shows the letter's "new sense.". This develops public shame and private identity: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance. She stays because "here should be the scene of her earthly punishment," and feels the letter "had endowed her with a new sense" of hidden sin.

22. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 1? “She could no longer borrow from the future to help her _____ the present grief.”

    A. looking

    B. future

    C. through

    D. supported

    Key: C (through)

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 5? “Deep ruffs, painfully wrought bands, and gorgeously _____ gloves, were all deemed necessary to the official state of men assuming the reins of power”

    A. embroidered

    B. monument

    C. comparatively

    D. characterized

    Key: A (embroidered)

24. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 4: “A mystic shadow of suspicion _____ attached itself to the spot.” Word bank: immediately, monument, future, embroidered

    Key: immediately

25. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 2: “Her sin, her _____, were the roots which she had struck into the soil.” Word bank: maidenhood, ignominy, comparatively, monument

    Key: ignominy

26. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Here, she said to herself, had been the scene of her guilt, and here should be the scene of her earthly punishment” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 3) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Why she stays. The evidence is “Here, she said to herself, had been the scene of her guilt, and here should be the scene of her earthly punishment” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 3).

27. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 1 reveal about the character or situation? “Her prison-door was thrown open, and she came forth into the sunshine, which, falling on all alike, seemed, to her sick and morbid heart, as if meant for no other purpose than to reveal the scarlet letter on her breast.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 1) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance. The words “sunshine” and “falling” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

28. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 6 reveal about the character or situation? “By degrees, nor very slowly, her handiwork became what would now be termed the fashion.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 6) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance. The words “handiwork” and “degrees” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 2 shapes its tone: "It was as if a new birth, with stronger assimilations than the first, had converted the forest-land, still so uncongenial to every other pilgrim and wanderer, into Hester Prynne's wild and dreary, but lifelong home." Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words "assimilations" and "uncongenial" (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 2) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.
30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 7 shapes its tone: "Much of the time, which she might readily have applied to the better efforts of her art, she employed in making coarse garments for the poor." Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words "employed" and "garments" (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 7) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.
31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 3 to the story's treatment of women and independence: "What she compelled herself to believe—what, finally, she reasoned upon, as her motive for continuing a resident of New England—was half a truth, and half a self-delusion." Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 3) develops women and independence: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance. Its words "continuing" and "compelled" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "It had been built by an earlier settler, and abandoned because the soil about it was too sterile for cultivation, while…" (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 4), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.
32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 9 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: "She grew to have a dread of children; for they had imbibed from their parents a vague idea of something horrible in this dreary woman, gliding silently through the town, with never any companion but one only child." Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 9) develops hypocrisy and truth: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance. Its words "something" and "companion" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Another peculiar torture was felt in the gaze of a new eye." (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 9), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.
33. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "In the array of funerals, too—whether for the apparel of the dead body, or to typify, by manifold _____ devices of sable cloth and snowy lawn, the sorrow of the survivors—there was a frequent and characteristic demand for such labor as Hester Prynne could…" Word bank: emolument, emblematic, moulder, irrepressibly
    Key: emblematic
34. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] How does she earn a living?

    A. Medicine

    B. Teaching

C. Farming

D. Needlework

Key: D (Needlework)

35. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 7 shapes its tone: “This morbid meddling of conscience with an immaterial matter betokened, it is to be feared, no genuine and steadfast penitence, but something doubtful, something that might be deeply wrong, beneath.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words “conscience” and “immaterial” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 7) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

36. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 1 shapes its tone: “Tomorrow would bring its own trial with it; so would the next day, and so would the next; each its own trial, and yet the very same that was now so unutterably grievous to be borne.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words “unutterably” and “grievous” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 1) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 5 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: “Lonely as was Hester’s situation, and without a friend on earth who dared to show himself, she, however, incurred no risk of want.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
Sample answer: This passage (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 5) develops hypocrisy and truth: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance. Its words “situation” and “incurred” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “It was the art—then, as now, almost the only one within a woman’s grasp—of needlework.” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 5), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 8 to the story's treatment of women and independence: “The poor, as we have already said, whom she sought out to be the objects of her bounty, often reviled the hand that was stretched forth to succor them.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
Sample answer: This passage (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 8) develops women and independence: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance. Its words “stretched” and “objects” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “She was patient—a martyr, indeed—but she forbore to pray for her enemies; lest, in spite of her forgiving aspirations,…” (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 8), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Synthesis: trace how public shame and private identity develops from II: The Marketplace to V: Hester at Her Needle. Use one quotation from each.
Sample answer: Earlier, in II: The Marketplace, paragraph 10, the text reads “On the breast of her gown, in fine red cloth, surrounded with an elaborate embroidery and fantastic flourishes of gold-thread, appeared the…” — First description of the letter. In V: Hester at Her Needle, “Here, she said to herself, had been the scene of her guilt, and here should be the scene of

her earthly punishment" (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 3) — Why she stays. Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance.

40. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What does this passage most clearly show? "more intolerable to a woman's heart than that which branded the brow of Cain" (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 8)

    A. The biblical allusion: Hester's mark is worse than Cain's.

    B. Mistress Hibbins to Pearl.

    C. Hawthorne's definition of romance.

    D. First description of the letter.

    Key: A (The biblical allusion: Hester's mark is worse than Cain's.)

41. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Vanity, it may be, chose to mortify itself, by putting on, for _____ of pomp and state, the garments that had been wrought by her sinful hands." Word bank: moulder, ceremonials, irrepressibly, emolument

    Key: ceremonials

42. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Here, she said to herself, had been the scene of her guilt, and here should be the scene of her earthly punishment" (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 3) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Why she stays. The evidence is "Here, she said to herself, had been the scene of her guilt, and here should be the scene of her earthly punishment" (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 3). This develops public shame and private identity: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance. The words "punishment" and "earthly" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. She stays because "here should be the scene of her earthly punishment," and feels the letter "had endowed her with a new sense" of hidden sin.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 11, inference 2, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	11, 17, 5, 3, 2, 6, 7, 1, 10, 13, 12, 18, 19, 14, 20, 21	recall 9, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	22, 7, 23, 24, 5, 25, 26, 13, 27, 28, 12, 20, 29, 30, 31, 32	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	25, 33, 22, 34, 6, 27, 28, 18, 13, 12, 30, 20, 19, 14, 21, 32	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	10, 5, 9, 3, 18, 13, 27, 28, 12, 35, 19, 36, 30, 31, 21, 37	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	3, 17, 10, 33, 27, 12, 28, 35, 36, 30, 19, 14, 37, 31, 38, 39	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	33, 5, 34, 12, 13, 40, 28, 30, 29, 19, 35, 36, 39, 21, 38, 31	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	33, 22, 41, 27, 40, 28, 20, 15, 30, 36, 29, 31, 21, 37, 32, 38	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 5

College Junior	4, 6, 33, 41, 12, 29, 36, 35, 14, 19, 39, 37, 21, 38, 32, 31	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	24, 33, 3, 12, 36, 30, 29, 20, 15, 37, 38, 31, 32, 42, 39, 16	recall 3, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	24, 33, 40, 12, 27, 35, 20, 36, 30, 15, 31, 37, 39, 21, 38, 32	recall 2, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 6

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “V: Hester at Her Needle,” how does Hawthorne show Hester at her needle? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In V: Hester at Her Needle, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of Hester at her needle? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how V: Hester at Her Needle develops the idea of Hester at her needle. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of V: Hester at Her Needle (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Hester at her needle. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what V: Hester at Her Needle suggests about Hester at her needle. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and setting), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses characterization in V: Hester at Her Needle to complicate the reader's understanding of Hester at her needle. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate V: Hester at Her Needle within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of Hester at her needle responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read V: Hester at Her Needle alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of Hester at her needle follows or

bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to V: Hester at Her Needle and its treatment of Hester at her needle. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and setting, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads V: Hester at Her Needle as evidence for a larger claim about Hester at her needle in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads V: Hester at Her Needle as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of Hester at her needle. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

SAT-style questions

1. *Her needlework was seen on the ruff of the Governor; military men wore it on their scarfs, and the minister on his band; it decked the baby's little cap; it was shut up, to be mildewed and moulder away, in the coffins of the dead.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "moulder" most nearly mean?

   A. prying and suspicious, like an investigator

   B. slowly decay into dust

   C. serving as a symbol

   D. formal ceremonies

2. *But sometimes, once in many days, or perchance in many months, she felt an eye—a human eye—upon the ignominious brand, that seemed to give a momentary relief, as if half of her agony were shared. The next instant, back it all rushed again, with still a deeper throb of pain; for, in that brief interval, she had sinned anew. Had Hester sinned alone?*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "V: Hester at Her Needle"?

   A. The physician probes the minister

   B. The recognition

   C. Hester at her needle

   D. Pearl

SAT key: 1. B (slowly decay into dust); 2. C (Hester at her needle)

Lesson 9: VI: Pearl

Focus: Pearl

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in “VI: Pearl” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Critical voice: “Little Pearl is perhaps Hawthorne’s finest poetical creation, and is the very perfection of ideal impishness.” (Edwin Percy Whipple (attrib.; the review is unsigned), critic, *Review of The Scarlet Letter, Graham's Magazine 36:5 (May 1850), "Review of New Books", review*; public domain). Pair with Trollope's entry below: is Pearl a child or a symbol? *Objective:* Analyze Pearl's characterization. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.3

Critical voice: “But Pearl is miraculous,--speaking, acting, and thinking like an elf,--and is therefore, I think, a drawback rather than an aid.” (Anthony Trollope, novelist, *"The Genius of Nathaniel Hawthorne," North American Review 129 (September 1879), pp. 203-22, section on Pearl*; public domain). Argument writing: defend Pearl against Trollope. ("thinking" appears as "think ing" on the source page because of a line-break artifact.) *Objective:* Evaluate whether Pearl works as a realistic child. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1

Teacher only · spoilers

Pearl grows into a beautiful, wild, clever child whom Hester dresses in rich crimson. She has no friends; other children taunt her. She is fascinated by the letter, throwing flowers at it. When Hester asks what she is, Pearl insists she has no Heavenly Father.

Background: Puritans believed children were born in sin and needed strict discipline; Hester's indulgence and Pearl's wildness break both rules.

Significance: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the living form of the letter.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What does a child's behavior reveal about how the child is raised? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to sin and guilt because....
Prompt: What does a child's behavior reveal about how the child is raised?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to sin and guilt because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: imbibing — taking in, as if drinking; inalienable — unable to be taken away; flightiness — changeable, unsteady moodiness; calculable — able to be measured or predicted; guiltiness — the state of being guilty. “inalienable”: Origin: French inaliénable. “calculable”: Origin: an English formation from calculate + -able.
Words: imbibing: taking in, as if drinking · inalienable: unable to be taken away · flightiness: changeable, unsteady moodiness · calculable: able to be measured or predicted · guiltiness: the state of being guilty

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Puritans believed children were born in sin and needed strict discipline; Hester's indulgence and Pearl's wildness break both rules. Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the living form of the letter. Characterization: Pearl is beautiful, wild, intelligent and ungovernable; Hester fears what she has passed on to her. Symbolism: Pearl is dressed in crimson and gold, "the scarlet letter in another form." Diction / vocabulary: Pearl is called an elf, an imp, an airy sprite: the town's vocabulary of the uncanny. Watch for Pearl: "Of great price," purchased with all Hester had; the letter endowed with life.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read “But she named the infant “Pearl,” as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother’s only treasure” slowly and put it in my own words: Hester names her child Pearl because she was bought at great price, with everything Hester had. Next, craft. I notice the biblical echo of the "pearl of great price," something worth all one owns. The strongest word is “treasure”: it shows the child is precious, not shameful, to her. Then, effect. Why does Hester name her daughter Pearl? My answer: The name turns the "sin" into her greatest value; Pearl is both Hester's punishment and her joy.

> *But she named the infant “Pearl,” as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother’s only treasure (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read “But she named the infant “Pearl,” as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother’s only treasure” slowly and put it in my own words: Hester names her child Pearl because she was bought at great price, with everything Hester had. Next, craft. I notice the biblical echo of the "pearl of great price," something worth all one owns. The strongest word is “treasure”: it shows the child is precious, not shameful, to her. Then, effect. Why does Hester name her daughter Pearl? My answer: The name turns the "sin" into her greatest value; Pearl is both Hester's punishment and her joy.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Pearl's refusal of a heavenly father echoes the hidden earthly father. Expected link: symbolism; sin and guilt. Ask: How does this line connect to sin and guilt? Expected: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment. (Hester's answer, which Pearl rejects.)

> *Thy Heavenly Father sent thee (VI: Pearl, paragraph 21)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Pearl's refusal of a heavenly father echoes the hidden earthly father. Expected link: symbolism; sin and guilt.
Ask: How does this line connect to sin and guilt?
Expected answer: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment. (Hester's answer, which Pearl rejects.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for characterization, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about Pearl? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how VI: Pearl develops the idea of Pearl. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin. When the text says "But she named the infant "Pearl," as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother's only treasure" (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1), it shows this directly. Hester names her Pearl "as being of great price,—purchased with all she had," yet asks in fear "Child, what art thou?", and Pearl insists "I have no Heavenly Father!"
Task: Annotate the chapter for characterization, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about Pearl? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how VI: Pearl develops the idea of Pearl. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin. When the text says "But she named the infant "Pearl," as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother's only treasure" (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1), it shows this directly. Hester names her Pearl "as being of great price,—purchased with all she had," yet asks in fear "Child, what art thou?", and Pearl insists "I have no Heavenly Father!"

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What does a child's behavior reveal about how the child is raised? Ask: is Pearl a realistic child, a symbol, or both? Find one sentence that supports each reading.
Anchor question: What does a child's behavior reveal about how the child is raised?
Facilitation: Ask: is Pearl a realistic child, a symbol, or both? Find one sentence that supports each reading.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about Pearl? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin. (“But she named the infant “Pearl,” as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother’s only treasure”, VI: Pearl, paragraph 1). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about Pearl? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin. (“But she named the infant “Pearl,” as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother’s only treasure”, VI: Pearl, paragraph 1). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes Pearl. Key takeaway: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Pearl is beautiful, wild, intelligent and ungovernable; Hester fears what she has passed on to her.
- **Symbolism:** Pearl is dressed in crimson and gold, "the scarlet letter in another form."
- **Diction / vocabulary:** Pearl is called an elf, an imp, an airy sprite: the town's vocabulary of the uncanny.

Themes and how they develop

- **sin and guilt:** Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment.

Symbols and motifs

- **Pearl:** "Of great price," purchased with all Hester had; the letter endowed with life.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “But she named the infant “Pearl,” as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother’s only treasure” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1) Why Hester names her Pearl.
- “Child, what art thou” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 13) Hester's question.
- “Thy Heavenly Father sent thee” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 21) Hester's answer, which Pearl rejects.
- “I have no Heavenly Father” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 23) Pearl's reply.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin.
Evidence: "But she named the infant "Pearl," as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother's only treasure" (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1)
Reasoning: Hester names her Pearl "as being of great price,—purchased with all she had," yet asks in fear "Child, what art thou?", and Pearl insists "I have no Heavenly Father!"

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
imbibing (verb)	taking in, as if drinking	*Hester could only account for the child's character—and even then most vaguely and imperfectly—by recalling what she herself had been, during that momentous period while Pearl was imbibing her soul from the spiritual world, and her bodily frame from its material of earth.*	
inalienable (adjective)	unable to be taken away	*All this enmity and passion had Pearl inherited, by inalienable right, out of Hester's heart.*	"inalienable": Origin: French inaliénable. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/inalienable#Etymology)
flightiness (noun)	changeable, unsteady moodiness	*She could recognize her wild, desperate, defiant mood, the flightiness of her temper, and even some of the very cloud-shapes of gloom and despondency that had brooded in her heart.*	
calculable (adjective)	able to be measured or predicted	*After testing both smiles and frowns, and proving that neither mode of treatment possessed any calculable influence, Hester was ultimately compelled to stand aside, and permit the child to be swayed by her own impulses.*	"calculable": Origin: an English formation from calculate + -able. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/calculable#Etymology)
guiltiness (noun)	the state of being guilty	*Day after day, she looked fearfully into the child's expanding nature, ever dreading to detect some dark and wild peculiarity, that should correspond with the guiltiness to which she owed her being.*	
baffling (adjective)	confusing; impossible to understand	*Heart-smitten at this bewildering and baffling spell, that so often came between herself and her sole treasure, whom she had bought so dear, and who was all her world,*	

		Hester sometimes burst into passionate tears.	
unsearchable (adjective)	too deep to be explored or understood	*At last, her shot being all expended, the child stood still and gazed at Hester, with that little, laughing image of a fiend peeping out—or, whether it peeped or no, her mother so imagined it—from the unsearchable abyss of her black eyes.*	"unsearchable": Origin: an English formation from un- + searchable. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/unsearchable#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. What does a child's behavior reveal about how the child is raised?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with hypocrisy and truth?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. How do the town's children treat Pearl? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: They gather to fling mud and insults; she fights back.
2. Why is she named Pearl? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: She is of great price
3. How does Hester dress Pearl? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: In rich, bright clothes
4. What does Pearl throw at the letter? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Wildflowers
5. Who taunts Pearl? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Puritan children
6. What does Pearl say about a Heavenly Father? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: She has none
7. Retell the three most important events of "VI: Pearl" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Pearl grows into a beautiful, wild, clever child whom Hester dresses in rich crimson. She has no friends; other children taunt her. She is fascinated by the letter, throwing flowers at it. When Hester asks what she is, Pearl insists she has no Heavenly Father.
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "VI: Pearl"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.

9. Where and when does “VI: Pearl” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: “Hester could only account for the child’s character—and even then most vaguely and imperfectly—by recalling what she herself had been, during that momentous period while Pearl was imbibing her soul from the spiritual…” What does “imbibing” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: imbibing: taking in, as if drinking.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Hester worry about Pearl? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: She fears the child inherited her passion and sin.
2. What does “VI: Pearl” suggest about Pearl? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the living form of the letter.
3. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the symbolism in this chapter shape what we understand about Pearl? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin. Useful evidence: “But she named the infant “Pearl,” as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother’s only treasure” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1): Why Hester names her Pearl. On symbolism: Pearl is dressed in crimson and gold, "the scarlet letter in another form." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “The truth was, that the little Puritans, being of the most intolerant brood that ever lived, had got a vague idea of something outlandish, unearthly, or at variance with ordinary…”, why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “VI: Pearl”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Pearl grows into a beautiful, wild, clever child whom Hester dresses in rich crimson. She has no friends; other children taunt her. She is fascinated by the letter, throwing flowers at it. When Hester asks what she is, Pearl insists she has no Heavenly Father.
7. How does “VI: Pearl” build on “V: Hester at Her Needle”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin. Useful evidence: “Child, what art thou” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 13): Hester's question. Theme link: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin. Useful evidence: “Thy Heavenly Father sent thee” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 21): Hester's answer, which

Pearl rejects. On characterization: Pearl is beautiful, wild, intelligent and ungovernable; Hester fears what she has passed on to her. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: "What does a child's behavior reveal about how the child is raised?" Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does diction / vocabulary appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with hypocrisy and truth? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for precise or unusual word choices and their connotations.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin. Useful evidence: "I have no Heavenly Father" (VI: Pearl, paragraph 23): Pearl's reply. On diction / vocabulary: Pearl is called an elf, an imp, an airy sprite: the town's vocabulary of the uncanny. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Pearl a realistic child or a symbol? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view with evidence for both.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin. Useful evidence: "But she named the infant "Pearl," as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother's only treasure" (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1): Why Hester names her Pearl. Theme link: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: "Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the living form of the letter." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin. Useful evidence: "Child, what art thou" (VI: Pearl, paragraph 13): Hester's question. Theme link: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin. Useful evidence: "Thy Heavenly Father sent thee" (VI: Pearl, paragraph 21): Hester's answer, which Pearl rejects. On characterization: Pearl is beautiful, wild, intelligent and ungovernable; Hester fears what she has passed on to her. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Rewrite one moment of "VI: Pearl" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about Pearl? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin. Useful evidence: "I have no Heavenly Father" (VI: Pearl, paragraph 23): Pearl's reply. Theme link:

Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “VI: Pearl”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin. Useful evidence: “But she named the infant “Pearl,” as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother’s only treasure” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1): Why Hester names her Pearl. Theme link: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to nature and the individual against society: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin. Useful evidence: “Child, what art thou” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 13): Hester's question. Theme link: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin. Useful evidence: “Thy Heavenly Father sent thee” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 21): Hester's answer, which Pearl rejects. On characterization: Pearl is beautiful, wild, intelligent and ungovernable; Hester fears what she has passed on to her. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “VI: Pearl” treats Pearl with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin. Useful evidence: “I have no Heavenly Father” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 23): Pearl's reply. Theme link: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “VII: The Governor’s Hall” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin. Useful evidence: “But she named the infant “Pearl,” as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother’s only treasure” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1): Why Hester names her Pearl. Theme link: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Pearl? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin. Useful evidence: "Child, what art thou" (VI: Pearl, paragraph 13): Hester's question. Theme link: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Diction / vocabulary**: precise or unusual word choices and their connotations

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who taunts Pearl?

   A. Sailors

   B. Chillingworth

   C. The governor

   D. Puritan children

   Key: D (Puritan children)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "After testing both smiles and frowns, and proving that neither mode of treatment possessed any calculable influence, Hester was ultimately compelled to stand aside, and permit the child to be swayed by her own impulses.", what does "calculable" most nearly mean?

   A. shut out from society and its protection

   B. promising solemnly

   C. bonds or ties connecting people

   D. able to be measured or predicted

   Key: D (able to be measured or predicted)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Pearl throw at the letter?

   A. Wildflowers

   B. Water

   C. Stones

   D. Mud

   Key: A (Wildflowers)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why is she named Pearl?

   A. She is of great price

   B. After a ship

   C. After her grandmother

   D. For her pale skin

   Key: A (She is of great price)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Pearl say about a Heavenly Father?

   A. She loves him

B. She fears him

C. She has met him

D. She has none

Key: D (She has none)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "At last, her shot being all expended, the child stood still and gazed at Hester, with that little, laughing image of a fiend peeping out—or, whether it peeped or no, her mother so imagined it—from the _____ abyss of her black eyes." Word bank: inalienable, unsearchable, imbibing, flightiness

   Key: unsearchable

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Hester dress Pearl?

   A. In black

   B. Like a boy

   C. In gray

   D. In rich, bright clothes

   Key: D (In rich, bright clothes)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Heart-smitten at this bewildering and _____ spell, that so often came between herself and her sole treasure, whom she had bought so dear, and who was all her world, Hester sometimes burst into passionate tears." Word bank: flightiness, imbibing, baffling, inalienable

   Key: baffling

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Day after day, she looked fearfully into the child's expanding nature, ever dreading to detect some dark and wild peculiarity, that should correspond with the _____ to which she owed her being." Word bank: inalienable, guiltiness, flightiness, imbibing

   Key: guiltiness

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "She could recognize her wild, desperate, defiant mood, the flightiness of her temper, and even some of the very cloud-shapes of gloom and despondency that had brooded in her heart.", what does "flightiness" most nearly mean?

    A. changeable, unsteady moodiness

    B. that cannot be taken away or cancelled

    C. nearness; closeness

    D. damage (a reputation)

    Key: A (changeable, unsteady moodiness)

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Hester could only account for the child's character—and even then most vaguely and imperfectly—by recalling what she herself had been, during that momentous period while Pearl was imbibing her soul from the spiritual…", what does "imbibing" most nearly mean?

    A. dislike or distrust of people

    B. nearness; closeness

    C. taking in, as if drinking

    D. mixed together

Key: C (taking in, as if drinking)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Hester worry about Pearl?
    Sample answer: She fears the child inherited her passion and sin. The evidence is "But she named the infant 'Pearl,' as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother's only treasure" (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1), which shows why Hester names her Pearl.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "Child, what art thou" (VI: Pearl, paragraph 13) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Hester's question. The evidence is "Child, what art thou" (VI: Pearl, paragraph 13). This develops sin and guilt: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Which literary element does this describe in "VI: Pearl"? Pearl is dressed in crimson and gold, 'the scarlet letter in another form.'
    A. Simile
    B. Metaphor
    C. Foreshadowing
    D. Symbolism

    Key: D (Symbolism)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in "VI: Pearl"? Pearl is beautiful, wild, intelligent and ungovernable; Hester fears what she has passed on to her.
    A. Imagery
    B. Characterization
    C. Simile
    D. Allusion

    Key: B (Characterization)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is Pearl a realistic child or a symbol? Argue.
    Sample answer: A reasoned view with evidence for both. The evidence is "But she named the infant 'Pearl,' as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother's only treasure" (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1), which shows why Hester names her Pearl. This develops sin and guilt: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment. Hester names her Pearl "as being of great price,—purchased with all she had," yet asks in fear "Child, what art thou?", and Pearl insists "I have no Heavenly Father!".

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "All this enmity and passion had Pearl inherited, by inalienable right, out of Hester's heart.", what does "inalienable" most nearly mean?
    A. not revealed
    B. lacking curiosity (here 'not incurious' means quite curious)
    C. in a sensible, knowing way
    D. unable to be taken away

    Key: D (unable to be taken away)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from VI: Pearl, paragraph 2: "Throughout all, _____, there was a trait of passion, a certain depth of hue, which she never lost; and if, in any of her changes, she had grown fainter or paler, she would have ceased to be herself—it would have been no longer Pearl!" Word bank: however, illuminated, impassioned, apprehension
    Key: however

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from VI: Pearl, paragraph 3? "They were now _____ by the morning radiance of a young child's disposition, but later in the day of earthly existence might be prolific of the storm and whirlwind."

    A. illuminated

    B. impassioned

    C. apprehension

    D. adaptation

    Key: A (illuminated)

20. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from VI: Pearl, paragraph 4: "As to any other kind of _____, whether addressed to her mind or heart, little Pearl might or might not be within its reach, in accordance with the caprice that ruled the moment." Word bank: discipline, adaptation, misfortunes, picture

    Key: discipline

21. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from VI: Pearl, paragraph 5 reveal about the character or situation? "Not seldom, she would laugh anew, and louder than before, like a thing incapable and unintelligent of human sorrow." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (VI: Pearl, paragraph 5) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment. The words "unintelligent" and "incapable" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

22. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from VI: Pearl, paragraph 1 reveal about the character or situation? "How strange it seemed to the sad woman, as she watched the growth, and the beauty that became every day more brilliant, and the intelligence that threw its quivering sunshine over the tiny features of this child!" Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment. The words "intelligence" and "quivering" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from VI: Pearl, paragraph 6 shapes its tone: "Pearl saw, and gazed intently, but never sought to make acquaintance." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "acquaintance" and "intently" (VI: Pearl, paragraph 6) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

24. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from VI: Pearl, paragraph 3 shapes its tone: "This outward mutability indicated, and did not more than fairly express, the various properties of her inner life." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "properties" and "mutability" (VI: Pearl, paragraph 3) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from VI: Pearl, paragraph 4 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: "Her mother, while Pearl was yet an infant, grew acquainted with a certain peculiar look, that warned her when it would be labor thrown away to insist, persuade, or plead." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (VI: Pearl, paragraph 4) develops hypocrisy and truth: Hester wonders whether her child is a

blessing or a living punishment. Its words “acquainted” and “persuade” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “She seemed rather an airy sprite, which, after playing its fantastic sports for a little while upon the cottage floor,…” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 4), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

26. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How do the town's children treat Pearl?
    Sample answer: They gather to fling mud and insults; she fights back.

27. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from VI: Pearl, paragraph 1: “We have as yet hardly spoken of the infant; that little creature, whose innocent life had sprung, by the _____ decree of Providence, a lovely and immortal flower, out of the rank luxuriance of a guilty passion.” Word bank: inexplicable, unsympathizing, inscrutable, application
    Key: inscrutable

28. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from VI: Pearl, paragraph 1: “But she named the infant ‘Pearl,’ as being of great price—_____ with all she had—her mother’s only treasure”
    Key: purchased

29. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment.
    A. Nature and the individual against society
    B. Public shame and private identity
    C. Hypocrisy and truth
    D. Sin and guilt

    Key: D (Sin and guilt)

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from VI: Pearl, paragraph 8 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: “It was like nothing so much as the phantasmagoric play of the northern lights.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (VI: Pearl, paragraph 8) develops hypocrisy and truth: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment. Its words “phantasmagoric” and “northern” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “The singularity lay in the hostile feelings with which the child regarded all these offspring of her own heart and mind.” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 8), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Child, what art thou” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 13) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Hester's question. The evidence is “Child, what art thou” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 13). This develops sin and guilt: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment. The words “what” and “thou” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Hester names her Pearl "as being of great price,—purchased with all she had," yet asks in fear "Child, what art thou?", and Pearl insists "I have no Heavenly Father!".

32. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “But she named the infant ‘Pearl,’ as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother’s only treasure” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Why Hester names her Pearl. The evidence is “But she named the infant ‘Pearl,’ as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother’s only treasure” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1).

33. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from VI: Pearl, paragraph 2 shapes its tone: “The child had a native grace which does not invariably coexist with faultless beauty; its attire, however simple, always impressed the beholder as if it were the very garb that precisely became it best.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “invariably” and “precisely” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 2) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.
34. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from VI: Pearl, paragraph 4 to the story's treatment of women and independence: “The discipline of the family, in those days, was of a far more rigid kind than now.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (VI: Pearl, paragraph 4) develops women and independence: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment. Its words “discipline” and “family” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Hester Prynne, nevertheless, the lonely mother of this one child, ran little risk of erring on the side of undue…” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 4), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.
35. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from VI: Pearl, paragraph 2? “By its perfect shape, its vigor, and its natural _____ in the use of all its untried limbs, the infant was worthy to have been brought forth in Eden”
    A. dexterity
    B. intangibility
    C. apprehension
    D. impassioned

    Key: A (dexterity)
36. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from VI: Pearl, paragraph 6 shapes its tone: “How soon—with what strange rapidity, indeed!—did Pearl arrive at an age that was capable of social intercourse, beyond the mother’s ever-ready smile and nonsense-words!” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “intercourse” and “rapidity” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 6) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.
37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Synthesis: trace how sin and guilt develops from IV: The Interview to VI: Pearl. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Earlier, in IV: The Interview, paragraph 20, the text reads “Mine was the first wrong, when I betrayed thy budding youth into a false and unnatural relation with my decay” — Chillingworth admits his part. In VI: Pearl, “But she named the infant ‘Pearl,’ as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother’s only treasure” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1), which shows why Hester names her Pearl. Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment.
38. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Analyze the word choice in “Thy Heavenly Father sent thee” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 21). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Hester's answer, which Pearl rejects. The evidence is “Thy Heavenly Father sent thee” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 21). This develops sin and guilt: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment. The words “sent” and “thee” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Connect this passage from VI: Pearl, paragraph 7 to the story's treatment of women and independence: “Mother and daughter stood together in the same circle of seclusion from human society” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (VI: Pearl, paragraph 7) develops women and independence: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment. Its words “seclusion” and “together” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “The spell of life went forth from her ever-creative spirit, and communicated itself to a thousand objects, as a torch…” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 8), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

40. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Which word completes this sentence from VI: Pearl, paragraph 5? “Then, perhaps—for there was no foreseeing how it might affect her—Pearl would frown, and clench her little fist, and harden her small features into a stern, _____ look of discontent.”

    A. unsympathizing

    B. application

    C. apprehension

    D. misfortunes

    Key: A (unsympathizing)

41. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] What does this passage most clearly show? “Thy Heavenly Father sent thee” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 21)

    A. Hester's answer, which Pearl rejects.

    B. The letter's mysterious power.

    C. Chillingworth admits his part.

    D. The author describes the local outrage at "The Customhouse."

    Key: A (Hester's answer, which Pearl rejects.)

42. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “But she named the infant ‘Pearl,’ as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother’s only treasure” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Why Hester names her Pearl. The evidence is “But she named the infant ‘Pearl,’ as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother’s only treasure” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1). This develops sin and guilt: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment. The words “purchased” and “treasure” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Hester names her Pearl "as being of great price,—purchased with all she had," yet asks in fear "Child, what art thou?", and Pearl insists "I have no Heavenly Father!".

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 11, inference 2, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	6, 4, 17, 18, 1, 2, 19, 20, 12, 21, 22, 13, 23, 15, 24, 25	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	8, 26, 27, 6, 1, 28, 2, 20, 12, 21, 22, 15, 14, 29, 30, 31	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	9, 8, 19, 5, 1, 4, 32, 22, 21, 12, 33, 23, 29, 24, 30, 34	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	35, 10, 8, 17, 20, 11, 21, 12, 22, 15, 33, 14, 36, 34, 25, 30	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3

AP	9, 7, 1, 8, 12, 13, 32, 29, 23, 33, 24, 14, 37, 16, 25, 30	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	18, 9, 10, 22, 13, 21, 12, 14, 38, 15, 36, 29, 39, 37, 34, 25	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	9, 40, 8, 12, 21, 29, 15, 33, 38, 14, 39, 25, 31, 30, 37, 34	recall 3, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Junior	6, 3, 9, 4, 41, 23, 15, 33, 24, 36, 39, 25, 30, 37, 16, 42	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	3, 9, 8, 4, 29, 33, 15, 24, 23, 39, 37, 30, 16, 34, 31, 25	recall 4, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	35, 9, 8, 38, 14, 29, 36, 23, 33, 15, 25, 39, 30, 37, 34, 16	recall 3, inference 0, analysis 7, synthesis 6

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "VI: Pearl," how does Hawthorne show Pearl? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In VI: Pearl, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of Pearl? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how VI: Pearl develops the idea of Pearl. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of VI: Pearl (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Pearl. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what VI: Pearl suggests about Pearl. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses characterization in VI: Pearl to complicate the reader's understanding of Pearl. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate VI: Pearl within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of Pearl responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read VI: Pearl alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of Pearl follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to VI: Pearl and its treatment of Pearl. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads VI: Pearl as evidence for a larger claim about Pearl in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads VI: Pearl as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of Pearl. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

SAT-style questions

1. *She could recognize her wild, desperate, defiant mood, the flightiness of her temper, and even some of the very cloud-shapes of gloom and despondency that had brooded in her heart.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “flightiness” most nearly mean?

   A. confusing; impossible to understand

   B. too deep to be explored or understood

   C. the state of being guilty

   D. changeable, unsteady moodiness

2. *The truth was, that the little Puritans, being of the most intolerant brood that ever lived, had got a vague idea of something outlandish, unearthly, or at variance with ordinary fashions, in the mother and child; and therefore scorned them in their hearts, and not unfrequently reviled them with their tongues. Pearl felt the sentiment, and requited it with the bitterest hatred that can be supposed to rankle in a childish bosom. These outbreaks of a fierce temper had a kind of value, and even comfort, for her mother; because there was at least an intelligible earnestness in the mood, instead of the fitful caprice that so often thwarted her in the child's manifestations. It appalled her, nevertheless, to discern here, again, a shadowy reflection of the evil that had existed in herself. All this enmity and passion had Pearl inherited, by inalienable right, out of Hester's heart. Mother and daughter stood together in the same circle of seclusion from human society; and in the nature of the child seemed to be perpetuated those unquiet elements that had distracted Hester Prynne before Pearl's birth, but had since begun to be soothed away by the softening influences of maternity.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “VI: Pearl”?

   A. The minister's vigil

   B. Pearl

C. The frame narrative and the found letter

D. The forest walk

SAT key: 1. D (changeable, unsteady moodiness); 2. B (Pearl)

Lesson 10: VII: The Governor’s Hall

Focus: the Governor's hall

Objective: Students will analyze how setting develops in “VII: The Governor’s Hall” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): This section mentions drinking or a drug (“…ve seen the frothy remnant of a recent draught of ale. On the wall hung a row of portraits, r…”). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: This section mentions drinking or a drug.
Suggested language: “What does this detail add to the scene?”

Teacher only · spoilers

Hearing that the magistrates may take Pearl, Hester brings gloves to Governor Bellingham's mansion. In a polished breastplate she sees the letter grotesquely magnified. Pearl, dressed in scarlet, cries for a red rose in the garden.

Background: Bellingham was governor several times; the narrator notes the English gentleman's attempt to make an English garden in rough soil.

Significance: In authority's mirror the letter dominates who Hester is.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How do people in power see those who are judged? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to public shame and private identity because.... Content note before we start: This section mentions drinking or a drug.
Prompt: How do people in power see those who are judged?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to public shame and private identity because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: frontispiece — the decorated front of a building; frisked — ran and skipped playfully; humoring — going along with (someone) to keep them content; arraying — dressing in fine clothes; cabalistic — mysterious and magical-looking. "cabalistic": Origin: an English formation from cabalist + -ic.
Words: frontispiece: the decorated front of a building · frisked: ran and skipped playfully · humoring: going along with (someone) to keep them content · arraying: dressing in fine clothes · cabalistic: mysterious and magical-looking

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Bellingham was governor several times; the narrator notes the English gentleman's attempt to make an English garden in rough soil. In authority's mirror the letter dominates who Hester is. Setting: Governor Bellingham's mansion, its glittering stucco and the convex breastplate that magnifies the letter. Symbolism: In the armor's curved mirror the scarlet letter appears "in exaggerated and gigantic proportions." Characterization: Bellingham's English garden fails: cabbages and pumpkin vines replace ornament. Watch for the scarlet letter: The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "went, one day, to the mansion of Governor Bellingham, with a pair of gloves, which she had fringed and embroidered to his" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 1).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance" slowly and put it in my own words: In the governor's polished armor, the scarlet letter appears hugely exaggerated, the most prominent part of Hester's appearance. Next, craft. I notice the distortion: the curved armor makes the letter swallow her image. The strongest word is "exaggerated": it shows how her shame dominates how others see her. Then, effect. What does the reflection in the armor show? My answer: The armor reflects society's view: the letter has replaced her as a person; Hawthorne shows how a label can overshadow identity.

> *the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 20)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance" slowly and put it in my own words: In the governor's polished armor, the scarlet letter appears hugely exaggerated, the most prominent part of Hester's appearance. Next, craft. I notice the distortion: the curved armor makes the letter swallow her image. The strongest word is "exaggerated": it shows how her shame dominates how others see her. Then, effect. What does the reflection in the armor show? My answer: The armor reflects society's view: the letter has replaced her as a person; Hawthorne shows how a label can overshadow identity.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The letter grows huge in the mirror, as it does in the eyes of the magistrates. Expected link: symbolism; public shame. Ask: How does this line connect to public shame and private identity? Expected: The letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority. (Pearl's dress.)

> *It was the scarlet letter in another form; the scarlet letter endowed with life* (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 4)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The letter grows huge in the mirror, as it does in the eyes of the magistrates. Expected link: symbolism; public shame.
Ask: How does this line connect to public shame and private identity?
Expected answer: The letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority. (Pearl's dress.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for setting, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the Governor's hall? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how VII: The Governor's Hall develops the idea of the Governor's hall. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity. When the text says "the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 20), it shows this directly. In the breastplate the letter appears "in exaggerated and gigantic proportions," and Pearl herself is "the scarlet letter endowed with life!"
Task: Annotate the chapter for setting, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the Governor's hall? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how VII: The Governor's Hall develops the idea of the Governor's hall. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity. When the text says "the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 20), it shows this directly. In the breastplate the letter appears "in exaggerated and gigantic proportions," and Pearl herself is "the scarlet letter endowed with life!"

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: How do people in power see those who are judged? Ask: why does Hawthorne put the distorting mirror in the Governor's house, not elsewhere?
Anchor question: How do people in power see those who are judged?
Facilitation: Ask: why does Hawthorne put the distorting mirror in the Governor's house, not elsewhere?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the Governor's hall? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity. (“the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance”, VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 20). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the Governor's hall? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity. (“the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance”, VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 20). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how setting shapes the Governor's hall. Key takeaway: the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Setting:** Governor Bellingham's mansion, its glittering stucco and the convex breastplate that magnifies the letter.
- **Symbolism:** In the armor's curved mirror the scarlet letter appears "in exaggerated and gigantic proportions."
- **Characterization:** Bellingham's English garden fails: cabbages and pumpkin vines replace ornament.

Themes and how they develop

- **public shame and private identity:** the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority.

Symbols and motifs

- **the scarlet letter:** The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: “went, one day, to the mansion of Governor Bellingham, with a pair of gloves, which she had fringed and embroidered to his” (VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 1).
- **light and darkness:** Sunshine avoids Hester but plays around Pearl; the forest is dim; the minister's vigil happens at midnight under a meteor. In this chapter: “of broken glass were plentifully intermixed; so that, when the sunshine fell aslant-wise over the front of the edifice, it glittered and” (VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 8).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 20) The mirror in the armor.
- "It was the scarlet letter in another form; the scarlet letter endowed with life" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 4) Pearl's dress.
- "Pearl, seeing the rosebushes, began to cry for a red rose" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 23) Pearl and the rose.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity.
Evidence: "the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 20)
Reasoning: In the breastplate the letter appears "in exaggerated and gigantic proportions," and Pearl herself is "the scarlet letter endowed with life!"

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
frontispiece (noun)	the decorated front of a building	*Little Pearl—who was as greatly pleased with the gleaming armor as she had been with the glittering frontispiece of the house—spent some time looking into the polished mirror of the breastplate.*	
frisked (verb)	ran and skipped playfully	*Often, nevertheless, more from caprice than necessity, she demanded to be taken up in arms; but was soon as imperious to be set down again, and frisked onward before Hester on the grassy pathway, with many a harmless trip and tumble.*	
humoring (verb)	going along with (someone) to keep them content	*Hester looked, by way of humoring the child; and she saw that, owing to the peculiar effect of this convex mirror, the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance.*	
arraying (verb)	dressing in fine clothes	*Her mother, in contriving the child's garb, had allowed the gorgeous tendencies of her imagination their full play; arraying her in a crimson velvet tunic, of a peculiar cut, abundantly embroidered with fantasies and flourishes of gold-thread.*	

cabalistic (adjective)	mysterious and magical-looking	*It was further decorated with strange and seemingly cabalistic figures and diagrams, suitable to the quaint taste of the age, which had been drawn in the stucco when newly laid on, and had now grown hard and durable, for the admiration of after times.*	"cabalistic": Origin: an English formation from cabalist + -ic. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/cabalistic#Etymology)
offshoot (noun)	something that grows out of something else	*There was fire in her and throughout her; she seemed the unpremeditated offshoot of a passionate moment.*	

Discussion questions

1. How do people in power see those who are judged?
2. Where does setting appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with nature and the individual against society?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Who owns the house? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Governor Bellingham.
2. Why does Hester go to the Governor's house? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: To deliver gloves and keep Pearl
3. What magnifies the letter? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A breastplate in a suit of armor
4. What does Pearl cry for? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A red rose
5. What grows in the Governor's garden? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Cabbages and pumpkins
6. What is Pearl's dress like? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The scarlet letter in another form
7. Retell the three most important events of "VII: The Governor's Hall" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Hearing that the magistrates may take Pearl, Hester brings gloves to Governor Bellingham's mansion. In a polished breastplate she sees the letter grotesquely magnified. Pearl, dressed in scarlet, cries for a red rose in the garden.
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "VII: The Governor's Hall"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.

9. Where and when does “VII: The Governor’s Hall” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: “Little Pearl—who was as greatly pleased with the gleaming armor as she had been with the glittering frontispiece of the house—spent some time looking into the polished mirror of the breastplate.” What does “frontispiece” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: frontispiece: the decorated front of a building.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does the letter look gigantic in the armor? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: It reflects how authorities see only her sin.
2. What does “VII: The Governor’s Hall” suggest about the Governor's hall? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: In authority's mirror the letter dominates who Hester is.
3. Find one example of setting in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
4. How does the symbolism in this chapter shape what we understand about the Governor's hall? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity. Useful evidence: “the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance” (VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 20): The mirror in the armor. On symbolism: In the armor's curved mirror the scarlet letter appears "in exaggerated and gigantic proportions." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Hester looked, by way of humoring the child; and she saw that, owing to the peculiar effect of this convex mirror, the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic…”, why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “VII: The Governor’s Hall”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Hearing that the magistrates may take Pearl, Hester brings gloves to Governor Bellingham's mansion. In a polished breastplate she sees the letter grotesquely magnified. Pearl, dressed in scarlet, cries for a red rose in the garden.
7. How does “VII: The Governor’s Hall” build on “VI: Pearl”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity. Useful evidence: “It was the scarlet letter in another form; the scarlet letter endowed with life” (VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 4): Pearl's dress. Theme link: the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a

quoted line.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity. Useful evidence: “Pearl, seeing the rosebushes, began to cry for a red rose” (VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 23): Pearl and the rose. On characterization: Bellingham's English garden fails: cabbages and pumpkin vines replace ornament. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “How do people in power see those who are judged?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with nature and the individual against society? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity. Useful evidence: “the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance” (VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 20): The mirror in the armor. On characterization: Bellingham's English garden fails: cabbages and pumpkin vines replace ornament. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Why does Hawthorne put the distorting mirror in the Governor's house? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view linking power and judgment.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity. Useful evidence: “It was the scarlet letter in another form; the scarlet letter endowed with life” (VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 4): Pearl's dress. Theme link: the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “In authority's mirror the letter dominates who Hester is.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity. Useful evidence: “Pearl, seeing the rosebushes, began to cry for a red rose” (VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 23): Pearl and the rose. Theme link: the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity. Useful evidence: “the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance” (VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 20): The mirror in the armor. On characterization: Bellingham's English garden fails: cabbages and pumpkin vines

replace ornament. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Rewrite one moment of "VII: The Governor's Hall" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the Governor's hall? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity. Useful evidence: "It was the scarlet letter in another form; the scarlet letter endowed with life" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 4): Pearl's dress. Theme link: the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about "VII: The Governor's Hall": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity. Useful evidence: "Pearl, seeing the rosebushes, began to cry for a red rose" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 23): Pearl and the rose. Theme link: the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to women and independence: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity. Useful evidence: "the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 20): The mirror in the armor. Theme link: the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the setting in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity. Useful evidence: "It was the scarlet letter in another form; the scarlet letter endowed with life" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 4): Pearl's dress. On setting: Governor Bellingham's mansion, its glittering stucco and the convex breastplate that magnifies the letter. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how "VII: The Governor's Hall" treats the Governor's hall with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity. Useful evidence: "Pearl, seeing the rosebushes, began to cry for a red rose" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 23): Pearl and the rose. Theme link: the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what "VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister" will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity. Useful evidence: "the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 20): The mirror in the armor. Theme link: the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the Governor's hall? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity. Useful evidence: "It was the scarlet letter in another form; the scarlet letter endowed with life" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 4): Pearl's dress. Theme link: the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "There was fire in her and throughout her; she seemed the unpremeditated _____ of a passionate moment." Word bank: frontispiece, humoring, offshoot, frisked
   Key: offshoot
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Little Pearl—who was as greatly pleased with the gleaming armor as she had been with the glittering frontispiece of the house—spent some time looking into the polished mirror of the breastplate.", what does "frontispiece" most nearly mean?
   A. getting back; recovering
   B. the decorated front of a building
   C. something that flows out
   D. a loud, ringing noise
   Key: B (the decorated front of a building)
3. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who owns the house?
   Sample answer: Governor Bellingham.

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Often, nevertheless, more from caprice than necessity, she demanded to be taken up in arms; but was soon as imperious to be set down again, and frisked onward before Hester on the grassy pathway, with many a harmless…”, what does “frisked” most nearly mean?

   A. focused together on one point

   B. getting back; recovering

   C. ran and skipped playfully

   D. strengthened; given new energy

   Key: C (ran and skipped playfully)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “It was further decorated with strange and seemingly _____ figures and diagrams, suitable to the quaint taste of the age, which had been drawn in the stucco when newly laid on, and had now grown hard and durable, for the admiration of after times.” Word bank: humoring, frontispiece, frisked, cabalistic

   Key: cabalistic

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Hester looked, by way of humoring the child; and she saw that, owing to the peculiar effect of this convex mirror, the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most…”, what does “humoring” most nearly mean?

   A. untidy mixture or confusion

   B. splash (with water or mud)

   C. sadly; mournfully

   D. going along with (someone) to keep them content

   Key: D (going along with (someone) to keep them content)

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 4: “It was the _____ letter in another form; the scarlet letter endowed with life”

   Key: scarlet

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What grows in the Governor's garden?

   A. Nothing

   B. Only roses

   C. Vines of grapes

   D. Cabbages and pumpkins

   Key: D (Cabbages and pumpkins)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 23: “Pearl, seeing the _____, began to cry for a red rose”

   Key: rosebushes

10. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 20: “the scarlet letter was _____ in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance”

    Key: represented

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What magnifies the letter?

    A. A breastplate in a suit of armor

    B. A window

C. A mirror in church

D. A pool

Key: A (A breastplate in a suit of armor)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does the letter look gigantic in the armor?
Sample answer: It reflects how authorities see only her sin. The evidence is "the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 20), which shows the mirror in the armor.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "It was the scarlet letter in another form; the scarlet letter endowed with life" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 4) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: Pearl's dress. The evidence is "It was the scarlet letter in another form; the scarlet letter endowed with life" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 4). This develops public shame and private identity: the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority.

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in "Pearl, seeing the rosebushes, began to cry for a red rose" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 23). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
Sample answer: Pearl and the rose. The evidence is "Pearl, seeing the rosebushes, began to cry for a red rose" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 23). This develops public shame and private identity: the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority. The words "rosebushes" and "seeing" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? The letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority.

A. Public shame and private identity

B. Nature and the individual against society

C. Sin and guilt

D. Hypocrisy and truth

Key: A (Public shame and private identity)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how public shame and private identity develops from V: Hester at Her Needle to VII: The Governor's Hall. Use one quotation from each.
Sample answer: Earlier, in V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 3, the text reads "Here, she said to herself, had been the scene of her guilt, and here should be the scene of her earthly punishment" — Why she stays. In VII: The Governor's Hall, "the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 20), which shows the mirror in the armor. The letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 2? "At that epoch of pristine simplicity, however, matters of even slighter public interest, and of far less intrinsic weight, than the welfare of Hester and her child, were strangely mixed up with the _____ of legislators and acts of state."

A. consequence

B. doubtless

C. deliberations

D. threatening

Key: C (deliberations)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 7? "She screamed and shouted, too, with a terrific volume of sound, which, _____, caused the hearts of the fugitives to quake within them."

    A. guardianship

    B. doubtless

    C. threatening

    D. deliberations

    Key: B (doubtless)

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 4: "But, in truth, Pearl was the one, as well as the other; and only in _____ of that identity had Hester contrived so perfectly to represent the scarlet letter in her appearance." Word bank: doubtless, inhabitants, imperatively, consequence

    Key: consequence

20. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 1: "Hester Prynne went, one day, to the mansion of Governor Bellingham, with a pair of gloves, which she had fringed and _____ to his order, and which were to be worn on some great occasion of state" Word bank: cheerfulness, embroidered, admitted, moreover

    Key: embroidered

21. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 2 reveal about the character or situation? "Among those who promoted the design, Governor Bellingham was said to be one of the most busy." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 2) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority. The words "promoted" and "design" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

22. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 15 reveal about the character or situation? "At one extremity, this spacious room was lighted by the windows of the two towers, which formed a small recess on either side of the portal." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 15) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority. The words "extremity" and "spacious" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

23. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 20) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The mirror in the armor. The evidence is "the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 20).

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in "VII: The Governor's Hall"? Governor Bellingham's mansion, its glittering stucco and the convex breastplate that magnifies the letter.

    A. Metaphor

    B. Setting

C. Allusion

D. Alliteration

Key: B (Setting)

25. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 3 shapes its tone: "Full of concern, therefore—but so conscious of her own right that it seemed scarcely an unequal match between the public, on the one side, and a lonely woman, backed by the sympathies of nature, on the other—Hester Prynne set forth from…" Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words "sympathies" and "conscious" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 3) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 17 shapes its tone: "There was a steel headpiece, a cuirass, a gorget, and greaves, with a pair of gauntlets and a sword hanging beneath" Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words "headpiece" and "gauntlets" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 17) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 7 to the story's treatment of women and independence: "The victory accomplished, Pearl returned quietly to her mother, and looked up, smiling, into her face." Use one other moment from the story as well.
Sample answer: This passage (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 7) develops women and independence: the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority. Its words "accomplished" and "returned" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "The brilliancy might have befitted Aladdin's palace, rather than the mansion of a grave old Puritan ruler." (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 8), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

28. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Pearl cry for?

A. Food

B. A toy

C. A red rose

D. Her father

Key: C (A red rose)

29. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 9: "Pearl, looking at this bright wonder of a house, began to caper and dance, and _____ required that the whole breadth of sunshine should be stripped off its front, and given her to play with." Word bank: cheerfulness, threatening, imperatively, hereditary
Key: imperatively

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "It was the scarlet letter in another form; the scarlet letter endowed with life" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 4) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: Pearl's dress. The evidence is "It was the scarlet letter in another form; the scarlet letter endowed with life"

(VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 4). This develops public shame and private identity: the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority. The words "another" and "scarlet" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. In the breastplate the letter appears "in exaggerated and gigantic proportions," and Pearl herself is "the scarlet letter endowed with life!".

31. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Why does Hester go to the Governor's house?

    A. To ask for a job

    B. To deliver gloves and keep Pearl

    C. To visit Dimmesdale

    D. To confess

    Key: B (To deliver gloves and keep Pearl)

32. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What is Pearl's dress like?

    A. Black wool

    B. The scarlet letter in another form

    C. White linen

    D. Plain gray

    Key: B (The scarlet letter in another form)

33. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: In the Governor's hall the letter swallows Hester's identity. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: "the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 20).

    Sample answer: In the breastplate the letter appears "in exaggerated and gigantic proportions," and Pearl herself is "the scarlet letter endowed with life!". The evidence is "the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 20), which shows the mirror in the armor. This develops public shame and private identity: the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority.

34. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 15 shapes its tone: "With many variations, suggested by the nature of his building-materials, diversity of climate, and a different mode of social life, Governor Bellingham had planned his new habitation after the residences of gentlemen of fair estate in his…" Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "variations" and "residences" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 15) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

35. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 22 to the story's treatment of women and independence: "There were a few rosebushes, however, and a number of apple-trees, probably the descendants of those planted by the Reverend Mr. Blackstone, the first settler of the peninsula; that half-mythological personage, who rides through our early…" Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 22) develops women and independence: the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority. Its words "mythological" and "descendants" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "In fact, adown the vista of the garden avenue a number of persons were seen

approaching towards the house." (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 25), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

36. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "VII: The Governor's Hall"?

    A. The revelation

    B. The Governor's hall

    C. The minister's vigil

    D. The frame narrative and the found letter

    Key: B (The Governor's hall)

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 5 shapes its tone: "As the two wayfarers came within the precincts of the town, the children of the Puritans looked up from their play—or what passed for play with those sombre little urchins—and spake gravely one to another:—" Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "precincts" and "wayfarers" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 5) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Why does Hawthorne put the distorting mirror in the Governor's house? Argue.

    Sample answer: A reasoned view linking power and judgment. The evidence is "the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 20), which shows the mirror in the armor. This develops public shame and private identity: the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority. In the breastplate the letter appears "in exaggerated and gigantic proportions," and Pearl herself is "the scarlet letter endowed with life!".

39. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? "Pearl, seeing the rosebushes, began to cry for a red rose" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 23)

    A. The letter at the brook's edge.

    B. The harshest woman in the crowd.

    C. Pearl and the rose.

    D. Hester demands Dimmesdale speak.

    Key: C (Pearl and the rose.)

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 11 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: "During that term he was to be the property of his master, and as much a commodity of bargain and sale as an ox, or a joint-stool." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 11) develops hypocrisy and truth: the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority. Its words "commodity" and "property" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "They approached the door; which was of an arched form, and flanked on each side by a narrow tower or projection of the…" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 11), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

41. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “VII: The Governor’s Hall”? In the armor's curved mirror the scarlet letter appears ‘in exaggerated and gigantic proportions.’

    A. Symbolism

    B. Personification

    C. Allusion

    D. Hyperbole

    Key: A (Symbolism)

42. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance” (VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 20) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The mirror in the armor. The evidence is “the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance” (VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 20). This develops public shame and private identity: the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority. The words “exaggerated” and “represented” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. In the breastplate the letter appears "in exaggerated and gigantic proportions," and Pearl herself is "the scarlet letter endowed with life!".

43. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] In the line “Her mother, in contriving the child’s garb, had allowed the gorgeous tendencies of her imagination their full play; arraying her in a crimson velvet tunic, of a peculiar cut, abundantly embroidered with fantasies and…”, what does “arraying” most nearly mean?

    A. ran and skipped playfully

    B. the decorated front of a building

    C. dressing in fine clothes

    D. going along with (someone) to keep them content

    Key: C (dressing in fine clothes)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 11, inference 2, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 18, 19, 9, 1, 20, 2, 11, 12, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	10, 17, 6, 5, 28, 9, 29, 23, 12, 22, 21, 14, 24, 15, 30, 16	recall 7, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	5, 9, 3, 31, 32, 8, 18, 21, 12, 22, 33, 24, 34, 15, 27, 35	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	19, 10, 31, 6, 12, 23, 21, 13, 36, 14, 37, 15, 26, 35, 38, 16	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	5, 1, 4, 36, 39, 12, 21, 15, 37, 26, 34, 25, 40, 38, 30, 27	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	5, 1, 11, 39, 22, 23, 12, 34, 24, 25, 37, 15, 35, 38, 16, 30	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	8, 10, 5, 31, 12, 21, 41, 33, 15, 25, 14, 27, 38, 40, 35, 16	recall 4, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	8, 11, 5, 1, 39, 25, 26, 24, 34, 37, 40, 42, 27, 35, 38, 16	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 6

College Senior	32, 5, 1, 31, 15, 25, 14, 34, 26, 37, 41, 27, 40, 38, 16, 35	recall 4, inference 0, analysis 7, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	43, 5, 1, 31, 36, 22, 26, 15, 34, 25, 27, 38, 16, 30, 35, 40	recall 4, inference 2, analysis 4, synthesis 6

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “VII: The Governor’s Hall,” how does Hawthorne show the Governor's hall? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In VII: The Governor’s Hall, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of the Governor's hall? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how VII: The Governor’s Hall develops the idea of the Governor's hall. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of VII: The Governor’s Hall (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of the Governor's hall. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what VII: The Governor’s Hall suggests about the Governor's hall. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's setting and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses setting in VII: The Governor’s Hall to complicate the reader's understanding of the Governor's hall. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate VII: The Governor’s Hall within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the Governor's hall responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read VII: The Governor’s Hall alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the Governor's hall follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to VII: The Governor's Hall and its treatment of the Governor's hall. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's setting and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads VII: The Governor's Hall as evidence for a larger claim about the Governor's hall in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads VII: The Governor's Hall as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the Governor's hall. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

SAT-style questions

1. *Hester looked, by way of humoring the child; and she saw that, owing to the peculiar effect of this convex mirror, the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "humoring" most nearly mean?

   A. going along with (someone) to keep them content

   B. mysterious and magical-looking

   C. dressing in fine clothes

   D. something that grows out of something else

2. *Hester looked, by way of humoring the child; and she saw that, owing to the peculiar effect of this convex mirror, the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance. In truth, she seemed absolutely hidden behind it. Pearl pointed upward, also, at a similar picture in the headpiece; smiling at her mother, with the elfish intelligence that was so familiar an expression on her small physiognomy. That look of naughty merriment was likewise reflected in the mirror, with so much breadth and intensity of effect, that it made Hester Prynne feel as if it could not be the image of her own child, but of an imp who was seeking to mould itself into Pearl's shape.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "VII: The Governor's Hall"?

   A. The Governor's hall

   B. The minister in a maze

   C. The elf-child and the minister

   D. Hester and Pearl

SAT key: 1. A (going along with (someone) to keep them content); 2. A (The Governor's hall)

Lesson 11: VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister

Focus: the elf-child and the minister

Objective: Students will analyze how conflict develops in "VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (witchcraft, removal of a child): Magistrates propose to take Pearl from her mother; Mistress Hibbins (a real woman later executed as a witch) invites Hester to the forest. Discuss fear of difference, not the occult.
Student preview: Authorities try to take a child from her mother.
Suggested language: "Who should decide how Pearl is raised?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Bellingham, Wilson, Dimmesdale and Chillingworth question Pearl, who says she was plucked from the rose-bush by the prison door. The magistrates move to take her; Hester appeals desperately to Dimmesdale, who argues the child is a blessing and a reminder of sin. Pearl takes his hand and lays her cheek against it, and he kisses her brow. Mistress Hibbins invites Hester to the forest; Hester says she would have gone if they had taken Pearl.

Background: Mistress Ann Hibbins, sister of Governor Bellingham, was executed as a witch in Boston in 1656.

Significance: Dimmesdale saves Pearl while hiding his claim to her.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Who should decide how a child is raised: parents or the community? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to sin and guilt because.... Content note before we start: Authorities try to take a child from her mother.
Prompt: Who should decide how a child is raised: parents or the community?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to sin and guilt because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: sundering — breaking apart; separating; expatiating — speaking at length (about); grandfatherly — kindly, like a grandfather; indefeasible — that cannot be taken away or cancelled; inopportune — happening at a bad time. "expatiating": Origin of "expatiate": Latin expatior. "inopportune": Origin: Latin inopportūnus.
Words: sundering: breaking apart; separating · expatiating: speaking at length (about) · grandfatherly: kindly, like a grandfather · indefeasible: that cannot be taken away or cancelled · inopportune: happening at a bad time

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Mistress Ann Hibbins, sister of Governor Bellingham, was executed as a witch in Boston in 1656. Dimmesdale saves Pearl while hiding his claim to her. Conflict: The magistrates propose to take Pearl from Hester; Hester appeals to Dimmesdale. Irony: Dimmesdale, the secret father, argues successfully that the child is a blessing and a reminder for her mother. Characterization: Pearl claims she was "plucked by her mother off the bush of wild roses." Watch for the scarlet letter: The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "Governor Bellingham, in a loose gown and easy cap—such as elderly gentlemen loved to endue" (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 1).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "God gave me the child … She is my happiness!—she is my torture, none the less" slowly and put it in my own words: Hester insists God gave her the child, who is both her joy and her torment. Next, craft. I notice the balanced contrast "my happiness! — my torture." The strongest word is "torture": it is a strong word for a child, showing the pain mixed with her love. Then, effect. What does Hester mean when she calls Pearl both happiness and torture? My answer: Pearl keeps Hester alive and reminds her of her sin; Hester's plea persuades the leaders to let her keep her daughter.

> *God gave me the child … She is my happiness!—she is my torture, none the less (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 22)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "God gave me the child … She is my happiness!—she is my torture, none the less" slowly and put it in my own words: Hester insists God gave her the child, who is both her joy and her torment. Next, craft. I notice the balanced contrast "my happiness! — my torture." The strongest word is "torture": it is a strong word for a child, showing the pain mixed with her love. Then, effect. What does Hester mean when she calls Pearl both happiness and torture? My answer: Pearl keeps Hester alive and reminds her of her sin; Hester's plea persuades the leaders to let her keep her daughter.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Hester demands Dimmesdale speak. Look at the craft: Dimmesdale, the secret father, argues successfully that the child is a blessing and a reminder for her mother. Ask: How does this line connect to sin and guilt? Expected: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain. (Hester demands Dimmesdale speak.)

> *Thou knowest—for thou hast sympathies which these men lack!—thou knowest what is in my heart (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 24)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Hester demands Dimmesdale speak. Look at the craft: Dimmesdale, the secret father, argues successfully that the child is a blessing and a reminder for her mother.
Ask: How does this line connect to sin and guilt?
Expected answer: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain. (Hester demands Dimmesdale speak.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for conflict, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the elf-child and the minister? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister develops the idea of the elf-child and the minister. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her. When the text says “God gave me the child … She is my happiness!—she is my torture, none the less” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 22), it shows this directly. Hester calls on him, "thou knowest what is in my heart," and he argues for the child she calls "my happiness" and "my torture."
Task: Annotate the chapter for conflict, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the elf-child and the minister? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister develops the idea of the elf-child and the minister. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her. When the text says “God gave me the child … She is my happiness!—she is my torture, none the less” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 22), it shows this directly. Hester calls on him, "thou knowest what is in my heart," and he argues for the child she calls "my happiness" and "my torture."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Who should decide how a child is raised: parents or the community? Ask: why does Dimmesdale win the argument? What does he risk by speaking?
Anchor question: Who should decide how a child is raised: parents or the community?
Facilitation: Ask: why does Dimmesdale win the argument? What does he risk by speaking?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the elf-child and the minister? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her. ("God gave me the child … She is my happiness!—she is my torture, none the less", VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 22). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the elf-child and the minister? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her. ("God gave me the child … She is my happiness!—she is my torture, none the less", VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 22). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how conflict shapes the elf-child and the minister. Key takeaway: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Conflict:** The magistrates propose to take Pearl from Hester; Hester appeals to Dimmesdale.
- **Irony:** Dimmesdale, the secret father, argues successfully that the child is a blessing and a reminder for her mother.
- **Characterization:** Pearl claims she was "plucked by her mother off the bush of wild roses."

Themes and how they develop

- **sin and guilt:** Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain.

Symbols and motifs

- **the scarlet letter:** The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter:

"Governor Bellingham, in a loose gown and easy cap—such as elderly gentlemen loved to endue" (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 1).

- **light and darkness:** Sunshine avoids Hester but plays around Pearl; the forest is dim; the minister's vigil happens at midnight under a meteor. In this chapter: "the great hall-window, found himself close to little Pearl. The shadow of the curtain fell on Hester Prynne, and partially concealed her" (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 3).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "God gave me the child … She is my happiness!—she is my torture, none the less" (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 22) Hester's plea.
- "Thou knowest—for thou hast sympathies which these men lack!—thou knowest what is in my heart" (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 24) Hester demands Dimmesdale speak.
- "this boon was meant, above all things else, to keep the mother's soul alive, and to preserve her from blacker depths of sin" (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 30) Dimmesdale's argument that Pearl is a blessing.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her.
Evidence: "God gave me the child … She is my happiness!—she is my torture, none the less" (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 22)
Reasoning: Hester calls on him, "thou knowest what is in my heart," and he argues for the child she calls "my happiness" and "my torture."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
sundering (verb)	breaking apart; separating	*But here—if we suppose this interview betwixt Mistress Hibbins and Hester Prynne to be authentic, and not a parable—was already an illustration of the young minister's argument against sundering the relation of a fallen mother to the offspring of her frailty.*	
expatiating (verb)	speaking at length (about)	*Governor Bellingham, in a loose gown and easy cap—such as elderly gentlemen loved to endue themselves with, in their domestic privacy—walked foremost, and appeared to be showing off his estate, and expatiating on his projected improvements.*	"expatiating": Origin of "expatiate": Latin expatior. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/expatiate#Etymology)
grandfatherly (adjective)	kindly, like a grandfather	*Wilson, not a little astonished at this outbreak—for he was a grandfatherly sort of personage, and usually a vast favorite*	

		with children—essayed, however, to proceed with the examination.	
indefeasible (adjective)	that cannot be taken away or cancelled	*Alone in the world, cast off by it, and with this sole treasure to keep her heart alive, she felt that she possessed indefeasible rights against the world, and was ready to defend them to the death.*	
inopportune (adjective)	happening at a bad time	*But that perversity which all children have more or less of, and of which little Pearl had a tenfold portion, now, at the most inopportune moment, took thorough possession of her, and closed her lips, or impelled her to speak words amiss.*	"inopportune": Origin: Latin **inopportūnus.** (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/inopportune#Etymology)
mountebank (noun)	a showy fake or performer who tricks people	*"I feared the woman had no better thought than to make a mountebank of her child!"*	"mountebank": Origin: Italian **montambanco.** (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/mountebank#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. Who should decide how a child is raised: parents or the community?
2. Where does conflict appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with women and independence?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What question does Wilson ask Pearl? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Who made her.
2. Where does Pearl say she came from? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The rose-bush by the prison door
3. Who argues that Hester should keep Pearl? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Dimmesdale
4. What does Pearl do to Dimmesdale? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Lays her cheek against his hand
5. What does Mistress Hibbins invite Hester to? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A meeting in the forest

6. What does Hester answer Mistress Hibbins? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: She would have gone if they had taken Pearl
7. Retell the three most important events of "VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Bellingham, Wilson, Dimmesdale and Chillingworth question Pearl, who says she was plucked from the rose-bush by the prison door. The magistrates move to take her; Hester appeals desperately to Dimmesdale, who argues the child is a blessing and a reminder of sin. Pearl takes his hand and lays her cheek against it, and he kisses her brow. Mistress Hibbins invites Hester to the forest; Hester says…
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: "But here—if we suppose this interview betwixt Mistress Hibbins and Hester Prynne to be authentic, and not a parable—was already an illustration of the young minister's argument against sundering the relation of a fallen…" What does "sundering" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: sundering: breaking apart; separating.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Dimmesdale win the argument? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: He speaks with feeling, as only the father could.
2. What does "VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister" suggest about the elf-child and the minister? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Dimmesdale saves Pearl while hiding his claim to her.
3. Find one example of conflict in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
4. How does the irony in this chapter shape what we understand about the elf-child and the minister? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her. Useful evidence: "God gave me the child … She is my happiness!—she is my torture, none the less" (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 22): Hester's plea. On irony: Dimmesdale, the secret father, argues successfully that the child is a blessing and a reminder for her mother. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "The old minister seated himself in an armchair, and made an effort to draw Pearl betwixt his knees.", why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Bellingham, Wilson, Dimmesdale and Chillingworth question Pearl, who says she was plucked from the rose-bush by the prison door. The magistrates move

to take her; Hester appeals desperately to Dimmesdale, who argues the child is a blessing and a reminder of sin. Pearl takes his hand and lays her…

7. How does “VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister” build on “VII: The Governor’s Hall”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her. Useful evidence: “Thou knowest—for thou hast sympathies which these men lack!—thou knowest what is in my heart” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 24): Hester demands Dimmesdale speak. Theme link: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her. Useful evidence: “this boon was meant, above all things else, to keep the mother’s soul alive, and to preserve her from blacker depths of sin” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 30): Dimmesdale's argument that Pearl is a blessing. On characterization: Pearl claims she was "plucked by her mother off the bush of wild roses." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Who should decide how a child is raised: parents or the community?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with women and independence? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her. Useful evidence: “God gave me the child … She is my happiness!—she is my torture, none the less” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 22): Hester's plea. On characterization: Pearl claims she was "plucked by her mother off the bush of wild roses." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Was Pearl saving Hester 'from Satan's snare,' as the narrator suggests? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her. Useful evidence: “Thou knowest—for thou hast sympathies which these men lack!—thou knowest what is in my heart” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 24): Hester demands Dimmesdale speak. Theme link: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Dimmesdale saves Pearl while hiding his claim to her.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1,

RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her. Useful evidence: “this boon was meant, above all things else, to keep the mother’s soul alive, and to preserve her from blacker depths of sin” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 30): Dimmesdale's argument that Pearl is a blessing. Theme link: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her. Useful evidence: “God gave me the child … She is my happiness!—she is my torture, none the less” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 22): Hester's plea. On characterization: Pearl claims she was "plucked by her mother off the bush of wild roses." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Rewrite one moment of “VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the elf-child and the minister? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her. Useful evidence: “Thou knowest—for thou hast sympathies which these men lack!—thou knowest what is in my heart” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 24): Hester demands Dimmesdale speak. Theme link: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her. Useful evidence: “this boon was meant, above all things else, to keep the mother’s soul alive, and to preserve her from blacker depths of sin” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 30): Dimmesdale's argument that Pearl is a blessing. Theme link: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to sin and guilt: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her. Useful evidence: “God gave me the child … She is my happiness!—she is my torture, none the less” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 22): Hester's plea. Theme link: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the conflict in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria

and evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her. Useful evidence: “Thou knowest—for thou hast sympathies which these men lack!—thou knowest what is in my heart” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 24): Hester demands Dimmesdale speak. On conflict: The magistrates propose to take Pearl from Hester; Hester appeals to Dimmesdale. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister” treats the elf-child and the minister with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her. Useful evidence: “this boon was meant, above all things else, to keep the mother’s soul alive, and to preserve her from blacker depths of sin” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 30): Dimmesdale's argument that Pearl is a blessing. Theme link: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “IX: The Leech” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her. Useful evidence: “God gave me the child … She is my happiness!—she is my torture, none the less” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 22): Hester's plea. Theme link: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the elf-child and the minister? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale saves Pearl for Hester while hiding his own claim to her. Useful evidence: “Thou knowest—for thou hast sympathies which these men lack!—thou knowest what is in my heart” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 24): Hester demands Dimmesdale speak. Theme link: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Conflict:** look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Alone in the world, cast off by it, and with this sole treasure to keep her heart alive, she felt that she possessed indefeasible rights against the world, and was ready to defend them to the death.", what does "indefeasible" most nearly mean?

   A. inflicted (revenge or harm)

   B. that cannot be taken away or cancelled

   C. bitter and corrupted

   D. shrubs and small plants under forest trees

   Key: B (that cannot be taken away or cancelled)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 5? "Prithee, young one, who art thou, and what has ailed thy mother to _____ thee in this strange fashion?"

   A. examine

   B. bedizen

   C. followed

   D. scarlet

   Key: B (bedizen)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 24: "Thou knowest—for thou hast _____ which these men lack!—thou knowest what is in my heart"

   Key: sympathies

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 2: "It was _____ that this learned man was the physician as well as friend of the young minister, whose health had severely suffered, of late, by his too unreserved self-sacrifice to the labors and duties of the pastoral relation." Word bank: scarlet, sacredness, bitterness, understood

   Key: understood

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 14? "Good Master Wilson, I pray you, _____ this Pearl—since that is her name—and see whether she hath had such Christian nurture as befits a child of her age."

   A. sacredness

   B. understood

   C. examine

   D. teaching

   Key: C (examine)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 9: "Governor Bellingham stepped through the window into the hall, _____ by his three guests." Word bank: teaching, depravity, scarlet, followed

   Key: followed

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "But that perversity which all children have more or less of, and of which little Pearl had a tenfold portion, now, at the most _____ moment, took thorough possession of her, and closed her lips, or impelled her to speak

words amiss." Word bank: expatiating, inopportune, grandfatherly, sundering

Key: inopportune

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 30: "this boon was meant, above all things else, to keep the mother's soul alive, and to _____ her from blacker depths of sin"

   Key: preserve

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Hester answer Mistress Hibbins?

   A. She will come tonight

   B. She laughs

   C. She reports her

   D. She would have gone if they had taken Pearl

   Key: D (She would have gone if they had taken Pearl)

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who argues that Hester should keep Pearl?

    A. Bellingham

    B. Wilson

    C. Mistress Hibbins

    D. Dimmesdale

    Key: D (Dimmesdale)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Dimmesdale win the argument?

    Sample answer: He speaks with feeling, as only the father could. The evidence is "this boon was meant, above all things else, to keep the mother's soul alive, and to preserve her from blacker depths of sin" (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 30) — Dimmesdale's argument that Pearl is a blessing.

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 2 reveal about the character or situation? "Behind the Governor and Mr. Wilson came two other guests: one the Reverend Arthur Dimmesdale, whom the reader may remember as having taken a brief and reluctant part in the scene of Hester Prynne's disgrace; and, in close companionship…" Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 2) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain. The words "companionship" and "reluctant" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 25 reveal about the character or situation? "At this wild and singular appeal, which indicated that Hester Prynne's situation had provoked her to little less than madness, the young minister at once came forward, pale, and holding his hand over his heart, as was his custom whenever…" Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 25) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain. The words "temperament" and "peculiarly" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain.

    A. Nature and the individual against society

    B. Sin and guilt

C. Hypocrisy and truth

D. Public shame and private identity

Key: B (Sin and guilt)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 33 shapes its tone: “Care must be had, nevertheless, to put the child to due and stated examination in the catechism, at thy hands or Master Dimmesdale’s.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “nevertheless” and “examination” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 33) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Was Pearl saving Hester 'from Satan's snare,' as the narrator suggests? Argue.

Sample answer: A reasoned view: Dimmesdale's argument that Pearl is a blessing. The evidence is “this boon was meant, above all things else, to keep the mother’s soul alive, and to preserve her from blacker depths of sin” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 30). This develops sin and guilt: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain. Hester calls on him, "thou knowest what is in my heart," and he argues for the child she calls "my happiness" and "my torture.".

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “I feared the woman had no better thought than to make a _____ of her child!” Word bank: mountebank, expatiating, sundering, grandfatherly

Key: mountebank

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “But here—if we suppose this interview betwixt Mistress Hibbins and Hester Prynne to be authentic, and not a parable—was already an illustration of the young minister’s argument against sundering the relation of a fallen…”, what does “sundering” most nearly mean?

A. calming

B. a member of a minister's congregation

C. breaking apart; separating

D. removed or done away with

Key: C (breaking apart; separating)

19. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What question does Wilson ask Pearl?

Sample answer: Who made her.

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Pearl do to Dimmesdale?

A. Ignores him

B. Lays her cheek against his hand

C. Bites him

D. Throws a burr

Key: B (Lays her cheek against his hand)

21. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 8 shapes its tone: “But she comes at a good time; and we will look

into this matter forthwith." Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words "forthwith" and "matter" (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 8) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

22. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 28 shapes its tone: "For, if we deem it otherwise, do we not thereby say that the Heavenly Father, the Creator of all flesh, hath lightly recognized a deed of sin, and made of no account the distinction between unhallowed lust and holy love?" Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "distinction" and "unhallowed" (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 28) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 5 shapes its tone: "Methinks I have seen just such figures, when the sun has been shining through a richly painted window, and tracing out the golden and crimson images across the floor." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "figures" and "tracing" (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 5) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 34 to the story's treatment of women and independence: "The minister—for, save the long-sought regards of woman, nothing is sweeter than these marks of childish preference, accorded spontaneously by a spiritual instinct, and therefore seeming to imply in us something truly worthy to be…" Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 34) develops women and independence: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain. Its words "spontaneously" and "preference" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "The young minister, on ceasing to speak, had withdrawn a few steps from the group, and stood with his face partially…" (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 34), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 28? "This child of its father's guilt and its mother's shame hath come from the hand of God, to work in many ways upon her heart, who pleads so earnestly, and with such _____ of spirit, the right to keep her."

    A. sacredness

    B. bitterness

    C. recollection

    D. disciplined

    Key: B (bitterness)

26. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Governor Bellingham, in a loose gown and easy cap—such as elderly gentlemen loved to endue themselves with, in their domestic privacy—walked foremost,

and appeared to be showing off his estate, and expatiating on his…", what does "expatiating" most nearly mean?

A. lack of accountability to anyone

B. a woman who founds something

C. lights up

D. speaking at length (about)

Key: D (speaking at length (about))

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 20 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: "Here is a child of three years old, and she cannot tell who made her!" Use one other moment from the story as well.
Sample answer: This passage (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 20) develops hypocrisy and truth: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain. Its words "cannot" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "He gave her in requital of all things else, which ye had taken from me." (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 22), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 38 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: "As they descended the steps, it is averred that the lattice of a chamber-window was thrown open, and forth into the sunny day was thrust the face of Mistress Hibbins, Governor Bellingham's bitter-tempered sister, and the same who, a few…" Use one other moment from the story as well.
Sample answer: This passage (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 38) develops hypocrisy and truth: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain. Its words "descended" and "executed" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "The affair being so satisfactorily concluded, Hester Prynne, with Pearl, departed from the house." (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 38), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

29. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 22: "See ye not, she is the scarlet letter, only capable of being loved, and so endowed with a million-fold the power of _____ for my sin?" Word bank: sacredness, teaching, depravity, retribution
Key: retribution

30. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Mistress Hibbins invite Hester to?

A. Church

B. A feast

C. A meeting in the forest

D. A trial

Key: C (A meeting in the forest)

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Which literary element does this describe in "VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister"? The magistrates propose to take Pearl from Hester; Hester appeals to Dimmesdale.

A. Conflict

B. Diction / vocabulary

C. Personification

D. Simile

Key: A (Conflict)

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 12 to the story's treatment of women and independence: “It is because of the stain which that letter indicates, that we would transfer thy child to other hands.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 12) develops women and independence: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain. Its words “indicates” and “transfer” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “We will judge warily,’ said Bellingham, ‘and look well what we are about to do.” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 14), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Synthesis: trace how sin and guilt develops from VI: Pearl to VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Earlier, in VI: Pearl, paragraph 1, the text reads “But she named the infant ‘Pearl,’ as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother’s only treasure”, which shows why Hester names her Pearl. In VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, “God gave me the child … She is my happiness!—she is my torture, none the less” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 22) — Hester's plea. Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain.

34. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Where does Pearl say she came from?

    A. The rose-bush by the prison door

    B. Heaven

    C. The forest

    D. England

    Key: A (The rose-bush by the prison door)

35. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the quotation from VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 22: “God gave me the child … She is my _____!—she is my torture, none the less”

    Key: happiness

36. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] In the line “Wilson, not a little astonished at this outbreak—for he was a grandfatherly sort of personage, and usually a vast favorite with children—essayed, however, to proceed with the examination.”, what does “grandfatherly” most nearly mean?

    A. kindly, like a grandfather

    B. a person who speaks for someone else

    C. raised to the level of a god; idolized

    D. payment for work; earnings

    Key: A (kindly, like a grandfather)

37. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Thou knowest—for thou hast sympathies which these men lack!—thou knowest what is in my heart” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 24)

    A. The prison as an image.

    B. Mistress Hibbins to Pearl.

    C. The question the letter's "new sense" raises.

    D. Hester demands Dimmesdale speak.

    Key: D (Hester demands Dimmesdale speak.)

38. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the word choice in “this boon was meant, above all things else, to keep the mother’s soul alive, and to preserve her from blacker depths of sin” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 30). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Dimmesdale's argument that Pearl is a blessing. The evidence is “this boon was meant, above all things else, to keep the mother’s soul alive, and to preserve her from blacker depths of sin” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 30). This develops sin and guilt: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain. The words “preserve” and “blacker” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “God gave me the child … She is my happiness!—she is my torture, none the less” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 22) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Hester's plea. The evidence is “God gave me the child … She is my happiness!—she is my torture, none the less” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 22). This develops sin and guilt: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain. The words “happiness” and “torture” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Hester calls on him, "thou knowest what is in my heart," and he argues for the child she calls "my happiness" and "my torture.".

40. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister”? Dimmesdale, the secret father, argues successfully that the child is a blessing and a reminder for her mother.
    A. Theme
    B. Tone / mood
    C. Simile
    D. Irony

    Key: D (Irony)

41. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Thou knowest—for thou hast sympathies which these men lack!—thou knowest what is in my heart” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 24) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Hester demands Dimmesdale speak. The evidence is “Thou knowest—for thou hast sympathies which these men lack!—thou knowest what is in my heart” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 24). This develops sin and guilt: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain. The words “sympathies” and “knowest” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Hester calls on him, "thou knowest what is in my heart," and he argues for the child she calls "my happiness" and "my torture.".

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	9, 4, 2, 17, 18, 19, 10, 7, 20, 11, 13, 12, 21, 22, 23, 24	recall 9, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	7, 9, 1, 19, 25, 26, 5, 17, 11, 13, 12, 15, 21, 23, 27, 28	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	29, 7, 30, 26, 19, 20, 2, 11, 13, 12, 15, 22, 23, 31, 32, 33	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	34, 35, 9, 1, 17, 36, 11, 13, 12, 21, 14, 15, 23, 16, 27, 33	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3

AP	7, 36, 18, 17, 12, 37, 11, 14, 23, 15, 22, 38, 33, 32, 24, 28	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	1, 7, 18, 17, 34, 10, 21, 38, 23, 22, 15, 32, 27, 39, 28, 24	recall 6, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	34, 2, 7, 17, 11, 31, 14, 23, 38, 15, 27, 24, 16, 28, 33, 32	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Junior	2, 29, 7, 34, 11, 38, 14, 23, 21, 40, 16, 24, 28, 32, 33, 27	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	10, 7, 17, 34, 21, 31, 14, 23, 22, 15, 27, 32, 16, 24, 33, 28	recall 4, inference 0, analysis 6, synthesis 6
Graduate / PhD	10, 7, 17, 34, 40, 21, 22, 14, 15, 33, 32, 41, 24, 28, 16, 27	recall 4, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 7

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister,” how does Hawthorne show the elf-child and the minister? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the conflict you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of the elf-child and the minister? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the conflict in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister develops the idea of the elf-child and the minister. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister (where it begins, turns and ends) and its conflict shape the reader's understanding of the elf-child and the minister. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister suggests about the elf-child and the minister. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's conflict and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses conflict in VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister to complicate the reader's understanding of the elf-child and the minister. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the elf-child and

the minister responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the elf-child and the minister follows or bends those conventions, using the conflict as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister and its treatment of the elf-child and the minister. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's conflict and irony, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister as evidence for a larger claim about the elf-child and the minister in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the elf-child and the minister. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

SAT-style questions

1. *Wilson, not a little astonished at this outbreak—for he was a grandfatherly sort of personage, and usually a vast favorite with children—essayed, however, to proceed with the examination.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “grandfatherly” most nearly mean?

   A. happening at a bad time

   B. that cannot be taken away or cancelled

   C. kindly, like a grandfather

   D. a showy fake or performer who tricks people

2. *The old minister seated himself in an armchair, and made an effort to draw Pearl betwixt his knees. But the child, unaccustomed to the touch or familiarity of any but her mother, escaped through the open window, and stood on the upper step, looking like a wild tropical bird, of rich plumage, ready to take flight into the upper air. Mr. Wilson, not a little astonished at this outbreak—for he was a grandfatherly sort of personage, and usually a vast favorite with children—essayed, however, to proceed with the examination.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister”?

   A. The elf-child and the minister

   B. Hester at her needle

   C. The prison door and the rose

   D. Hester and Pearl

SAT key: 1. C (kindly, like a grandfather); 2. A (The elf-child and the minister)

Lesson 12: IX: The Leech

Focus: the leech

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in “IX: The Leech” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

Chillingworth settles in Boston as a physician and becomes the ailing Dimmesdale's doctor; at a hint from him, the two lodge in the same house beside the graveyard. Dimmesdale constantly presses his hand to his heart. Some townspeople begin to think the doctor's face has grown darker and that he is Satan's emissary.

Background: 'Leech' was an old word for a physician; leeches were also used to bleed patients.

Significance: Care becomes a disguise for revenge.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Can someone hurt you while seeming to help you? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to sin and guilt because....
Prompt: Can someone hurt you while seeming to help you?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to sin and guilt because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: pilloried — publicly punished and shamed, as in the pillory; vilified — spoke of with harsh, abusive criticism; decried — publicly condemned; chirurgical — surgical (old form); religionist — a deeply religious person. “vilified”: Origin of “vilify”: Late Latin vīlificāre. “chirurgical”: Origin: Middle French cirurgical; earlier Medieval Latin chirurgicālis.
Words: pilloried: publicly punished and shamed, as in the pillory · vilified: spoke of with harsh, abusive criticism · decried: publicly condemned · chirurgical: surgical (old form) · religionist: a deeply religious person

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
'Leech' was an old word for a physician; leeches were also used to bleed patients. Care becomes a disguise for revenge. Characterization: Chillingworth becomes the minister's physician and companion; his face grows darker. Foreshadowing: People begin to whisper that the physician is Satan's emissary. Imagery: Chillingworth is a "leech," a word for a doctor and a bloodsucker. Watch for the scarlet letter: The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "in the crowd that witnessed Hester Prynne's ignominious exposure, stood a man, elderly, travel-worn, who, just emerging from the perilous wilderness, beheld" (IX: The Leech, paragraph 1).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart" slowly and put it in my own words: Dimmesdale now constantly presses his hand over his heart. Next, craft. I notice the gesture is described as habit, not chance. The strongest word is "heart": it is where his secret guilt hides. Then, effect. What does Dimmesdale's habit reveal? My answer: Dimmesdale's habit of pressing his hand over his heart reveals the hidden guilt that is destroying him physically; the gesture marks the weakness Chillingworth will exploit.

> *it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart (IX: The Leech, paragraph 7)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart" slowly and put it in my own words: Dimmesdale now constantly presses his hand over his heart. Next, craft. I notice the gesture is described as habit, not chance. The strongest word is "heart": it is where his secret guilt hides. Then, effect. What does Dimmesdale's habit reveal? My answer: Dimmesdale's habit of pressing his hand over his heart reveals the hidden guilt that is destroying him physically; the gesture marks the weakness Chillingworth will exploit.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The town imagines Chillingworth's fire "brought from the lower regions": the community senses evil it cannot name. Expected link: imagery; revenge as a hunt. Ask: How does this line connect to sin and guilt? Expected: The physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret. (The townspeople's suspicion.)

> *the fire in his laboratory had been brought from the lower regions (IX: The Leech, paragraph 17)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The town imagines Chillingworth's fire "brought from the lower regions": the community senses evil it cannot name. Expected link: imagery; revenge as a hunt.
Ask: How does this line connect to sin and guilt?
Expected answer: The physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret. (The townspeople's suspicion.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for characterization, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the leech? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how IX: The Leech develops the idea of the leech. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The physician's care is a disguise for persecution. When the text says “it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 7), it shows this directly. Dimmesdale's habit "to press his hand over his heart" draws the physician close, and the town comes to believe he is haunted by "Satan's emissary, in the guise of old Roger Chillingworth."
Task: Annotate the chapter for characterization, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the leech? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how IX: The Leech develops the idea of the leech. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The physician's care is a disguise for persecution. When the text says “it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 7), it shows this directly. Dimmesdale's habit "to press his hand over his heart" draws the physician close, and the town comes to believe he is haunted by "Satan's emissary, in the guise of old Roger Chillingworth."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Can someone hurt you while seeming to help you? Ask: what are the two meanings of "leech," and why does Hawthorne choose the word?
Anchor question: Can someone hurt you while seeming to help you?
Facilitation: Ask: what are the two meanings of "leech," and why does Hawthorne choose the word?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the leech? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The physician's care is a disguise for persecution. (“it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart”, IX: The Leech, paragraph 7). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the leech? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The physician's care is a disguise for persecution. (“it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart”, IX: The Leech, paragraph 7). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes the leech. Key takeaway: the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Chillingworth becomes the minister's physician and companion; his face grows darker.
- **Foreshadowing:** People begin to whisper that the physician is Satan's emissary.
- **Imagery:** Chillingworth is a "leech," a word for a doctor and a bloodsucker.

Themes and how they develop

- **sin and guilt:** the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret.

Symbols and motifs

- **the scarlet letter:** The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: “in the crowd that witnessed Hester Prynne’s ignominious exposure, stood a man, elderly, travel-worn, who, just emerging from the perilous wilderness, beheld” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 1).
- **light and darkness:** Sunshine avoids Hester but plays around Pearl; the forest is dim; the minister's vigil happens at midnight under a meteor. In this chapter: “interests would immediately spring up, and likewise a new purpose; dark, it is true, if not guilty, but of force enough to” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 1).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 7) Dimmesdale's telltale gesture.
- “the fire in his laboratory had been brought from the lower regions” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 17) The townspeople's suspicion.
- “haunted either by Satan himself, or Satan’s emissary, in the guise of old Roger Chillingworth” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 18) The town's suspicion.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The physician's care is a disguise for persecution.
Evidence: “it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 7)

Reasoning: Dimmesdale's habit "to press his hand over his heart" draws the physician close, and the town comes to believe he is haunted by "Satan's emissary, in the guise of old Roger Chillingworth."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
pilloried (verb)	publicly punished and shamed, as in the pillory	*He resolved not to be pilloried beside her on her pedestal of shame.*	
vilified (verb)	spoke of with harsh, abusive criticism	*Here the pale clergyman piled up his library, rich with parchment-bound folios of the Fathers, and the lore of Rabbis, and monkish erudition, of which the Protestant divines, even while they vilified and decried that class of writers, were yet constrained often to avail themselves.*	"vilified": Origin of "vilify": Late Latin vīlificāre. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/vilify#Etymology)
decried (verb)	publicly condemned	*Here the pale clergyman piled up his library, rich with parchment-bound folios of the Fathers, and the lore of Rabbis, and monkish erudition, of which the Protestant divines, even while they vilified and decried that class of writers, were yet constrained often to avail themselves.*	
chirurgical (adjective)	surgical (old form)	*Skilful men, of the medical and chirurgical profession, were of rare occurrence in the colony.*	"chirurgical": Origin: Middle French cirurgical; earlier Medieval Latin chirurgicālis. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/chirurgical#Etymology)
religionist (noun)	a deeply religious person	*Dimmesdale was a true priest, a true religionist, with the reverential sentiment largely developed, and an order of mind that impelled itself powerfully along the track of a creed, and wore its passage continually deeper with the lapse of time.*	
parishioner (noun)	a member of a minister's congregation	*This idea was countenanced by the strong interest which the physician ever manifested in the young clergyman; he attached himself to him as a parishioner, and sought to win a friendly regard and confidence from his naturally reserved sensibility.*	"parishioner": Origin: Old French paroissien. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/parishioner#Etymology)
incurious (adjective)	lacking curiosity (here 'not	*With such commodiousness of situation, these two learned persons sat themselves*	"incurious": Origin: Latin incūriōsus ("careless"). (Liber et Libri origin note,

	incurious' means quite curious)	*down, each in his own domain, yet familiarly passing from one apartment to the other, and bestowing a mutual and not incurious inspection into one another's business.*	https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/incurious#Etymology)
delving (verb)	digging or searching deeply	*So Roger Chillingworth—the man of skill, the kind and friendly physician—strove to go deep into his patient's bosom, delving among his principles, prying into his recollections, and probing everything with a cautious touch, like a treasure-seeker in a dark cavern.*	

Discussion questions

1. Can someone hurt you while seeming to help you?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with sin and guilt?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Why are the parishioners glad of the doctor? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: They think Providence sent him to save their minister.
2. What profession does Chillingworth practice? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Physician
3. Where do the two men live? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: In the same house by the graveyard
4. What gesture does Dimmesdale make? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Presses his hand over his heart
5. What do some townspeople suspect? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The doctor is Satan's agent
6. What two meanings does 'leech' have? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Doctor and bloodsucker
7. Retell the three most important events of "IX: The Leech" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Chillingworth settles in Boston as a physician and becomes the ailing Dimmesdale's doctor; at a hint from him, the two lodge in the same house beside the graveyard.

Dimmesdale constantly presses his hand to his heart. Some townspeople begin to think the doctor's face has grown darker and that he is Satan's emissary.

8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “IX: The Leech”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “IX: The Leech” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: “He resolved not to be pilloried beside her on her pedestal of shame.” What does “pilloried” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: pilloried: publicly punished and shamed, as in the pillory.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Hawthorne call the chapter 'The Leech'? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Chillingworth heals and drains Dimmesdale at once.
2. What does “IX: The Leech” suggest about the leech? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Care becomes a disguise for revenge.
3. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the foreshadowing in this chapter shape what we understand about the leech? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The physician's care is a disguise for persecution. Useful evidence: “it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 7): Dimmesdale's telltale gesture. On foreshadowing: People begin to whisper that the physician is Satan's emissary. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “This idea was countenanced by the strong interest which the physician ever manifested in the young clergyman; he attached himself to him as a parishioner, and sought to win a…”, why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “IX: The Leech”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Chillingworth settles in Boston as a physician and becomes the ailing Dimmesdale's doctor; at a hint from him, the two lodge in the same house beside the graveyard. Dimmesdale constantly presses his hand to his heart. Some townspeople begin to think the doctor's face has grown darker and that he is…
7. How does “IX: The Leech” build on “VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The physician's care is a disguise for persecution. Useful evidence: “the fire in his laboratory had been brought from the lower regions” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 17): The townspeople's suspicion. Theme link: the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's

secret. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The physician's care is a disguise for persecution. Useful evidence: “haunted either by Satan himself, or Satan’s emissary, in the guise of old Roger Chillingworth” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 18): The town's suspicion. On characterization: Chillingworth becomes the minister's physician and companion; his face grows darker. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Can someone hurt you while seeming to help you?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does imagery appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with sin and guilt? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The physician's care is a disguise for persecution. Useful evidence: “it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 7): Dimmesdale's telltale gesture. On imagery: Chillingworth is a "leech," a word for a doctor and a bloodsucker. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is the town's suspicion of Chillingworth wisdom or superstition? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The physician's care is a disguise for persecution. Useful evidence: “the fire in his laboratory had been brought from the lower regions” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 17): The townspeople's suspicion. Theme link: the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Care becomes a disguise for revenge.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The physician's care is a disguise for persecution. Useful evidence: “haunted either by Satan himself, or Satan’s emissary, in the guise of old Roger Chillingworth” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 18): The town's suspicion. Theme link: the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The physician's care is a disguise for persecution. Useful evidence: “it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his

heart” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 7): Dimmesdale's telltale gesture. On characterization: Chillingworth becomes the minister's physician and companion; his face grows darker. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Rewrite one moment of “IX: The Leech” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the leech? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The physician's care is a disguise for persecution. Useful evidence: “the fire in his laboratory had been brought from the lower regions” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 17): The townspeople's suspicion. Theme link: the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “IX: The Leech”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The physician's care is a disguise for persecution. Useful evidence: “haunted either by Satan himself, or Satan’s emissary, in the guise of old Roger Chillingworth” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 18): The town's suspicion. Theme link: the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to public shame and private identity: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The physician's care is a disguise for persecution. Useful evidence: “it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 7): Dimmesdale's telltale gesture. Theme link: the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The physician's care is a disguise for persecution. Useful evidence: “the fire in his laboratory had been brought from the lower regions” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 17): The townspeople's suspicion. On characterization: Chillingworth becomes the minister's physician and companion; his face grows darker. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “IX: The Leech” treats the leech with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The physician's care is a disguise for persecution. Useful evidence: “haunted either by Satan himself, or Satan’s emissary, in the guise of old Roger Chillingworth” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 18): The town's suspicion. Theme link: the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “X: The Leech and His Patient” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The physician's care is a disguise for persecution. Useful evidence: “it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 7): Dimmesdale's telltale gesture. On foreshadowing: People begin to whisper that the physician is Satan's emissary. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the leech? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The physician's care is a disguise for persecution. Useful evidence: “the fire in his laboratory had been brought from the lower regions” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 17): The townspeople's suspicion. Theme link: the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What do some townspeople suspect?
   A. Hester is cured
   B. The doctor is a saint
   C. Dimmesdale is a witch
   D. The doctor is Satan's agent

   Key: D (The doctor is Satan's agent)
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from IX: The Leech, paragraph 18: “haunted either by Satan himself, or Satan’s _____, in the guise of old Roger Chillingworth”
   Key: emissary
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “With such commodiousness of situation, these two learned persons sat themselves down, each in his own domain, yet familiarly passing from one apartment to the other, and bestowing a mutual and not _____ inspection into one another’s business.” Word bank: incurious, pilloried, vilified, decried
   Key: incurious
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “So Roger Chillingworth—the man of skill, the kind and friendly physician—strove to go deep into his patient’s bosom, _____ among his principles, prying into his recollections, and probing everything with a cautious

touch, like a treasure-seeker in a dark…" Word bank: vilified, delving, decried, pilloried

Key: delving

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from IX: The Leech, paragraph 17: "the fire in his _____ had been brought from the lower regions"

   Key: laboratory

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "He resolved not to be pilloried beside her on her pedestal of shame.", what does "pilloried" most nearly mean?

   A. long spears with an axe blade, carried by guards

   B. happening at a bad time

   C. publicly punished and shamed, as in the pillory

   D. a person who speaks for someone else

   Key: C (publicly punished and shamed, as in the pillory)

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "This idea was countenanced by the strong interest which the physician ever manifested in the young clergyman; he attached himself to him as a _____, and sought to win a friendly regard and confidence from his naturally reserved sensibility." Word bank: vilified, parishioner, decried, pilloried

   Key: parishioner

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What two meanings does 'leech' have?

   A. Farmer and herb

   B. Thief and sailor

   C. Priest and judge

   D. Doctor and bloodsucker

   Key: D (Doctor and bloodsucker)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Skilful men, of the medical and chirurgical profession, were of rare occurrence in the colony.", what does "chirurgical" most nearly mean?

   A. denies having (a motive or intention)

   B. playfully, in a teasing way

   C. surgical (old form)

   D. a sorcerer

   Key: C (surgical (old form))

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What gesture does Dimmesdale make?

    A. Clenches his fists

    B. Folds his arms

    C. Covers his eyes

    D. Presses his hand over his heart

    Key: D (Presses his hand over his heart)

11. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Dimmesdale was a true priest, a true _____, with the reverential sentiment largely developed, and an order of mind that impelled itself powerfully along the track of a creed, and wore its passage continually deeper with the lapse

of time." Word bank: vilified, decried, religionist, pilloried

Key: religionist

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart" (IX: The Leech, paragraph 7) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Dimmesdale's telltale gesture. The evidence is "it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart" (IX: The Leech, paragraph 7).

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Hawthorne call the chapter 'The Leech'?

    Sample answer: Chillingworth heals and drains Dimmesdale at once. The evidence is "haunted either by Satan himself, or Satan's emissary, in the guise of old Roger Chillingworth" (IX: The Leech, paragraph 18) — The town's suspicion.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? The physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret.

    A. Sin and guilt

    B. Hypocrisy and truth

    C. Public shame and private identity

    D. Nature and the individual against society

    Key: A (Sin and guilt)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in "IX: The Leech"? Chillingworth becomes the minister's physician and companion; his face grows darker.

    A. Personification

    B. Characterization

    C. Diction / vocabulary

    D. Hyperbole

    Key: B (Characterization)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is the town's suspicion of Chillingworth wisdom or superstition? Argue.

    Sample answer: A reasoned view: the town's suspicion. The evidence is "haunted either by Satan himself, or Satan's emissary, in the guise of old Roger Chillingworth" (IX: The Leech, paragraph 18). This develops sin and guilt: the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret. Dimmesdale's habit "to press his hand over his heart" draws the physician close, and the town comes to believe he is haunted by "Satan's emissary, in the guise of old Roger Chillingworth.".

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from IX: The Leech, paragraph 2: "In his Indian captivity, moreover, he had gained much knowledge of the _____ of native herbs and roots" Word bank: evidently, appellation, properties, undertaken

    Key: properties

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Here the pale clergyman piled up his library, rich with parchment-bound folios of the Fathers, and the lore of Rabbis, and monkish erudition, of which the Protestant divines, even while they vilified and decried that…", what does "decried" most nearly mean?

    A. an unhealthy gloominess of mind

    B. prying and suspicious, like an investigator

    C. publicly condemned

    D. the decorated front of a building

Key: C (publicly condemned)

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from IX: The Leech, paragraph 9? "And saintly men, who walk with God on earth, would fain be away, to walk with him on the golden _____ of the New Jerusalem."

    A. propounded

    B. professional

    C. pavements

    D. properties

    Key: C (pavements)

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from IX: The Leech, paragraph 2? "In pursuance of this resolve, he took up his residence in the Puritan town, as Roger Chillingworth, without other _____ than the learning and intelligence of which he possessed more than a common measure."

    A. evidently

    B. introduction

    C. marketplace

    D. professional

    Key: B (introduction)

21. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from IX: The Leech, paragraph 1: "Under the _____ of Roger Chillingworth, the reader will remember, was hidden another name, which its former wearer had resolved should never more be spoken." Word bank: evidently, extinguished, introduction, appellation

    Key: appellation

22. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What profession does Chillingworth practice?

    A. Merchant

    B. Soldier

    C. Physician

    D. Minister

    Key: C (Physician)

23. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from IX: The Leech, paragraph 1 reveal about the character or situation? "Her matronly fame was trodden under all men's feet." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (IX: The Leech, paragraph 1) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret. The words "matronly" and "trodden" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

24. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from IX: The Leech, paragraph 10 reveal about the character or situation? "Nay,' rejoined the young minister, putting his hand to his heart, with a flush of pain flitting over his brow, 'were I worthier to walk there, I could be better content to toil here." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (IX: The Leech, paragraph 10) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret. The words "flitting" and "rejoined" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

25. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “the fire in his laboratory had been brought from the lower regions” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 17) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The townspeople's suspicion. The evidence is “the fire in his laboratory had been brought from the lower regions” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 17). This develops sin and guilt: the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret.

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from IX: The Leech, paragraph 3 shapes its tone: “This learned stranger was exemplary, as regarded, at least, the outward forms of a religious life, and, early after his arrival, had chosen for his spiritual guide the Reverend Mr. Dimmesdale.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “religious” and “spiritual” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 3) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

27. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which literary element does this describe in “IX: The Leech”? People begin to whisper that the physician is Satan's emissary.
    A. Foreshadowing
    B. Setting
    C. Alliteration
    D. Theme

    Key: A (Foreshadowing)

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: The physician's care is a disguise for persecution. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 7).
    Sample answer: Dimmesdale's habit "to press his hand over his heart" draws the physician close, and the town comes to believe he is haunted by "Satan's emissary, in the guise of old Roger Chillingworth.". The evidence is “it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 7) — Dimmesdale's telltale gesture. This develops sin and guilt: the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from IX: The Leech, paragraph 16 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: “The new abode of the two friends was with a pious widow, of good social rank, who dwelt in a house covering pretty nearly the site on which the venerable structure of King’s Chapel has since been built.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (IX: The Leech, paragraph 16) develops hypocrisy and truth: the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret. Its words “structure” and “venerable” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “The motherly care of the good widow assigned to Mr. Dimmesdale a front apartment, with a sunny exposure, and heavy…” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 16), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

30. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from IX: The Leech, paragraph 5: “He expressed great alarm at his pastor’s state of health, but was anxious to attempt the cure, and, if early _____, seemed not despondent of a favorable result.” Word bank: evidently, characteristic, propounded, undertaken
    Key: undertaken

31. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where do the two men live?
    A. In separate towns

B. In the forest

C. In the same house by the graveyard

D. In the church

Key: C (In the same house by the graveyard)

32. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from IX: The Leech, paragraph 12 shapes its tone: “In truth, he was startled, if not shocked, to find this attribute in the physician.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words “physician” and “attribute” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 12) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

33. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from IX: The Leech, paragraph 13 shapes its tone: “He deemed it essential, it would seem, to know the man, before attempting to do him good.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words “attempting” and “essential” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 13) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

34. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from IX: The Leech, paragraph 14 to the story's treatment of women and independence: “Roger Chillingworth possessed all, or most, of the attributes above enumerated.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
Sample answer: This passage (IX: The Leech, paragraph 14) develops women and independence: the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret. Its words “attributes” and “enumerated” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “After a time, at a hint from Roger Chillingworth, the friends of Mr. Dimmesdale effected an arrangement by which the…” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 15), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

35. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from IX: The Leech, paragraph 4 to the story's treatment of women and independence: “His first entry on the scene, few people could tell whence, dropping down, as it were, out of the sky, or starting from the nether earth, had an aspect of mystery, which was easily heightened to the miraculous.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
Sample answer: This passage (IX: The Leech, paragraph 4) develops women and independence: the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret. Its words “miraculous” and “heightened” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Why, with such rank in the learned world, had he come hither?” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 4), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

36. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from IX: The Leech, paragraph 4? “Such was the young clergyman’s condition, and so imminent the prospect that his dawning light would be _____, all untimely, when Roger Chillingworth made his advent to the town.”

A. marketplace

B. propounded

C. characteristic

D. extinguished

Key: D (extinguished)

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Synthesis: trace how sin and guilt develops from VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister to IX: The Leech. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Earlier, in VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 22, the text reads “God gave me the child … She is my happiness!—she is my torture, none the less” — Hester's plea. In IX: The Leech, “it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 7) — Dimmesdale's telltale gesture. The physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret.
38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 7) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Dimmesdale's telltale gesture. The evidence is “it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 7). This develops sin and guilt: the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret. The words “constant” and “gesture” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Dimmesdale's habit "to press his hand over his heart" draws the physician close, and the town comes to believe he is haunted by "Satan's emissary, in the guise of old Roger Chillingworth.".
39. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from IX: The Leech, paragraph 2 shapes its tone: “As his studies, at a previous period of his life, had made him extensively acquainted with the medical science of the day, it was as a physician that he presented himself, and as such was cordially received.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “extensively” and “acquainted” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 2) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.
40. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Analyze the word choice in “haunted either by Satan himself, or Satan’s emissary, in the guise of old Roger Chillingworth” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 18). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: The town's suspicion. The evidence is “haunted either by Satan himself, or Satan’s emissary, in the guise of old Roger Chillingworth” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 18). This develops sin and guilt: the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret. The words “emissary” and “haunted” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.
41. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Connect this passage from IX: The Leech, paragraph 5 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: “The elders, the deacons, the motherly dames, and the young and fair maidens, of Mr. Dimmesdale’s flock, were alike importunate that he should make trial of the physician’s frankly offered skill.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (IX: The Leech, paragraph 5) develops hypocrisy and truth: the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret. Its words “importunate” and “physician” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “He listened in silence, and finally promised to confer with the physician.” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 7), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.
42. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “the fire in his laboratory had been brought from the lower regions” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 17) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: The townspeople's suspicion. The evidence is “the fire in his laboratory had been brought from the lower regions” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 17). This develops sin and guilt: the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret. The words “laboratory” and “brought” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and

changing either would soften the effect. Dimmesdale's habit "to press his hand over his heart" draws the physician close, and the town comes to believe he is haunted by "Satan's emissary, in the guise of old Roger Chillingworth.".

43. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Complete the quotation from IX: The Leech, paragraph 7: “it had now become a _____ habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart”
Key: constant

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 11, inference 2, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 18, 2, 19, 11, 20, 21, 22, 13, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	10, 17, 30, 21, 22, 9, 11, 31, 24, 13, 23, 26, 32, 33, 16, 34	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	4, 22, 9, 17, 11, 25, 24, 23, 13, 12, 14, 32, 15, 26, 34, 35	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	8, 21, 36, 4, 30, 7, 23, 13, 24, 33, 26, 14, 27, 37, 38, 35	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	6, 4, 22, 11, 31, 13, 24, 15, 39, 32, 33, 26, 16, 37, 29, 34	recall 5, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	4, 7, 6, 22, 31, 24, 32, 28, 33, 27, 40, 29, 41, 42, 34, 16	recall 5, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	7, 43, 22, 31, 23, 13, 14, 32, 27, 33, 39, 42, 41, 29, 34, 16	recall 4, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	10, 11, 7, 22, 25, 26, 32, 39, 15, 14, 34, 41, 37, 29, 16, 35	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	8, 11, 7, 22, 26, 14, 33, 40, 27, 35, 29, 16, 37, 38, 41, 34	recall 4, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	21, 11, 22, 31, 14, 33, 27, 39, 26, 40, 29, 41, 34, 35, 37, 16	recall 4, inference 0, analysis 6, synthesis 6

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “IX: The Leech,” how does Hawthorne show the leech? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In IX: The Leech, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of the leech? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how IX: The Leech develops the idea of the leech. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of IX: The Leech (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of the leech. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what IX: The Leech suggests about the leech. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and foreshadowing), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses characterization in IX: The Leech to complicate the reader's understanding of the leech. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate IX: The Leech within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the leech responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read IX: The Leech alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the leech follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to IX: The Leech and its treatment of the leech. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and foreshadowing, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads IX: The Leech as evidence for a larger claim about the leech in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads IX: The Leech as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the leech. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

SAT-style questions

1. *Here the pale clergyman piled up his library, rich with parchment-bound folios of the Fathers, and the lore of Rabbis, and monkish erudition, of which the Protestant divines, even while they vilified and decried that class of writers, were yet constrained often to avail themselves.*

As used in the text, what does the word "decried" most nearly mean?

A. publicly condemned

B. lacking curiosity (here 'not incurious' means quite curious)

C. digging or searching deeply

D. a member of a minister's congregation

2. *This idea was countenanced by the strong interest which the physician ever manifested in the young clergyman; he attached himself to him as a parishioner, and sought to win a friendly regard and confidence from his naturally reserved sensibility. He expressed great alarm at his pastor's state of health, but was anxious to attempt the cure, and, if early undertaken, seemed not despondent of a favorable result. The elders, the deacons, the motherly dames, and the young and fair maidens, of Mr. Dimmesdale's flock, were alike importunate that he should make trial of the physician's frankly offered skill. Mr. Dimmesdale gently repelled their entreaties.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "IX: The Leech"?

A. The interview in prison

B. Hester at her needle

C. The leech

D. The frame narrative and the found letter

SAT key: 1. A (publicly condemned); 2. C (The leech)

Lesson 13: X: The Leech and His Patient

Focus: the physician probes the minister

Objective: Students will analyze how structure develops in “X: The Leech and His Patient” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Critical voice: “There is a strange fascination to a man of contemplative genius in the psychological details of a strange crime like that which forms the plot of the Scarlet Letter, and he is therefore apt to become, like Hawthorne, too painfully anatomical in his exhibition of them.” (Edwin Percy Whipple (attrib.; the review is unsigned), critic, *Review of The Scarlet Letter, Graham's Magazine 36:5 (May 1850), "Review of New Books", review*; public domain). Irony: Chillingworth is a physician who "anatomizes" the minister. Is Hawthorne doing the same to his characters? *Objective:* Analyze Chillingworth's psychological probing of Dimmesdale. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.3

Teacher only · spoilers

Chillingworth digs ever deeper into Dimmesdale's mind. Over black weeds from an unmarked grave they argue about why some men never confess. Pearl, in the graveyard, throws a burr at the minister and calls the physician the Black Man. Later Chillingworth opens the sleeping minister's vestment, sees something on his breast, and reacts with wild joy.

Background: Puritans believed God sometimes revealed hidden sin through signs; Hawthorne plays with such 'types' and 'emblems'.

Significance: Chillingworth's search ends in near-certainty and a joy like Satan's.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *When should a person confess a secret wrong? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to hypocrisy and truth because....*
> **Prompt:** When should a person confess a secret wrong?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to hypocrisy and truth because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: bespatter — splash (with water or mud); palliate — make (a wrong) seem less serious; forebode — predict or sense (something) in advance; irreverently — without proper respect; morbidness — an unhealthy gloominess of mind. "morbidness": Origin: an English formation from morbid + -ness.
Words: bespatter: splash (with water or mud) · palliate: make (a wrong) seem less serious · forebode: predict or sense (something) in advance · irreverently: without proper respect · morbidness: an unhealthy gloominess of mind

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Puritans believed God sometimes revealed hidden sin through signs; Hawthorne plays with such 'types' and 'emblems'. Chillingworth's search ends in near-certainty and a joy like Satan's. Structure: Under talk of weeds on an unmarked grave, the physician and the minister argue about whether hidden sinners should confess. Symbolism: Black weeds that "have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime." Foreshadowing: Chillingworth opens the sleeping minister's vestment and sees something that fills him with ghastly rapture. Watch for Pearl: She throws a burr at the minister and calls the physician the Black Man.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime" slowly and put it in my own words: Chillingworth says the dark weeds grew from a buried heart to show an unconfessed crime. Next, craft. I notice the symbolic image of guilt growing from a grave. The strongest word is "unspoken": it points directly at secret sin. Then, effect. What does Chillingworth suggest with the black weeds? My answer: With the black weeds, Chillingworth suggests that hidden sin grows out of a buried heart and will show itself; he is testing Dimmesdale and putting pressure on the guilty minister.

> *these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime" slowly and put it in my own words: Chillingworth says the dark weeds grew from a buried heart to show an unconfessed crime. Next, craft. I notice the symbolic image of guilt growing from a grave. The strongest word is "unspoken": it points directly at secret sin. Then, effect. What does Chillingworth suggest with the black weeds? My answer: With the black weeds, Chillingworth suggests that hidden sin grows out of a buried heart and will show itself; he is testing Dimmesdale and putting pressure on the guilty minister.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Dimmesdale says Pearl has "the freedom of a broken law." Expected link: Pearl as the letter alive; the minister half-confessing. Ask: How does this line connect to hypocrisy and truth? Expected: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception. (Dimmesdale on Pearl's nature.)

> *None, save the freedom of a broken law (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 21)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Dimmesdale says Pearl has "the freedom of a broken law." Expected link: Pearl as the letter alive; the minister half-confessing.
Ask: How does this line connect to hypocrisy and truth?
Expected answer: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception. (Dimmesdale on Pearl's nature.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for structure, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the physician probes the minister? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how X: The Leech and His Patient develops the idea of the physician probes the minister. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret. When the text says “these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10), it shows this directly. He describes weeds springing "out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime" and insists "These men deceive themselves," and when he finally sees the minister's breast his joy differs from Satan's only by "the trait of wonder in it!"
Task: Annotate the chapter for structure, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the physician probes the minister? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how X: The Leech and His Patient develops the idea of the physician probes the minister. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret. When the text says “these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10), it shows this directly. He describes weeds springing "out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime" and insists "These men deceive themselves," and when he finally sees the minister's breast his joy differs from Satan's only by "the trait of wonder in it!"

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: When should a person confess a secret wrong? Ask: who controls this conversation, and how can you tell?
Anchor question: When should a person confess a secret wrong?
Facilitation: Ask: who controls this conversation, and how can you tell?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the physician probes the minister? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret. ("these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime", X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the physician probes the minister? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret. ("these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime", X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how structure shapes the physician probes the minister. Key takeaway: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Structure:** Under talk of weeds on an unmarked grave, the physician and the minister argue about whether hidden sinners should confess.
- **Symbolism:** Black weeds that "have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime."
- **Foreshadowing:** Chillingworth opens the sleeping minister's vestment and sees something that fills him with ghastly rapture.

Themes and how they develop

- **hypocrisy and truth:** Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception.

Symbols and motifs

- **Pearl:** She throws a burr at the minister and calls the physician the Black Man.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10) Chillingworth's probing image.
- “These men deceive themselves” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 16) Chillingworth's verdict on concealed sinners.
- “None, save the freedom of a broken law” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 21) Dimmesdale on Pearl's nature.
- “But what distinguished the physician’s ecstasy from Satan’s was the trait of wonder in it” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 45) The end of the chapter.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret.
Evidence: “these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10)
Reasoning: He describes weeds springing "out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime" and insists "These men deceive themselves," and when he finally sees the minister's breast his joy differs from Satan's only by "the trait of wonder in it!"

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
bespatter (verb)	splash (with water or mud)	*“I saw her, the other day, bespatter the Governor himself with water, at the cattle-trough in Spring Lane.*	
palliate (verb)	make (a wrong) seem less serious	*The young clergyman, after a few hours of privacy, was sensible that the disorder of his nerves had hurried him into an unseemly outbreak of temper, which there had been nothing in the physician’s words to excuse or palliate.*	
forebode (verb)	predict or sense (something) in advance	*“There can be, if I forebode aright, no power, short of the Divine mercy, to disclose, whether by uttered words, or by type or emblem, the secrets that may be buried with a human heart.*	
irreverently (adverb)	without proper respect	*She now skipped irreverently from one grave to another; until, coming to the broad, flat, armorial tombstone of a*	

		departed worthy—perhaps of Isaac Johnson himself—she began to dance upon it.	
morbidness (noun)	an unhealthy gloominess of mind	*Dimmesdale would perhaps have seen this individual's character more perfectly, if a certain morbidness, to which sick hearts are liable, had not rendered him suspicious of all mankind.*	"morbidness": Origin: an English formation from morbid + -ness. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/morbidness#Etymology)
proffering (verb)	offering	*He marvelled, indeed, at the violence with which he had thrust back the kind old man, when merely proffering the advice which it was his duty to bestow, and which the minister himself had expressly sought.*	
griping (verb)	gripping tightly	*"They mostly do," said the clergyman, griping hard at his breast as if afflicted with an importunate throb of pain.*	
waiving (verb)	setting aside; declining to pursue	*"It may be so," said the young clergyman, indifferently, as waiving a discussion that he considered irrelevant or unseasonable.*	

Discussion questions

1. When should a person confess a secret wrong?
2. Where does structure appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with public shame and private identity?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Pearl call Chillingworth? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The Black Man.
2. Where did the physician find the black weeds? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: On an unmarked grave
3. What does Dimmesdale say keeps some sinners silent? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Their nature and their zeal for good works
4. What does Pearl throw? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A burr

5. What does Chillingworth do while the minister sleeps? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Opens his vestment
6. How does Chillingworth react? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: With ghastly rapture
7. Retell the three most important events of "X: The Leech and His Patient" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Chillingworth digs ever deeper into Dimmesdale's mind. Over black weeds from an unmarked grave they argue about why some men never confess. Pearl, in the graveyard, throws a burr at the minister and calls the physician the Black Man. Later Chillingworth opens the sleeping minister's vestment, sees something on his breast, and reacts with wild joy.
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "X: The Leech and His Patient"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "X: The Leech and His Patient" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: ""I saw her, the other day, bespatter the Governor himself with water, at the cattle-trough in Spring Lane." What does "bespatter" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: bespatter: splash (with water or mud).

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does the talk about weeds unsettle Dimmesdale? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: They suggest buried sin must come out.
2. What does "X: The Leech and His Patient" suggest about the physician probes the minister? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Chillingworth's search ends in near-certainty and a joy like Satan's.
3. Find one example of structure in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for how the chapter is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.
4. How does the symbolism in this chapter shape what we understand about the physician probes the minister? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret. Useful evidence: "these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime" (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10): Chillingworth's probing image. On symbolism: Black weeds that "have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "Yet Mr.", why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "X: The Leech and His Patient", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Chillingworth digs ever deeper into Dimmesdale's mind. Over black weeds from an unmarked grave they argue about why some men never confess. Pearl, in the

graveyard, throws a burr at the minister and calls the physician the Black Man. Later Chillingworth opens the sleeping minister's vestment, sees…

7. How does “X: The Leech and His Patient” build on “IX: The Leech”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret. Useful evidence: “These men deceive themselves” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 16): Chillingworth's verdict on concealed sinners. On structure: Under talk of weeds on an unmarked grave, the physician and the minister argue about whether hidden sinners should confess. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret. Useful evidence: “None, save the freedom of a broken law” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 21): Dimmesdale on Pearl's nature. Theme link: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “When should a person confess a secret wrong?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does foreshadowing appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with public shame and private identity? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret. Useful evidence: “But what distinguished the physician’s ecstasy from Satan’s was the trait of wonder in it” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 45): The end of the chapter. On foreshadowing: Chillingworth opens the sleeping minister's vestment and sees something that fills him with ghastly rapture. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Why doesn't Hawthorne say what Chillingworth sees? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view about ambiguity.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret. Useful evidence: “these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10): Chillingworth's probing image. Theme link: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Chillingworth's search ends in near-certainty and a joy like Satan's.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2,

SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret. Useful evidence: “These men deceive themselves” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 16): Chillingworth's verdict on concealed sinners. Theme link: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret. Useful evidence: “None, save the freedom of a broken law” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 21): Dimmesdale on Pearl's nature. Theme link: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Rewrite one moment of “X: The Leech and His Patient” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the physician probes the minister? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret. Useful evidence: “But what distinguished the physician’s ecstasy from Satan’s was the trait of wonder in it” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 45): The end of the chapter. Theme link: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “X: The Leech and His Patient”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret. Useful evidence: “these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10): Chillingworth's probing image. Theme link: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to hypocrisy and truth: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret. Useful evidence: “These men deceive themselves” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 16): Chillingworth's verdict on concealed sinners. Theme link: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the structure in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret. Useful evidence: “None, save the freedom of a broken law” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 21): Dimmesdale on Pearl's nature. On structure: Under talk of weeds on an unmarked grave, the physician and the minister argue about whether hidden sinners should confess. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “X: The Leech and His Patient” treats the physician probes the minister with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret. Useful evidence: “But what distinguished the physician’s ecstasy from Satan’s was the trait of wonder in it” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 45): The end of the chapter. Theme link: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “XI: The Interior of a Heart” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret. Useful evidence: “these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10): Chillingworth's probing image. On foreshadowing: Chillingworth opens the sleeping minister's vestment and sees something that fills him with ghastly rapture. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the physician probes the minister? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret. Useful evidence: “These men deceive themselves” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 16): Chillingworth's verdict on concealed sinners. Theme link: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Structure:** look for how the chapter is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "'It may be so,' said the young clergyman, indifferently, as _____ a discussion that he considered irrelevant or unseasonable." Word bank: forebode, palliate, bespatter, waiving
   Key: waiving
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "'They mostly do,' said the clergyman, _____ hard at his breast as if afflicted with an importunate throb of pain." Word bank: griping, palliate, forebode, bespatter
   Key: griping
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "She now skipped irreverently from one grave to another; until, coming to the broad, flat, armorial tombstone of a departed worthy—perhaps of Isaac Johnson himself—she began to dance upon it.", what does "irreverently" most nearly mean?
   A. took cruel pleasure in someone's suffering
   B. without proper respect
   C. doorways; the entrance of a house
   D. make more kind, gentle and human

   Key: B (without proper respect)
4. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Pearl call Chillingworth?
   Sample answer: The Black Man.
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "I saw her, the other day, bespatter the Governor himself with water, at the cattle-trough in Spring Lane.", what does "bespatter" most nearly mean?
   A. forever, beyond death
   B. splash (with water or mud)
   C. stubbornly defying authority
   D. a reddish glow

   Key: B (splash (with water or mud))
6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "The young clergyman, after a few hours of privacy, was sensible that the disorder of his nerves had hurried him into an unseemly outbreak of temper, which there had been nothing in the physician's words to excuse or…", what does "palliate" most nearly mean?
   A. not yet healed
   B. make (a wrong) seem less serious
   C. lack of modesty or tact
   D. one's deepest feelings

   Key: B (make (a wrong) seem less serious)
7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 45: "But what _____ the physician's ecstasy from Satan's was the trait of wonder in it"
   Key: distinguished
8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "He marvelled, indeed, at the violence with which he had thrust back the kind old man, when merely _____ the advice which it was his duty to bestow, and which the minister himself had expressly sought." Word bank:

proffering, forebode, bespatter, palliate

Key: proffering

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 21: “None, save the _____ of a broken law”

   Key: freedom

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Pearl throw?

    A. A stone

    B. A burr

    C. A rose

    D. A shell

    Key: B (A burr)

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “But what distinguished the physician’s ecstasy from Satan’s was the trait of wonder in it” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 45)

    A. The sexton's unknowing irony.

    B. The end of the chapter.

    C. Why Hester names her Pearl.

    D. The letter's mysterious power.

    Key: B (The end of the chapter.)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “These men deceive themselves” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 16) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Chillingworth's verdict on concealed sinners. The evidence is “These men deceive themselves” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 16). This develops hypocrisy and truth: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does the talk about weeds unsettle Dimmesdale?

    Sample answer: They suggest buried sin must come out. The evidence is “these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10) — Chillingworth's probing image.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception.

    A. Nature and the individual against society

    B. Sin and guilt

    C. Hypocrisy and truth

    D. Public shame and private identity

    Key: C (Hypocrisy and truth)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “None, save the freedom of a broken law” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 21). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Dimmesdale on Pearl's nature. The evidence is “None, save the freedom of a broken law” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 21). This develops hypocrisy and truth: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of

their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception. The words “freedom” and “broken” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Why doesn't Hawthorne say what Chillingworth sees? Argue.
    Sample answer: A reasoned view about ambiguity: Chillingworth's probing image. The evidence is “these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10). This develops hypocrisy and truth: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception. He describes weeds springing "out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime" and insists "These men deceive themselves," and when he finally sees the minister's breast his joy differs from Satan's only by "the trait of wonder in it!".

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Dimmesdale would perhaps have seen this individual’s character more perfectly, if a certain _____, to which sick hearts are liable, had not rendered him suspicious of all mankind.” Word bank: bespatter, morbidness, forebode, palliate
    Key: morbidness

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where did the physician find the black weeds?
    A. In the forest
    B. In the garden
    C. On an unmarked grave
    D. By the sea

    Key: C (On an unmarked grave)

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Chillingworth do while the minister sleeps?
    A. Opens his vestment
    B. Leaves the house
    C. Poisons him
    D. Prays

    Key: A (Opens his vestment)

20. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10: “these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make _____ an unspoken crime”
    Key: manifest

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Dimmesdale say keeps some sinners silent?
    A. Their nature and their zeal for good works
    B. Love of money
    C. Ignorance
    D. Fear of hell

    Key: A (Their nature and their zeal for good works)

22. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “X: The Leech and His Patient”?
    A. An author answering his critics
    B. The revelation
    C. The frame narrative and the found letter
    D. The physician probes the minister

Key: D (The physician probes the minister)

23. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how hypocrisy and truth develops from III: The Recognition to X: The Leech and His Patient. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Earlier, in III: The Recognition, paragraph 31, the text reads “Speak, woman … Speak; and give your child a father” — Mr. Wilson presses Hester. In X: The Leech and His Patient, “these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10) — Chillingworth's probing image. Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception.

24. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “There can be, if I forebode aright, no power, short of the Divine mercy, to disclose, whether by uttered words, or by type or emblem, the secrets that may be buried with a human heart.”, what does “forebode” most nearly mean?
    A. belonging to a small, inner circle
    B. predict or sense (something) in advance
    C. like a shifting series of dreamlike images
    D. iron parts or fittings

    Key: B (predict or sense (something) in advance)

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Chillingworth react?
    A. With pity
    B. With fear
    C. With ghastly rapture
    D. With sorrow

    Key: C (With ghastly rapture)

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which literary element does this describe in “X: The Leech and His Patient”? Under talk of weeds on an unmarked grave, the physician and the minister argue about whether hidden sinners should confess.
    A. Setting
    B. Conflict
    C. Simile
    D. Structure

    Key: D (Structure)

27. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 1: “Old Roger Chillingworth, throughout life, had been calm in _____, kindly, though not of warm affections, but ever, and in all his relations with the world, a pure and upright man.” Word bank: sinfulness, gladly, temperament, remembrance
    Key: temperament

28. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 4? “In other words, Mr. Dimmesdale, whose _____ of nerve often produced the effect of spiritual intuition, would become vaguely aware that something inimical to his peace had thrust itself into relation with him.”
    A. sensibility
    B. remembrance
    C. sinfulness

D. graveyard

Key: A (sensibility)

29. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does this passage from X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 1 reveal about the character or situation? “But, as he proceeded, a terrible fascination, a kind of fierce, though still calm, necessity, seized the old man within its grip, and never set him free again, until he had done all its bidding.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: The passage (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 1) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception. The words “fascination” and “necessity” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

30. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What does this passage from X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 23 reveal about the character or situation? “It was as if she had been made afresh, out of new elements, and must perforce be permitted to live her own life, and be a law unto herself, without her eccentricities being reckoned to her for a crime.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: The passage (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 23) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception. The words “eccentricities” and “permitted” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

31. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 31 shapes its tone: “Then, to speak more plainly,’ continued the physician, ‘and I crave pardon, Sir—should it seem to require pardon—for this needful plainness of my speech.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words “physician” and “plainness” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 31) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

32. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 27 shapes its tone: “You inquired of me, a little time agone,’ said he, at length, ‘my judgment as touching your health.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words “touching” and “inquired” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 27) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

33. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 2 shapes its tone: “Sometimes, a light glimmered out of the physician’s eyes, burning blue and ominous, like the reflection of a furnace, or, let us say, like one of those gleams of ghastly fire that darted from Bunyan’s awful doorway in the hillside, and…” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words “reflection” and “physician” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 2) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

34. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 15 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: “Or—can we not suppose it?—guilty as they may be, retaining, nevertheless, a zeal for God’s glory and man’s welfare, they shrink from displaying themselves black and filthy in the view of men; because, thenceforward, no good can be achieved…” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 15) develops hypocrisy and truth: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception. Its words “thenceforward” and “nevertheless” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Roger Chillingworth had by this time approached the window, and smiled grimly down.” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 19), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

35. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 33? “He to whom only the outward and physical evil is laid open, knoweth, _____, but half the evil which he is called upon to cure.”

    A. oftentimes

    B. sinfulness

    C. fantastically

    D. physician

    Key: A (oftentimes)

36. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 12: “Why should not the guilty ones sooner avail themselves of this _____ solace?” Word bank: sinfulness, graveyard, fantastically, unutterable

    Key: unutterable

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “These men deceive themselves” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 16) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Chillingworth's verdict on concealed sinners. The evidence is “These men deceive themselves” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 16). This develops hypocrisy and truth: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception. The words “themselves” and “deceive” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He describes weeds springing "out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime" and insists "These men deceive themselves," and when he finally sees the minister's breast his joy differs from Satan's only by "the trait of wonder in it!".

38. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “None, save the freedom of a broken law” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 21)

    A. The core of his hypocrisy.

    B. The harshest woman in the crowd.

    C. His imagined ancestors' contempt for him.

    D. Dimmesdale on Pearl's nature.

    Key: D (Dimmesdale on Pearl's nature.)

39. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 4 shapes its tone: “He groped along as stealthily, with as cautious a tread, and as wary an outlook, as a thief entering a chamber where a man lies only half asleep—or, it may be, broad awake—with purpose to steal the very treasure which this man guards as…” Pick two words and

explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “stealthily” and “cautious” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 4) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 7 to the story's treatment of women and independence: “Where,’ asked he, with a look askance at them—for it was the clergyman’s peculiarity that he seldom, nowadays, looked straightforth at any object, whether human or inanimate—‘where, my kind doctor, did you gather those herbs, with such a…” Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 7) develops women and independence: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception. Its words “straightforth” and “peculiarity” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “They grew out of his heart, and typify, it may be, some hideous secret that was buried with him, and which he had done…” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 8), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

41. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 33 to the story's treatment of women and independence: “You, Sir, of all men whom I have known, are he whose body is the closest conjoined, and imbued, and identified, so to speak, with the spirit whereof it is the instrument.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 33) develops women and independence: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception. Its words “instrument” and “identified” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Thus, a sickness,’ continued Roger Chillingworth, going on, in an unaltered tone, without heeding the interruption—but…” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 35), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

42. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Which word completes this sentence from X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 23? “So she drew her mother away, skipping, dancing, and frisking _____, among the hillocks of the dead people, like a creature that had nothing in common with a bygone and buried generation, nor owned herself akin to it.”

A. fantastically

B. remembrance

C. sinfulness

D. gladly

Key: A (fantastically)

43. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Which literary element does this describe in “X: The Leech and His Patient”? Black weeds that ‘have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime.’

A. Personification

B. Allusion

C. Symbolism

D. Plot

Key: C (Symbolism)

44. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10) supports it: He describes weeds springing "out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime" and insists "These men deceive themselves," and when he finally sees the minister's breast his joy differs from Satan's only by "the trait of wonder in it!". But “But what distinguished the physician’s ecstasy from Satan’s was the trait of wonder in it” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 45) complicates it: The end of the chapter, and its “But” marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. The claim is therefore a strong reading, not a complete one, and a careful answer says where it stops applying.
45. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Claim: Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10).
    Sample answer: He describes weeds springing "out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime" and insists "These men deceive themselves," and when he finally sees the minister's breast his joy differs from Satan's only by "the trait of wonder in it!". The evidence is “these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10) — Chillingworth's probing image. This develops hypocrisy and truth: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception.
46. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Connect this passage from X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 36 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: “Let him do with me as, in his justice and wisdom, he shall see good.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 36) develops hypocrisy and truth: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception. Its words “justice” and “wisdom” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “But see, now, how passion takes hold upon this man, and hurrieth him out of himself!” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 38), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.
47. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Chillingworth's probing image. The evidence is “these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10). This develops hypocrisy and truth: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception. The words “manifest” and “unspoken” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He describes weeds springing "out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime" and insists "These men deceive themselves," and when he finally sees the minister's breast his joy differs from Satan's only by "the trait of wonder in it!".

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	1, 17, 18, 7, 8, 19, 20, 21, 6, 4, 11, 13, 22, 14, 15, 23	

		recall 10, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	17, 24, 21, 25, 7, 5, 4, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 26, 23, 16	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	27, 9, 18, 28, 21, 29, 11, 13, 30, 12, 31, 15, 32, 33, 34, 23	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	35, 36, 1, 28, 5, 30, 11, 29, 13, 32, 31, 26, 15, 37, 16, 23	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	17, 7, 28, 11, 13, 38, 29, 39, 14, 31, 33, 32, 23, 37, 40, 41	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	17, 8, 42, 13, 11, 29, 30, 43, 39, 14, 15, 31, 23, 16, 44, 37	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	7, 21, 17, 30, 13, 11, 26, 32, 14, 39, 45, 44, 34, 16, 23, 40	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	17, 18, 8, 21, 38, 31, 33, 14, 32, 39, 23, 40, 41, 46, 16, 34	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	2, 17, 18, 11, 33, 31, 26, 39, 14, 23, 34, 44, 46, 16, 41, 40	recall 3, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	42, 17, 8, 18, 21, 39, 33, 26, 40, 46, 34, 44, 41, 16, 23, 47	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 3, synthesis 8

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “X: The Leech and His Patient,” how does Hawthorne show the physician probes the minister? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the structure you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In X: The Leech and His Patient, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of the physician probes the minister? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the structure in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how X: The Leech and His Patient develops the idea of the physician probes the minister. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of X: The Leech and His Patient (where it begins, turns and ends) and its structure shape the reader's understanding of the physician probes the minister. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what X: The Leech and His Patient suggests about the physician probes the minister. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's structure and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses structure in X: The Leech and His Patient to complicate the reader's understanding

of the physician probes the minister. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate X: The Leech and His Patient within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the physician probes the minister responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read X: The Leech and His Patient alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the physician probes the minister follows or bends those conventions, using the structure as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to X: The Leech and His Patient and its treatment of the physician probes the minister. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's structure and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads X: The Leech and His Patient as evidence for a larger claim about the physician probes the minister in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads X: The Leech and His Patient as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the physician probes the minister. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

SAT-style questions

1. *“There can be, if I forebode aright, no power, short of the Divine mercy, to disclose, whether by uttered words, or by type or emblem, the secrets that may be buried with a human heart.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “forebode” most nearly mean?

   A. gripping tightly

   B. setting aside; declining to pursue

   C. offering

   D. predict or sense (something) in advance

2. *Yet Mr. Dimmesdale would perhaps have seen this individual’s character more perfectly, if a certain morbidness, to which sick hearts are liable, had not rendered him suspicious of all mankind. Trusting no man as his friend, he could not recognize his enemy when the latter actually appeared. He therefore still kept up a familiar intercourse with him, daily receiving the old physician in his study; or visiting the laboratory, and, for recreation’s sake, watching the processes by which weeds were converted into drugs of potency.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “X: The Leech and His Patient”?

   A. The frame narrative and the found letter

B. The physician probes the minister

C. Hester and Pearl

D. The recognition

SAT key: 1. D (predict or sense (something) in advance); 2. B (The physician probes the minister)

Lesson 14: XI: The Interior of a Heart

Focus: the interior of a heart

Objective: Students will analyze how irony develops in "XI: The Interior of a Heart" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (self-harm): Dimmesdale scourges himself, fasts and keeps sleepless vigils out of guilt. Treat this as self-harm with care: do not dwell on details, and remind students that support is available.
Student preview: A character hurts himself out of guilt. Support is available if this is hard to read.
Suggested language: "What is guilt doing to Dimmesdale?"
Safe messaging: Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this chapter is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

Dimmesdale's suffering makes him a more powerful preacher; his people revere him more as he calls himself vile. He fasts, keeps vigils and scourges himself in a locked closet, sees visions, and cannot confess.

Background: Puritan ministers were the colony's intellectual leaders; fasting and self-examination were accepted disciplines, but self-scourging was associated with Catholic penance.

Significance: His vague confessions turn truth into a deeper lie.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Is admitting you are bad in general the same as confessing a specific wrong? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to hypocrisy and truth because.... Content note before we start: A character hurts himself out of guilt. Support is available if this is hard to read. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.
Prompt: Is admitting you are bad in general the same as confessing a specific wrong?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to hypocrisy and truth because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: diabolic — devilish; introspection — examining one's own thoughts and feelings; reputations — what people generally think of someone; saintlike — holy, like a saint; attestation — proof or confirmation. "introspection": Origin: Latin intrōspectiō. "attestation": Origin: Middle French attestation; earlier Latin attestātiō.
Words: diabolic: devilish · introspection: examining one's own thoughts and feelings · reputations: what people generally think of someone · saintlike: holy, like a saint · attestation: proof or confirmation

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Puritan ministers were the colony's intellectual leaders; fasting and self-examination were accepted disciplines, but self-scourging was associated with Catholic penance. His vague confessions turn truth into a deeper lie. Irony: The more Dimmesdale suffers, the more powerful his sermons and the more the people revere him. Characterization: He tells his congregation he is vile, and they hear humility. Imagery: Self-scourging, fasting and visions in the dark closet. Watch for the scarlet letter: The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "had previously been. The intellect of Roger Chillingworth had now a sufficiently plain path before it. It was not, indeed, precisely that" (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 1).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "He had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood" slowly and put it in my own words: Dimmesdale tells his congregation that he is a vile sinner, but they take his words as proof of his holy humility. Next, craft. I notice the paradox "spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood," which sets truth and lie side by side. The strongest word is "falsehood": it shows how a true statement, made vaguely, becomes a lie. Then, effect. Why does Dimmesdale's public confession make his guilt worse? My answer: Dimmesdale's public confession makes his guilt worse because he never names his sin, so the congregation thinks him even holier; each sermon deepens his self-hatred and his hypocrisy.

> *He had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 7)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "He had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood" slowly and put it in my own words: Dimmesdale tells his congregation that he is a vile sinner, but they take his words as proof of his holy humility. Next, craft. I notice the paradox "spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood," which sets truth and lie side by side. The strongest word is "falsehood": it shows how a true statement, made vaguely, becomes a lie. Then, effect. Why does Dimmesdale's public confession make his guilt worse? My answer: Dimmesdale's public confession makes his guilt worse because he never names his sin, so the congregation thinks him even holier; each sermon deepens his self-hatred and his hypocrisy.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The congregation reads his self-accusation as saintliness. Expected link: irony; hypocrisy and truth. Ask: How does this line connect to hypocrisy and truth? Expected: His "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie. (Anguish as his only truth.)

> *The only truth that continued to give Mr. Dimmesdale a real existence on this earth, was the anguish in his inmost soul (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The congregation reads his self-accusation as saintliness. Expected link: irony; hypocrisy and truth.
Ask: How does this line connect to hypocrisy and truth?
Expected answer: His "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie. (Anguish as his only truth.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the interior of a heart? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XI: The Interior of a Heart develops the idea of the interior of a heart. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence. When the text says “The only truth that continued to give Mr. Dimmesdale a real existence on this earth, was the anguish in his inmost soul” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9), it shows this directly. Hawthorne says he "had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood," and that only "the anguish in his inmost soul" gives him "a real existence."
Task: Annotate the chapter for irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the interior of a heart? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XI: The Interior of a Heart develops the idea of the interior of a heart. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence. When the text says “The only truth that continued to give Mr. Dimmesdale a real existence on this earth, was the anguish in his inmost soul” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9), it shows this directly. Hawthorne says he "had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood," and that only "the anguish in his inmost soul" gives him "a real existence."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Is admitting you are bad in general the same as confessing a specific wrong? Ask: is Dimmesdale a coward, a hypocrite, a victim, or all three?
Anchor question: Is admitting you are bad in general the same as confessing a specific wrong?
Facilitation: Ask: is Dimmesdale a coward, a hypocrite, a victim, or all three?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the interior of a heart? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence. ("The only truth that continued to give Mr. Dimmesdale a real existence on this earth, was the anguish in his inmost soul", XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the interior of a heart? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence. ("The only truth that continued to give Mr. Dimmesdale a real existence on this earth, was the anguish in his inmost soul", XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how irony shapes the interior of a heart. Key takeaway: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Irony:** The more Dimmesdale suffers, the more powerful his sermons and the more the people revere him.
- **Characterization:** He tells his congregation he is vile, and they hear humility.
- **Imagery:** Self-scourging, fasting and visions in the dark closet.

Themes and how they develop

- **hypocrisy and truth:** his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie.

Symbols and motifs

- **the scarlet letter:** The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "had previously been. The intellect of Roger Chillingworth had now a sufficiently plain path before it. It was not, indeed, precisely that" (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 1).
- **light and darkness:** Sunshine avoids Hester but plays around Pearl; the forest is dim; the minister's vigil happens at midnight under a meteor. In this chapter: "to him, the Pitiless, to him, the Unforgiving! All that dark treasure to be lavished on the very man, to whom nothing" (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 1).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "He had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood" (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 7) The core of his hypocrisy.
- "It is the unspeakable misery of a life so false as his" (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9) The cost of falseness.
- "The only truth that continued to give Mr. Dimmesdale a real existence on this earth, was the anguish in his inmost soul" (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9) Anguish as his only truth.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence.
Evidence: "The only truth that continued to give Mr. Dimmesdale a real existence on this earth, was the anguish in his inmost soul" (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9)
Reasoning: Hawthorne says he "had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood," and that only "the anguish in his inmost soul" gives him "a real existence."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
diabolic (adjective)	devilish	*Now it was a herd of diabolic shapes, that grinned and mocked at the pale minister, and beckoned him away with them; now a group of shining angels, who flew upward heavily, as sorrow-laden, but grew more ethereal as they rose.*	
introspection (noun)	examining one's own thoughts and feelings	*He thus typified the constant introspection wherewith he tortured, but could not purify, himself.*	"introspection": Origin: Latin intrōspectiō. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/introspection#Etymology)
reputations (noun)	what people generally think of someone	*His fame, though still on its upward slope, already overshadowed the soberer reputations of his fellow-clergymen, eminent as several of them were.*	
saintlike (adjective)	holy, like a saint	*Now came the dead friends of his youth, and his white-bearded father, with a saintlike frown, and his mother, turning her face away as she passed by.*	
attestation (noun)	proof or confirmation	*These fathers, otherwise so apostolic, lacked Heaven's last and rarest attestation of their office, the Tongue of Flame.*	"attestation": Origin: Middle French attestation; earlier Latin attestātiō. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://

			en.wiktionary.org/wiki/attestation#Etymology)
wreaked (verb)	inflicted (revenge or harm)	*Calm, gentle, passionless, as he appeared, there was yet, we fear, a quiet depth of malice, hitherto latent, but active now, in this unfortunate old man, which led him to imagine a more intimate revenge than any mortal had ever wreaked upon an enemy.*	
infecting (verb)	spreading disease or corruption into	*Dimmesdale, conscious that the poison of one morbid spot was infecting his heart's entire substance, attributed all his presentiments to no other cause.*	"infecting": Origin of "infect": Middle French infect; earlier Latin infectus. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/infect#Etymology)
mouthpiece (noun)	a person who speaks for someone else	*They fancied him the mouthpiece of Heaven's messages of wisdom, and rebuke, and love.*	

Discussion questions

1. Is admitting you are bad in general the same as confessing a specific wrong?
2. Where does irony appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with hypocrisy and truth?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does he do in his vigils? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He sits up at night, sometimes looking at his face in a mirror by lamplight.
2. What makes Dimmesdale's sermons powerful? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: His own suffering
3. How do his people react when he calls himself vile? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: They revere him more
4. What does he use on himself in the closet? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A scourge
5. What does he see in his visions? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Figures including his parents and Hester

6. Why can he not confess? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He lacks the courage
7. Retell the three most important events of "XI: The Interior of a Heart" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Dimmesdale's suffering makes him a more powerful preacher; his people revere him more as he calls himself vile. He fasts, keeps vigils and scourges himself in a locked closet, sees visions, and cannot confess.
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "XI: The Interior of a Heart"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "XI: The Interior of a Heart" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: "Now it was a herd of diabolic shapes, that grinned and mocked at the pale minister, and beckoned him away with them; now a group of shining angels, who flew upward heavily, as sorrow-laden, but grew more ethereal as…" What does "diabolic" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: diabolic: devilish.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why is his vague confession worse than silence? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: It wins praise and hides the truth.
2. What does "XI: The Interior of a Heart" suggest about the interior of a heart? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: His vague confessions turn truth into a deeper lie.
3. Find one example of irony in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
4. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about the interior of a heart? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence. Useful evidence: "He had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood" (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 7): The core of his hypocrisy. On characterization: He tells his congregation he is vile, and they hear humility. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "After the incident last described, the intercourse between the clergyman and the physician, though externally the same, was really of another character than it had previously been.", why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "XI: The Interior of a Heart", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Dimmesdale's suffering makes him a more powerful preacher; his people revere him more as he calls himself vile. He fasts, keeps vigils and scourges himself in a locked closet, sees visions, and cannot confess.

7. How does “XI: The Interior of a Heart” build on “X: The Leech and His Patient”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence. Useful evidence: “It is the unspeakable misery of a life so false as his” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9): The cost of falseness. Theme link: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence. Useful evidence: “The only truth that continued to give Mr. Dimmesdale a real existence on this earth, was the anguish in his inmost soul” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9): Anguish as his only truth. On characterization: He tells his congregation he is vile, and they hear humility. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Is admitting you are bad in general the same as confessing a specific wrong?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does imagery appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with hypocrisy and truth? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence. Useful evidence: “He had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 7): The core of his hypocrisy. On imagery: Self-scourging, fasting and visions in the dark closet. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Dimmesdale a hypocrite or a victim? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence. Useful evidence: “It is the unspeakable misery of a life so false as his” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9): The cost of falseness. Theme link: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “His vague confessions turn truth into a deeper lie.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence. Useful evidence: “The only truth that continued to give Mr. Dimmesdale a real existence on this earth, was the anguish in his inmost soul” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9): Anguish as his only

truth. Theme link: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence. Useful evidence: “He had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 7): The core of his hypocrisy. On characterization: He tells his congregation he is vile, and they hear humility. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Rewrite one moment of “XI: The Interior of a Heart” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the interior of a heart? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence. Useful evidence: “It is the unspeakable misery of a life so false as his” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9): The cost of falseness. Theme link: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “XI: The Interior of a Heart”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence. Useful evidence: “The only truth that continued to give Mr. Dimmesdale a real existence on this earth, was the anguish in his inmost soul” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9): Anguish as his only truth. Theme link: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to nature and the individual against society: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence. Useful evidence: “He had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 7): The core of his hypocrisy. Theme link: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the irony in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence. Useful evidence: “It is the unspeakable misery of a life so false as his” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9): The cost of falseness. On irony: The more Dimmesdale suffers, the more powerful his sermons and the more the people revere him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “XI: The Interior of a Heart” treats the interior of a heart with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence. Useful evidence: “The only truth that continued to give Mr. Dimmesdale a real existence on this earth, was the anguish in his inmost soul” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9): Anguish as his only truth. Theme link: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “XII: The Minister’s Vigil” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence. Useful evidence: “He had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 7): The core of his hypocrisy. Theme link: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the interior of a heart? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence. Useful evidence: “It is the unspeakable misery of a life so false as his” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9): The cost of falseness. Theme link: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What makes Dimmesdale's sermons powerful?
   A. His own suffering
   B. His wealth
   C. His loud voice
   D. His fame in Oxford

   Key: A (His own suffering)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does he use on himself in the closet?
   A. A sword
   B. A rope
   C. Fire

D. A scourge

Key: D (A scourge)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "He thus typified the constant introspection wherewith he tortured, but could not purify, himself.", what does "introspection" most nearly mean?

   A. happening at a bad time

   B. examining one's own thoughts and feelings

   C. spoke of with harsh, abusive criticism

   D. in a way that cannot be held back

   Key: B (examining one's own thoughts and feelings)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9: "The only truth that _____ to give Mr. Dimmesdale a real existence on this earth, was the anguish in his inmost soul"

   Key: continued

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Calm, gentle, passionless, as he appeared, there was yet, we fear, a quiet depth of malice, hitherto latent, but active now, in this unfortunate old man, which led him to imagine a more intimate revenge than any mortal had ever _____ upon an enemy." Word bank: introspection, diabolic, wreaked, reputations

   Key: wreaked

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Now came the dead friends of his youth, and his white-bearded father, with a saintlike frown, and his mother, turning her face away as she passed by.", what does "saintlike" most nearly mean?

   A. open the fastening of

   B. returned (a feeling or gesture)

   C. holy, like a saint

   D. a poisonous plant

   Key: C (holy, like a saint)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How do his people react when he calls himself vile?

   A. They laugh

   B. They revere him more

   C. They expel him

   D. They investigate

   Key: B (They revere him more)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "His fame, though still on its upward slope, already overshadowed the soberer reputations of his fellow-clergymen, eminent as several of them were.", what does "reputations" most nearly mean?

   A. bringing back to life in the imagination

   B. open the fastening of

   C. what people generally think of someone

   D. kindly, like a grandfather

   Key: C (what people generally think of someone)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Now it was a herd of diabolic shapes, that grinned and mocked at the pale minister, and beckoned him away with them; now a group of shining angels, who flew upward heavily, as sorrow-laden, but grew more ethereal as…”, what does “diabolic” most nearly mean?

    A. being a sign of

    B. bonds or ties connecting people

    C. predict or sense (something) in advance

    D. devilish

    Key: D (devilish)

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why can he not confess?

    A. He forgets

    B. He lacks the courage

    C. He is innocent

    D. He is forbidden

    Key: B (He lacks the courage)

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does he see in his visions?

    A. The devil only

    B. Heaven

    C. Figures including his parents and Hester

    D. The sea

    Key: C (Figures including his parents and Hester)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “It is the unspeakable misery of a life so false as his” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The cost of falseness. The evidence is “It is the unspeakable misery of a life so false as his” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9). This develops hypocrisy and truth: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why is his vague confession worse than silence?

    Sample answer: It wins praise and hides the truth. The evidence is “He had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 7), which shows the core of his hypocrisy.

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: Dimmesdale's vague public confessions are worse than silence. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “The only truth that continued to give Mr. Dimmesdale a real existence on this earth, was the anguish in his inmost soul” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9).

    Sample answer: Hawthorne says he "had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood," and that only "the anguish in his inmost soul" gives him "a real existence.". The evidence is “The only truth that continued to give Mr. Dimmesdale a real existence on this earth, was the anguish in his inmost soul” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9) — Anguish as his only truth. This develops hypocrisy and truth: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie.

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? His ‘confessions’ in vague terms are a deeper lie.

    A. Nature and the individual against society

    B. Public shame and private identity

    C. Sin and guilt

D. Hypocrisy and truth

Key: D (Hypocrisy and truth)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is Dimmesdale a hypocrite or a victim? Argue.
Sample answer: A reasoned view: the cost of falseness. The evidence is “It is the unspeakable misery of a life so false as his” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9). This develops hypocrisy and truth: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie. Hawthorne says he "had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood," and that only "the anguish in his inmost soul" gives him "a real existence.".

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Dimmesdale, conscious that the poison of one morbid spot was _____ his heart’s entire substance, attributed all his presentiments to no other cause.” Word bank: reputations, introspection, diabolic, infecting
Key: infecting

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “They fancied him the _____ of Heaven’s messages of wisdom, and rebuke, and love.” Word bank: reputations, diabolic, mouthpiece, introspection
Key: mouthpiece

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9: “It is the _____ misery of a life so false as his”
Key: unspeakable

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “He had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 7) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: The core of his hypocrisy. The evidence is “He had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 7). This develops hypocrisy and truth: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which literary element does this describe in “XI: The Interior of a Heart”? The more Dimmesdale suffers, the more powerful his sermons and the more the people revere him.

A. Personification
B. Irony
C. Conflict
D. Allusion

Key: B (Irony)

22. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how hypocrisy and truth develops from X: The Leech and His Patient to XI: The Interior of a Heart. Use one quotation from each.
Sample answer: Earlier, in X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10, the text reads “these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime” — Chillingworth's probing image. In XI: The Interior of a Heart, “He had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 7), which shows the core of his hypocrisy. His "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie.

23. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 2: “The victim was forever on the rack; it needed only to know the spring that _____ the engine; —and the physician knew it well!” Word bank: precisely, controlled, intercourse, improbably
Key: controlled

24. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 2? "The _____'s shy and sensitive reserve had balked this scheme."

    A. clergyman

    B. improbably

    C. subsequent

    D. accomplished

    Key: A (clergyman)

25. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 1: "After the incident last described, the _____ between the clergyman and the physician, though externally the same, was really of another character than it had previously been." Word bank: forgiven, machinations, revelation, intercourse

    Key: intercourse

26. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 7: "He had spoken the very truth, and _____ it into the veriest falsehood"

    Key: transformed

27. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in XI: The Interior of a Heart?

    A. "After the incident last described, the intercourse between the clergyman and the physician, though externally the same, was really of…"

    B. "It was not, indeed, precisely that which he had laid out for himself to tread."

    C. "The intellect of Roger Chillingworth had now a sufficiently plain path before it."

    D. "To make himself the one trusted friend, to whom should be confided all the fear, the remorse, the agony, the ineffectual repentance, the…"

    Key: A ("After the incident last described, the intercourse between the clergyman and the physician, though externally the same, was really of…")

28. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 8 reveal about the character or situation? "His inward trouble drove him to practices more in accordance with the old, corrupted faith of Rome, than with the better light of the church in which he had been born and bred." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 8) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie. The words "accordance" and "corrupted" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

29. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 4 reveal about the character or situation? "He won it, indeed, in great part, by his sorrows." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 4) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie. The words "sorrows" and "indeed" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 1 shapes its tone: "To make himself the one trusted friend, to whom should be confided all the fear, the remorse, the agony, the ineffectual repentance, the backward rush of sinful thoughts, expelled in vain!" Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “ineffectual” and “repentance” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 1) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

31. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 8 shapes its tone: “And now, through the chamber which these spectral thoughts had made so ghastly, glided Hester Prynne, leading along little Pearl, in her scarlet garb, and pointing her forefinger, first at the scarlet letter on her bosom, and then at the…” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “forefinger” and “clergyman” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 8) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 7 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: “Would not the people start up in their seats, by a simultaneous impulse, and tear him down out of the pulpit which he defiled?” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 7) develops hypocrisy and truth: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie. Its words “simultaneous” and “impulse” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “They little guessed what deadly purport lurked in those self-condemning words.” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 7), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

33. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 4 shapes its tone: “Their voices came down, afar and indistinctly, from the upper heights where they habitually dwelt.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “indistinctly” and “habitually” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 4) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

34. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the word choice in “The only truth that continued to give Mr. Dimmesdale a real existence on this earth, was the anguish in his inmost soul” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Anguish as his only truth. The evidence is “The only truth that continued to give Mr. Dimmesdale a real existence on this earth, was the anguish in his inmost soul” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9). This develops hypocrisy and truth: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie. The words “continued” and “existence” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

35. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 2 to the story's treatment of women and independence: “It mattered little, for his object, whether celestial, or from what other region.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 2) develops women and independence: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie. Its words “celestial” and “mattered” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “He became, thenceforth, not a spectator only, but a chief actor, in the poor minister’s interior world.” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 2), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Which literary element does this describe in “XI: The Interior of a Heart”? He tells his congregation he is vile, and they hear humility.

    A. Metaphor

    B. Simile

    C. Theme

    D. Characterization

    Key: D (Characterization)

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 5 shapes its tone: “They deemed the young clergyman a miracle of holiness.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “clergyman” and “holiness” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 5) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “He had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 7) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The core of his hypocrisy. The evidence is “He had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 7). This develops hypocrisy and truth: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie. The words “transformed” and “falsehood” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Hawthorne says he "had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood," and that only "the anguish in his inmost soul" gives him "a real existence.".

39. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “These fathers, otherwise so apostolic, lacked Heaven’s last and rarest _____ of their office, the Tongue of Flame.” Word bank: diabolic, introspection, reputations, attestation

    Key: attestation

40. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What does he do in his vigils?

    Sample answer: He sits up at night, sometimes looking at his face in a mirror by lamplight.

41. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What does this passage most clearly show? “He had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 7)

    A. Dimmesdale after meeting Mistress Hibbins.

    B. The core of his hypocrisy.

    C. The harshest woman in the crowd.

    D. The opening irony about utopias.

    Key: B (The core of his hypocrisy.)

42. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Connect this passage from XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 2 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: “As at the waving of a magician’s wand, uprose a grisly phantom—uprose a thousand phantoms—in many shapes, of death, or more awful shame, all flocking round about the clergyman, and pointing with their fingers at his breast!” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 2) develops hypocrisy and truth: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie. Its words “clergyman” and “phantoms” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern

returns in “True, he looked doubtfully, fearfully—even, at times, with horror and the bitterness of hatred—at the deformed figure…” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 3), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

43. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Connect this passage from XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 6 to the story's treatment of women and independence: “Then, what was he? —a substance?—or the dimmest of all shadows?” Use one other moment from the story as well.
Sample answer: This passage (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 6) develops women and independence: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie. Its words “substance” and “dimmest” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “More than once, Mr. Dimmesdale had gone into the pulpit, with a purpose never to come down its steps, until he should…” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 7), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

44. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] What does this passage most clearly show? “The only truth that continued to give Mr. Dimmesdale a real existence on this earth, was the anguish in his inmost soul” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9)
    A. The letter at the brook's edge.
    B. The end of the chapter.
    C. Anguish as his only truth.
    D. One account of the revelation.

    Key: C (Anguish as his only truth.)

45. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “It is the unspeakable misery of a life so false as his” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: The cost of falseness. The evidence is “It is the unspeakable misery of a life so false as his” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9). This develops hypocrisy and truth: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie. The words “unspeakable” and “misery” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Hawthorne says he "had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood," and that only "the anguish in his inmost soul" gives him "a real existence.".

46. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Which word completes this sentence from XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 4? “While thus suffering under bodily disease, and gnawed and tortured by some black trouble of the soul, and given over to the _____ of his deadliest enemy, the Reverend Mr. Dimmesdale had achieved a brilliant popularity in his sacred office.”
    A. controlled
    B. machinations
    C. humblest
    D. subsequent

    Key: B (machinations)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 11, inference 2, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	4, 17, 10, 5, 3, 18, 8, 19, 9, 12, 20, 13, 14, 15, 21, 22	recall 9, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 1

HS Sophomore	23, 11, 2, 10, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 13, 21, 30, 31, 16, 32	recall 7, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	6, 25, 24, 10, 5, 12, 28, 29, 13, 27, 33, 30, 34, 31, 16, 35	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	6, 23, 7, 5, 27, 12, 29, 13, 28, 36, 15, 30, 31, 22, 32, 16	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	5, 17, 7, 1, 27, 29, 13, 14, 15, 30, 37, 31, 38, 22, 16, 32	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	39, 5, 40, 12, 27, 41, 29, 33, 15, 37, 31, 21, 32, 42, 43, 22	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	18, 7, 39, 13, 29, 27, 33, 15, 14, 37, 36, 43, 16, 22, 32, 42	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	39, 5, 27, 44, 29, 37, 15, 36, 31, 33, 32, 35, 16, 43, 45, 42	recall 2, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	46, 39, 5, 1, 30, 15, 14, 37, 31, 36, 22, 43, 16, 42, 32, 35	recall 4, inference 0, analysis 6, synthesis 6
Graduate / PhD	26, 39, 1, 27, 31, 21, 30, 15, 37, 22, 43, 32, 42, 45, 16, 35	recall 3, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 7

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "XI: The Interior of a Heart," how does Hawthorne show the interior of a heart? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1, W.9-10.1): In XI: The Interior of a Heart, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of the interior of a heart? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1, W.9-10.1): Analyze how XI: The Interior of a Heart develops the idea of the interior of a heart. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of XI: The Interior of a Heart (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of the interior of a heart. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what XI: The Interior of a Heart suggests about the interior of a heart. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh

the evidence for each (including the chapter's irony and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses irony in XI: The Interior of a Heart to complicate the reader's understanding of the interior of a heart. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate XI: The Interior of a Heart within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the interior of a heart responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read XI: The Interior of a Heart alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the interior of a heart follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to XI: The Interior of a Heart and its treatment of the interior of a heart. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's irony and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads XI: The Interior of a Heart as evidence for a larger claim about the interior of a heart in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads XI: The Interior of a Heart as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the interior of a heart. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

SAT-style questions

1. *His fame, though still on its upward slope, already overshadowed the soberer reputations of his fellow-clergymen, eminent as several of them were.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “reputations” most nearly mean?

   A. what people generally think of someone

   B. inflicted (revenge or harm)

   C. spreading disease or corruption into

   D. a person who speaks for someone else

2. *After the incident last described, the intercourse between the clergyman and the physician, though externally the same, was really of another character than it had previously been. The intellect of Roger Chillingworth*

had now a sufficiently plain path before it. It was not, indeed, precisely that which he had laid out for himself to tread. Calm, gentle, passionless, as he appeared, there was yet, we fear, a quiet depth of malice, hitherto latent, but active now, in this unfortunate old man, which led him to imagine a more intimate revenge than any mortal had ever wreaked upon an enemy. To make himself the one trusted friend, to whom should be confided all the fear, the remorse, the agony, the ineffectual repentance, the backward rush of sinful thoughts, expelled in vain! All that guilty sorrow, hidden from the world, whose great heart would have pitied and forgiven, to be revealed to him, the Pitiless, to him, the Unforgiving! All that dark treasure to be lavished on the very man, to whom nothing else could so adequately pay the debt of vengeance!

Which choice best states a central concern of "XI: The Interior of a Heart"?

A. The interior of a heart

B. The frame narrative and the found letter

C. Conclusion

D. The elf-child and the minister

SAT key: 1. A (what people generally think of someone); 2. A (The interior of a heart)

Lesson 15: XII: The Minister's Vigil

Focus: the minister's vigil

Objective: Students will analyze how setting develops in "XII: The Minister's Vigil" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Critical voice: "In _The Scarlet Letter_ there is a great deal of symbolism; there is, I think, too much. It is overdone at times, and becomes mechanical; it ceases to be impressive, and grazes triviality." (Henry James, novelist and critic, *Hawthorne (English Men of Letters, 1879), Chapter V, Ch. V*; public domain). Debate: is the A in the sky the novel's worst moment (James) or its boldest? *Objective:* Evaluate the meteor and symbolism in the minister's vigil. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.4, RL.11-12.5

Teacher only · spoilers

One May midnight, Dimmesdale climbs the scaffold and shrieks; nobody wakes except Governor Bellingham and Mistress Hibbins, who see nothing. Hester and Pearl, returning from Governor Winthrop's deathbed, join him hand in hand. Pearl asks if he will stand with them at noon; he says no. A meteor lights the sky in the shape of an A, and Chillingworth is seen watching. Next day the sexton returns the minister's glove and reports the A in the sky means Angel.

Background: John Winthrop, the colony's first governor, died in March 1649; Hawthorne sets his death on the night of the vigil.

Significance: A secret confession in darkness changes nothing.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Does confessing in private count if no one sees? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to public shame and private identity because....*
> **Prompt:** Does confessing in private count if no one sees?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to public shame and private identity because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: thresholds — doorways; the entrance of a house; betokening — being a sign of; awfulness — a feeling of awe and dread; scurrilous — insulting and mocking; distorting — changing the true shape or meaning. "thresholds": Origin of "threshold": Old English þrescold ("doorsill"). "awfulness": Origin: an English formation from awful + -ness. "scurrilous": Origin: Latin scurrīlis ("buffoon-like").
Words: thresholds: doorways; the entrance of a house · betokening: being a sign of · awfulness: a feeling of awe and dread · scurrilous: insulting and mocking · distorting: changing the true shape or meaning

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
John Winthrop, the colony's first governor, died in March 1649; Hawthorne sets his death on the night of the vigil. A secret confession in darkness changes nothing. Setting: Midnight in May; Dimmesdale stands on the scaffold where Hester stood seven years before. Symbolism: A meteor draws a great red "A" across the sky; the town reads it as "Angel" for Governor Winthrop. Irony: Pearl asks him to stand with them "tomorrow noontide," and he will not. Watch for the scaffold: The three stand together in the dark, "an electric chain."

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide" slowly and put it in my own words: On the midnight scaffold, Pearl asks whether he will stand there with her mother and her at noon tomorrow. Next, craft. I notice the simple child's question, which demands in daylight what he will only do in the dark. The strongest word is "noontide": it means full noon, when the whole town would see them together. Then, effect. What is Pearl really asking Dimmesdale to do? My answer: Pearl asks for public acknowledgment; when Dimmesdale refuses and says "not tomorrow," the scene shows his fear and sets up his final confession on the same scaffold in daylight.

> *Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide* (XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 21)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide" slowly and put it in my own words: On the midnight scaffold, Pearl asks whether he will stand there with her mother and her at noon tomorrow. Next, craft. I notice the simple child's question, which demands in daylight what he will only do in the dark. The strongest word is "noontide": it means full noon, when the whole town would see them together. Then, effect. What is Pearl really asking Dimmesdale to do? My answer: Pearl asks for public acknowledgment; when Dimmesdale refuses and says "not tomorrow," the scene shows his fear and sets up his final confession on the same scaffold in daylight.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The returned glove and the sexton's line about "a pure hand" are dramatic irony. Expected link: irony and symbolism. Ask: How does this line connect to public shame and private identity? Expected: A private, unseen confession that changes nothing. (The sexton's unknowing irony.)

> *A pure hand needs no glove to cover it (XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 49)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The returned glove and the sexton's line about "a pure hand" are dramatic irony. Expected link: irony and symbolism.
Ask: How does this line connect to public shame and private identity?
Expected answer: A private, unseen confession that changes nothing. (The sexton's unknowing irony.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for setting, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the minister's vigil? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XII: The Minister's Vigil develops the idea of the minister's vigil. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness. When the text says "Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide" (XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 21), it shows this directly. He refuses Pearl's request to stand with them "tomorrow noontide," and the town reads the red letter as "Angel" while the sexton praises "a pure hand."
Task: Annotate the chapter for setting, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the minister's vigil? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XII: The Minister's Vigil develops the idea of the minister's vigil. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness. When the text says "Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide" (XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 21), it shows this directly. He refuses Pearl's request to stand with them "tomorrow noontide," and the town reads the red letter as "Angel" while the sexton praises "a pure hand."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Does confessing in private count if no one sees? Have students map the novel's three scaffold scenes and compare who stands there, when and who sees.
Anchor question: Does confessing in private count if no one sees?
Facilitation: Have students map the novel's three scaffold scenes and compare who stands there, when and who sees.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the minister's vigil? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness. ("Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide", XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 21). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the minister's vigil? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness. ("Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide", XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 21). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how setting shapes the minister's vigil. Key takeaway: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Setting:** Midnight in May; Dimmesdale stands on the scaffold where Hester stood seven years before.
- **Symbolism:** A meteor draws a great red "A" across the sky; the town reads it as "Angel" for Governor Winthrop.
- **Irony:** Pearl asks him to stand with them "tomorrow noontide," and he will not.

Themes and how they develop

- **public shame and private identity:** a private, unseen confession that changes nothing.

Symbols and motifs

- **the scaffold:** The three stand together in the dark, "an electric chain."

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide" (XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 21) Pearl's question.
- "the letter A, which we interpret to stand for Angel" (XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 51) The sexton's reading of the sign.
- "A pure hand needs no glove to cover it" (XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 49) The sexton's unknowing irony.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness.
Evidence: "Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide" (XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 21)
Reasoning: He refuses Pearl's request to stand with them "tomorrow noontide," and the town reads the red letter as "Angel" while the sexton praises "a pure hand."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
thresholds (noun)	doorways; the entrance of a house	*All people, in a word, would come stumbling over their thresholds, and turning up their amazed and horror-stricken visages around the scaffold.*	"thresholds": Origin of "threshold": Old English þrescold ("doorsill"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/threshold#Etymology)
betokening (verb)	being a sign of	*The belief was a favorite one with our forefathers, as betokening that their infant commonwealth was under a celestial guardianship of peculiar intimacy and strictness.*	
awfulness (noun)	a feeling of awe and dread	*It showed the familiar scene of the street, with the distinctness of midday, but also with the awfulness that is always imparted to familiar objects by an unaccustomed light.*	"awfulness": Origin: an English formation from awful + -ness. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/awfulness#Etymology)
scurrilous (adjective)	insulting and mocking	*Satan dropped it there, I take it, intending a scurrilous jest against your reverence.*	"scurrilous": Origin: Latin scurrīlis ("buffoon-like"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/scurrilous#Etymology)
distorting (adjective)	changing the true shape or meaning	*Oftener, however, its credibility rested on the faith of some lonely eyewitness, who beheld the wonder through the colored, magnifying, and distorting medium of his imagination, and shaped it more distinctly in his afterthought.*	
meteoric (adjective)	having to do with meteors or bright objects in the sky	*Nothing was more common, in those days, than to interpret all meteoric appearances, and other natural phenomena, that occurred with less regularity than the rise and set of sun and moon, as so many revelations from a supernatural source.*	
credibility (noun)	the quality of being believable	*Oftener, however, its credibility rested on the faith of some lonely eyewitness, who beheld the wonder through the colored, magnifying, and distorting medium of his*	

		imagination, and shaped it more distinctly in his afterthought.	
chilliness (noun)	coldness	*He felt his limbs growing stiff with the unaccustomed chilliness of the night, and doubted whether he should be able to descend the steps of the scaffold.*	

Discussion questions

1. Does confessing in private count if no one sees?
2. Where does setting appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with nature and the individual against society?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Whose deathbed has Hester come from? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Governor Winthrop's.
2. Where does Dimmesdale stand at midnight? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: On the scaffold
3. Who joins him? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Hester and Pearl
4. What does Pearl ask? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Will he stand with them at noon tomorrow
5. What appears in the sky? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A red letter A
6. What does the town say the A means? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Angel
7. Retell the three most important events of "XII: The Minister's Vigil" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: One May midnight, Dimmesdale climbs the scaffold and shrieks; nobody wakes except Governor Bellingham and Mistress Hibbins, who see nothing. Hester and Pearl, returning from Governor Winthrop's deathbed, join him hand in hand. Pearl asks if he will stand with them at noon; he says no. A meteor lights the sky in the shape of an A, and Chillingworth is seen watching. Next day the sexton returns the…
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "XII: The Minister's Vigil"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "XII: The Minister's Vigil" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.

10. Reread: “All people, in a word, would come stumbling over their thresholds, and turning up their amazed and horror-stricken visages around the scaffold.” What does “thresholds” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: thresholds: doorways; the entrance of a house.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why is the sexton's 'A pure hand needs no glove' ironic? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Dimmesdale's hand is not pure.
2. What does “XII: The Minister’s Vigil” suggest about the minister's vigil? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A secret confession in darkness changes nothing.
3. Find one example of setting in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
4. How does the symbolism in this chapter shape what we understand about the minister's vigil? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness. Useful evidence: “Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 21): Pearl's question. On symbolism: A meteor draws a great red "A" across the sky; the town reads it as "Angel" for Governor Winthrop. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins ““It was found,””, why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “XII: The Minister’s Vigil”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: One May midnight, Dimmesdale climbs the scaffold and shrieks; nobody wakes except Governor Bellingham and Mistress Hibbins, who see nothing. Hester and Pearl, returning from Governor Winthrop's deathbed, join him hand in hand. Pearl asks if he will stand with them at noon; he says no. A meteor…
7. How does “XII: The Minister’s Vigil” build on “XI: The Interior of a Heart”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness. Useful evidence: “the letter A, which we interpret to stand for Angel” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 51): The sexton's reading of the sign. Theme link: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness. Useful evidence: “A pure hand needs no glove to cover it” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 49): The

sexton's unknowing irony. Theme link: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “Does confessing in private count if no one sees?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does irony appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with nature and the individual against society? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness. Useful evidence: “Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 21): Pearl's question. On irony: Pearl asks him to stand with them "tomorrow noontide," and he will not. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Compare the vigil with the first scaffold scene. What has changed? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned comparison.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness. Useful evidence: “the letter A, which we interpret to stand for Angel” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 51): The sexton's reading of the sign. Theme link: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “A secret confession in darkness changes nothing.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness. Useful evidence: “A pure hand needs no glove to cover it” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 49): The sexton's unknowing irony. Theme link: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness. Useful evidence: “Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 21): Pearl's question. Theme link: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Rewrite one moment of “XII: The Minister’s Vigil” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the minister's vigil? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness.

Useful evidence: “the letter A, which we interpret to stand for Angel” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 51): The sexton's reading of the sign. Theme link: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “XII: The Minister’s Vigil”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness. Useful evidence: “A pure hand needs no glove to cover it” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 49): The sexton's unknowing irony. Theme link: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to women and independence: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness. Useful evidence: “Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 21): Pearl's question. Theme link: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the setting in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness. Useful evidence: “the letter A, which we interpret to stand for Angel” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 51): The sexton's reading of the sign. On setting: Midnight in May; Dimmesdale stands on the scaffold where Hester stood seven years before. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “XII: The Minister’s Vigil” treats the minister's vigil with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness. Useful evidence: “A pure hand needs no glove to cover it” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 49): The sexton's unknowing irony. Theme link: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “XIII: Another View of Hester” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness. Useful evidence: “Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 21): Pearl's question. Theme link: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing.

Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the minister's vigil? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness. Useful evidence: “the letter A, which we interpret to stand for Angel” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 51): The sexton's reading of the sign. Theme link: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the town say the A means?
    A. Angel
    B. Adultery
    C. Able
    D. Arthur

    Key: A (Angel)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 6? “The magistrate, after a wary observation of the darkness—into which, _____, he could see but little further than he might into a millstone—retired from the window.”
    A. inextricable
    B. possessed
    C. nevertheless
    D. believed

    Key: C (nevertheless)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 10: “For one instant, he _____ that these words had passed his lips.” Word bank: reverberations, before, believed, minister

    Key: believed

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where does Dimmesdale stand at midnight?
    A. In the forest
    B. On the scaffold
    C. In the pulpit
    D. On a ship

Key: B (On the scaffold)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 5: "The shriek had perhaps sounded with a far greater power, to his own startled ears, than it actually _____." Word bank: inextricable, grotesque, discontented, possessed

   Key: possessed

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 2? "Poor, _____ man! what right had infirmity like his to burden itself with crime?"

   A. poisonous

   B. believed

   C. minister

   D. miserable

   Key: D (miserable)

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "He felt his limbs growing stiff with the unaccustomed _____ of the night, and doubted whether he should be able to descend the steps of the scaffold." Word bank: chilliness, awfulness, betokening, thresholds

   Key: chilliness

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "The belief was a favorite one with our forefathers, as betokening that their infant commonwealth was under a celestial guardianship of peculiar intimacy and strictness.", what does "betokening" most nearly mean?

   A. removed or done away with

   B. being a sign of

   C. a hooped frame worn under a skirt to make it stand out

   D. not saved from sin

   Key: B (being a sign of)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What appears in the sky?

   A. A red letter A

   B. An eclipse

   C. A comet shaped like a rose

   D. A cross

   Key: A (A red letter A)

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "the letter A, which we interpret to stand for Angel" (XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 51) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The sexton's reading of the sign. The evidence is "the letter A, which we interpret to stand for Angel" (XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 51). This develops public shame and private identity: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing.

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 10 reveal about the character or situation? "The venerable Father Wilson continued to step slowly onward, looking carefully at the muddy pathway before his feet, and never once turning his head towards the guilty platform." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 10) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: a

private, unseen confession that changes nothing. The words “carefully” and “venerable” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 1 reveal about the character or situation? “The same platform or scaffold, black and weather-stained with the storm or sunshine of seven long years, and foot-worn, too, with the tread of many culprits who had since ascended it, remained standing beneath the balcony of the…” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 1) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing. The words “meetinghouse” and “standing” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why is the sexton's 'A pure hand needs no glove' ironic?

    Sample answer: Dimmesdale's hand is not pure: the sexton's unknowing irony. The evidence is “A pure hand needs no glove to cover it” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 49). This develops public shame and private identity: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “XII: The Minister’s Vigil”? Midnight in May; Dimmesdale stands on the scaffold where Hester stood seven years before.

    A. Setting

    B. Diction / vocabulary

    C. Structure

    D. Alliteration

    Key: A (Setting)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 17 shapes its tone: “Come up hither once again, and we will stand all three together!” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “together” and “hither” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 17) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 43 to the story's treatment of women and independence: “We men of study, whose heads are in our books, have need to be straitly looked after!” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 43) develops women and independence: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing. Its words “straitly” and “looked” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “He going home to a better world, I, likewise, was on my way homeward, when this strange light shone out.” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 45), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Satan dropped it there, I take it, intending a scurrilous jest against your reverence.”, what does “scurrilous” most nearly mean?

    A. acts of care or service

    B. bold, reckless lawbreakers

    C. insulting and mocking

    D. restlessness; uneasiness

Key: C (insulting and mocking)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 51: "the letter A, which we _____ to stand for Angel"
    Key: interpret

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Nothing was more common, in those days, than to interpret all _____ appearances, and other natural phenomena, that occurred with less regularity than the rise and set of sun and moon, as so many revelations from a supernatural source." Word bank: betokening, awfulness, thresholds, meteoric
    Key: meteoric

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Pearl ask?
    A. Is he her father
    B. Can she go home
    C. Why is he there
    D. Will he stand with them at noon tomorrow

    Key: D (Will he stand with them at noon tomorrow)

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "All people, in a word, would come stumbling over their thresholds, and turning up their amazed and horror-stricken visages around the scaffold.", what does "thresholds" most nearly mean?
    A. make (a wrong) seem less serious
    B. breaking apart; separating
    C. on which a customs tax must be paid
    D. doorways; the entrance of a house

    Key: D (doorways; the entrance of a house)

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Oftener, however, its credibility rested on the faith of some lonely eyewitness, who beheld the wonder through the colored, magnifying, and _____ medium of his imagination, and shaped it more distinctly in his afterthought." Word bank: thresholds, awfulness, distorting, betokening
    Key: distorting

23. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "XII: The Minister's Vigil"?
    A. The minister's vigil
    B. The Governor's hall
    C. The revelation
    D. An author answering his critics

    Key: A (The minister's vigil)

24. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in "A pure hand needs no glove to cover it" (XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 49). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: The sexton's unknowing irony. The evidence is "A pure hand needs no glove to cover it" (XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 49). This develops public shame and private identity: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing. The words "glove" and "needs" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? A private, unseen confession that changes nothing.

    A. Hypocrisy and truth

    B. Sin and guilt

    C. Nature and the individual against society

    D. Public shame and private identity

    Key: D (Public shame and private identity)

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 21).

    Sample answer: He refuses Pearl's request to stand with them "tomorrow noontide," and the town reads the red letter as "Angel" while the sexton praises "a pure hand.". The evidence is “Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 21) — Pearl's question. This develops public shame and private identity: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing.

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “the letter A, which we interpret to stand for Angel” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 51) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The sexton's reading of the sign. The evidence is “the letter A, which we interpret to stand for Angel” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 51). This develops public shame and private identity: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing. The words “interpret” and “letter” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He refuses Pearl's request to stand with them "tomorrow noontide," and the town reads the red letter as "Angel" while the sexton praises "a pure hand.".

28. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Oftener, however, its _____ rested on the faith of some lonely eyewitness, who beheld the wonder through the colored, magnifying, and distorting medium of his imagination, and shaped it more distinctly in his afterthought.” Word bank: awfulness, credibility, betokening, thresholds

    Key: credibility

29. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who joins him?

    A. Wilson

    B. Hester and Pearl

    C. Bellingham

    D. Chillingworth

    Key: B (Hester and Pearl)

30. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “It showed the familiar scene of the street, with the distinctness of midday, but also with the awfulness that is always imparted to familiar objects by an unaccustomed light.”, what does “awfulness” most nearly mean?

    A. a shield bearing a coat of arms

    B. a feeling of awe and dread

    C. removed or done away with

    D. shakily, nervously

    Key: B (a feeling of awe and dread)

31. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 21) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Pearl's question. The evidence is “Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 21). This develops public shame and private identity: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing.

32. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Which literary element does this describe in “XII: The Minister’s Vigil”? A meteor draws a great red ‘A’ across the sky; the town reads it as ‘Angel’ for Governor Winthrop.
    A. Symbolism
    B. Hyperbole
    C. Foreshadowing
    D. Personification
    Key: A (Symbolism)

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “The vigil is a confession that hides itself in darkness.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 21) supports it: He refuses Pearl's request to stand with them "tomorrow noontide," and the town reads the red letter as "Angel" while the sexton praises "a pure hand.". But “A pure hand needs no glove to cover it” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 49) complicates it: the line (the sexton's unknowing irony) shows the same issue from another side, and its “no” marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. A fair verdict is that the claim is mostly right but overstated; it needs a limiting clause to cover that passage.

34. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how public shame and private identity develops from VII: The Governor’s Hall to XII: The Minister’s Vigil. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Earlier, in VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 20, the text reads “the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance”, which shows the mirror in the armor. In XII: The Minister’s Vigil, “Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 21) — Pearl's question. A private, unseen confession that changes nothing.

35. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 1: “Walking in the shadow of a dream, as it were, and perhaps actually under the influence of a species of _____, Mr. Dimmesdale reached the spot where, now so long since, Hester Prynne had lived through her first hours of public ignominy.” Word bank: inextricable, before, nevertheless, somnambulism
    Key: somnambulism

36. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 31 shapes its tone: “She withdrew her hand from Mr. Dimmesdale’s, and pointed across the street.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “withdrew” and “pointed” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 31) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Compare the vigil with the first scaffold scene. What has changed? Argue.
    Sample answer: A reasoned comparison: the sexton's reading of the sign. The evidence is “the letter A, which we interpret

to stand for Angel" (XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 51). This develops public shame and private identity: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing. He refuses Pearl's request to stand with them "tomorrow noontide," and the town reads the red letter as "Angel" while the sexton praises "a pure hand.".

38. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 2 shapes its tone: "He had been driven hither by the impulse of that Remorse which dogged him everywhere, and whose own sister and closely linked companion was that Cowardice which invariably drew him back, with her tremulous grip, just when the other impulse…" Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "everywhere" and "disclosure" (XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 2) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

39. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 3 shapes its tone: "And thus, while standing on the scaffold, in this vain show of expiation, Mr. Dimmesdale was overcome with a great horror of mind, as if the universe were gazing at a scarlet token on his naked breast, right over his heart." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "expiation" and "universe" (XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 3) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 5 to the story's treatment of women and independence: "She thrust forth her head from the lattice, and looked anxiously upward." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 5) develops women and independence: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing. Its words "anxiously" and "lattice" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "The clergyman, therefore, hearing no symptoms of disturbance, uncovered his eyes and looked about him." (XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 5), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

41. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? "A pure hand needs no glove to cover it" (XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 49)

    A. One account of the revelation.

    B. Pearl's demand that Hester take up the letter.

    C. The opening irony about utopias.

    D. The sexton's unknowing irony.

    Key: D (The sexton's unknowing irony.)

42. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 45 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: "You should study less, good Sir, and take a little pastime; or these night-whimseys will grow upon you." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 45) develops hypocrisy and truth: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing. Its words "whimseys" and "pastime" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "But, as he came down the pulpit steps, the gray-bearded sexton met him, holding up a black glove, which the minister…" (XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 48), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

43. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Which word completes this sentence from XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 17? "Ye have both been here _____, but I was not with you."

    A. before

    B. minister

    C. discontented

    D. grotesque

    Key: A (before)

44. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Connect this passage from XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 7 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: "His eyes, however, were soon greeted by a little, glimmering light, which, at first a long way off, was approaching up the street." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 7) develops hypocrisy and truth: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing. Its words "approaching" and "glimmering" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "The glimmer of this luminary suggested the above conceits to Mr. Dimmesdale, who smiled—nay, almost laughed at them—and…" (XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 7), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

45. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] What does this passage most clearly show? "the letter A, which we interpret to stand for Angel" (XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 51)

    A. The opening irony about utopias.

    B. Hester's answer, which Pearl rejects.

    C. The sexton's reading of the sign.

    D. The letter's "new sense."

    Key: C (The sexton's reading of the sign.)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	7, 9, 17, 18, 19, 4, 20, 21, 8, 22, 23, 13, 24, 25, 26, 27	recall 10, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	9, 28, 7, 29, 1, 19, 4, 30, 13, 31, 10, 24, 25, 32, 33, 34	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	5, 21, 22, 35, 30, 18, 29, 12, 13, 11, 24, 14, 36, 15, 33, 37	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	22, 2, 19, 30, 35, 29, 13, 11, 12, 32, 38, 24, 39, 40, 16, 34	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	35, 8, 19, 41, 13, 12, 11, 38, 25, 39, 15, 14, 34, 42, 37, 40	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	35, 43, 8, 22, 41, 10, 12, 26, 15, 38, 36, 25, 44, 37, 42, 34	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	22, 29, 19, 23, 13, 45, 38, 25, 39, 15, 36, 37, 44, 40, 33, 16	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 5

College Junior	22, 19, 13, 45, 41, 38, 15, 25, 32, 39, 37, 40, 34, 42, 44, 16	recall 2, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	21, 22, 19, 4, 23, 25, 38, 15, 24, 33, 37, 42, 40, 44, 34, 16	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 4, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	6, 22, 19, 4, 25, 14, 36, 39, 27, 44, 16, 37, 42, 34, 33, 40	recall 4, inference 0, analysis 4, synthesis 8

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "XII: The Minister's Vigil," how does Hawthorne show the minister's vigil? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In XII: The Minister's Vigil, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of the minister's vigil? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how XII: The Minister's Vigil develops the idea of the minister's vigil. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of XII: The Minister's Vigil (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of the minister's vigil. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what XII: The Minister's Vigil suggests about the minister's vigil. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's setting and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses setting in XII: The Minister's Vigil to complicate the reader's understanding of the minister's vigil. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate XII: The Minister's Vigil within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the minister's vigil responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read XII: The Minister's Vigil alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the minister's vigil

follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to XII: The Minister's Vigil and its treatment of the minister's vigil. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's setting and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads XII: The Minister's Vigil as evidence for a larger claim about the minister's vigil in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads XII: The Minister's Vigil as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the minister's vigil. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

SAT-style questions

1. *It showed the familiar scene of the street, with the distinctness of midday, but also with the awfulness that is always imparted to familiar objects by an unaccustomed light.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "awfulness" most nearly mean?

   A. a feeling of awe and dread

   B. coldness

   C. the quality of being believable

   D. having to do with meteors or bright objects in the sky

2. *"It was found," said the sexton, "this morning, on the scaffold where evildoers are set up to public shame. Satan dropped it there, I take it, intending a scurrilous jest against your reverence. But, indeed, he was blind and foolish, as he ever and always is. A pure hand needs no glove to cover it!"*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "XII: The Minister's Vigil"?

   A. Pearl

   B. The minister's vigil

   C. Hester on the scaffold

   D. An author answering his critics

SAT key: 1. A (a feeling of awe and dread); 2. B (The minister's vigil)

Lesson 16: XIII: Another View of Hester

Focus: another view of Hester

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in “XIII: Another View of Hester” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Critical voice: “Hester Prynne is the great nemesis of woman. She is the KNOWING Ligeia risen diabolic from the grave.” (D. H. Lawrence, novelist and poet, *Studies in Classic American Literature (1923), Ch. VII, "Nathaniel Hawthorne and 'The Scarlet Letter'", Ch. VII*; public domain). Context note: Ligeia is Poe's heroine who returns from death. Discuss how Lawrence's hostile reading contrasts with the feminist readings of Hester. (Lawrence's tone is deliberately provocative; frame it for students before reading.) *Objective:* Analyze Hester's transformation and her power. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.3

Content note (suicidal thoughts, thoughts of harming a child): Hester sometimes wonders whether to send Pearl to heaven and go herself to whatever future Eternal Justice provides. Use the safe-messaging script; focus on her isolation and on the change in her thinking.
Student preview: A character has thoughts about death. Support is available if this is hard to read.
Suggested language: “What has isolation done to Hester's thinking?”
Safe messaging: Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this chapter is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

Seven years have passed. Hester has become a sister of mercy, nursing the sick; many now say her A means Able. Yet her life has turned to thought: she questions the whole position of women and has dark thoughts. Shocked at Dimmesdale's state, she resolves to help him against her husband.

Background: Hester's thoughts recall nineteenth-century debates about women's rights (the Seneca Falls convention was in 1848) and Hawthorne's acquaintance with Margaret Fuller.

Significance: The letter changes meaning in the town but has not made Hester penitent.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Can a symbol mean different things to different people? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to women and independence because.... Content note before we start: A character has thoughts about death. Support is available if this is hard to read. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.
Prompt: Can a symbol mean different things to different people?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to women and independence because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: obviated — removed or done away with; retrieving — getting back; recovering; acquiescing — accepting something without protest; tampering — interfering in a harmful way; transfiguration — a complete change of appearance. "acquiescing": Origin of "acquiesce": Middle French acquiescer; earlier Latin acquiescō. "transfiguration": Origin: Old French transfiguracion; earlier Latin transfigūrātio.
Words: obviated: removed or done away with · retrieving: getting back; recovering · acquiescing: accepting something without protest · tampering: interfering in a harmful way · transfiguration: a complete change of appearance

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Hester's thoughts recall nineteenth-century debates about women's rights (the Seneca Falls convention was in 1848) and Hawthorne's acquaintance with Margaret Fuller. The letter changes meaning in the town but has not made Hester penitent. Characterization: Seven years on, Hester is a sister of mercy; many say the A means "Able." Theme: Her life turns "from passion and feeling, to thought," including radical thoughts about women. Irony: The letter has made her free in thought while it has not made her penitent: "The scarlet letter had not done its office." Watch for the scarlet letter: The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "intellectual faculties retained their pristine strength, or had perhaps acquired a morbid energy, which disease only could have given them. With her" (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 1).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "The scarlet letter had not done its office" slowly and put it in my own words: The narrator says the letter has not done its office. Next, craft. I notice the official word "office," as if the letter were a public servant. The strongest word is "office": it means duty, so the letter failed its purpose. Then, effect. Why hasn't the scarlet letter worked as intended? My answer: The scarlet letter hasn't worked as intended because it was meant to shame Hester into repentance, but it has made her independent and questioning instead.

> *The scarlet letter had not done its office (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "The scarlet letter had not done its office" slowly and put it in my own words: The narrator says the letter has not done its office. Next, craft. I notice the official word "office," as if the letter were a public servant. The strongest word is "office": it means duty, so the letter failed its purpose. Then, effect. Why hasn't the scarlet letter worked as intended? My answer: The scarlet letter hasn't worked as intended because it was meant to shame Hester into repentance, but it has made her independent and questioning instead.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The A now means Able to many townsfolk. Expected link: symbolism; public shame and private identity. Ask: How does this line connect to women and independence? Expected: Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women. (The changed meaning of the letter.)

> *They said that it meant Able; so strong was Hester Prynne, with a woman's strength (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The A now means Able to many townsfolk. Expected link: symbolism; public shame and private identity.
Ask: How does this line connect to women and independence?
Expected answer: Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women. (The changed meaning of the letter.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for characterization, theme (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about another view of Hester? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XIII: Another View of Hester develops the idea of another view of Hester. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment. When the text says “The scarlet letter had not done its office” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10), it shows this directly. People say "it meant Able," yet Hawthorne admits "The scarlet letter had not done its office," because Hester's life "had turned … to thought."
Task: Annotate the chapter for characterization, theme (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about another view of Hester? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XIII: Another View of Hester develops the idea of another view of Hester. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment. When the text says “The scarlet letter had not done its office” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10), it shows this directly. People say "it meant Able," yet Hawthorne admits "The scarlet letter had not done its office," because Hester's life "had turned … to thought."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Can a symbol mean different things to different people? Ask: what does Hester think about the position of women? Does the narrator approve?
Anchor question: Can a symbol mean different things to different people?
Facilitation: Ask: what does Hester think about the position of women? Does the narrator approve?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about another view of Hester? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment. (“The scarlet letter had not done its office”, XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about another view of Hester? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment. (“The scarlet letter had not done its office”, XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes another view of Hester. Key takeaway: Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Seven years on, Hester is a sister of mercy; many say the A means "Able."
- **Theme:** Her life turns "from passion and feeling, to thought," including radical thoughts about women.
- **Irony:** The letter has made her free in thought while it has not made her penitent: "The scarlet letter had not done its office."

Themes and how they develop

- **women and independence:** Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women.

Symbols and motifs

- **the scarlet letter:** The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: “intellectual faculties retained their pristine strength, or had perhaps acquired a morbid energy, which disease only could have given them. With her” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 1).
- **light and darkness:** Sunshine avoids Hester but plays around Pearl; the forest is dim; the minister's vigil happens at midnight under a meteor. In this chapter: “had shown him where to set his foot, while the light of earth was fast becoming dim, and ere the light of” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “They said that it meant Able; so strong was Hester Prynne, with a woman’s strength” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3) The changed meaning of the letter.
- “The scarlet letter had not done its office” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10) The letter's failure as a punishment.
- “her life had turned, in a great measure, from passion and feeling, to thought” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 7) Hester's change.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

> **Claim:** The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment.
> **Evidence:** “The scarlet letter had not done its office” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10)

Reasoning: People say "it meant Able," yet Hawthorne admits "The scarlet letter had not done its office," because Hester's life "had turned ... to thought."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
obviated (verb)	removed or done away with	*Finally, all other difficulties being obviated, woman cannot take advantage of these preliminary reforms, until she herself shall have undergone a still mightier change; in which, perhaps, the ethereal essence, wherein she has her truest life, will be found to have evaporated.*	
retrieving (verb)	getting back; recovering	*Standing alone in the world—alone, as to any dependence on society, and with little Pearl to be guided and protected—alone, and hopeless of retrieving her position, even had she not scorned to consider it desirable—she cast away the fragments of a broken chain.*	
acquiescing (verb)	accepting something without protest	*Her only justification lay in the fact, that she had been able to discern no method of rescuing him from a blacker ruin than had overwhelmed herself, except by acquiescing in Roger Chillingworth's scheme of disguise.*	"acquiescing": Origin of "acquiesce": Middle French acquiescer; earlier Latin acquiescō. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/acquiesce#Etymology)
tampering (verb)	interfering in a harmful way	*A secret enemy had been continually by his side, under the semblance of a friend and helper, and had availed himself of the opportunities thus afforded for tampering with the delicate springs of Mr.*	
transfiguration (noun)	a complete change of appearance	*She who has once been woman, and ceased to be so, might at any moment become a woman again if there were only the magic touch to effect the transfiguration.*	"transfiguration": Origin: Old French transfiguracion; earlier Latin transfigūrātio. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/transfiguration#Etymology)
wellspring (noun)	a source that never runs dry	*In such emergencies, Hester's nature showed itself warm and rich; a wellspring of human tenderness,*	

		unfailing to every real demand, and inexhaustible by the largest.	
foundress (noun)	a woman who founds something	*Then, she might have come down to us in history, hand in hand with Ann Hutchinson, as the foundress of a religious sect.*	
stigmatized (verb)	marked out as shameful	*She assumed a freedom of speculation, then common enough on the other side of the Atlantic, but which our forefathers, had they known it, would have held to be a deadlier crime than that stigmatized by the scarlet letter.*	
concoct (verb)	make by mixing ingredients	*One afternoon, walking with Pearl in a retired part of the peninsula, she beheld the old physician, with a basket on one arm, and a staff in the other hand, stooping along the ground, in quest of roots and herbs to concoct his medicines withal.*	

Discussion questions

1. Can a symbol mean different things to different people?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with women and independence?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What has happened to Hester's appearance? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Her beauty has turned cold and severe; her hair is hidden.
2. How many years have passed? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Seven
3. What do many people say the A means now? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Able
4. What does Hester do for the town? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Nurses the sick and helps the poor

5. What does Hester question? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The position of women
6. What does she decide? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: To help Dimmesdale against Chillingworth
7. Retell the three most important events of "XIII: Another View of Hester" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Seven years have passed. Hester has become a sister of mercy, nursing the sick; many now say her A means Able. Yet her life has turned to thought: she questions the whole position of women and has dark thoughts. Shocked at Dimmesdale's state, she resolves to help him against her husband.
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "XIII: Another View of Hester"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "XIII: Another View of Hester" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: "Finally, all other difficulties being obviated, woman cannot take advantage of these preliminary reforms, until she herself shall have undergone a still mightier change; in which, perhaps, the ethereal essence, wherein…" What does "obviated" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: obviated: removed or done away with.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why has the letter 'not done its office'? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: It made her think freely, not repent.
2. What does "XIII: Another View of Hester" suggest about another view of Hester? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The letter changes meaning in the town but has not made Hester penitent.
3. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the theme in this chapter shape what we understand about another view of Hester? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment. Useful evidence: "They said that it meant Able; so strong was Hester Prynne, with a woman's strength" (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3): The changed meaning of the letter. On theme: Her life turns "from passion and feeling, to thought," including radical thoughts about women. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "In fine, Hester Prynne resolved to meet her former husband, and do what might be in her power for the rescue of the victim on whom he had so evidently set his grip.", why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

6. What causes the main turn in “XIII: Another View of Hester”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Seven years have passed. Hester has become a sister of mercy, nursing the sick; many now say her A means Able. Yet her life has turned to thought: she questions the whole position of women and has dark thoughts. Shocked at Dimmesdale's state, she resolves to help him against her husband.
7. How does “XIII: Another View of Hester” build on “XII: The Minister’s Vigil”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment. Useful evidence: “The scarlet letter had not done its office” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10): The letter's failure as a punishment. Theme link: Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment. Useful evidence: “her life had turned, in a great measure, from passion and feeling, to thought” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 7): Hester's change. On characterization: Seven years on, Hester is a sister of mercy; many say the A means "Able." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Can a symbol mean different things to different people?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does irony appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with women and independence? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment. Useful evidence: “They said that it meant Able; so strong was Hester Prynne, with a woman’s strength” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3): The changed meaning of the letter. On irony: The letter has made her free in thought while it has not made her penitent: "The scarlet letter had not done its office." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Does the narrator approve of Hester's thoughts about women? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment. Useful evidence: “The scarlet letter had not done its office” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10): The letter's failure as a punishment. On theme: Her life turns "from passion and feeling, to thought," including radical thoughts about women. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “The letter changes meaning in the town but has not made Hester penitent.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment. Useful evidence: “her life had turned, in a great measure, from passion and feeling, to thought” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 7): Hester's change. On theme: Her life turns "from passion and feeling, to thought," including radical thoughts about women. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment. Useful evidence: “They said that it meant Able; so strong was Hester Prynne, with a woman’s strength” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3): The changed meaning of the letter. On characterization: Seven years on, Hester is a sister of mercy; many say the A means "Able." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Rewrite one moment of “XIII: Another View of Hester” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about another view of Hester? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment. Useful evidence: “The scarlet letter had not done its office” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10): The letter's failure as a punishment. Theme link: Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “XIII: Another View of Hester”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment. Useful evidence: “her life had turned, in a great measure, from passion and feeling, to thought” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 7): Hester's change. On theme: Her life turns "from passion and feeling, to thought," including radical thoughts about women. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this chapter to sin and guilt: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment. Useful evidence: “They said that it meant Able; so strong was Hester Prynne, with a woman’s strength” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3): The changed meaning of the letter. On theme: Her life turns "from passion and feeling, to thought," including radical thoughts about women. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment. Useful evidence: “The scarlet letter had not done its office” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10): The letter's failure as a punishment. On characterization: Seven years on, Hester is a sister of mercy; many say the A means "Able." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “XIII: Another View of Hester” treats another view of Hester with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment. Useful evidence: “her life had turned, in a great measure, from passion and feeling, to thought” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 7): Hester's change. On theme: Her life turns "from passion and feeling, to thought," including radical thoughts about women. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “XIV: Hester and the Physician” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment. Useful evidence: “They said that it meant Able; so strong was Hester Prynne, with a woman’s strength” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3): The changed meaning of the letter. Theme link: Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about another view of Hester? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment. Useful evidence: “The scarlet letter had not done its office” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10): The letter's failure as a punishment. On theme: Her life turns "from passion and feeling, to thought," including radical thoughts about women. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “She assumed a freedom of speculation, then common enough on the other side of the Atlantic, but which our forefathers,

had they known it, would have held to be a deadlier crime than that _____ by the scarlet letter." Word bank: stigmatized, retrieving, obviated, acquiescing

Key: stigmatized

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Standing alone in the world—alone, as to any dependence on society, and with little Pearl to be guided and protected—alone, and hopeless of retrieving her position, even had she not scorned to consider it desirable—she…", what does "retrieving" most nearly mean?

   A. a person who speaks for someone else

   B. lack of modesty or tact

   C. spreading disease or corruption into

   D. getting back; recovering

   Key: D (getting back; recovering)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "In such emergencies, Hester's nature showed itself warm and rich; a _____ of human tenderness, unfailing to every real demand, and inexhaustible by the largest." Word bank: acquiescing, retrieving, wellspring, obviated

   Key: wellspring

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Hester do for the town?

   A. Rules

   B. Nurses the sick and helps the poor

   C. Teaches school

   D. Preaches

   Key: B (Nurses the sick and helps the poor)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What do many people say the A means now?

   A. Angel

   B. Adultery

   C. Alone

   D. Able

   Key: D (Able)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10: "The _____ letter had not done its office"

   Key: scarlet

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Finally, all other difficulties being obviated, woman cannot take advantage of these preliminary reforms, until she herself shall have undergone a still mightier change; in which, perhaps, the ethereal essence, wherein…", what does "obviated" most nearly mean?

   A. (trundle-bed) a low bed on wheels kept under another bed

   B. removed or done away with

   C. a deeply religious person

   D. stand as a sign or symbol of

   Key: B (removed or done away with)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does she decide?

   A. To leave Boston

   B. To confess publicly

   C. To help Dimmesdale against Chillingworth

   D. To remarry

   Key: C (To help Dimmesdale against Chillingworth)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “A secret enemy had been continually by his side, under the semblance of a friend and helper, and had availed himself of the opportunities thus afforded for tampering with the delicate springs of Mr.”, what does “tampering” most nearly mean?

   A. stand as a sign or symbol of

   B. splash (with water or mud)

   C. interfering in a harmful way

   D. slowly decay into dust

   Key: C (interfering in a harmful way)

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How many years have passed?

    A. Twenty

    B. One

    C. Two

    D. Seven

    Key: D (Seven)

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Hester question?

    A. The king's power

    B. The Bible's language

    C. The position of women

    D. Her love for Pearl

    Key: C (The position of women)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “The scarlet letter had not done its office” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The letter's failure as a punishment. The evidence is “The scarlet letter had not done its office” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10). This develops women and independence: Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why has the letter 'not done its office'?

    Sample answer: It made her think freely, not repent. The evidence is “The scarlet letter had not done its office” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10), which shows the letter's failure as a punishment.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “XIII: Another View of Hester”? Seven years on, Hester is a sister of mercy; many say the A means ‘Able.’

    A. Characterization

    B. Imagery

    C. Personification

D. Alliteration

Key: A (Characterization)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in "her life had turned, in a great measure, from passion and feeling, to thought" (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 7). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Hester's change. The evidence is "her life had turned, in a great measure, from passion and feeling, to thought" (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 7). This develops women and independence: Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women. The words "feeling" and "measure" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how women and independence develops from XII: The Minister's Vigil to XIII: Another View of Hester. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Earlier, in XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 21, the text reads "Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide" — Pearl's question. In XIII: Another View of Hester, "They said that it meant Able; so strong was Hester Prynne, with a woman's strength" (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3), which shows the changed meaning of the letter. Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women.
17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 1: "In her late singular _____ with Mr. Dimmesdale, Hester Prynne was shocked at the condition to which she found the clergyman reduced." Word bank: interview, sunshine, transformed, whatever
    Key: interview
18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Her only justification lay in the fact, that she had been able to discern no method of rescuing him from a blacker ruin than had overwhelmed herself, except by acquiescing in Roger Chillingworth's scheme of disguise.", what does "acquiescing" most nearly mean?

    A. accepting something without protest

    B. sadly; mournfully

    C. the system of coats of arms

    D. focused together on one point

    Key: A (accepting something without protest)
19. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3: "It had shown him where to set his foot, while the light of earth was fast _____ dim, and ere the light of futurity could reach him." Word bank: becoming, transformed, uncomplainingly, interview
    Key: becoming
20. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 7: "her life had turned, in a great _____, from passion and feeling, to thought"
    Key: measure
21. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3? "None so self-devoted as Hester, when _____ stalked through the town."

    A. chamber

    B. interview

    C. pestilence

    D. ordained

    Key: C (pestilence)

22. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 4 reveal about the character or situation? "The helpful inmate had departed, without one backward glance to gather up the meed of gratitude, if any were in the hearts of those whom she had served so zealously." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 4) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women. The words "gratitude" and "zealously" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

23. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 1 reveal about the character or situation? "His moral force was abased into more than childish weakness." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 1) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women. The words "weakness" and "childish" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

24. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "They said that it meant Able; so strong was Hester Prynne, with a woman's strength" (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The changed meaning of the letter. The evidence is "They said that it meant Able; so strong was Hester Prynne, with a woman's strength" (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3).

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women.

    A. Women and independence

    B. Hypocrisy and truth

    C. Sin and guilt

    D. Public shame and private identity

    Key: A (Women and independence)

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 1 shapes its tone: "Here was the iron link of mutual crime, which neither he nor she could break." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "neither" and "mutual" (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 1) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 5 shapes its tone: "The prejudices which they shared in common with the latter were fortified in themselves by an iron framework of reasoning, that made it a far tougher labor to expel them." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "prejudices" and "themselves" (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 5) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

28. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3: “They said that it meant Able; so strong was Hester Prynne, with a woman’s _____”
    Key: strength
29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 5 shapes its tone: “Had she fallen among thieves, it would have kept her safe.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “thieves” and “fallen” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 5) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.
30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 2 shapes its tone: “In this matter of Hester Prynne, there was neither irritation nor irksomeness.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “irksomeness” and “irritation” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 2) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.
31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “The scarlet letter had not done its office” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: The letter's failure as a punishment. The evidence is “The scarlet letter had not done its office” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10). This develops women and independence: Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women. The words “scarlet” and “letter” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. People say "it meant Able," yet Hawthorne admits "The scarlet letter had not done its office," because Hester's life "had turned ... to thought.".
32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 2: “Hatred, by a gradual and quiet process, will even be _____ to love, unless the change be impeded by a continually new irritation of the original feeling of hostility.” Word bank: transformed, seemingly, interview, whatever
    Key: transformed
33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 6 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: “We shall see whether Hester Prynne were ever afterwards so touched, and so transfigured.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 6) develops hypocrisy and truth: Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women. Its words “transfigured” and “afterwards” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “It was an age in which the human intellect, newly emancipated, had taken a more active and a wider range than for many…” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 7), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.
34. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3 to the story's treatment of women and independence: “In all seasons of calamity, indeed, whether general or of individuals, the outcast of society at once found her place.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3) develops women and independence: Hester

imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women. Its words "individuals" and "calamity" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "There glimmered the embroidered letter, with comfort in its unearthly ray." (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

35. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 1? "The links that united her to the rest of human kind—links of flowers, or silk, or gold, or _____ the material—had all been broken."

    A. uncomplainingly

    B. whatever

    C. obligations

    D. pestilence

    Key: B (whatever)

36. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Then, she might have come down to us in history, hand in hand with Ann Hutchinson, as the _____ of a religious sect." Word bank: obviated, retrieving, foundress, acquiescing

    Key: foundress

37. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which literary element does this describe in "XIII: Another View of Hester"? Her life turns 'from passion and feeling, to thought,' including radical thoughts about women.

    A. Theme

    B. Foreshadowing

    C. Imagery

    D. Diction / vocabulary

    Key: A (Theme)

38. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "She who has once been woman, and ceased to be so, might at any moment become a woman again if there were only the magic touch to effect the _____." Word bank: transfiguration, acquiescing, obviated, retrieving

    Key: transfiguration

39. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? "They said that it meant Able; so strong was Hester Prynne, with a woman's strength" (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3)

    A. The changed meaning of the letter.

    B. The end of the chapter.

    C. The sexton's reading of the sign.

    D. The core of his hypocrisy.

    Key: A (The changed meaning of the letter.)

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Does the narrator approve of Hester's thoughts about women? Argue.

    Sample answer: A reasoned view: the changed meaning of the letter. The evidence is "They said that it meant Able; so strong was Hester Prynne, with a woman's strength" (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3). This develops women

and independence: Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women. People say "it meant Able," yet Hawthorne admits "The scarlet letter had not done its office," because Hester's life "had turned ... to thought.".

41. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: “Her breast, with its badge of shame, was but the softer pillow for the head that needed one.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3) develops hypocrisy and truth: Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women. Its words “pillow” and “softer” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “The letter was the symbol of her calling.” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.
42. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Claim: The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “The scarlet letter had not done its office” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10).
    Sample answer: People say "it meant Able," yet Hawthorne admits "The scarlet letter had not done its office," because Hester's life "had turned ... to thought.". The evidence is “The scarlet letter had not done its office” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10), which shows the letter's failure as a punishment. This develops women and independence: Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women.
43. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Connect this passage from XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 6 to the story's treatment of women and independence: “It was a sad transformation, too, that her rich and luxuriant hair had either been cut off, or was so completely hidden by a cap, that not a shining lock of it ever once gushed into the sunshine.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 6) develops women and independence: Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women. Its words “transformation” and “completely” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Some attribute had departed from her, the permanence of which had been essential to keep her a woman.” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 6), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.
44. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “They said that it meant Able; so strong was Hester Prynne, with a woman’s strength” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: The changed meaning of the letter. The evidence is “They said that it meant Able; so strong was Hester Prynne, with a woman’s strength” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3). This develops women and independence: Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women. The words “strength” and “strong” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. People say "it meant Able," yet Hawthorne admits "The scarlet letter had not done its office," because Hester's life "had turned ... to thought.".

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 11, inference 2, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	10, 17, 7, 18, 19, 20, 21, 6, 22, 13, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 16	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	2, 17, 9, 8, 19, 4, 28, 21, 22, 13, 23, 29, 30, 27, 31, 16	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	2, 28, 1, 21, 4, 19, 32, 22, 13, 23, 14, 27, 25, 29, 33, 34	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 2

HS Senior	1, 35, 8, 36, 4, 20, 23, 22, 13, 27, 30, 37, 25, 34, 33, 31	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	36, 10, 38, 23, 39, 13, 22, 25, 29, 27, 26, 37, 33, 40, 34, 41	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	10, 1, 6, 5, 4, 13, 24, 26, 29, 14, 27, 42, 34, 41, 40, 33	recall 5, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	28, 6, 10, 5, 4, 23, 27, 25, 15, 30, 29, 43, 33, 41, 34, 16	recall 5, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	32, 2, 38, 39, 22, 29, 15, 25, 26, 14, 34, 41, 40, 33, 43, 16	recall 3, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	1, 38, 10, 5, 4, 27, 37, 26, 15, 16, 34, 40, 41, 43, 44, 33	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 4, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	10, 38, 3, 5, 14, 30, 25, 27, 29, 15, 33, 40, 34, 16, 43, 41	recall 4, inference 0, analysis 6, synthesis 6

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “XIII: Another View of Hester,” how does Hawthorne show another view of Hester? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In XIII: Another View of Hester, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of another view of Hester? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how XIII: Another View of Hester develops the idea of another view of Hester. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of XIII: Another View of Hester (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of another view of Hester. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what XIII: Another View of Hester suggests about another view of Hester. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses characterization in XIII: Another View of Hester to complicate the reader's

understanding of another view of Hester. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate XIII: Another View of Hester within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of another view of Hester responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read XIII: Another View of Hester alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of another view of Hester follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to XIII: Another View of Hester and its treatment of another view of Hester. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and theme, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads XIII: Another View of Hester as evidence for a larger claim about another view of Hester in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads XIII: Another View of Hester as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of another view of Hester. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

SAT-style questions

1. *Her only justification lay in the fact, that she had been able to discern no method of rescuing him from a blacker ruin than had overwhelmed herself, except by acquiescing in Roger Chillingworth's scheme of disguise.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "acquiescing" most nearly mean?

   A. marked out as shameful

   B. make by mixing ingredients

   C. a woman who founds something

   D. accepting something without protest

2. *In fine, Hester Prynne resolved to meet her former husband, and do what might be in her power for the rescue of the victim on whom he had so evidently set his grip. The occasion was not long to seek. One afternoon, walking with Pearl in a retired part of the peninsula, she beheld the old physician, with a basket on one arm, and a staff in the other hand, stooping along the ground, in quest of roots and herbs to concoct his medicines withal.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "XIII: Another View of Hester"?

   A. Another view of Hester

B. The elf-child and the minister

C. The minister in a maze

D. The recognition

SAT key: 1. D (accepting something without protest); 2. A (Another view of Hester)

Lesson 17: XIV: Hester and the Physician

Focus: Hester and the physician

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in “XIV: Hester and the Physician” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

On the shore Hester confronts Chillingworth, who has grown darker and fiendish. She asks him to stop tormenting the minister and says she will reveal his identity. He admits he has become a fiend but says he cannot pardon; it is all 'a dark necessity'.

Background: Calvinist belief in predestination held that God had decided who would be saved; Chillingworth uses fate to excuse himself.

Significance: Revenge has destroyed the avenger.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Can a person be changed by hate? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to sin and guilt because....*
> **Prompt:** Can a person be changed by hate?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to sin and guilt because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: revenge has made a wise man into a fiend.

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
> Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
> *Today's words: propinquity — nearness; closeness; gloated — took cruel pleasure in someone's suffering; pledging — promising solemnly; usurping — taking a place or power wrongfully; heartstrings — one's deepest feelings.*
> *“usurping”: Origin of “usurp”: Old French usurper; earlier Latin ūsūrpō.*
> **Words:** propinquity: nearness; closeness · gloated: took cruel pleasure in someone's suffering · pledging: promising solemnly · usurping: taking a place or power wrongfully · heartstrings: one's deepest feelings

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Calvinist belief in predestination held that God had decided who would be saved; Chillingworth uses fate to excuse himself. Revenge has destroyed the avenger. Characterization: Chillingworth has transformed himself into a devil by undertaking a devil's office. Conflict: Hester tells him she will reveal his identity to Dimmesdale. Theme: Chillingworth accepts fate: "It is not granted me to pardon." Watch for the scarlet letter: The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "yonder gatherer of herbs. So the child flew away like a bird, and, making bare her small white feet, went pattering along" (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 1).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "I have left thee to the scarlet letter" slowly and put it in my own words: Refusing to plead with Chillingworth, Hester tells him she leaves him to the scarlet letter. Next, craft. I notice she speaks of the letter as if it were a judge who will deal with him, the way people say "I leave you to God." The strongest word is "letter": the symbol of her own punishment becomes, in her words, the power that will judge him too. Then, effect. Why does Hester leave Chillingworth "to the scarlet letter"? My answer: Hester means that the letter's lesson, the cost of hidden sin, applies to him; his secret revenge has made him guiltier than she is, and she will no longer beg him for mercy.

> *I have left thee to the scarlet letter (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 25)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "I have left thee to the scarlet letter" slowly and put it in my own words: Refusing to plead with Chillingworth, Hester tells him she leaves him to the scarlet letter. Next, craft. I notice she speaks of the letter as if it were a judge who will deal with him, the way people say "I leave you to God." The strongest word is "letter": the symbol of her own punishment becomes, in her words, the power that will judge him too. Then, effect. Why does Hester leave Chillingworth "to the scarlet letter"? My answer: Hester means that the letter's lesson, the cost of hidden sin, applies to him; his secret revenge has made him guiltier than she is, and she will no longer beg him for mercy.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Chillingworth sees himself as a fiend and blames others. Expected link: characterization; the sin of revenge. Ask: How does this line connect to sin and guilt? Expected: Revenge has made a wise man into a fiend. (The narrator's judgment.)

> *old Roger Chillingworth was a striking evidence of man's faculty of transforming himself into a devil, if he will only, for a reasonable space of time, undertake a devil's office (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 8)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Chillingworth sees himself as a fiend and blames others. Expected link: characterization; the sin of revenge.
Ask: How does this line connect to sin and guilt?
Expected answer: Revenge has made a wise man into a fiend. (The narrator's judgment.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for characterization, conflict (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about Hester and the physician? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XIV: Hester and the Physician develops the idea of Hester and the physician. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim. When the text says “Peace, Hester, peace … It is not granted me to pardon” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 32), it shows this directly. The narrator calls him evidence of "man's faculty of transforming himself into a devil," and he himself asks "A fiend! Who made me so?" yet says "It is not granted me to pardon."

Task: Annotate the chapter for characterization, conflict (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about Hester and the physician? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XIV: Hester and the Physician develops the idea of Hester and the physician. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

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70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Can a person be changed by hate? Ask: does Chillingworth have any freedom left? Does he believe he does?

Anchor question: Can a person be changed by hate?

Facilitation: Ask: does Chillingworth have any freedom left? Does he believe he does?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about Hester and the physician? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim. (“Peace, Hester, peace … It is not granted me to pardon”, XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 32). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about Hester and the physician? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim. (“Peace, Hester, peace … It is not granted me to pardon”, XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 32). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes Hester and the physician. Key takeaway: revenge has made a wise man into a fiend.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Chillingworth has transformed himself into a devil by undertaking a devil's office.
- **Conflict:** Hester tells him she will reveal his identity to Dimmesdale.
- **Theme:** Chillingworth accepts fate: "It is not granted me to pardon."

Themes and how they develop

- **sin and guilt:** revenge has made a wise man into a fiend.

Symbols and motifs

- **the scarlet letter:** The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: “yonder gatherer of herbs. So the child flew away like a bird, and, making bare her small white feet, went pattering along” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 1).
- **light and darkness:** Sunshine avoids Hester but plays around Pearl; the forest is dim; the minister's vigil happens at midnight under a meteor. In this chapter: “in. Forth peeped at her, out of the pool, with dark, glistening curls around her head, and an elf-smile in her eyes” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 1).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “old Roger Chillingworth was a striking evidence of man’s faculty of transforming himself into a devil, if he will only, for a reasonable space of time, undertake a devil’s office” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 8) The narrator's judgment.
- “I have left thee to the scarlet letter” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 25) Chillingworth on Hester's punishment.
- “Peace, Hester, peace … It is not granted me to pardon” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 32) Chillingworth's refusal.
- “A fiend! Who made me so” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 23) His self-recognition.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim.
Evidence: “Peace, Hester, peace … It is not granted me to pardon” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 32)

Reasoning: The narrator calls him evidence of "man's faculty of transforming himself into a devil," and he himself asks "A fiend! Who made me so?" yet says "It is not granted me to pardon."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
propinquity (noun)	nearness; closeness	*But it was the constant shadow of my presence!—the closest propinquity of the man whom he had most vilely wronged!—and who had grown to exist only by this perpetual poison of the direst revenge!*	
gloated (verb)	took cruel pleasure in someone's suffering	*This unhappy person had effected such a transformation, by devoting himself, for seven years, to the constant analysis of a heart full of torture, and deriving his enjoyment thence, and adding fuel to those fiery tortures which he analyzed and gloated over.*	
pledging (verb)	promising solemnly	*Yet it was not without heavy misgivings that I thus bound myself; for, having cast off all duty towards other human beings, there remained a duty towards him; and something whispered me that I was betraying it, in pledging myself to keep your counsel.*	
usurping (verb)	taking a place or power wrongfully	*The unfortunate physician, while uttering these words, lifted his hands with a look of horror, as if he had beheld some frightful shape, which he could not recognize, usurping the place of his own image in a glass.*	“usurping”: Origin of “usurp”: Old French usurper; earlier Latin ūsūrpō. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/usurp#Etymology)
heartstrings (noun)	one's deepest feelings	*He knew, by some spiritual sense—for the Creator never made another being so sensitive as this—he knew that no friendly hand was pulling at his heartstrings, and that an eye was looking curiously into him, which sought only evil, and found it.*	
derisively (adverb)	mockingly	*It seemed to be his wish and purpose to mask this expression with a smile; but the latter played him false, and flickered over his visage so derisively, that the spectator could see his blackness all the better for it.*	
gatherer (noun)	someone who collects (here, herbs)	*Hester bade little Pearl run down to the margin of the water, and play with the shells and tangled seaweed, until she should have talked awhile with yonder gatherer of herbs.*	

perpetration (noun)	the act of committing (a crime)	*But for my aid, his life would have burned away in torments, within the first two years after the perpetration of his crime and thine.*	

Discussion questions

1. Can a person be changed by hate?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with sin and guilt?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What did the magistrates discuss about the letter? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Letting Hester take it off.
2. Where do Hester and Chillingworth meet? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: By the shore
3. What does Hester say she will do? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Reveal his identity to Dimmesdale
4. What has Chillingworth become? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A fiend
5. What does he say he cannot do? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Pardon
6. What does Pearl do meanwhile? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Plays by the water
7. Retell the three most important events of “XIV: Hester and the Physician” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: On the shore Hester confronts Chillingworth, who has grown darker and fiendish. She asks him to stop tormenting the minister and says she will reveal his identity. He admits he has become a fiend but says he cannot pardon; it is all 'a dark necessity'.
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “XIV: Hester and the Physician”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “XIV: Hester and the Physician” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: “But it was the constant shadow of my presence!—the closest propinquity of the man whom he had most vilely wronged!—and who had grown to exist only by this perpetual poison of the direst revenge!” What does “propinquity” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: propinquity: nearness; closeness.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Hester feel responsible for Chillingworth? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: She married him without love.
2. What does "XIV: Hester and the Physician" suggest about Hester and the physician? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Revenge has destroyed the avenger.
3. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the conflict in this chapter shape what we understand about Hester and the physician? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim. Useful evidence: "old Roger Chillingworth was a striking evidence of man's faculty of transforming himself into a devil, if he will only, for a reasonable space of time, undertake a devil's office" (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 8): The narrator's judgment. On conflict: Hester tells him she will reveal his identity to Dimmesdale. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "In a word, old Roger Chillingworth was a striking evidence of man's faculty of transforming himself into a devil, if he will only, for a reasonable space of time, undertake a…", why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "XIV: Hester and the Physician", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: On the shore Hester confronts Chillingworth, who has grown darker and fiendish. She asks him to stop tormenting the minister and says she will reveal his identity. He admits he has become a fiend but says he cannot pardon; it is all 'a dark necessity'.
7. How does "XIV: Hester and the Physician" build on "XIII: Another View of Hester"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim. Useful evidence: "I have left thee to the scarlet letter" (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 25): Chillingworth on Hester's punishment. Theme link: revenge has made a wise man into a fiend. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim. Useful evidence: "Peace, Hester, peace … It is not granted me to pardon" (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 32): Chillingworth's refusal. On characterization: Chillingworth has transformed himself into a devil by undertaking a devil's office. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “Can a person be changed by hate?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with sin and guilt? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim. Useful evidence: “A fiend! Who made me so” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 23): His self-recognition. On theme: Chillingworth accepts fate: "It is not granted me to pardon." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Chillingworth free to forgive? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim. Useful evidence: “old Roger Chillingworth was a striking evidence of man’s faculty of transforming himself into a devil, if he will only, for a reasonable space of time, undertake a devil’s office” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 8): The narrator's judgment. On theme: Chillingworth accepts fate: "It is not granted me to pardon." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Revenge has destroyed the avenger.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim. Useful evidence: “I have left thee to the scarlet letter” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 25): Chillingworth on Hester's punishment. On theme: Chillingworth accepts fate: "It is not granted me to pardon." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim. Useful evidence: “Peace, Hester, peace … It is not granted me to pardon” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 32): Chillingworth's refusal. On characterization: Chillingworth has transformed himself into a devil by undertaking a devil's office. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Rewrite one moment of “XIV: Hester and the Physician” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about Hester and the physician? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim. Useful evidence: “A fiend! Who made me so” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 23): His

self-recognition. Theme link: revenge has made a wise man into a fiend. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “XIV: Hester and the Physician”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim. Useful evidence: “old Roger Chillingworth was a striking evidence of man’s faculty of transforming himself into a devil, if he will only, for a reasonable space of time, undertake a devil’s office” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 8): The narrator's judgment. On theme: Chillingworth accepts fate: "It is not granted me to pardon." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to public shame and private identity: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim. Useful evidence: “I have left thee to the scarlet letter” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 25): Chillingworth on Hester's punishment. On theme: Chillingworth accepts fate: "It is not granted me to pardon." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim. Useful evidence: “Peace, Hester, peace … It is not granted me to pardon” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 32): Chillingworth's refusal. On characterization: Chillingworth has transformed himself into a devil by undertaking a devil's office. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “XIV: Hester and the Physician” treats Hester and the physician with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim. Useful evidence: “A fiend! Who made me so” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 23): His self-recognition. On theme: Chillingworth accepts fate: "It is not granted me to pardon." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “XV: Hester and Pearl” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim. Useful evidence: “old Roger Chillingworth was a striking evidence of man’s faculty of transforming himself into a devil, if he will only, for a reasonable space of time, undertake a devil’s office” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 8): The narrator's judgment. Theme link: revenge has made a

wise man into a fiend. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Hester and the physician? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim. Useful evidence: “I have left thee to the scarlet letter” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 25): Chillingworth on Hester's punishment. On theme: Chillingworth accepts fate: "It is not granted me to pardon." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 8: “old Roger Chillingworth was a striking evidence of man’s faculty of _____ himself into a devil, if he will only, for a reasonable space of time, undertake a devil’s office”

    Key: transforming

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does he say he cannot do?

    A. Read

    B. Leave

    C. Sleep

    D. Pardon

    Key: D (Pardon)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “The unfortunate physician, while uttering these words, lifted his hands with a look of horror, as if he had beheld some frightful shape, which he could not recognize, usurping the place of his own image in a glass.”, what does “usurping” most nearly mean?

    A. playfully, in a teasing way

    B. drooping and withering

    C. taking a place or power wrongfully

    D. sadly; mournfully

    Key: C (taking a place or power wrongfully)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 32: “Peace, Hester, peace … It is not _____ me to pardon”

    Key: granted

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where do Hester and Chillingworth meet?

    A. By the shore

B. In church

C. In the forest

D. In prison

Key: A (By the shore)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Yet it was not without heavy misgivings that I thus bound myself; for, having cast off all duty towards other human beings, there remained a duty towards him; and something whispered me that I was betraying it, in…", what does "pledging" most nearly mean?

   A. digging or searching deeply

   B. put out (a fire)

   C. promising solemnly

   D. insistently, in a troubling way

   Key: C (promising solemnly)

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 25: "I have left thee to the _____ letter"

   Key: scarlet

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "But for my aid, his life would have burned away in torments, within the first two years after the _____ of his crime and thine." Word bank: gloated, pledging, propinquity, perpetration

   Key: perpetration

9. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What did the magistrates discuss about the letter?

   Sample answer: Letting Hester take it off.

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "But it was the constant shadow of my presence!—the closest propinquity of the man whom he had most vilely wronged!—and who had grown to exist only by this perpetual poison of the direst revenge!", what does "propinquity" most nearly mean?

    A. a complete change of appearance

    B. put out (a fire)

    C. happening at a bad time

    D. nearness; closeness

    Key: D (nearness; closeness)

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Hester say she will do?

    A. Confess publicly

    B. Reveal his identity to Dimmesdale

    C. Leave Boston

    D. Kill him

    Key: B (Reveal his identity to Dimmesdale)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Hester feel responsible for Chillingworth?

    Sample answer: She married him without love: the narrator's judgment. The evidence is "old Roger Chillingworth was a striking evidence of man's faculty of transforming himself into a devil, if he will only, for a reasonable…" (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 8).

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "I have left thee to the scarlet letter" (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 25) Answer in two or three sentences with one

detail.

Sample answer: Chillingworth on Hester's punishment. The evidence is “I have left thee to the scarlet letter” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 25). This develops sin and guilt: revenge has made a wise man into a fiend.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “XIV: Hester and the Physician”? Chillingworth has transformed himself into a devil by undertaking a devil's office.

    A. Tone / mood

    B. Irony

    C. Characterization

    D. Alliteration

    Key: C (Characterization)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Revenge has made a wise man into a fiend.

    A. Nature and the individual against society

    B. Sin and guilt

    C. Hypocrisy and truth

    D. Public shame and private identity

    Key: B (Sin and guilt)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how sin and guilt develops from IX: The Leech to XIV: Hester and the Physician. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Earlier, in IX: The Leech, paragraph 7, the text reads “it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart” — Dimmesdale's telltale gesture. In XIV: Hester and the Physician, “old Roger Chillingworth was a striking evidence of man’s faculty of transforming himself into a devil, if he will only, for a reasonable…” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 8) — The narrator's judgment. Revenge has made a wise man into a fiend.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What has Chillingworth become?

    A. A sailor

    B. A fiend

    C. A minister

    D. A saint

    Key: B (A fiend)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Pearl do meanwhile?

    A. Sleeps

    B. Prays

    C. Plays by the water

    D. Visits the minister

    Key: C (Plays by the water)

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 16: “I tell thee, Hester Prynne, the richest fee that ever _____ earned from monarch could not have bought such care as I have wasted on this miserable priest!” Word bank: physician, advancing, scarlet,

permitting

Key: physician

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 21 reveal about the character or situation? “Dost thou remember me, Hester, as I was nine years agone?” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 21) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: revenge has made a wise man into a fiend. The words “remember” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

21. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 7 reveal about the character or situation? “All this while, Hester had been looking steadily at the old man, and was shocked, as well as wonder-smitten, to discern what a change had been wrought upon him within the past seven years.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 7) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: revenge has made a wise man into a fiend. The words “steadily” and “wrought” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

22. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in XIV: Hester and the Physician?

    A. “Why, Mistress, I hear good tidings of you on all hands!”

    B. “No longer ago than yester-eve, a magistrate, a wise and godly man, was discoursing of your affairs, Mistress Hester, and whispered me that…”

    C. “It was debated whether or no, with safety to the common weal, yonder scarlet letter might be taken off your bosom.”

    D. “On my life, Hester, I made my entreaty to the worshipful magistrate that it might be done forthwith!”

    Key: A (“Why, Mistress, I hear good tidings of you on all hands!”)

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 24 shapes its tone: “Why hast thou not avenged thyself on me?” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “thyself” and “avenged” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 24) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: revenge has made a wise man into a fiend. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

24. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 29 shapes its tone: “But this long debt of confidence, due from me to him, whose bane and ruin I have been, shall at length be paid.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “confidence” and “length” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 29) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: revenge has made a wise man into a fiend. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 12? “Not to hide the truth, Mistress Hester, my thoughts happen just now to be busy with the _____.”

    A. together

    B. gentleman

    C. transformed

D. pattering

Key: B (gentleman)

26. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “He knew, by some spiritual sense—for the Creator never made another being so sensitive as this—he knew that no friendly hand was pulling at his _____, and that an eye was looking curiously into him, which sought only evil, and found it.” Word bank: heartstrings, pledging, gloated, propinquity

Key: heartstrings

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “This unhappy person had effected such a transformation, by devoting himself, for seven years, to the constant analysis of a heart full of torture, and deriving his enjoyment thence, and adding fuel to those fiery…”, what does “gloated” most nearly mean?

A. interfering in a harmful way

B. formal ceremonies

C. took cruel pleasure in someone's suffering

D. lacking curiosity (here 'not incurious' means quite curious)

Key: C (took cruel pleasure in someone's suffering)

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 13 shapes its tone: “As the life and good fame of yonder man were in your hands, there seemed no choice to me, save to be silent, in accordance with your behest.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “accordance” and “choice” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 13) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: revenge has made a wise man into a fiend. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 16 to the story's treatment of women and independence: “For, Hester, his spirit lacked the strength that could have borne up, as thine has, beneath a burden like thy scarlet letter.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 16) develops women and independence: revenge has made a wise man into a fiend. Its words “strength” and “scarlet” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “That he now breathes, and creeps about on earth, is owing all to me!” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 16), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

30. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 4? “It was _____ whether or no, with safety to the common weal, yonder scarlet letter might be taken off your bosom.”

A. embroidered

B. tidings

C. debated

D. transformed

Key: C (debated)

31. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 9 shapes its tone: “Here was another ruin, the responsibility of which came partly home to her.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “responsibility” and “another” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 9) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: revenge has made a wise man into a fiend. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

32. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Which literary element does this describe in “XIV: Hester and the Physician”? Hester tells him she will reveal his identity to Dimmesdale.

    A. Foreshadowing

    B. Conflict

    C. Hyperbole

    D. Setting

    Key: B (Conflict)

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 4 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: “No longer ago than yester-eve, a magistrate, a wise and godly man, was discoursing of your affairs, Mistress Hester, and whispered me that there had been question concerning you in the council.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 4) develops hypocrisy and truth: revenge has made a wise man into a fiend. Its words “discoursing” and “magistrate” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “On my life, Hester, I made my entreaty to the worshipful magistrate that it might be done forthwith!” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 4), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

34. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 18 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: “But he knew not that the eye and hand were mine!” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 18) develops hypocrisy and truth: revenge has made a wise man into a fiend. Its words its wording carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Yea, indeed! —he did not err!—there was a fiend at his elbow!” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 18), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

35. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “It seemed to be his wish and purpose to mask this expression with a smile; but the latter played him false, and flickered over his visage so _____, that the spectator could see his blackness all the better for it.” Word bank: gloated, pledging, derisively, propinquity

    Key: derisively

36. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I have left thee to the scarlet letter” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 25) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Chillingworth on Hester's punishment. The evidence is “I have left thee to the scarlet letter” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 25). This develops sin and guilt: revenge has made a wise man into a fiend. The words “scarlet” and “letter” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The narrator calls him evidence of "man's faculty of transforming himself into a devil," and he himself asks "A fiend! Who made me so?" yet says "It is not granted me to pardon.".

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Is Chillingworth free to forgive? Argue.

    Sample answer: A reasoned view: the narrator's judgment. The evidence is “old Roger Chillingworth was a striking evidence of man’s faculty of transforming himself into a devil, if he will only, for a reasonable…” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 8). This develops sin and guilt: revenge has made a wise man into a fiend. The narrator calls him

evidence of "man's faculty of transforming himself into a devil," and he himself asks "A fiend! Who made me so?" yet says "It is not granted me to pardon.".

38. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “I have left thee to the scarlet letter” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 25)

    A. Pearl on the sunshine.

    B. The sexton's reading of the sign.

    C. Chillingworth on Hester's punishment.

    D. His imagined ancestors' contempt for him.

    Key: C (Chillingworth on Hester's punishment.)

39. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the word choice in “Peace, Hester, peace … It is not granted me to pardon” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 32). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Chillingworth's refusal. The evidence is “Peace, Hester, peace … It is not granted me to pardon” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 32). This develops sin and guilt: revenge has made a wise man into a fiend. The words “granted” and “pardon” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “Peace, Hester, peace … It is not granted me to pardon” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 32) supports it: The narrator calls him evidence of "man's faculty of transforming himself into a devil," and he himself asks "A fiend! Who made me so?" yet says "It is not granted me to pardon.". But “old Roger Chillingworth was a striking evidence of man’s faculty of transforming himself into a devil, if he will only, for a reasonable space of time,…” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 8) complicates it: the line (the narrator's judgment) shows the same issue from another side, and its “only” marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. A fair verdict is that the claim is mostly right but overstated; it needs a limiting clause to cover that passage.

41. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 30 to the story's treatment of women and independence: “I pity thee, for the good that has been wasted in thy nature!” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 30) develops women and independence: revenge has made a wise man into a fiend. Its words “wasted” and “nature” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Here and there she came to a full stop, and peeped curiously into a pool, left by the retiring tide as a mirror for…” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 1), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

42. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “old Roger Chillingworth was a striking evidence of man’s faculty of transforming himself into a devil, if he will only, for a reasonable space of time, undertake a devil’s office” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 8) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The narrator's judgment. The evidence is “old Roger Chillingworth was a striking evidence of man’s faculty of transforming himself into a devil, if he will only, for a reasonable…” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 8). This develops sin and guilt: revenge has made a wise man into a fiend. The words “transforming” and “reasonable” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The narrator calls him

evidence of "man's faculty of transforming himself into a devil," and he himself asks "A fiend! Who made me so?" yet says "It is not granted me to pardon.".

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 11, inference 2, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	11, 6, 1, 17, 18, 5, 19, 3, 20, 12, 21, 22, 14, 23, 24, 16	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	25, 11, 10, 1, 26, 27, 13, 12, 21, 20, 22, 23, 28, 24, 16, 29	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	26, 30, 9, 18, 5, 4, 20, 21, 12, 22, 31, 32, 28, 15, 33, 34	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	3, 35, 11, 25, 8, 12, 21, 20, 22, 23, 14, 24, 15, 33, 36, 37	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	26, 35, 2, 20, 38, 12, 21, 15, 39, 24, 32, 28, 34, 29, 40, 41	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	26, 6, 10, 35, 21, 20, 12, 14, 15, 23, 24, 39, 29, 16, 33, 41	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	30, 2, 26, 35, 22, 13, 24, 31, 23, 28, 15, 37, 16, 34, 33, 42	recall 4, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	5, 17, 26, 35, 11, 2, 39, 31, 24, 23, 34, 40, 37, 29, 41, 33	recall 6, inference 0, analysis 4, synthesis 6
College Senior	6, 26, 35, 5, 23, 14, 24, 15, 28, 37, 40, 33, 16, 29, 34, 41	recall 4, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	2, 26, 35, 38, 32, 23, 39, 31, 15, 40, 37, 16, 34, 41, 33, 29	recall 3, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 7

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “XIV: Hester and the Physician,” how does Hawthorne show Hester and the physician? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In XIV: Hester and the Physician, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of Hester and the physician? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how XIV: Hester and the Physician develops the idea of Hester and the physician. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of XIV: Hester and the Physician (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Hester and the physician. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what XIV: Hester and the Physician suggests about Hester and the physician. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and conflict), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses characterization in XIV: Hester and the Physician to complicate the reader's understanding of Hester and the physician. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate XIV: Hester and the Physician within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of Hester and the physician responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read XIV: Hester and the Physician alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of Hester and the physician follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to XIV: Hester and the Physician and its treatment of Hester and the physician. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and conflict, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads XIV: Hester and the Physician as evidence for a larger claim about Hester and the physician in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads XIV: Hester and the Physician as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of Hester and the physician. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

SAT-style questions

1. *Yet it was not without heavy misgivings that I thus bound myself; for, having cast off all duty towards other human beings, there remained a duty towards him; and something whispered me that I was betraying it, in pledging myself to keep your counsel.*

As used in the text, what does the word "pledging" most nearly mean?

A. the act of committing (a crime)

B. mockingly

C. promising solemnly

D. someone who collects (here, herbs)

2. *In a word, old Roger Chillingworth was a striking evidence of man's faculty of transforming himself into a devil, if he will only, for a reasonable space of time, undertake a devil's office. This unhappy person had effected such a transformation, by devoting himself, for seven years, to the constant analysis of a heart full of torture, and deriving his enjoyment thence, and adding fuel to those fiery tortures which he analyzed and gloated over.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "XIV: Hester and the Physician"?

A. Hester at her needle

B. Conclusion

C. Hester and the physician

D. The pastor and his parishioner

SAT key: 1. C (promising solemnly); 2. C (Hester and the physician)

Lesson 18: XV: Hester and Pearl

Focus: Hester and Pearl

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in "XV: Hester and Pearl" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

Hester admits to herself that she hates Chillingworth. Pearl makes a green letter A of eelgrass on her own breast and asks what the scarlet letter means and why the minister keeps his hand over his heart. Hester, for the first time, lies to her.

Background: Hester has never lied to the magistrates; her lie to Pearl shows how the secret is spreading.

Significance: Pearl insists on the truth the adults hide.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Should parents always tell their children the truth? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to hypocrisy and truth because....
Prompt: Should parents always tell their children the truth?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to hypocrisy and truth because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Hester's first lie to Pearl.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: nightshade — a poisonous plant; reciprocated — returned (a feeling or gesture); sedulous — careful and hard-working; fancifully — playfully and imaginatively; deleterious — harmful. "reciprocated": Origin of "reciprocate": possibly Latin recīprocātus.
Words: nightshade: a poisonous plant · reciprocated: returned (a feeling or gesture) · sedulous: careful and hard-working · fancifully: playfully and imaginatively · deleterious: harmful

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Hester has never lied to the magistrates; her lie to Pearl shows how the secret is spreading. Pearl insists on the truth the adults hide. Characterization: Hester admits to herself that she hates Chillingworth. Symbolism: Pearl makes a green "A" of seaweed on her own breast. Conflict: Pearl asks why the minister keeps his hand over his heart; Hester lies for the first time. Watch for the scarlet letter: The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "So Roger Chillingworth—a deformed old figure, with a face that haunted men's memories longer" (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 1).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean" slowly and put it in my own words: Pearl asks her mother what the letter means and why the minister keeps his hand over his heart. Next, craft. I notice the child's direct, repeated question breaks into the adults' silence. The strongest word is "mean": Pearl treats the letter as a riddle with an answer, not as a fixed shame. Then, effect. Why does Pearl keep asking what the scarlet letter means? My answer: Pearl presses toward the truth Hester will not say; her question links the letter to Dimmesdale's hidden guilt and keeps the secret from resting.

> *Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean* *(XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 29)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean" slowly and put it in my own words: Pearl asks her mother what the letter means and why the minister keeps his hand over his heart. Next, craft. I notice the child's direct, repeated question breaks into the adults' silence. The strongest word is "mean": Pearl treats the letter as a riddle with an answer, not as a fixed shame. Then, effect. Why does Pearl keep asking what the scarlet letter means? My answer: Pearl presses toward the truth Hester will not say; her question links the letter to Dimmesdale's hidden guilt and keeps the secret from resting.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Hester's "Yes, I hate him!" shows her bitterness. Expected link: characterization; sin and guilt. Ask: How does this line connect to hypocrisy and truth? Expected: Hester's first lie to Pearl. (Hester's admission.)

> *Yes, I hate him* *(XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 4)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Hester's "Yes, I hate him!" shows her bitterness. Expected link: characterization; sin and guilt.
Ask: How does this line connect to hypocrisy and truth?
Expected answer: Hester's first lie to Pearl. (Hester's admission.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for characterization, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about Hester and Pearl? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XV: Hester and Pearl develops the idea of Hester and Pearl. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Pearl presses the truth that adults hide. When the text says "Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean" (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 29), it shows this directly. She asks "what does the scarlet letter mean?" and "why does the minister keep his hand over his heart?", and Hester, who has never lied, evades her.
Task: Annotate the chapter for characterization, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about Hester and Pearl? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XV: Hester and Pearl develops the idea of Hester and Pearl. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Pearl presses the truth that adults hide. When the text says "Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean" (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 29), it shows this directly. She asks "what does the scarlet letter mean?" and "why does the minister keep his hand over his heart?", and Hester, who has never lied, evades her.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Should parents always tell their children the truth? Ask: why does Hester lie to Pearl here, when she would not lie to the magistrates?
Anchor question: Should parents always tell their children the truth?
Facilitation: Ask: why does Hester lie to Pearl here, when she would not lie to the magistrates?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about Hester and Pearl? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Pearl presses the truth that adults hide. ("Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean", XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 29). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about Hester and Pearl? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Pearl presses the truth that adults hide. ("Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean", XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 29). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes Hester and Pearl. Key takeaway: Hester's first lie to Pearl.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Hester admits to herself that she hates Chillingworth.
- **Symbolism:** Pearl makes a green "A" of seaweed on her own breast.
- **Conflict:** Pearl asks why the minister keeps his hand over his heart; Hester lies for the first time.

Themes and how they develop

- **hypocrisy and truth:** Hester's first lie to Pearl.

Symbols and motifs

- **the scarlet letter:** The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: “So Roger Chillingworth—a deformed old figure, with a face that haunted men’s memories longer” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 1).
- **light and darkness:** Sunshine avoids Hester but plays around Pearl; the forest is dim; the minister's vigil happens at midnight under a meteor. In this chapter: “was there, as it rather seemed, a circle of ominous shadow moving along with his deformity, whichever way he turned himself? And” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 1).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Yes, I hate him” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 4) Hester's admission.
- “Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 29) Pearl's question.
- “and why does the minister keep his hand over his heart” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 19) Pearl links the minister to the letter.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Pearl presses the truth that adults hide.
Evidence: “Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 29)
Reasoning: She asks "what does the scarlet letter mean?" and "why does the minister keep his hand over his heart?", and Hester, who has never lied, evades her.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
nightshade (noun)	a poisonous plant	*Would he not suddenly sink into the earth, leaving a barren and blasted spot, where, in due course of time, would be seen deadly nightshade, dogwood, henbane, and*	

		whatever else of vegetable wickedness the climate could produce, all flourishing with hideous luxuriance?	
reciprocated (verb)	returned (a feeling or gesture)	*She deemed it her crime most to be repented of, that she had ever endured, and reciprocated, the lukewarm grasp of his hand, and had suffered the smile of her lips and eyes to mingle and melt into his own.*	"reciprocated": Origin of "reciprocate": possibly Latin recīprocātus. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/reciprocate#Etymology)
sedulous (adjective)	careful and hard-working	*She wondered what sort of herbs they were, which the old man was so sedulous to gather.*	
fancifully (adverb)	playfully and imaginatively	*At first, as already told, she had flirted fancifully with her own image in a pool of water, beckoning the phantom forth, and—as it declined to venture—seeking a passage for herself into its sphere of impalpable earth and unattainable sky.*	
deleterious (adjective)	harmful	*Or might it suffice him, that every wholesome growth should be converted into something deleterious and malignant at his touch?*	
intelligently (adverb)	in a sensible, knowing way	*The thought occurred to Hester, that the child might really be seeking to approach her with childlike confidence, and doing what she could, and as intelligently as she knew how, to establish a meeting-point of sympathy.*	

Discussion questions

1. Should parents always tell their children the truth?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with public shame and private identity?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Hester threaten when Pearl keeps asking? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: To shut her in the dark closet.
2. What does Hester admit? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: She hates Chillingworth
3. What does Pearl make of seaweed? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A letter A
4. What does Pearl ask? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Why the minister keeps his hand over his heart
5. How does Hester answer? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: She lies or evades
6. What color is Pearl's A? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Green
7. Retell the three most important events of "XV: Hester and Pearl" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Hester admits to herself that she hates Chillingworth. Pearl makes a green letter A of eelgrass on her own breast and asks what the scarlet letter means and why the minister keeps his hand over his heart. Hester, for the first time, lies to her.
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "XV: Hester and Pearl"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "XV: Hester and Pearl" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: "Would he not suddenly sink into the earth, leaving a barren and blasted spot, where, in due course of time, would be seen deadly nightshade, dogwood, henbane, and whatever else of vegetable wickedness the climate could…" What does "nightshade" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: nightshade: a poisonous plant.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Hester lie? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: She fears the truth will hurt Pearl or Dimmesdale.
2. What does "XV: Hester and Pearl" suggest about Hester and Pearl? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Pearl insists on the truth the adults hide.
3. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the symbolism in this chapter shape what we understand about Hester and Pearl? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl presses the truth that adults hide. Useful evidence: "Yes, I hate him" (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 4): Hester's admission. On symbolism: Pearl makes a

green "A" of seaweed on her own breast. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “Let men tremble to win the hand of woman, unless they win along with it the utmost passion of her heart!”, why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “XV: Hester and Pearl”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Hester admits to herself that she hates Chillingworth. Pearl makes a green letter A of eelgrass on her own breast and asks what the scarlet letter means and why the minister keeps his hand over his heart. Hester, for the first time, lies to her.
7. How does “XV: Hester and Pearl” build on “XIV: Hester and the Physician”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl presses the truth that adults hide. Useful evidence: “Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 29): Pearl's question. Theme link: Hester's first lie to Pearl. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl presses the truth that adults hide. Useful evidence: “and why does the minister keep his hand over his heart” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 19): Pearl links the minister to the letter. On characterization: Hester admits to herself that she hates Chillingworth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Should parents always tell their children the truth?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does conflict appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with public shame and private identity? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl presses the truth that adults hide. Useful evidence: “Yes, I hate him” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 4): Hester's admission. On conflict: Pearl asks why the minister keeps his hand over his heart; Hester lies for the first time. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Hester's lie justified? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl presses the truth that adults hide. Useful evidence: “Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 29): Pearl's question. Theme link: Hester's first lie to Pearl. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: "Pearl insists on the truth the adults hide." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl presses the truth that adults hide. Useful evidence: "and why does the minister keep his hand over his heart" (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 19): Pearl links the minister to the letter. Theme link: Hester's first lie to Pearl. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl presses the truth that adults hide. Useful evidence: "Yes, I hate him" (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 4): Hester's admission. On characterization: Hester admits to herself that she hates Chillingworth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Rewrite one moment of "XV: Hester and Pearl" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about Hester and Pearl? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl presses the truth that adults hide. Useful evidence: "Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean" (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 29): Pearl's question. Theme link: Hester's first lie to Pearl. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about "XV: Hester and Pearl": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl presses the truth that adults hide. Useful evidence: "and why does the minister keep his hand over his heart" (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 19): Pearl links the minister to the letter. Theme link: Hester's first lie to Pearl. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to hypocrisy and truth: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl presses the truth that adults hide. Useful evidence: "Yes, I hate him" (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 4): Hester's admission. Theme link: Hester's first lie to Pearl. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl presses the truth that adults hide. Useful evidence: "Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean" (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 29): Pearl's question. On characterization: Hester admits to herself that she hates Chillingworth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “XV: Hester and Pearl” treats Hester and Pearl with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl presses the truth that adults hide. Useful evidence: “and why does the minister keep his hand over his heart” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 19): Pearl links the minister to the letter. Theme link: Hester's first lie to Pearl. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “XVI: A Forest Walk” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl presses the truth that adults hide. Useful evidence: “Yes, I hate him” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 4): Hester's admission. Theme link: Hester's first lie to Pearl. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Hester and Pearl? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl presses the truth that adults hide. Useful evidence: “Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 29): Pearl's question. Theme link: Hester's first lie to Pearl. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 19: “and why does the _____ keep his hand over his heart”
   Key: minister
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “She deemed it her crime most to be repented of, that she had ever endured, and reciprocated, the lukewarm grasp of his hand, and had suffered the smile of her lips and eyes to mingle and melt into his own.”, what does “reciprocated” most nearly mean?
   A. lively and bold
   B. built or reinforced with heavy wooden beams
   C. spoke of with harsh, abusive criticism
   D. returned (a feeling or gesture)
   Key: D (returned (a feeling or gesture))
3. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Hester threaten when Pearl keeps asking?
   Sample answer: To shut her in the dark closet.

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Pearl ask?

   A. Who the governor is

   B. Why the minister keeps his hand over his heart

   C. Where her father lives

   D. Why the sky is red

   Key: B (Why the minister keeps his hand over his heart)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Or might it suffice him, that every wholesome growth should be converted into something _____ and malignant at his touch?" Word bank: reciprocated, sedulous, deleterious, nightshade

   Key: deleterious

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What color is Pearl's A?

   A. Gold

   B. Black

   C. Green

   D. Red

   Key: C (Green)

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 29: "Mother … what does the _____ letter mean"

   Key: scarlet

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Hester admit?

   A. She is sorry

   B. She wants to leave

   C. She hates Chillingworth

   D. She loves Chillingworth

   Key: C (She hates Chillingworth)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "The thought occurred to Hester, that the child might really be seeking to approach her with childlike confidence, and doing what she could, and as _____ as she knew how, to establish a meeting-point of sympathy." Word bank: sedulous, intelligently, reciprocated, nightshade

   Key: intelligently

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "She wondered what sort of herbs they were, which the old man was so sedulous to gather.", what does "sedulous" most nearly mean?

    A. a person who breaks a law or moral rule

    B. careful and hard-working

    C. lights up

    D. keep and nurse (a feeling) in one's heart

    Key: B (careful and hard-working)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "Yes, I hate him" (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 4) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Hester's admission. The evidence is “Yes, I hate him” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 4). This develops hypocrisy and truth: Hester's first lie to Pearl.

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 29) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Pearl's question. The evidence is “Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 29). This develops hypocrisy and truth: Hester's first lie to Pearl.
13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Hester lie?
    Sample answer: She fears the truth will hurt Pearl or Dimmesdale. The evidence is “and why does the minister keep his hand over his heart” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 19) — Pearl links the minister to the letter.
14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “XV: Hester and Pearl”? Hester admits to herself that she hates Chillingworth.
    A. Alliteration
    B. Characterization
    C. Imagery
    D. Tone / mood

    Key: B (Characterization)
15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Hester's first lie to Pearl.
    A. Sin and guilt
    B. Nature and the individual against society
    C. Hypocrisy and truth
    D. Public shame and private identity

    Key: C (Hypocrisy and truth)
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is Hester's lie justified? Argue.
    Sample answer: A reasoned view: Hester's admission. The evidence is “Yes, I hate him” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 4). This develops hypocrisy and truth: Hester's first lie to Pearl. She asks "what does the scarlet letter mean?" and "why does the minister keep his hand over his heart?", and Hester, who has never lied, evades her.
17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 9: “Then she took up the white foam, that streaked the line of the advancing tide, and threw it upon the breeze, _____ after it, with winged footsteps, to catch the great snowflakes ere they fell.” Word bank: employment, injustice, scampering, quickened
    Key: scampering
18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 6? “The emotions of that brief space, while she stood gazing after the crooked figure of old Roger Chillingworth, threw a dark light on Hester’s state of mind, revealing much that she might not otherwise have _____ to herself.”
    A. employment
    B. bitterly
    C. deformed
    D. acknowledged

Key: D (acknowledged)

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Hester answer?

    A. She leaves

    B. She tells the truth

    C. She lies or evades

    D. She laughs

    Key: C (She lies or evades)

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "At first, as already told, she had flirted fancifully with her own image in a pool of water, beckoning the phantom forth, and—as it declined to venture—seeking a passage for herself into its sphere of impalpable earth…", what does "fancifully" most nearly mean?

    A. a reddish glow

    B. playfully and imaginatively

    C. never having happened before

    D. accepting something without protest

    Key: B (playfully and imaginatively)

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Pearl make of seaweed?

    A. A letter A

    B. A crown

    C. A rose

    D. A boat

    Key: A (A letter A)

22. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 21 reveal about the character or situation? "From the earliest epoch of her conscious life, she had entered upon this as her appointed mission." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 21) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: Hester's first lie to Pearl. The words "appointed" and "conscious" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

23. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 7 reveal about the character or situation? "He being gone, she summoned back her child." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 7) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: Hester's first lie to Pearl. The words "summoned" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

24. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 10 shapes its tone: "A letter—the letter A—but freshly green, instead of scarlet!" Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "instead" and "scarlet" (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 10) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: Hester's first lie to Pearl. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

25. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in "and why does the minister keep his hand over his heart" (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 19). Pick two words and explain what they

suggest.

Sample answer: Pearl links the minister to the letter. The evidence is “and why does the minister keep his hand over his heart” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 19). This develops hypocrisy and truth: Hester's first lie to Pearl. The words “minister” and “heart” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 15 to the story's treatment of women and independence: “She felt a morbid desire to ascertain the point.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 15) develops women and independence: Hester's first lie to Pearl. Its words “ascertain” and “morbid” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “It is for the same reason that the minister keeps his hand over his heart!” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 17), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Would he not suddenly sink into the earth, leaving a barren and blasted spot, where, in due course of time, would be seen deadly nightshade, dogwood, henbane, and whatever else of vegetable wickedness the climate could…”, what does “nightshade” most nearly mean?

A. the quality of being believable

B. changing the true shape or meaning

C. a poisonous plant

D. changeable, unsteady moodiness

Key: C (a poisonous plant)

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Which literary element does this describe in “XV: Hester and Pearl”? Pearl makes a green ‘A’ of seaweed on her own breast.

A. Foreshadowing

B. Allusion

C. Symbolism

D. Structure

Key: C (Symbolism)

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how hypocrisy and truth develops from XI: The Interior of a Heart to XV: Hester and Pearl. Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: Earlier, in XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 7, the text reads “He had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood”, which shows the core of his hypocrisy. In XV: Hester and Pearl, “Yes, I hate him” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 4) — Hester's admission. Hester's first lie to Pearl.

30. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in XV: Hester and Pearl?

A. “He gathered here and there an herb, or grubbed up a root, and put it into the basket on his arm.”

B. “So Roger Chillingworth—a deformed old figure, with a face that haunted men’s memories longer than they liked—took leave of Hester Prynne,…”

C. “Hester gazed after him a little while, looking with a half-fantastic curiosity to see whether the tender grass of early spring would not be…”

D. “His gray beard almost touched the ground, as he crept onward.”

Key: B ("So Roger Chillingworth—a deformed old figure, with a face that haunted men's memories longer than they liked—took leave of Hester Prynne,…")

31. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 1 shapes its tone: "Hester gazed after him a little while, looking with a half-fantastic curiosity to see whether the tender grass of early spring would not be blighted beneath him, and show the wavering track of his footsteps, sere and brown, across its…" Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "fantastic" and "footsteps" (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 1) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: Hester's first lie to Pearl. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

32. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 9 shapes its tone: "Perceiving a flock of beach-birds, that fed and fluttered along the shore, the naughty child picked up her apron full of pebbles, and, creeping from rock to rock after these small sea-fowl, displayed remarkable dexterity in pelting them." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "remarkable" and "dexterity" (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 9) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: Hester's first lie to Pearl. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 20 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: "Heretofore, the mother, while loving her child with the intensity of a sole affection, had schooled herself to hope for little other return than the waywardness of an April breeze" Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 20) develops hypocrisy and truth: Hester's first lie to Pearl. Its words "waywardness" and "affection" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Any other observer might have seen few but unamiable traits, and have given them a far darker coloring." (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 20), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

34. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 3 to the story's treatment of women and independence: "She upbraided herself for the sentiment, but could not overcome or lessen it." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 3) develops women and independence: Hester's first lie to Pearl. Its words "sentiment" and "upbraided" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "He needed to bask himself in that smile, he said, in order that the chill of so many lonely hours among his books might…" (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 3), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

35. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 26 shapes its tone: "There are many things in this world that a child must not ask about." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "things" (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 26) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: Hester's first lie to Pearl. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

36. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean" (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 29) shape its meaning? Consider a

second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Pearl's question. The evidence is “Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 29). This develops hypocrisy and truth: Hester's first lie to Pearl. The words “scarlet” and “letter” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. She asks "what does the scarlet letter mean?" and "why does the minister keep his hand over his heart?", and Hester, who has never lied, evades her.

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Claim: Pearl presses the truth that adults hide. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 29).

    Sample answer: She asks "what does the scarlet letter mean?" and "why does the minister keep his hand over his heart?", and Hester, who has never lied, evades her. The evidence is “Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 29) — Pearl's question. This develops hypocrisy and truth: Hester's first lie to Pearl.

38. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] What does this passage most clearly show? “and why does the minister keep his hand over his heart” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 19)

    A. The novel's best-known statement on hypocrisy.

    B. First description of the letter.

    C. Pearl links the minister to the letter.

    D. The cost of falseness.

    Key: C (Pearl links the minister to the letter.)

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Connect this passage from XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 3 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: “And it seemed a fouler offence committed by Roger Chillingworth, than any which had since been done him, that, in the time when her heart knew no better, he had persuaded her to fancy herself happy by his side.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 3) develops hypocrisy and truth: Hester's first lie to Pearl. Its words “persuaded” and “committed” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Let men tremble to win the hand of woman, unless they win along with it the utmost passion of her heart!” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 5), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Yes, I hate him” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 4) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Hester's admission. The evidence is “Yes, I hate him” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 4). This develops hypocrisy and truth: Hester's first lie to Pearl. The words “hate” and “him” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. She asks "what does the scarlet letter mean?" and "why does the minister keep his hand over his heart?", and Hester, who has never lied, evades her.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	2, 8, 5, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 13, 11, 23, 24, 25, 15, 26	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	20, 27, 5, 7, 6, 2, 21, 10, 11, 12, 13, 15, 28, 25, 16, 29	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	9, 4, 5, 8, 27, 30, 23, 13, 11, 22, 14, 31, 32, 25, 33, 34	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2

HS Senior	5, 21, 9, 6, 20, 22, 30, 23, 13, 28, 24, 15, 35, 34, 33, 26	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	5, 2, 17, 22, 30, 23, 11, 28, 25, 35, 32, 15, 34, 36, 26, 33	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	5, 9, 4, 13, 11, 30, 23, 35, 37, 14, 24, 15, 26, 16, 34, 29	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	5, 10, 9, 38, 23, 12, 31, 28, 32, 24, 15, 26, 29, 33, 39, 16	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	5, 18, 9, 30, 22, 32, 15, 14, 25, 35, 34, 40, 33, 39, 29, 36	recall 3, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	4, 5, 9, 30, 15, 24, 32, 25, 35, 14, 33, 29, 26, 39, 16, 34	recall 3, inference 1, analysis 6, synthesis 6
Graduate / PhD	7, 5, 8, 38, 32, 15, 31, 37, 28, 39, 33, 40, 34, 29, 16, 26	recall 3, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 7

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "XV: Hester and Pearl," how does Hawthorne show Hester and Pearl? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In XV: Hester and Pearl, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of Hester and Pearl? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how XV: Hester and Pearl develops the idea of Hester and Pearl. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of XV: Hester and Pearl (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Hester and Pearl. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what XV: Hester and Pearl suggests about Hester and Pearl. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses characterization in XV: Hester and Pearl to complicate the reader's understanding of Hester and Pearl. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate XV: Hester and Pearl within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of Hester and Pearl responds to that

context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read XV: Hester and Pearl alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of Hester and Pearl follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to XV: Hester and Pearl and its treatment of Hester and Pearl. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads XV: Hester and Pearl as evidence for a larger claim about Hester and Pearl in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads XV: Hester and Pearl as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of Hester and Pearl. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

SAT-style questions

1. *She wondered what sort of herbs they were, which the old man was so sedulous to gather.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “sedulous” most nearly mean?

   A. careful and hard-working

   B. in a sensible, knowing way

   C. playfully and imaginatively

   D. harmful

2. *Let men tremble to win the hand of woman, unless they win along with it the utmost passion of her heart! Else it may be their miserable fortune, as it was Roger Chillingworth's, when some mightier touch than their own may have awakened all her sensibilities, to be reproached even for the calm content, the marble image of happiness, which they will have imposed upon her as the warm reality. But Hester ought long ago to have done with this injustice. What did it betoken? Had seven long years, under the torture of the scarlet letter, inflicted so much of misery, and wrought out no repentance?*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “XV: Hester and Pearl”?

   A. Hester and Pearl

   B. The pastor and his parishioner

   C. The interview in prison

   D. Hester at her needle

SAT key: 1. A (careful and hard-working); 2. A (Hester and Pearl)

Lesson 19: XVI: A Forest Walk

Focus: the forest walk

Objective: Students will analyze how setting develops in "XVI: A Forest Walk" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

Hester waits in the forest for Dimmesdale. Sunlight flickers around Pearl but flees from Hester. Pearl asks about the Black Man; Hester says she met him once, and the letter is his mark. The brook babbles but tells no secrets.

Background: Puritans saw the forest as the devil's ground, where witches met the Black Man.

Significance: The forest offers freedom but Hester brings the letter's shadow into it.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Is nature a place of freedom or danger? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to nature and the individual against society because....*
> **Prompt:** Is nature a place of freedom or danger?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to nature and the individual against society because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the forest as a world outside Puritan law.

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
> Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
> *Today's words: scintillating — sparkling; straggled — wandered in a scattered, irregular way; humanize — make more kind, gentle and human; pensiveness — deep, sad thoughtfulness; mischievously — playfully, in a teasing way. "mischievously": Origin of "mischievous": Anglo-Norman meschevous.*
> **Words:** scintillating: sparkling · straggled: wandered in a scattered, irregular way · humanize: make more kind, gentle and human · pensiveness: deep, sad thoughtfulness · mischievously: playfully, in a teasing way

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Puritans saw the forest as the devil's ground, where witches met the Black Man. The forest offers freedom but Hester brings the letter's shadow into it. Setting: The forest path, dark and wild, with sunshine that flees from Hester. Symbolism: Sunlight plays around Pearl but vanishes as Hester reaches for it. Foreshadowing: Pearl asks about the Black Man and whether Hester's letter is his mark. Watch for light and darkness: "Mother, the sunshine does not love you."

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Mother … the sunshine does not love you" slowly and put it in my own words: In the forest, Pearl says the sunlight runs from her mother because of something on her breast. Next, craft. I notice the childlike personification of sunshine as a creature that loves or avoids people. The strongest word is "sunshine": it stands for joy and grace, which seem to flee the letter. Then, effect. What is Pearl suggesting when she says the sunshine does not love Hester? My answer: Pearl voices what the town believes, that the letter cuts Hester off from happiness; the moment prepares for Hester throwing the letter off and the sun pouring in.

> *Mother … the sunshine does not love you* (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Mother … the sunshine does not love you" slowly and put it in my own words: In the forest, Pearl says the sunlight runs from her mother because of something on her breast. Next, craft. I notice the childlike personification of sunshine as a creature that loves or avoids people. The strongest word is "sunshine": it stands for joy and grace, which seem to flee the letter. Then, effect. What is Pearl suggesting when she says the sunshine does not love Hester? My answer: Pearl voices what the town believes, that the letter cuts Hester off from happiness; the moment prepares for Hester throwing the letter off and the sun pouring in.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Hester admits the letter as the Black Man's mark. Expected link: symbolism; forest and town. Ask: How does this line connect to nature and the individual against society? Expected: The forest as a world outside Puritan law. (Hester's answer.)

> *Once in my life I met the Black Man … This scarlet letter is his mark* (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 22)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Hester admits the letter as the Black Man's mark. Expected link: symbolism; forest and town.
Ask: How does this line connect to nature and the individual against society?
Expected answer: The forest as a world outside Puritan law. (Hester's answer.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for setting, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the forest walk? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XVI: A Forest Walk develops the idea of the forest walk. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. When the text says "Mother … the sunshine does not love you" (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4), it shows this directly. Pearl says "the sunshine does not love you," and Hester tells her "This scarlet letter is his mark!"
Task: Annotate the chapter for setting, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the forest walk? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XVI: A Forest Walk develops the idea of the forest walk. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. When the text says "Mother … the sunshine does not love you" (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4), it shows this directly. Pearl says "the sunshine does not love you," and Hester tells her "This scarlet letter is his mark!"

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Is nature a place of freedom or danger? Ask: what does the brook, which tells no secret, have in common with Dimmesdale?
Anchor question: Is nature a place of freedom or danger?
Facilitation: Ask: what does the brook, which tells no secret, have in common with Dimmesdale?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the forest walk? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. ("Mother … the sunshine does not love you", XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the forest walk? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. ("Mother … the sunshine does not love you", XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how setting shapes the forest walk. Key takeaway: the forest as a world outside Puritan law.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Setting:** The forest path, dark and wild, with sunshine that flees from Hester.
- **Symbolism:** Sunlight plays around Pearl but vanishes as Hester reaches for it.
- **Foreshadowing:** Pearl asks about the Black Man and whether Hester's letter is his mark.

Themes and how they develop

- **nature and the individual against society:** the forest as a world outside Puritan law.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and darkness:** "Mother, the sunshine does not love you."

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Mother … the sunshine does not love you" (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4) Pearl's observation.
- "Once in my life I met the Black Man … This scarlet letter is his mark" (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 22) Hester's answer.
- "It runs away and hides itself, because it is afraid of something on your bosom" (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4) Pearl on the sunshine.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it.
Evidence: "Mother … the sunshine does not love you" (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4)
Reasoning: Pearl says "the sunshine does not love you," and Hester tells her "This scarlet letter is his mark!"

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
scintillating (verb)	sparkling	*Pearl set forth, at a great pace, and, as Hester smiled to perceive, did actually catch the sunshine, and stood laughing in the midst of it, all brightened by its splendor, and scintillating with the vivacity excited by rapid motion.*	
straggled (verb)	wandered in a scattered, irregular way	*It straggled onward into the mystery of the primeval forest.*	
humanize (verb)	make more kind, gentle and human	*She wanted—what some people want throughout life—a grief that should*	

		deeply touch her, and thus humanize and make her capable of sympathy.	
pensiveness (noun)	deep, sad thoughtfulness	*The sportive sunlight—feebly sportive, at best, in the predominant pensiveness of the day and scene—withdrew itself as they came nigh, and left the spots where it had danced the drearier, because they had hoped to find them bright.*	
mischievously (adverb)	playfully, in a teasing way	*"O, a story about the Black Man," answered Pearl, taking hold of her mother's gown, and looking up, half earnestly, half mischievously, into her face.*	"mischievously": Origin of "mischievous": Anglo-Norman meschevous. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/mischievous#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. Is nature a place of freedom or danger?
2. Where does setting appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with hypocrisy and truth?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Where is Dimmesdale coming from? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A visit to the Apostle Eliot among the Native converts.
2. Where does Hester wait? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: In the forest
3. What avoids Hester? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Sunshine
4. Who is the Black Man? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The devil of local legend
5. What does Hester call the letter? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The Black Man's mark
6. What does the brook do? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Babbles but tells no secret
7. Retell the three most important events of "XVI: A Forest Walk" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Hester waits in the forest for Dimmesdale. Sunlight

flickers around Pearl but flees from Hester. Pearl asks about the Black Man; Hester says she met him once, and the letter is his mark. The brook babbles but tells no secrets.

8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "XVI: A Forest Walk"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "XVI: A Forest Walk" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: "Pearl set forth, at a great pace, and, as Hester smiled to perceive, did actually catch the sunshine, and stood laughing in the midst of it, all brightened by its splendor, and scintillating with the vivacity excited by…" What does "scintillating" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: scintillating: sparkling.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does the sunshine avoid Hester? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Something on her bosom, the letter, keeps it away.
2. What does "XVI: A Forest Walk" suggest about the forest walk? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The forest offers freedom but Hester brings the letter's shadow into it.
3. Find one example of setting in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
4. How does the symbolism in this chapter shape what we understand about the forest walk? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. Useful evidence: "Mother … the sunshine does not love you" (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4): Pearl's observation. On symbolism: Sunlight plays around Pearl but vanishes as Hester reaches for it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "Pearl set forth, at a great pace, and, as Hester smiled to perceive, did actually catch the sunshine, and stood laughing in the midst of it, all brightened by its splendor, and…", why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "XVI: A Forest Walk", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Hester waits in the forest for Dimmesdale. Sunlight flickers around Pearl but flees from Hester. Pearl asks about the Black Man; Hester says she met him once, and the letter is his mark. The brook babbles but tells no secrets.
7. How does "XVI: A Forest Walk" build on "XV: Hester and Pearl"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. Useful evidence: "Once in my life I met the Black Man … This scarlet letter is his mark" (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 22): Hester's answer. Theme link: the forest as a world outside Puritan

law. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. Useful evidence: “It runs away and hides itself, because it is afraid of something on your bosom” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4): Pearl on the sunshine. Theme link: the forest as a world outside Puritan law. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Is nature a place of freedom or danger?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does foreshadowing appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with hypocrisy and truth? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. Useful evidence: “Mother … the sunshine does not love you” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4): Pearl's observation. On foreshadowing: Pearl asks about the Black Man and whether Hester's letter is his mark. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is the forest good or evil in the novel? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. Useful evidence: “Once in my life I met the Black Man … This scarlet letter is his mark” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 22): Hester's answer. Theme link: the forest as a world outside Puritan law. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The forest offers freedom but Hester brings the letter's shadow into it.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. Useful evidence: “It runs away and hides itself, because it is afraid of something on your bosom” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4): Pearl on the sunshine. Theme link: the forest as a world outside Puritan law. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. Useful evidence: “Mother … the sunshine does not love you” (XVI: A Forest Walk,

paragraph 4): Pearl's observation. Theme link: the forest as a world outside Puritan law. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Rewrite one moment of "XVI: A Forest Walk" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the forest walk? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. Useful evidence: "Once in my life I met the Black Man … This scarlet letter is his mark" (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 22): Hester's answer. Theme link: the forest as a world outside Puritan law. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about "XVI: A Forest Walk": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. Useful evidence: "It runs away and hides itself, because it is afraid of something on your bosom" (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4): Pearl on the sunshine. Theme link: the forest as a world outside Puritan law. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to nature and the individual against society: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. Useful evidence: "Mother … the sunshine does not love you" (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4): Pearl's observation. Theme link: the forest as a world outside Puritan law. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the setting in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. Useful evidence: "Once in my life I met the Black Man … This scarlet letter is his mark" (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 22): Hester's answer. On setting: The forest path, dark and wild, with sunshine that flees from Hester. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how "XVI: A Forest Walk" treats the forest walk with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. Useful evidence: "It runs away and hides itself, because it is afraid of something on your bosom" (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4): Pearl on the sunshine. Theme link: the forest as a world outside Puritan law. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. Useful evidence: “Mother … the sunshine does not love you” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4): Pearl's observation. On foreshadowing: Pearl asks about the Black Man and whether Hester's letter is his mark. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the forest walk? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. Useful evidence: “Once in my life I met the Black Man … This scarlet letter is his mark” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 22): Hester's answer. Theme link: the forest as a world outside Puritan law. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who is the Black Man?
   A. A minister
   B. The devil of local legend
   C. Chillingworth's servant
   D. A sailor

   Key: B (The devil of local legend)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Hester call the letter?
   A. A gift
   B. Her shame alone
   C. The Black Man's mark
   D. An angel's sign

   Key: C (The Black Man's mark)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “She wanted—what some people want throughout life—a grief that should deeply touch her, and thus humanize and make her capable of sympathy.”, what does “humanize” most nearly mean?
   A. bordered or edged
   B. make more kind, gentle and human

C. lacking curiosity (here 'not incurious' means quite curious)

D. built or reinforced with heavy wooden beams

Key: B (make more kind, gentle and human)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What avoids Hester?

   A. Sunshine

   B. The brook

   C. Pearl

   D. Birds

   Key: A (Sunshine)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4: "It runs away and hides itself, because it is afraid of _____ on your bosom"

   Key: something

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4: "Mother … the _____ does not love you"

   Key: sunshine

7. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where is Dimmesdale coming from?

   Sample answer: A visit to the Apostle Eliot among the Native converts.

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "The sportive sunlight—feebly sportive, at best, in the predominant pensiveness of the day and scene—withdrew itself as they came nigh, and left the spots where it had danced the drearier, because they had hoped to find…", what does "pensiveness" most nearly mean?

   A. promising solemnly

   B. a poisonous plant

   C. restless turning movements

   D. deep, sad thoughtfulness

   Key: D (deep, sad thoughtfulness)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Pearl set forth, at a great pace, and, as Hester smiled to perceive, did actually catch the sunshine, and stood laughing in the midst of it, all brightened by its splendor, and scintillating with the vivacity excited by…", what does "scintillating" most nearly mean?

   A. sparkling

   B. the quality of being believable

   C. serving as an introduction to what follows

   D. a complete change of appearance

   Key: A (sparkling)

10. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "'O, a story about the Black Man,' answered Pearl, taking hold of her mother's gown, and looking up, half earnestly, half _____, into her face." Word bank: straggled, humanize, scintillating, mischievously

    Key: mischievously

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where does Hester wait?

    A. In the forest

    B. At home

C. By the scaffold

D. At church

Key: A (In the forest)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does the sunshine avoid Hester?
Sample answer: Something on her bosom, the letter, keeps it away. The evidence is “It runs away and hides itself, because it is afraid of something on your bosom” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4) — Pearl on the sunshine.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Mother … the sunshine does not love you” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: Pearl's observation. The evidence is “Mother … the sunshine does not love you” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4). This develops nature and the individual against society: the forest as a world outside Puritan law.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “XVI: A Forest Walk”? The forest path, dark and wild, with sunshine that flees from Hester.

A. Conflict

B. Structure

C. Setting

D. Simile

Key: C (Setting)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? The forest as a world outside Puritan law.

A. Hypocrisy and truth

B. Nature and the individual against society

C. Public shame and private identity

D. Sin and guilt

Key: B (Nature and the individual against society)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is the forest good or evil in the novel? Argue.
Sample answer: A reasoned view: Hester's answer. The evidence is “Once in my life I met the Black Man … This scarlet letter is his mark” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 22). This develops nature and the individual against society: the forest as a world outside Puritan law. Pearl says "the sunshine does not love you," and Hester tells her "This scarlet letter is his mark!".

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 3? “The road, after the two _____ had crossed from the peninsula to the mainland, was no other than a footpath.”

A. untransmitted

B. accord

C. wayfarers

D. mother

Key: C (wayfarers)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 6: “Will not it come of its own _____, when I am a woman grown?” Word bank: consequences, midnight, wayfarers,

accord

Key: accord

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the brook do?

    A. Freezes

    B. Babbles but tells no secret

    C. Dries up

    D. Floods

    Key: B (Babbles but tells no secret)

20. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 15: "Didst thou ever meet the Black Man, _____?" Word bank: certainly, ourselves, mother, consequences

    Key: mother

21. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 1: "Hester Prynne remained constant in her resolve to make known to Mr. Dimmesdale, at whatever risk of present pain or ulterior _____, the true character of the man who had crept into his intimacy." Word bank: flickering, thousand, consequences, afternoon

    Key: consequences

22. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 11 reveal about the character or situation? "But there was time enough yet for little Pearl." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 11) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: the forest as a world outside Puritan law. The words "enough" and "little" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

23. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in XVI: A Forest Walk?

    A. "There would have been no scandal, indeed, nor peril to the holy whiteness of the clergyman's good fame, had she visited him in his own study"

    B. "At last, while attending in a sick-chamber, whither the Reverend Mr. Dimmesdale had been summoned to make a prayer, she learnt that he had…"

    C. "Hester Prynne remained constant in her resolve to make known to Mr. Dimmesdale, at whatever risk of present pain or ulterior consequences,…"

    D. "For several days, however, she vainly sought an opportunity of addressing him in some of the meditative walks which she knew him to be in…"

    Key: C ("Hester Prynne remained constant in her resolve to make known to Mr. Dimmesdale, at whatever risk of present pain or ulterior consequences,…")

24. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 17 shapes its tone: "But she fancied me asleep while she was talking of it." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "talking" and "fancied" (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 17) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: the forest as a world outside Puritan law. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

25. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 2 shapes its tone: "At last, while attending in a sick-chamber, whither the

Reverend Mr. Dimmesdale had been summoned to make a prayer, she learnt that he had gone, the day before, to visit the Apostle Eliot, among his Indian converts." Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words "attending" and "summoned" (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 2) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: the forest as a world outside Puritan law. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how nature and the individual against society develops from XV: Hester and Pearl to XVI: A Forest Walk. Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: Earlier, in XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 4, the text reads "Yes, I hate him" — Hester's admission. In XVI: A Forest Walk, "Mother … the sunshine does not love you" (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4) — Pearl's observation. The forest as a world outside Puritan law.

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "It straggled onward into the mystery of the primeval forest.", what does "straggled" most nearly mean?

A. fully satisfying

B. carrying too heavy a load

C. strengthened; given new energy

D. wandered in a scattered, irregular way

Key: D (wandered in a scattered, irregular way)

28. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "XVI: A Forest Walk"?

A. Hester on the scaffold

B. The physician probes the minister

C. The minister's vigil

D. The forest walk

Key: D (The forest walk)

29. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 32 reveal about the character or situation? "But why does he not wear it outside his bosom, as thou dost, mother?" Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The passage (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 32) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: the forest as a world outside Puritan law. The words "outside" and "mother" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 35 shapes its tone: "When her elf-child had departed, Hester Prynne made a step or two towards the track that led through the forest, but still remained under the deep shadow of the trees." Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words "remained" and "departed" (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 35) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: the forest as a world outside Puritan law. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

31. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: "Mother … the sunshine does not love you" (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4).

Sample answer: Pearl says "the sunshine does not love you," and Hester tells her "This scarlet letter is his mark!". The

evidence is “Mother … the sunshine does not love you” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4) — Pearl's observation. This develops nature and the individual against society: the forest as a world outside Puritan law.

32. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Which literary element does this describe in “XVI: A Forest Walk”? Sunlight plays around Pearl but vanishes as Hester reaches for it.

    A. Characterization

    B. Plot

    C. Symbolism

    D. Metaphor

    Key: C (Symbolism)

33. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 23 shapes its tone: “Thus conversing, they entered sufficiently deep into the wood to secure themselves from the observation of any casual passenger along the forest track.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “sufficiently” and “observation” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 23) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: the forest as a world outside Puritan law. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

34. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 29 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: “But do not stray far into the wood.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 29) develops hypocrisy and truth: the forest as a world outside Puritan law. Its words its wording carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “But if it be the Black Man, wilt thou not let me stay a moment, and look at him, with his big book under his arm?” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 30), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

35. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Mother … the sunshine does not love you” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Pearl's observation. The evidence is “Mother … the sunshine does not love you” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4). This develops nature and the individual against society: the forest as a world outside Puritan law. The words “sunshine” and “does” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Pearl says "the sunshine does not love you," and Hester tells her "This scarlet letter is his mark!".

36. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 25 to the story's treatment of women and independence: “But the brook, in the course of its little lifetime among the forest-trees, had gone through so solemn an experience that it could not help talking about it, and seemed to have nothing else to say.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 25) develops women and independence: the forest as a world outside Puritan law. Its words “experience” and “lifetime” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “But, unlike the little stream, she danced and sparkled, and prattled airily along her course.” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 25), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Once in my life I met the Black Man … This scarlet letter is his mark” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 22) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Hester's answer. The evidence is “Once in my life I met the Black Man … This scarlet letter is his mark” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 22). This develops nature and the individual against society: the forest as a world outside Puritan law. The words “scarlet” and “letter” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Pearl says "the sunshine does not love you," and Hester tells her "This scarlet letter is his mark!".

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 3 to the story's treatment of women and independence: “This flitting cheerfulness was always at the farther extremity of some long vista through the forest.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
Sample answer: This passage (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 3) develops women and independence: the forest as a world outside Puritan law. Its words “cheerfulness” and “extremity” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “There it is, playing, a good way off.” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

39. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What can you infer from this line? “Once in my life I met the Black Man … This scarlet letter is his mark” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 22) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: Hester's answer. The evidence is “Once in my life I met the Black Man … This scarlet letter is his mark” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 22). This develops nature and the individual against society: the forest as a world outside Puritan law.

40. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] What does this passage most clearly show? “It runs away and hides itself, because it is afraid of something on your bosom” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4)
A. First description of the letter.
B. The letter's "new sense."
C. Pearl on the sunshine.
D. Hawthorne's definition of romance.
Key: C (Pearl on the sunshine.)

41. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Connect this passage from XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 7 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: “Run away, child,’ answered her mother, ‘and catch the sunshine!” Use one other moment from the story as well.
Sample answer: This passage (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 7) develops hypocrisy and truth: the forest as a world outside Puritan law. Its words “sunshine” and “answered” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Now I can stretch out my hand, and grasp some of it.” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 10), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

42. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Analyze the word choice in “It runs away and hides itself, because it is afraid of something on your bosom” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
Sample answer: Pearl on the sunshine. The evidence is “It runs away and hides itself, because it is afraid of something on your bosom” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4). This develops nature and the individual against society: the forest as a world outside Puritan law. The words “something” and “because” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 11, inference 2, analysis 2, synthesis 1

HS Freshman	17, 2, 18, 5, 8, 19, 20, 21, 13, 12, 22, 23, 24, 25, 15, 26	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	6, 20, 7, 27, 17, 11, 23, 22, 28, 12, 29, 24, 30, 31, 26, 16	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	18, 7, 10, 27, 20, 19, 12, 29, 23, 22, 32, 33, 30, 25, 34, 26	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	6, 19, 1, 8, 21, 23, 22, 12, 29, 15, 32, 33, 30, 26, 35, 34	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	10, 6, 27, 12, 22, 29, 23, 14, 15, 24, 33, 30, 36, 37, 26, 38	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	5, 17, 18, 39, 29, 22, 23, 14, 25, 24, 31, 15, 16, 36, 34, 26	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	10, 21, 29, 23, 40, 39, 24, 33, 32, 30, 15, 35, 36, 16, 41, 26	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	8, 10, 6, 11, 28, 42, 15, 30, 33, 24, 36, 37, 34, 41, 26, 16	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	11, 10, 6, 23, 15, 30, 32, 31, 25, 33, 41, 38, 16, 36, 34, 26	recall 3, inference 1, analysis 6, synthesis 6
Graduate / PhD	8, 10, 6, 40, 15, 24, 30, 14, 25, 16, 36, 26, 35, 38, 34, 41	recall 3, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 7

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "XVI: A Forest Walk," how does Hawthorne show the forest walk? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In XVI: A Forest Walk, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of the forest walk? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how XVI: A Forest Walk develops the idea of the forest walk. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and symbolism shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of XVI: A Forest Walk (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of the forest walk. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what XVI: A Forest Walk suggests about the forest walk. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence

for each (including the chapter's setting and symbolism), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses setting in XVI: A Forest Walk to complicate the reader's understanding of the forest walk. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate XVI: A Forest Walk within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the forest walk responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read XVI: A Forest Walk alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the forest walk follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to XVI: A Forest Walk and its treatment of the forest walk. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's setting and symbolism, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads XVI: A Forest Walk as evidence for a larger claim about the forest walk in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads XVI: A Forest Walk as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the forest walk. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

SAT-style questions

1. *Pearl set forth, at a great pace, and, as Hester smiled to perceive, did actually catch the sunshine, and stood laughing in the midst of it, all brightened by its splendor, and scintillating with the vivacity excited by rapid motion.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “scintillating” most nearly mean?

   A. deep, sad thoughtfulness

   B. make more kind, gentle and human

   C. sparkling

   D. playfully, in a teasing way

2. *Pearl set forth, at a great pace, and, as Hester smiled to perceive, did actually catch the sunshine, and stood laughing in the midst of it, all brightened by its splendor, and scintillating with the vivacity excited by rapid motion. The light lingered about the lonely child, as if glad of such a playmate, until her mother had drawn almost nigh enough to step into the magic circle too.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "XVI: A Forest Walk"?

A. The minister's vigil

B. An author answering his critics

C. Hester on the scaffold

D. The forest walk

SAT key: 1. C (sparkling); 2. D (The forest walk)

Lesson 20: XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner

Focus: the pastor and his parishioner

Objective: Students will analyze how conflict develops in “XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Critical voice: “The "Vicar of Wakefield" is sometimes coarsely virtuous, but "the Scarlet Letter" is delicately immoral.” (Arthur Cleveland Coxe, clergyman and critic, *"The Writings of Hawthorne," Church Review (January 1851), pp. 489-511 (excerpt), excerpt*; public domain). Seminar: "What we did had a consecration of its own." Does the novel endorse Hester's claim, as Coxe fears? *Objective:* Evaluate the moral argument of the forest scene. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.2, SL.11-12.1

Teacher only · spoilers

Hester and Dimmesdale meet like ghosts. He tells her of his torment; she reveals that Chillingworth is her husband. He is horrified, then forgives her, saying the old man's revenge is blacker than their sin. Hester urges him to flee with her to Europe and promises he will not go alone.

Background: Ships sailed regularly between Boston and Bristol; escape to Europe was realistic.

Significance: The lovers reframe their sin as less than revenge.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Is one sin worse than another? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to sin and guilt because....
Prompt: Is one sin worse than another?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to sin and guilt because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: a hierarchy of sins.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: satiating — fully satisfying; misanthropy — dislike or distrust of people; invigorated — strengthened; given new energy; dolefully — sadly; mournfully; contiguity — nearness; being next to. “misanthropy”: Origin: Ancient Greek μισανθρωπία. “dolefully”: Origin of “doleful”: an English formation from dole + -ful. “contiguity”: Origin: French contiguïté; earlier Late Latin contiguitās.
Words: satiating: fully satisfying · misanthropy: dislike or distrust of people · invigorated: strengthened; given new energy · dolefully: sadly; mournfully · contiguity: nearness; being next to

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Ships sailed regularly between Boston and Bristol; escape to Europe was realistic. The lovers reframe their sin as less than revenge. Conflict: Hester tells Dimmesdale that Chillingworth is her husband; he is horrified, then forgives her. Characterization: Dimmesdale's despair; Hester's strength: "Thou shalt not go alone!" Theme: They insist their sin was less than Chillingworth's: "What we did had a consecration of its own." Watch for the scarlet letter: The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: “Gathering himself quickly up, he stood more erect, like a man taken by surprise in a mood to which he was” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 4).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read “What we did had a consecration of its own. We felt it so! We said so to each other” slowly and put it in my own words: Hester tells Dimmesdale that what they did had a holiness of its own, which they both felt and said. Next, craft. I notice the religious word "consecration" used for the act the Puritans call sin. The strongest word is “consecration”: it means a making holy, so she defends their love in the town's own sacred language. Then, effect. What does Hester claim about her love for Dimmesdale? My answer: Hester claims that her love for Dimmesdale had a consecration of its own, which the Puritan verdict cannot cancel; her years of isolation have made her think for herself, which frightens and tempts him.

> *What we did had a consecration of its own. We felt it so! We said so to each other (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 32)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read “What we did had a consecration of its own. We felt it so! We said so to each other” slowly and put it in my own words: Hester tells Dimmesdale that what they did had a holiness of its own, which they both felt and said. Next, craft. I notice the religious word "consecration" used for the act the Puritans call sin. The strongest word is “consecration”: it means a making holy, so she defends their love in the town's own sacred language. Then, effect. What does Hester claim about her love for Dimmesdale? My answer: Hester claims that her love for Dimmesdale had a consecration of its own, which the Puritan verdict cannot cancel; her years of isolation have made her think for herself, which frightens and tempts him.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The lovers judge Chillingworth's sin worse than theirs. Expected link: theme; sin and guilt. Ask: How does this line connect to sin and guilt? Expected: A hierarchy of sins. (Dimmesdale's verdict.)

> *That old man's revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The lovers judge Chillingworth's sin worse than theirs. Expected link: theme; sin and guilt.
Ask: How does this line connect to sin and guilt?
Expected answer: A hierarchy of sins. (Dimmesdale's verdict.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for conflict, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the pastor and his parishioner? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner develops the idea of the pastor and his parishioner. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin. When the text says "That old man's revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart" (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31), it shows this directly. Dimmesdale calls Chillingworth's revenge "blacker than my sin" because it "violated … the sanctity of a human heart," and Hester insists "What we did had a consecration of its own."
Task: Annotate the chapter for conflict, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the pastor and his parishioner? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner develops the idea of the pastor and his parishioner. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin. When the text says "That old man's revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart" (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31), it shows this directly. Dimmesdale calls Chillingworth's revenge "blacker than my sin" because it "violated … the sanctity of a human heart," and Hester insists "What we did had a consecration of its own."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Is one sin worse than another? Ask: do you agree with Dimmesdale's ranking of sins? Is he being honest or making excuses?
Anchor question: Is one sin worse than another?
Facilitation: Ask: do you agree with Dimmesdale's ranking of sins? Is he being honest or making excuses?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the pastor and his parishioner? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin. ("That old man's revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart", XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the pastor and his parishioner? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin. ("That old man's revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart", XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how conflict shapes the pastor and his parishioner. Key takeaway: a hierarchy of sins.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Conflict:** Hester tells Dimmesdale that Chillingworth is her husband; he is horrified, then forgives her.
- **Characterization:** Dimmesdale's despair; Hester's strength: "Thou shalt not go alone!"
- **Theme:** They insist their sin was less than Chillingworth's: "What we did had a consecration of its own."

Themes and how they develop

- **sin and guilt:** a hierarchy of sins.

Symbols and motifs

- **the scarlet letter:** The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "Gathering himself quickly up, he stood more erect, like a man taken by surprise in a mood to which he was" (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 4).

- **light and darkness:** Sunshine avoids Hester but plays around Pearl; the forest is dim; the minister's vigil happens at midnight under a meteor. In this chapter: "he knew not whether it were a woman or a shadow. It may be, that his pathway through life was haunted thus" (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 4).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "What we did had a consecration of its own. We felt it so! We said so to each other" (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 32) Hester's defense.
- "That old man's revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart" (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31) Dimmesdale's verdict.
- "Thou shalt not go alone" (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 56) Hester's promise.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin.
Evidence: "That old man's revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart" (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31)
Reasoning: Dimmesdale calls Chillingworth's revenge "blacker than my sin" because it "violated ... the sanctity of a human heart," and Hester insists "What we did had a consecration of its own."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
satiating (verb)	fully satisfying	*He will doubtless seek other means of satiating his dark passion."*	
misanthropy (noun)	dislike or distrust of people	*There had been a period when Hester was less alive to this consideration; or, perhaps, in the misanthropy of her own trouble, she left the minister to bear what she might picture to herself as a more tolerable doom.*	"misanthropy": Origin: Ancient Greek μισανθρωπία. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/misanthropy#Etymology)
invigorated (verb)	strengthened; given new energy	*But of late, since the night of his vigil, all her sympathies towards him had been both softened and invigorated.*	
dolefully (adverb)	sadly; mournfully	*The boughs were tossing heavily above their heads; while one solemn old tree groaned dolefully to another, as if telling the sad story of the pair that sat beneath, or constrained to forebode evil to come.*	"dolefully": Origin of "doleful": an English formation from dole + -ful. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/doleful#Etymology)
contiguity (noun)	nearness; being next to	*The very contiguity of his enemy, beneath whatever mask the latter might conceal himself, was enough to disturb*	"contiguity": Origin: French contiguïté; earlier Late Latin contiguitās. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://

		the magnetic sphere of a being so sensitive as Arthur Dimmesdale.	en.wiktionary.org/wiki/contiguity#Etymology)
indelicacy (noun)	lack of modesty or tact	*And the shame!—the indelicacy!—the horrible ugliness of this exposure of a sick and guilty heart to the very eye that would gloat over it!*	

Discussion questions

1. Is one sin worse than another?
2. Where does conflict appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with nature and the individual against society?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Hester say their act had? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A consecration of its own.
2. What does Hester reveal? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Chillingworth is her husband
3. How does Dimmesdale react first? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: With horror and anger
4. Whose sin does Dimmesdale call blacker? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Chillingworth's
5. What does Hester suggest? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Fleeing to Europe
6. What does Hester promise? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He shall not go alone
7. Retell the three most important events of "XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Hester and Dimmesdale meet like ghosts. He tells her of his torment; she reveals that Chillingworth is her husband. He is horrified, then forgives her, saying the old man's revenge is blacker than their sin. Hester urges him to flee with her to Europe and promises he will not go alone.
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.

10. Reread: “He will doubtless seek other means of satiating his dark passion.”” What does “satiating” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: satiating: fully satisfying.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Dimmesdale say he cannot flee alone? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: He lacks the strength.
2. What does “XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner” suggest about the pastor and his parishioner? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The lovers reframe their sin as less than revenge.
3. Find one example of conflict in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
4. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about the pastor and his parishioner? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin. Useful evidence: “What we did had a consecration of its own. We felt it so! We said so to each other” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 32): Hester's defense. On characterization: Dimmesdale's despair; Hester's strength: "Thou shalt not go alone!" Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins ““I might have known it,””, why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Hester and Dimmesdale meet like ghosts. He tells her of his torment; she reveals that Chillingworth is her husband. He is horrified, then forgives her, saying the old man's revenge is blacker than their sin. Hester urges him to flee with her to Europe and promises he will not go alone.
7. How does “XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner” build on “XVI: A Forest Walk”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin. Useful evidence: “That old man’s revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31): Dimmesdale's verdict. Theme link: a hierarchy of sins. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin. Useful evidence: “Thou shalt not go alone” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 56): Hester's promise. On characterization: Dimmesdale's despair; Hester's strength: "Thou shalt not go alone!" Credit

any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “Is one sin worse than another?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with nature and the individual against society? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin. Useful evidence: “What we did had a consecration of its own. We felt it so! We said so to each other” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 32): Hester's defense. On theme: They insist their sin was less than Chillingworth's: "What we did had a consecration of its own." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Do you agree with Dimmesdale's ranking of sins? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin. Useful evidence: “That old man’s revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31): Dimmesdale's verdict. On theme: They insist their sin was less than Chillingworth's: "What we did had a consecration of its own." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The lovers reframe their sin as less than revenge.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin. Useful evidence: “Thou shalt not go alone” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 56): Hester's promise. On theme: They insist their sin was less than Chillingworth's: "What we did had a consecration of its own." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin. Useful evidence: “What we did had a consecration of its own. We felt it so! We said so to each other” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 32): Hester's defense. On characterization: Dimmesdale's despair; Hester's strength: "Thou shalt not go alone!" Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Rewrite one moment of “XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the pastor and his parishioner? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin.

Useful evidence: “That old man’s revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31): Dimmesdale's verdict. Theme link: a hierarchy of sins. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin. Useful evidence: “Thou shalt not go alone” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 56): Hester's promise. On theme: They insist their sin was less than Chillingworth's: "What we did had a consecration of its own." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to women and independence: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin. Useful evidence: “What we did had a consecration of its own. We felt it so! We said so to each other” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 32): Hester's defense. On theme: They insist their sin was less than Chillingworth's: "What we did had a consecration of its own." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the conflict in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin. Useful evidence: “That old man’s revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31): Dimmesdale's verdict. On conflict: Hester tells Dimmesdale that Chillingworth is her husband; he is horrified, then forgives her. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner” treats the pastor and his parishioner with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin. Useful evidence: “Thou shalt not go alone” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 56): Hester's promise. On theme: They insist their sin was less than Chillingworth's: "What we did had a consecration of its own." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin. Useful evidence: “What we did had a consecration of its own. We felt it so! We said so to each other” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 32): Hester's defense. Theme link: a hierarchy of sins.

Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the pastor and his parishioner? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin. Useful evidence: “That old man’s revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31): Dimmesdale's verdict. On theme: They insist their sin was less than Chillingworth's: "What we did had a consecration of its own." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Conflict:** look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “There had been a period when Hester was less alive to this consideration; or, perhaps, in the misanthropy of her own trouble, she left the minister to bear what she might picture to herself as a more tolerable doom.”, what does “misanthropy” most nearly mean?

    A. close, focused attention

    B. dislike or distrust of people

    C. lack of clarity; blurriness

    D. harmful

    Key: B (dislike or distrust of people)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Hester reveal?

    A. Chillingworth is her husband

    B. She is leaving

    C. Pearl is ill

    D. She will confess

    Key: A (Chillingworth is her husband)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “He will doubtless seek other means of satiating his dark passion.”, what does “satiating” most nearly mean?

    A. a feeling of awe and dread

    B. a member of a minister's congregation

    C. the system of coats of arms

    D. fully satisfying

    Key: D (fully satisfying)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 32: “What we did had a _____ of its own. We felt it so! We said so to each other”
   Key: consecration
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Hester promise?
   A. He shall not go alone
   B. She will pray
   C. She will remarry
   D. She will stay

   Key: A (He shall not go alone)
6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “And the shame!—the _____!—the horrible ugliness of this exposure of a sick and guilty heart to the very eye that would gloat over it!” Word bank: invigorated, misanthropy, indelicacy, satiating
   Key: indelicacy
7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “The very _____ of his enemy, beneath whatever mask the latter might conceal himself, was enough to disturb the magnetic sphere of a being so sensitive as Arthur Dimmesdale.” Word bank: invigorated, satiating, misanthropy, contiguity
   Key: contiguity
8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “The boughs were tossing heavily above their heads; while one solemn old tree groaned dolefully to another, as if telling the sad story of the pair that sat beneath, or constrained to forebode evil to come.”, what does “dolefully” most nearly mean?
   A. examining one's own thoughts and feelings
   B. approaching and speaking to (someone)
   C. make more kind, gentle and human
   D. sadly; mournfully

   Key: D (sadly; mournfully)
9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whose sin does Dimmesdale call blacker?
   A. The town's
   B. Chillingworth's
   C. Hester's
   D. His own

   Key: B (Chillingworth's)
10. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Hester say their act had?
    Sample answer: A consecration of its own.
11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “But of late, since the night of his vigil, all her sympathies towards him had been both softened and invigorated.”, what does “invigorated” most nearly mean?
    A. devilish
    B. publish again
    C. strengthened; given new energy
    D. untidy mixture or confusion

Key: C (strengthened; given new energy)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “What we did had a consecration of its own. We felt it so! We said so to each other” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 32) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Hester's defense. The evidence is “What we did had a consecration of its own. We felt it so! We said so to each other” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 32).
13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Dimmesdale say he cannot flee alone?
    Sample answer: He lacks the strength: Dimmesdale's verdict. The evidence is “That old man’s revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31).
14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “Thou shalt not go alone” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 56). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Hester's promise. The evidence is “Thou shalt not go alone” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 56). This develops sin and guilt: a hierarchy of sins. The words “alone” and “shalt” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.
15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner”? Hester tells Dimmesdale that Chillingworth is her husband; he is horrified, then forgives her.
    A. Diction / vocabulary
    B. Alliteration
    C. Metaphor
    D. Conflict

    Key: D (Conflict)
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Do you agree with Dimmesdale's ranking of sins? Argue.
    Sample answer: A reasoned view: Dimmesdale's verdict. The evidence is “That old man’s revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31). This develops sin and guilt: a hierarchy of sins. Dimmesdale calls Chillingworth's revenge "blacker than my sin" because it "violated ... the sanctity of a human heart," and Hester insists "What we did had a consecration of its own.".
17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Hester suggest?
    A. Fleeing to Europe
    B. Confessing
    C. Killing Chillingworth
    D. Going to the governor

    Key: A (Fleeing to Europe)
18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Dimmesdale react first?
    A. With laughter
    B. With horror and anger
    C. With silence
    D. With joy

    Key: B (With horror and anger)
19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “That old man’s revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart” (XVII:

The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Dimmesdale's verdict. The evidence is “That old man’s revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31).

20. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? A hierarchy of sins.

    A. Sin and guilt

    B. Public shame and private identity

    C. Nature and the individual against society

    D. Hypocrisy and truth

    Key: A (Sin and guilt)

21. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how sin and guilt develops from XIV: Hester and the Physician to XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Earlier, in XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 8, the text reads “old Roger Chillingworth was a striking evidence of man’s faculty of transforming himself into a devil, if he will only, for a reasonable…” — The narrator's judgment. In XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, “What we did had a consecration of its own. We felt it so! We said so to each other” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 32) — Hester's defense. A hierarchy of sins.

22. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 16? “I have laughed, in _____ and agony of heart, at the contrast between what I seem and what I am!”

    A. tremulously

    B. penitence

    C. bitterness

    D. consciousness

    Key: C (bitterness)

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 8? “It was with fear, and _____, and, as it were, by a slow, reluctant necessity, that Arthur Dimmesdale put forth his hand, chill as death, and touched the chill hand of Hester Prynne.”

    A. leading

    B. intermixed

    C. tremulously

    D. threaten

    Key: C (tremulously)

24. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 18: “Had I one friend—or were it my worst enemy!—to whom, when _____ with the praises of all other men, I could daily betake myself, and be known as the vilest of all sinners, methinks my soul might keep itself alive thereby.” Word bank: thoughts, clutching, penitence, sickened

    Key: sickened

25. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 4 reveal about the character or situation? “Gathering himself quickly up, he stood more erect, like a man taken by surprise in a mood to which he was reluctant to have witnesses.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The passage (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 4) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: a hierarchy of sins. The words "reluctant" and "witnesses" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

26. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 26 reveal about the character or situation? "Never was there a blacker or a fiercer frown than Hester now encountered." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The passage (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 26) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: a hierarchy of sins. The words "encountered" and "fiercer" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 14 shapes its tone: "Were I an atheist—a man devoid of conscience—a wretch with coarse and brutal instincts—I might have found peace, long ere now." Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words "conscience" and "instincts" (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 14) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: a hierarchy of sins. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 17 to the story's treatment of women and independence: "Your present life is not less holy, in very truth, than it seems in people's eyes." Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 17) develops women and independence: a hierarchy of sins. Its words "present" and "people" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Else, I should long ago have thrown off these garments of mock holiness, and have shown myself to mankind as they will…" (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 18), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 47 to the story's treatment of women and independence: "Is there not shade enough in all this boundless forest to hide thy heart from the gaze of Roger Chillingworth?" Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 47) develops women and independence: a hierarchy of sins. Its words "boundless" and "enough" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "And what hast thou to do with all these iron men, and their opinions?" (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 49), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

30. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 1: "Slowly as the minister walked, he had almost gone by, before Hester Prynne could gather voice enough to attract his _____." Word bank: originally, unexpressed, observation, purification
    Key: observation

31. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 8 shapes its tone: "The grasp, cold as it was, took away what was dreariest in the interview." Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words "interview" and "dreariest" (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 8) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: a hierarchy of sins. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

32. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 35 shapes its tone: “Here, seen only by her eyes, Arthur Dimmesdale, false to God and man, might be, for one moment, true!” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “moment” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 35) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: a hierarchy of sins. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “That old man’s revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31) supports it: Dimmesdale calls Chillingworth's revenge "blacker than my sin" because it "violated ... the sanctity of a human heart," and Hester insists "What we did had a consecration of its own.". But “Thou shalt not go alone” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 56) complicates it: the line (Hester's promise) shows the same issue from another side, and its “not” marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. So the claim stands only in a qualified form: true of the chapter's main pattern, but not of every moment in it.

34. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 26? “The minister looked at her, for an instant, with all that violence of passion, which—_____, in more shapes than one, with his higher, purer, softer qualities—was, in fact, the portion of him which the Devil claimed, and through which he sought to win the rest.”

    A. unexpressed

    B. intermixed

    C. consciousness

    D. scarlet

    Key: B (intermixed)

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Which literary element does this describe in “XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner”? Dimmesdale's despair; Hester's strength: ‘Thou shalt not go alone!’

    A. Irony

    B. Characterization

    C. Diction / vocabulary

    D. Symbolism

    Key: B (Characterization)

36. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 19 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: “Yet, uttering his long-restrained emotions so vehemently as he did, his words here offered her the very point of circumstances in which to interpose what she came to say.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 19) develops hypocrisy and truth: a hierarchy of sins. Its words “circumstances” and “vehemently” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Truth was the one virtue which I might have held fast, and did hold fast, through all extremity; save when thy good—thy…” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 25), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 29 shapes its tone: “Hester would not set him free, lest he should look her sternly in the face.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “sternly” and “should” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 29) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: a hierarchy of sins. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.
38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 51 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: “It shall not cumber thy steps, as thou treadest along the forest-path; neither shalt thou freight the ship with it, if thou prefer to cross the sea.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 51) develops hypocrisy and truth: a hierarchy of sins. Its words “treadest” and “neither” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Or—as is more thy nature—be a scholar and a sage among the wisest and the most renowned of the cultivated world.” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 51), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.
39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “What we did had a consecration of its own. We felt it so! We said so to each other” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 32) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Hester's defense. The evidence is “What we did had a consecration of its own. We felt it so! We said so to each other” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 32). This develops sin and guilt: a hierarchy of sins. The words “consecration” and “other” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Dimmesdale calls Chillingworth's revenge "blacker than my sin" because it "violated ... the sanctity of a human heart," and Hester insists "What we did had a consecration of its own.".

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 11, inference 2, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	3, 11, 17, 18, 1, 6, 2, 4, 10, 12, 19, 13, 15, 20, 14, 21	recall 9, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	22, 7, 8, 23, 24, 3, 11, 10, 13, 25, 26, 15, 27, 20, 28, 29	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	30, 9, 4, 11, 22, 23, 24, 26, 25, 13, 20, 14, 31, 32, 21, 33	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	30, 3, 6, 34, 22, 12, 25, 26, 13, 20, 14, 27, 35, 33, 36, 28	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	23, 3, 18, 7, 6, 13, 26, 37, 31, 32, 14, 15, 21, 33, 38, 36	recall 5, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	11, 9, 4, 7, 2, 18, 27, 14, 32, 37, 31, 21, 16, 29, 38, 28	recall 6, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	18, 34, 7, 6, 2, 37, 35, 14, 31, 32, 39, 29, 36, 28, 16, 33	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Junior	7, 17, 6, 2, 18, 27, 20, 14, 37, 31, 38, 16, 33, 29, 28, 36	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	30, 7, 2, 18, 9, 14, 31, 27, 15, 16, 29, 39, 21, 36, 28, 38	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 4, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	30, 7, 2, 18, 37, 20, 35, 14, 39, 33, 38, 36, 29, 21, 28, 16	recall 4, inference 0, analysis 4, synthesis 8

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner,” how does Hawthorne show the pastor and his parishioner? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the conflict you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of the pastor and his parishioner? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the conflict in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner develops the idea of the pastor and his parishioner. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner (where it begins, turns and ends) and its conflict shape the reader's understanding of the pastor and his parishioner. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner suggests about the pastor and his parishioner. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's conflict and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses conflict in XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner to complicate the reader's understanding of the pastor and his parishioner. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the pastor and his parishioner responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the pastor and his parishioner follows or bends those conventions, using the conflict as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner and its treatment of the pastor and his parishioner. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's conflict and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner as evidence for a larger claim about the pastor and his parishioner in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the pastor and his parishioner. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

SAT-style questions

1. *But of late, since the night of his vigil, all her sympathies towards him had been both softened and invigorated.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "invigorated" most nearly mean?

   A. sadly; mournfully

   B. lack of modesty or tact

   C. nearness; being next to

   D. strengthened; given new energy

2. *"I might have known it," murmured he. "I did know it! Was not the secret told me, in the natural recoil of my heart, at the first sight of him, and as often as I have seen him since? Why did I not understand? O Hester Prynne, thou little, little knowest all the horror of this thing! And the shame!—the indelicacy!—the horrible ugliness of this exposure of a sick and guilty heart to the very eye that would gloat over it! Woman, woman, thou art accountable for this! I cannot forgive thee!"*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner"?

   A. The revelation

   B. The minister in a maze

   C. The pastor and his parishioner

   D. Pearl

SAT key: 1. D (strengthened; given new energy); 2. C (The pastor and his parishioner)

Lesson 21: XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine

Focus: a flood of sunshine

Objective: Students will analyze how symbolism develops in "XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

Dimmesdale decides to flee. Hester unfastens the letter and throws it toward the brook, lets down her hair, and sunshine floods the forest. The narrator warns that she has wandered in a moral wilderness. Hester calls Pearl to meet her father.

Background: Hawthorne had lived at Brook Farm, a utopian community, and knew Transcendentalist celebrations of nature.

Significance: Freedom in the forest is beautiful but the narrator doubts it.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Can you leave your past behind? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to nature and the individual against society because....
Prompt: Can you leave your past behind?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to nature and the individual against society because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: nature responds to their happiness.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: transmuting — changing into something else; clucked — made the clicking sound a hen makes; gladdening — making glad; effluence — something that flows out; outlawed — shut out from society and its protection. "transmuting": Origin of "transmute": Latin trānsmūtāre. "effluence": Origin: French effluence; earlier Latin effluentia.
Words: transmuting: changing into something else · clucked: made the clicking sound a hen makes · gladdening: making glad · effluence: something that flows out · outlawed: shut out from society and its protection

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Hawthorne had lived at Brook Farm, a utopian community, and knew Transcendentalist celebrations of nature. Freedom in the forest is beautiful but the narrator doubts it. Symbolism: Hester throws away the letter and lets down her hair; sunshine floods the forest. Imagery: "A flood of sunshine" bursts through the trees. Characterization: Hester's radical freedom: "The tendency of her fate and fortunes had been to set her free." Watch for the scarlet letter: The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "Arthur Dimmesdale gazed into Hester's face with a look in which hope and joy shone out, indeed, but with" (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 1).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "she undid the clasp that fastened the scarlet letter, and, taking it from her bosom, threw it to a distance among the withered leaves" slowly and put it in my own words: Hester unfastens the scarlet letter and throws it away among the dead leaves. Next, craft. I notice the careful steps of undoing the clasp, then a sudden throw, like shedding a weight. The strongest word is "withered": the dead leaves suggest the letter belongs with what is past and dying. Then, effect. What does Hester's act in the forest mean? My answer: In the forest, outside the town's law, Hester frees herself for a moment; the sunshine that follows shows how much the letter had darkened her life.

> *she undid the clasp that fastened the scarlet letter, and, taking it from her bosom, threw it to a distance among the withered leaves (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 11)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "she undid the clasp that fastened the scarlet letter, and, taking it from her bosom, threw it to a distance among the withered leaves" slowly and put it in my own words: Hester unfastens the scarlet letter and throws it away among the dead leaves. Next, craft. I notice the careful steps of undoing the clasp, then a sudden throw, like shedding a weight. The strongest word is "withered": the dead leaves suggest the letter belongs with what is past and dying. Then, effect. What does Hester's act in the forest mean? My answer: In the forest, outside the town's law, Hester frees herself for a moment; the sunshine that follows shows how much the letter had darkened her life.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Nature, "never subjugated by human law," celebrates them. Expected link: setting; nature and society. Ask: How does this line connect to nature and the individual against society? Expected: Nature responds to their happiness. (Nature's response.)

> *Such was the sympathy of Nature—that wild, heathen Nature of the forest, never subjugated by human law, nor illumined by higher truth—with the bliss of these two spirits (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 13)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Nature, "never subjugated by human law," celebrates them. Expected link: setting; nature and society.
Ask: How does this line connect to nature and the individual against society?
Expected answer: Nature responds to their happiness. (Nature's response.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for symbolism, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about a flood of sunshine? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine develops the idea of a flood of sunshine. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom. When the text says "Such was the sympathy of Nature—that wild, heathen Nature of the forest, never subjugated by human law, nor illumined by higher truth—with the bliss of these two spirits" (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 13), it shows this directly. Nature shows "sympathy" with "these two spirits," yet Hester has "wandered, without rule or guidance, in a moral wilderness."

Task: Annotate the chapter for symbolism, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about a flood of sunshine? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine develops the idea of a flood of sunshine. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom. When the text says “Such was the sympathy of Nature—that wild, heathen Nature of the forest, never subjugated by human law, nor illumined by higher truth—with the bliss of these two spirits” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 13), it shows this directly. Nature shows "sympathy" with "these two spirits," yet Hester has "wandered, without rule or guidance, in a moral wilderness."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Can you leave your past behind? Ask: is the narrator celebrating or warning? Find words that point each way.

Anchor question: Can you leave your past behind?

Facilitation: Ask: is the narrator celebrating or warning? Find words that point each way.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about a flood of sunshine? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom. ("Such was the sympathy of Nature—that wild, heathen Nature of the forest, never subjugated by human law, nor illumined by higher truth—with the bliss of these tw", XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 13). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about a flood of sunshine? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom. ("Such was the sympathy of Nature—that wild, heathen Nature of the forest, never subjugated by human law, nor illumined by higher truth—with the bliss of these tw", XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 13). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how symbolism shapes a flood of sunshine. Key takeaway: nature responds to their happiness.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Symbolism:** Hester throws away the letter and lets down her hair; sunshine floods the forest.
- **Imagery:** "A flood of sunshine" bursts through the trees.
- **Characterization:** Hester's radical freedom: "The tendency of her fate and fortunes had been to set her free."

Themes and how they develop

- **nature and the individual against society:** nature responds to their happiness.

Symbols and motifs

- **the scarlet letter:** The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "Arthur Dimmesdale gazed into Hester's face with a look in which hope and joy shone out, indeed, but with" (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 1).
- **light and darkness:** Sunshine avoids Hester but plays around Pearl; the forest is dim; the minister's vigil happens at midnight under a meteor. In this chapter: "as intricate and shadowy, as the untamed forest, amid the gloom of which they were now holding a colloquy that was to" (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 2).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "she undid the clasp that fastened the scarlet letter, and, taking it from her bosom, threw it to a distance among the withered leaves" (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 11) Hester casts off the letter.
- "Such was the sympathy of Nature—that wild, heathen Nature of the forest, never subjugated by human law, nor illumined by higher truth—with the bliss of these two spirits" (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 13) Nature's response.
- "The tendency of her fate and fortunes had been to set her free" (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 2) Hester's freedom.
- "She had wandered, without rule or guidance, in a moral wilderness" (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 2) The narrator's qualification.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom.
Evidence: "Such was the sympathy of Nature—that wild, heathen Nature of the forest, never subjugated by human law, nor illumined by higher truth—with the bliss of these two spirits" (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 13)
Reasoning: Nature shows "sympathy" with "these two spirits," yet Hester has "wandered, without rule or guidance, in a moral wilderness."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
transmuting (verb)	changing into something else	*All at once, as with a sudden smile of heaven, forth burst the sunshine, pouring a very flood into the obscure forest, gladdening each green leaf, transmuting the yellow fallen ones to gold, and gleaming adown the gray trunks of the solemn trees.*	"transmuting": Origin of "transmute": Latin trānsmūtāre. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/transmute#Etymology)
clucked (verb)	made the clicking sound a hen makes	*A partridge, indeed, with a brood of ten behind her, ran forward threateningly, but soon repented of her fierceness, and clucked to her young ones not to be afraid.*	
gladdening (verb)	making glad	*All at once, as with a sudden smile of heaven, forth burst the sunshine, pouring a very flood into the obscure forest, gladdening each green leaf, transmuting the yellow fallen ones to gold, and gleaming adown the gray trunks of the solemn trees.*	
effluence (noun)	something that flows out	*And, as if the gloom of the earth and sky had been but the effluence of these two mortal hearts, it vanished with their sorrow.*	"effluence": Origin: French effluence; earlier Latin effluentia. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/effluence#Etymology)

outlawed (verb)	shut out from society and its protection	*But Hester Prynne, with a mind of native courage and activity, and for so long a period not merely estranged, but outlawed, from society, had habituated herself to such latitude of speculation as was altogether foreign to the clergyman.*	
margined (adjective)	bordered or edged	*And she was gentler here than in the grassy-margined streets of the settlement, or in her mother's cottage.*	
unhealed (adjective)	not yet healed	*As a man who had once sinned, but who kept his conscience all alive and painfully sensitive by the fretting of an unhealed wound, he might have been supposed safer within the line of virtue than if he had never sinned at all.*	
unredeemed (adjective)	not saved from sin	*It was the exhilarating effect—upon a prisoner just escaped from the dungeon of his own heart—of breathing the wild, free atmosphere of an unredeemed, unchristianized, lawless region.*	

Discussion questions

1. Can you leave your past behind?
2. Where does symbolism appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with women and independence?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Where does the letter land? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: On the edge of the brook.
2. What does Hester throw away? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The scarlet letter
3. What happens when she does? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Sunshine floods the forest

4. What does Hester do with her hair? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Lets it down
5. What does Dimmesdale decide? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: To flee
6. Whom does Hester call? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Pearl
7. Retell the three most important events of "XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Dimmesdale decides to flee. Hester unfastens the letter and throws it toward the brook, lets down her hair, and sunshine floods the forest. The narrator warns that she has wandered in a moral wilderness. Hester calls Pearl to meet her father.
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: "All at once, as with a sudden smile of heaven, forth burst the sunshine, pouring a very flood into the obscure forest, gladdening each green leaf, transmuting the yellow fallen ones to gold, and gleaming adown the gray…" What does "transmuting" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: transmuting: changing into something else.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does nature 'sympathize' with them? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: The forest is outside human law.
2. What does "XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine" suggest about a flood of sunshine? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Freedom in the forest is beautiful but the narrator doubts it.
3. Find one example of symbolism in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.
4. How does the imagery in this chapter shape what we understand about a flood of sunshine? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom. Useful evidence: "she undid the clasp that fastened the scarlet letter, and, taking it from her bosom, threw it to a distance among the withered leaves" (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 11): Hester casts off the letter. On imagery: "A flood of sunshine" bursts through the trees. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "The decision once made, a glow of strange enjoyment threw its flickering brightness over the trouble of his breast.", why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

6. What causes the main turn in “XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Dimmesdale decides to flee. Hester unfastens the letter and throws it toward the brook, lets down her hair, and sunshine floods the forest. The narrator warns that she has wandered in a moral wilderness. Hester calls Pearl to meet her father.
7. How does “XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine” build on “XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom. Useful evidence: “Such was the sympathy of Nature—that wild, heathen Nature of the forest, never subjugated by human law, nor illumined by higher truth—with the bliss of these two spirits” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 13): Nature's response. Theme link: nature responds to their happiness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom. Useful evidence: “The tendency of her fate and fortunes had been to set her free” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 2): Hester's freedom. On characterization: Hester's radical freedom: "The tendency of her fate and fortunes had been to set her free." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Can you leave your past behind?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with women and independence? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom. Useful evidence: “She had wandered, without rule or guidance, in a moral wilderness” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 2): The narrator's qualification. On characterization: Hester's radical freedom: "The tendency of her fate and fortunes had been to set her free." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is the narrator celebrating or warning? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom. Useful evidence: “she undid the clasp that fastened the scarlet letter, and, taking it from her bosom, threw it to a distance among the withered leaves” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 11): Hester casts off the letter. Theme link: nature responds to their happiness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Freedom in the forest is beautiful but the narrator doubts it.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1,

RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom. Useful evidence: “Such was the sympathy of Nature—that wild, heathen Nature of the forest, never subjugated by human law, nor illumined by higher truth—with the bliss of these two spirits” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 13): Nature's response. Theme link: nature responds to their happiness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom. Useful evidence: “The tendency of her fate and fortunes had been to set her free” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 2): Hester's freedom. On characterization: Hester's radical freedom: "The tendency of her fate and fortunes had been to set her free." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Rewrite one moment of “XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about a flood of sunshine? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom. Useful evidence: “She had wandered, without rule or guidance, in a moral wilderness” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 2): The narrator's qualification. Theme link: nature responds to their happiness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom. Useful evidence: “she undid the clasp that fastened the scarlet letter, and, taking it from her bosom, threw it to a distance among the withered leaves” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 11): Hester casts off the letter. Theme link: nature responds to their happiness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to sin and guilt: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom. Useful evidence: “Such was the sympathy of Nature—that wild, heathen Nature of the forest, never subjugated by human law, nor illumined by higher truth—with the bliss of these two spirits” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 13): Nature's response. Theme link: nature responds to their happiness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the symbolism in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom. Useful evidence: “The tendency of her fate and fortunes had been to set her free” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 2): Hester's freedom. On symbolism: Hester throws away the letter and lets down her hair; sunshine floods the forest. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine” treats a flood of sunshine with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom. Useful evidence: “She had wandered, without rule or guidance, in a moral wilderness” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 2): The narrator's qualification. Theme link: nature responds to their happiness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom. Useful evidence: “she undid the clasp that fastened the scarlet letter, and, taking it from her bosom, threw it to a distance among the withered leaves” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 11): Hester casts off the letter. Theme link: nature responds to their happiness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about a flood of sunshine? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom. Useful evidence: “Such was the sympathy of Nature—that wild, heathen Nature of the forest, never subjugated by human law, nor illumined by higher truth—with the bliss of these two spirits” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 13): Nature's response. Theme link: nature responds to their happiness. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Symbolism:** look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “And she was gentler here than in the grassy-_____ streets of the settlement, or in her mother’s cottage.” Word bank: clucked, gladdening, transmuting, margined
   Key: margined

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What happens when she does?

   A. A storm begins

   B. It rains

   C. Sunshine floods the forest

   D. Night falls

   Key: C (Sunshine floods the forest)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 1: "Arthur Dimmesdale gazed into Hester's face with a look in which hope and joy shone out, indeed, but with fear betwixt them, and a kind of horror at her _____, who had spoken what he vaguely hinted at, but dared not speak." Word bank: boldness, alighted, clergyman, regulations

   Key: boldness

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 13: "Such was the sympathy of Nature—that wild, heathen Nature of the forest, never _____ by human law, nor illumined by higher truth—with the bliss of these two spirits"

   Key: subjugated

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 2: "She had wandered, without rule or guidance, in a moral _____"

   Key: wilderness

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Hester do with her hair?

   A. Lets it down

   B. Cuts it

   C. Covers it

   D. Braids it

   Key: A (Lets it down)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whom does Hester call?

   A. Wilson

   B. Pearl

   C. Chillingworth

   D. Mistress Hibbins

   Key: B (Pearl)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 11? "But there lay the embroidered letter, glittering like a lost jewel, which some ill-fated wanderer might pick up, and thenceforth be haunted by strange phantoms of guilt, sinkings of the heart, and _____ misfortune."

   A. unaccountable

   B. temperament

   C. regulations

   D. preparation

   Key: A (unaccountable)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “And, as if the gloom of the earth and sky had been but the effluence of these two mortal hearts, it vanished with their sorrow.”, what does “effluence” most nearly mean?

    A. something that flows out

    B. prying and suspicious, like an investigator

    C. taking in, as if drinking

    D. predict or sense (something) in advance

    Key: A (something that flows out)

10. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “But Hester Prynne, with a mind of native courage and activity, and for so long a period not merely estranged, but _____, from society, had habituated herself to such latitude of speculation as was altogether foreign to the clergyman.” Word bank: transmuting, clucked, outlawed, gladdening

    Key: outlawed

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does nature 'sympathize' with them?

    Sample answer: The forest is outside human law. The evidence is “Such was the sympathy of Nature—that wild, heathen Nature of the forest, never subjugated by human law, nor illumined by higher truth—with…” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 13) — Nature's response.

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 2 reveal about the character or situation? “Her intellect and heart had their home, as it were, in desert places, where she roamed as freely as the wild Indian in his woods.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 2) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: nature responds to their happiness. The words “intellect” and “roamed” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 12 reveal about the character or situation? “The stigma gone, Hester heaved a long, deep sigh, in which the burden of shame and anguish departed from her spirit.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 12) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: nature responds to their happiness. The words “departed” and “anguish” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Nature responds to their happiness.

    A. Hypocrisy and truth

    B. Public shame and private identity

    C. Sin and guilt

    D. Nature and the individual against society

    Key: D (Nature and the individual against society)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 12 shapes its tone: “The objects that had made a shadow hitherto, embodied the brightness now.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “brightness” and “hitherto” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 12) make the tone heavy and

deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: nature responds to their happiness. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 20 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: “It offered her the partridgeberries, the growth of the preceding autumn, but ripening only in the spring, and now red as drops of blood upon the withered leaves.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 20) develops hypocrisy and truth: nature responds to their happiness. Its words “partridgeberries” and “preceding” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “The small denizens of the wilderness hardly took pains to move out of her path.” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 20), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “A partridge, indeed, with a brood of ten behind her, ran forward threateningly, but soon repented of her fierceness, and clucked to her young ones not to be afraid.”, what does “clucked” most nearly mean?
    A. mockingly
    B. belonging to a small, inner circle
    C. someone who collects (here, herbs)
    D. made the clicking sound a hen makes

    Key: D (made the clicking sound a hen makes)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 2: “The _____ of her fate and fortunes had been to set her free”
    Key: tendency

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Dimmesdale decide?
    A. To confess
    B. To flee
    C. To die
    D. To stay

    Key: B (To flee)

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Hester throw away?
    A. A ring
    B. Her cap only
    C. A Bible
    D. The scarlet letter

    Key: D (The scarlet letter)

21. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “As a man who had once sinned, but who kept his conscience all alive and painfully sensitive by the fretting of an _____ wound, he might have been supposed safer within the line of virtue than if he had never sinned at all.”
    Word bank: transmuting, gladdening, clucked, unhealed
    Key: unhealed

22. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “she undid the clasp that fastened the scarlet letter, and, taking it from her bosom, threw it to a distance among the withered

leaves" (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 11) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Hester casts off the letter. The evidence is "she undid the clasp that fastened the scarlet letter, and, taking it from her bosom, threw it to a distance among the withered leaves" (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 11).

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in "The tendency of her fate and fortunes had been to set her free" (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 2). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: Hester's freedom. The evidence is "The tendency of her fate and fortunes had been to set her free" (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 2). This develops nature and the individual against society: nature responds to their happiness. The words "fortunes" and "tendency" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Which literary element does this describe in "XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine"? 'A flood of sunshine' bursts through the trees.

A. Alliteration
B. Foreshadowing
C. Imagery
D. Structure

Key: C (Imagery)

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: "The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom." Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. "Such was the sympathy of Nature—that wild, heathen Nature of the forest, never subjugated by human law, nor illumined by higher truth—with the bliss of these…" (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 13) supports it: Nature shows "sympathy" with "these two spirits," yet Hester has "wandered, without rule or guidance, in a moral wilderness.". But "She had wandered, without rule or guidance, in a moral wilderness" (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 2) complicates it: the line (the narrator's qualification) shows the same issue from another side, and its "without" marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. A fair verdict is that the claim is mostly right but overstated; it needs a limiting clause to cover that passage.

26. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 3? "But this had been a sin of passion, not of _____, nor even purpose."

A. principle
B. irrevocably
C. clergyman
D. companionship

Key: A (principle)

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 6? "But now—since I am _____ doomed—wherefore should I not snatch the solace allowed to the condemned culprit before his execution?"

A. irrevocably
B. principle
C. unforgotten
D. boldness

Key: A (irrevocably)

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 15 shapes its tone: “But thou wilt love her dearly, as I do, and wilt advise me how to deal with her.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words “dearly” and “advise” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 15) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: nature responds to their happiness. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 19 to the story's treatment of women and independence: “Hester smiled, and again called to Pearl, who was visible, at some distance, as the minister had described her, like a bright-apparelled vision, in a sunbeam, which fell down upon her through an arch of boughs.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
Sample answer: This passage (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 19) develops women and independence: nature responds to their happiness. Its words “apparelled” and “described” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “She heard her mother’s voice, and approached slowly through the forest.” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 19), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

30. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the quotation from XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 11: “she undid the clasp that _____ the scarlet letter, and, taking it from her bosom, threw it to a distance among the withered leaves”
Key: fastened

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Which literary element does this describe in “XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine”? Hester throws away the letter and lets down her hair; sunshine floods the forest.
A. Alliteration
B. Personification
C. Simile
D. Symbolism

Key: D (Symbolism)

32. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 4 shapes its tone: “It may be watched and guarded; so that the enemy shall not force his way again into the citadel, and might even, in his subsequent assaults, select some other avenue, in preference to that where he had formerly succeeded.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words “preference” and “subsequent” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 4) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: nature responds to their happiness. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

33. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 3 shapes its tone: “Since that wretched epoch, he had watched, with morbid zeal and minuteness, not his acts—for those it was easy to arrange—but each breath of emotion, and his every thought.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words “minuteness” and “wretched” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 3) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: nature responds to their happiness. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

34. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Is the narrator celebrating or warning? Argue.
    Sample answer: A reasoned view: the narrator's qualification. The evidence is “She had wandered, without rule or guidance, in a moral wilderness” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 2). This develops nature and the individual against society: nature responds to their happiness. Nature shows "sympathy" with "these two spirits," yet Hester has "wandered, without rule or guidance, in a moral wilderness.".

35. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Synthesis: trace how nature and the individual against society develops from XVI: A Forest Walk to XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Earlier, in XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4, the text reads “Mother … the sunshine does not love you” — Pearl's observation. In XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, “she undid the clasp that fastened the scarlet letter, and, taking it from her bosom, threw it to a distance among the withered leaves” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 11) — Hester casts off the letter. Nature responds to their happiness.

36. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 6 to the story's treatment of women and independence: “Or, if this be the path to a better life, as Hester would persuade me, I surely give up no fairer prospect by pursuing it!” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 6) develops women and independence: nature responds to their happiness. Its words “pursuing” and “persuade” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “O Thou to whom I dare not lift mine eyes, wilt Thou yet pardon me!” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 6), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

37. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: The forest sets Hester free but the narrator questions that freedom. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Such was the sympathy of Nature—that wild, heathen Nature of the forest, never subjugated by human law, nor illumined by higher truth—with the bliss of these two spirits” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 13).
    Sample answer: Nature shows "sympathy" with "these two spirits," yet Hester has "wandered, without rule or guidance, in a moral wilderness.". The evidence is “Such was the sympathy of Nature—that wild, heathen Nature of the forest, never subjugated by human law, nor illumined by higher truth—with…” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 13) — Nature's response. This develops nature and the individual against society: nature responds to their happiness.

38. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What can you infer from this line? “Such was the sympathy of Nature—that wild, heathen Nature of the forest, never subjugated by human law, nor illumined by higher truth—with the bliss of these two spirits” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 13) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Nature's response. The evidence is “Such was the sympathy of Nature—that wild, heathen Nature of the forest, never subjugated by human law, nor illumined by higher truth—with…” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 13).

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “she undid the clasp that fastened the scarlet letter, and, taking it from her bosom, threw it to a distance among the withered leaves” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 11) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Hester casts off the letter. The evidence is “she undid the clasp that fastened the scarlet letter, and, taking it from her bosom, threw it to a distance among the withered leaves” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 11). This develops nature and the individual against society: nature responds to their happiness. The words “withered” and “distance” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Nature shows "sympathy" with "these two spirits," yet Hester has "wandered, without rule or guidance, in a moral wilderness.".

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Such was the sympathy of Nature—that wild, heathen Nature of the forest, never subjugated by human law, nor illumined by higher truth—with the bliss of these two spirits" (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 13) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Nature's response. The evidence is "Such was the sympathy of Nature—that wild, heathen Nature of the forest, never subjugated by human law, nor illumined by higher truth—with…" (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 13). This develops nature and the individual against society: nature responds to their happiness. The words "subjugated" and "illumined" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Nature shows "sympathy" with "these two spirits," yet Hester has "wandered, without rule or guidance, in a moral wilderness.".
41. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Connect this passage from XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 9 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: "Methought the germ of it was dead in me!" Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 9) develops hypocrisy and truth: nature responds to their happiness. Its words its wording carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "With this symbol, I undo it all, and make it as it had never been!" (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 10), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	4, 9, 17, 7, 18, 19, 20, 5, 21, 2, 22, 11, 23, 14, 24, 25	recall 10, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	3, 26, 17, 7, 1, 5, 27, 18, 13, 11, 12, 24, 28, 23, 29, 25	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	20, 2, 21, 5, 1, 18, 30, 12, 13, 11, 14, 31, 23, 28, 29, 25	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	4, 9, 2, 21, 17, 27, 12, 13, 11, 15, 32, 23, 33, 34, 35, 36	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	6, 10, 20, 1, 22, 12, 13, 28, 37, 33, 14, 31, 16, 29, 35, 34	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	9, 3, 6, 10, 38, 12, 13, 15, 23, 14, 28, 24, 36, 35, 16, 25	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	10, 5, 20, 2, 6, 32, 33, 14, 23, 28, 25, 35, 16, 39, 40, 29	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Junior	18, 8, 10, 20, 2, 32, 23, 14, 33, 28, 16, 35, 25, 36, 34, 41	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	10, 1, 20, 2, 6, 14, 23, 28, 15, 29, 34, 25, 35, 40, 41, 16	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 4, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	19, 10, 1, 20, 28, 14, 24, 15, 29, 36, 41, 35, 34, 25, 40, 16	recall 4, inference 0, analysis 4, synthesis 8

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine," how does Hawthorne show a flood of sunshine? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the symbolism you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of a flood of sunshine? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the symbolism in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine develops the idea of a flood of sunshine. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine (where it begins, turns and ends) and its symbolism shape the reader's understanding of a flood of sunshine. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine suggests about a flood of sunshine. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's symbolism and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses symbolism in XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine to complicate the reader's understanding of a flood of sunshine. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of a flood of sunshine responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of a flood of sunshine follows or bends those conventions, using the symbolism as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine and its treatment of a flood of sunshine. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's symbolism and imagery, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine as evidence for a larger claim about a flood of sunshine in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of a flood of sunshine. Position your

reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

SAT-style questions

1. *All at once, as with a sudden smile of heaven, forth burst the sunshine, pouring a very flood into the obscure forest, gladdening each green leaf, transmuting the yellow fallen ones to gold, and gleaming adown the gray trunks of the solemn trees.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "gladdening" most nearly mean?

   A. making glad
   B. not saved from sin
   C. bordered or edged
   D. not yet healed

2. *The decision once made, a glow of strange enjoyment threw its flickering brightness over the trouble of his breast. It was the exhilarating effect—upon a prisoner just escaped from the dungeon of his own heart—of breathing the wild, free atmosphere of an unredeemed, unchristianized, lawless region. His spirit rose, as it were, with a bound, and attained a nearer prospect of the sky, than throughout all the misery which had kept him grovelling on the earth. Of a deeply religious temperament, there was inevitably a tinge of the devotional in his mood.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine"?

   A. The interior of a heart
   B. The minister in a maze
   C. An author answering his critics
   D. A flood of sunshine

SAT key: 1. A (making glad); 2. D (A flood of sunshine)

Lesson 22: XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side

Focus: the child at the brook-side

Objective: Students will analyze how symbolism develops in “XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Critical voice: “Hester was scared only of one result of her sin: Pearl. Pearl, the scarlet letter incarnate.” (D. H. Lawrence, novelist and poet, *Studies in Classic American Literature (1923), Ch. VII, "Nathaniel Hawthorne and 'The Scarlet Letter'", Ch. VII*; public domain). Close reading: why will Pearl not cross the brook until Hester puts the letter back on? *Objective:* Analyze Pearl at the brook-side as the letter made flesh. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.3

Teacher only · spoilers

Pearl stops across the brook and will not come. She points at Hester's breast and screams until Hester picks up the letter and fastens it again and hides her hair. Pearl then kisses her and the letter. She asks whether the minister will walk with them into town and washes off his kiss in the brook.

Background: Folk belief held that spirits could not cross running water; Dimmesdale wonders whether Pearl is such a spirit.

Significance: Pearl demands that the truth be visible.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why might a child resist a big change in her family? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to public shame and private identity because....
Prompt: Why might a child resist a big change in her family?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to public shame and private identity because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: freakish — unpredictable and odd; accosting — approaching and speaking to (someone); pacifying — calming; encouragingly — in a way that gives hope or confidence; overburdened — carrying too heavy a load. “accosting”: Origin of “accost”: Middle French accoster; earlier Old French acoster (“to stand beside”). “pacifying”: Origin of “pacify”: Middle French pacifier.
Words: freakish: unpredictable and odd · accosting: approaching and speaking to (someone) · pacifying: calming · encouragingly: in a way that gives hope or confidence · overburdened: carrying too heavy a load

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Folk belief held that spirits could not cross running water; Dimmesdale wonders whether Pearl is such a spirit. Pearl demands that the truth be visible. Characterization: Pearl refuses to cross the brook until Hester puts the letter back. Symbolism: The brook as a boundary between Pearl and her mother; Pearl's reflection in the pool. Conflict: Pearl washes off the minister's kiss. Watch for the scarlet letter: The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "wood, they could not have become her better. She is a splendid child! But I know whose brow she has" (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 1).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "there lay the scarlet letter, so close upon the margin of the stream, that the gold embroidery was reflected in it" slowly and put it in my own words: The discarded letter lies so close to the stream that its gold embroidery is reflected in the water. Next, craft. I notice the reflection doubles the symbol, so throwing it away has not made it disappear. The strongest word is "reflected": the letter is still visible even after Hester throws it off. Then, effect. Why does the letter's reflection in the brook matter? My answer: The letter's reflection in the brook matters because Pearl refuses to come to her mother until Hester puts the letter back on; it shows that the past cannot simply be thrown away.

> *there lay the scarlet letter, so close upon the margin of the stream, that the gold embroidery was reflected in it*
> *(XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 21)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "there lay the scarlet letter, so close upon the margin of the stream, that the gold embroidery was reflected in it" slowly and put it in my own words: The discarded letter lies so close to the stream that its gold embroidery is reflected in the water. Next, craft. I notice the reflection doubles the symbol, so throwing it away has not made it disappear. The strongest word is "reflected": the letter is still visible even after Hester throws it off. Then, effect. Why does the letter's reflection in the brook matter? My answer: The letter's reflection in the brook matters because Pearl refuses to come to her mother until Hester puts the letter back on; it shows that the past cannot simply be thrown away.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Pearl's question. Look at the craft: The brook as a boundary between Pearl and her mother; Pearl's reflection in the pool. Ask: How does this line connect to public shame and private identity? Expected: The letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child. (Pearl's question.)

> *Will he go back with us, hand in hand, we three together, into the town (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 33)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Pearl's question. Look at the craft: The brook as a boundary between Pearl and her mother; Pearl's reflection in the pool.
Ask: How does this line connect to public shame and private identity?
Expected answer: The letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child. (Pearl's question.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for characterization, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the child at the brook-side? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side develops the idea of the child at the brook-side. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Pearl demands that the truth be public. When the text says "Will he go back with us, hand in hand, we three together, into the town" (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 33), it shows this directly. She refuses to come until Hester restores the letter and asks whether the minister will go "hand in hand, we three together, into the town."
Task: Annotate the chapter for characterization, symbolism (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the child at the brook-side? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side develops the idea of the child at the brook-side. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Pearl demands that the truth be public. When the text says "Will he go back with us, hand in hand, we three together, into the town" (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 33), it shows this directly. She refuses to come until Hester restores the letter and asks whether the minister will go "hand in hand, we three together, into the town."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Why might a child resist a big change in her family? Ask: why does Pearl reject her mother without the letter?
Anchor question: Why might a child resist a big change in her family?
Facilitation: Ask: why does Pearl reject her mother without the letter?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the child at the brook-side? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Pearl demands that the truth be public. ("Will he go back with us, hand in hand, we three together, into the town", XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 33). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the child at the brook-side? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Pearl demands that the truth be public. ("Will he go back with us, hand in hand, we three together, into the town", XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 33). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes the child at the brook-side. Key takeaway: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Pearl refuses to cross the brook until Hester puts the letter back.
- **Symbolism:** The brook as a boundary between Pearl and her mother; Pearl's reflection in the pool.
- **Conflict:** Pearl washes off the minister's kiss.

Themes and how they develop

- **public shame and private identity:** the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child.

Symbols and motifs

- **the scarlet letter:** The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "wood, they could not have become her better. She is a splendid child! But I know whose brow she has" (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 1).
- **light and darkness:** Sunshine avoids Hester but plays around Pearl; the forest is dim; the minister's vigil happens at midnight under a meteor. In this chapter: "the forest-gloom; herself, meanwhile, all glorified with a ray of sunshine, that was attracted thitherward as by a certain sympathy. In the" (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 8).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "there lay the scarlet letter, so close upon the margin of the stream, that the gold embroidery was reflected in it" (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 21) The letter at the brook's edge.

- “Will he go back with us, hand in hand, we three together, into the town” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 33) Pearl's question.
- “Come thou and take it up” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 23) Pearl's demand that Hester take up the letter.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Pearl demands that the truth be public.
Evidence: “Will he go back with us, hand in hand, we three together, into the town” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 33)
Reasoning: She refuses to come until Hester restores the letter and asks whether the minister will go "hand in hand, we three together, into the town."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
freakish (adjective)	unpredictable and odd	*But, whether influenced by the jealousy that seems instinctive with every petted child towards a dangerous rival, or from whatever caprice of her freakish nature, Pearl would show no favor to the clergyman.*	
accosting (verb)	approaching and speaking to (someone)	*“Let her see nothing strange—no passion nor eagerness—in thy way of accosting her,” whispered Hester.*	“accosting”: Origin of “accost”: Middle French accoster; earlier Old French acoster (“to stand beside”). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/accost#Etymology)
pacifying (verb)	calming	*“I pray you,” answered the minister, “if thou hast any means of pacifying the child, do it forthwith!*	“pacifying”: Origin of “pacify”: Middle French pacifier. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/pacify#Etymology)
encouragingly (adverb)	in a way that gives hope or confidence	*“Come, dearest child!” said Hester, encouragingly, and stretching out both her arms.*	
overburdened (adjective)	carrying too heavy a load	*And the melancholy brook would add this other tale to the mystery with which its little heart was already overburdened, and whereof it still kept up a murmuring babble, with not a whit more cheerfulness of tone than for ages heretofore.*	

cankered (adjective)	bitter and corrupted	*Save it were the cankered wrath of an old witch, like Mistress Hibbins," added he, attempting to smile, "I know nothing that I would not sooner encounter than this passion in a child.*	"cankered": Origin: an English formation from canker + -ed. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/cankered#Etymology)
immortally (adverb)	forever, beyond death	*Be the foregone evil what it might, how could they doubt that their earthly lives and future destinies were conjoined, when they beheld at once the material union, and the spiritual idea, in whom they met, and were to dwell immortally together?*	
reverberated (verb)	echoed	*She accompanied this wild outbreak with piercing shrieks, which the woods reverberated on all sides; so that, alone as she was in her childish and unreasonable wrath, it seemed as if a hidden multitude were lending her their sympathy and encouragement.*	

Discussion questions

1. Why might a child resist a big change in her family?
2. Where does symbolism appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with sin and guilt?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Pearl say after Hester puts the letter back? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Now thou art my mother indeed.
2. Where does Pearl stop? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Across the brook
3. What does Pearl point at? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Hester's breast, where the letter was
4. What does Hester do? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Puts the letter back on
5. What does Pearl wash off? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The minister's kiss

6. What does Pearl ask about the minister? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Will he walk with them into town
7. Retell the three most important events of "XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Pearl stops across the brook and will not come. She points at Hester's breast and screams until Hester picks up the letter and fastens it again and hides her hair. Pearl then kisses her and the letter. She asks whether the minister will walk with them into town and washes off his kiss in the brook.
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: "But, whether influenced by the jealousy that seems instinctive with every petted child towards a dangerous rival, or from whatever caprice of her freakish nature, Pearl would show no favor to the clergyman." What does "freakish" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: freakish: unpredictable and odd.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Pearl reject the minister? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: He will not acknowledge them in public.
2. What does "XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side" suggest about the child at the brook-side? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Pearl demands that the truth be visible.
3. Find one example of symbolism in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.
4. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about the child at the brook-side? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl demands that the truth be public. Useful evidence: "there lay the scarlet letter, so close upon the margin of the stream, that the gold embroidery was reflected in it" (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 21): The letter at the brook's edge. On characterization: Pearl refuses to cross the brook until Hester puts the letter back. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins ""Let her see nothing strange—no passion nor eagerness—in thy way of accosting her,"", why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Pearl stops across the brook and will not come. She points at Hester's breast and screams until Hester picks up the letter and fastens it again and hides her hair. Pearl then kisses her and the letter. She asks whether the minister will walk with them into town and washes off his kiss in the brook.

7. How does “XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side” build on “XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl demands that the truth be public. Useful evidence: “Will he go back with us, hand in hand, we three together, into the town” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 33): Pearl's question. Theme link: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl demands that the truth be public. Useful evidence: “Come thou and take it up” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 23): Pearl's demand that Hester take up the letter. On characterization: Pearl refuses to cross the brook until Hester puts the letter back. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Why might a child resist a big change in her family?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does conflict appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with sin and guilt? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl demands that the truth be public. Useful evidence: “there lay the scarlet letter, so close upon the margin of the stream, that the gold embroidery was reflected in it” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 21): The letter at the brook's edge. On conflict: Pearl washes off the minister's kiss. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Pearl a moral guide in this scene? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl demands that the truth be public. Useful evidence: “Will he go back with us, hand in hand, we three together, into the town” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 33): Pearl's question. Theme link: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Pearl demands that the truth be visible.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl demands that the truth be public. Useful evidence: “Come thou and take it up” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 23): Pearl's demand that Hester take up the letter. Theme link: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child. Credit any

position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl demands that the truth be public. Useful evidence: “there lay the scarlet letter, so close upon the margin of the stream, that the gold embroidery was reflected in it” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 21): The letter at the brook's edge. On characterization: Pearl refuses to cross the brook until Hester puts the letter back. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Rewrite one moment of “XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the child at the brook-side? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl demands that the truth be public. Useful evidence: “Will he go back with us, hand in hand, we three together, into the town” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 33): Pearl's question. Theme link: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl demands that the truth be public. Useful evidence: “Come thou and take it up” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 23): Pearl's demand that Hester take up the letter. Theme link: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to public shame and private identity: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl demands that the truth be public. Useful evidence: “there lay the scarlet letter, so close upon the margin of the stream, that the gold embroidery was reflected in it” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 21): The letter at the brook's edge. Theme link: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the symbolism in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl demands that the truth be public. Useful evidence: “Will he go back with us, hand in hand, we three together, into the town” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 33): Pearl's question. On symbolism: The brook as a boundary between Pearl and her mother; Pearl's reflection in the pool. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side” treats the child at the brook-side with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl demands that the truth be public. Useful evidence: “Come thou and take it up” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 23): Pearl's demand that Hester take up the letter. Theme link: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “XX: The Minister in a Maze” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl demands that the truth be public. Useful evidence: “there lay the scarlet letter, so close upon the margin of the stream, that the gold embroidery was reflected in it” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 21): The letter at the brook's edge. Theme link: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the child at the brook-side? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Pearl demands that the truth be public. Useful evidence: “Will he go back with us, hand in hand, we three together, into the town” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 33): Pearl's question. Theme link: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Symbolism:** look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 1: “And see with what _____ skill she has made those simple flowers adorn her!” Word bank: impression, natural, strange, yonder
   Key: natural
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “‘Come, dearest child!’ said Hester, encouragingly, and stretching out both her arms.”, what does “encouragingly” most nearly mean?
   A. a complete change of appearance
   B. inflicted (revenge or harm)
   C. setting aside; declining to pursue
   D. in a way that gives hope or confidence

Key: D (in a way that gives hope or confidence)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Pearl point at?

   A. The minister's face

   B. The sky

   C. The forest

   D. Hester's breast, where the letter was

   Key: D (Hester's breast, where the letter was)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Pearl wash off?

   A. Blood

   B. Mud

   C. Her mother's tears

   D. The minister's kiss

   Key: D (The minister's kiss)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Pearl ask about the minister?

   A. Will he walk with them into town

   B. Where he lives

   C. Who he is

   D. Is he ill

   Key: A (Will he walk with them into town)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 5: "Especially, she is seldom tolerant of emotion, when she does not fully _____ the why and wherefore." Word bank: imparted, communicate, visible, comprehend

   Key: comprehend

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 3? "It is as if one of the _____, whom we left in our dear old England, had decked her out to meet us."

   A. natural

   B. children

   C. communicate

   D. fairies

   Key: D (fairies)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 21: "there lay the scarlet letter, so close upon the margin of the stream, that the gold _____ was reflected in it"

   Key: embroidery

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 33: "Will he go back with us, hand in hand, we three _____, into the town"

   Key: together

10. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "And the melancholy brook would add this other tale to the mystery with which its little heart was already _____,

and whereof it still kept up a murmuring babble, with not a whit more cheerfulness of tone than for ages heretofore." Word bank: overburdened, pacifying, freakish, accosting

Key: overburdened

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 11 reveal about the character or situation? "When hast thou been so sluggish before now?" Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 11) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child. The words "sluggish" and "before" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Pearl reject the minister?

    Sample answer: He will not acknowledge them in public. The evidence is "Will he go back with us, hand in hand, we three together, into the town" (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 33) — Pearl's question.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 1 reveal about the character or situation? "Had she gathered pearls, and diamonds, and rubies, in the wood, they could not have become her better." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 1) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child. The words "diamonds" and "gathered" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 6 shapes its tone: "Thou canst not think,' said the minister, glancing aside at Hester Prynne, 'how my heart dreads this interview, and yearns for it!" Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "interview" and "glancing" (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 6) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Which literary element does this describe in "XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side"? The brook as a boundary between Pearl and her mother; Pearl's reflection in the pool.

    A. Plot
    B. Metaphor
    C. Diction / vocabulary
    D. Symbolism

    Key: D (Symbolism)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 24 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: "The mid-ocean shall take it from my hand, and swallow it up forever!" Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 24) develops hypocrisy and truth: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child. Its words "swallow" and "forever" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Hopefully, but a moment ago, as Hester had spoken of drowning it in the deep sea, there was a sense of inevitable doom…" (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 25), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 10? “Pray hasten her; for this delay has already _____ a tremor to my nerves.”

    A. imparted

    B. children

    C. needest

    D. fairies

    Key: A (imparted)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “She accompanied this wild outbreak with piercing shrieks, which the woods _____ on all sides; so that, alone as she was in her childish and unreasonable wrath, it seemed as if a hidden multitude were lending her their sympathy and encouragement.” Word bank: accosting, reverberated, pacifying, freakish

    Key: reverberated

19. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Pearl say after Hester puts the letter back?

    Sample answer: Now thou art my mother indeed.

20. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Be the foregone evil what it might, how could they doubt that their earthly lives and future destinies were conjoined, when they beheld at once the material union, and the spiritual idea, in whom they met, and were to dwell _____ together?” Word bank: immortally, freakish, pacifying, accosting

    Key: immortally

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where does Pearl stop?

    A. By the scaffold

    B. In the town

    C. Across the brook

    D. At the door

    Key: C (Across the brook)

22. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Hester do?

    A. Leaves Pearl

    B. Throws the letter in

    C. Puts the letter back on

    D. Carries her across

    Key: C (Puts the letter back on)

23. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 8: “In the brook beneath stood another child—another and the same—with _____ its ray of golden light.” Word bank: comprehend, likewise, children, needest

    Key: likewise

24. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “there lay the scarlet letter, so close upon the margin of the stream, that the gold embroidery was reflected in it” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 21) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The letter at the brook's edge. The evidence is “there lay the scarlet letter, so close upon the margin of the stream, that the gold embroidery was reflected in it” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 21).

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? The letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child.

    A. Hypocrisy and truth

    B. Public shame and private identity

    C. Sin and guilt

    D. Nature and the individual against society

    Key: B (Public shame and private identity)

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 15 shapes its tone: “Leap across the brook, naughty child, and run hither!” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “naughty” and “hither” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 15) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how public shame and private identity develops from XII: The Minister’s Vigil to XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Earlier, in XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 21, the text reads “Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide” — Pearl's question. In XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, “there lay the scarlet letter, so close upon the margin of the stream, that the gold embroidery was reflected in it” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 21), which shows the letter at the brook's edge. The letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child.

28. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 6? “The last was when thou ledst her with thee to the house of _____ stern old Governor.”

    A. visible

    B. sensitive

    C. communicate

    D. yonder

    Key: D (yonder)

29. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Save it were the _____ wrath of an old witch, like Mistress Hibbins,’ added he, attempting to smile, ‘I know nothing that I would not sooner encounter than this passion in a child.” Word bank: pacifying, accosting, freakish, cankered

    Key: cankered

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: Pearl demands that the truth be public. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Will he go back with us, hand in hand, we three together, into the town” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 33).

    Sample answer: She refuses to come until Hester restores the letter and asks whether the minister will go "hand in hand, we three together, into the town.". The evidence is “Will he go back with us, hand in hand, we three together, into the town” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 33) — Pearl's question. This develops public shame and private identity: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child.

31. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “Come thou and take it up” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 23). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Pearl's demand that Hester take up the letter. The evidence is “Come thou and take it up” (XIX: The Child

at the Brook-Side, paragraph 23). This develops public shame and private identity: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child. The words “thou” and “take” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 8 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: “Hester felt herself, in some indistinct and tantalizing manner, estranged from Pearl” Use one other moment from the story as well.
Sample answer: This passage (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 8) develops hypocrisy and truth: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child. Its words “tantalizing” and “indistinct” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Since the latter rambled from her side, another inmate had been admitted within the circle of the mother’s feelings,…” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 9), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 7 to the story's treatment of women and independence: “I remember it; and so shall little Pearl.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
Sample answer: This passage (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 7) develops women and independence: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child. Its words “remember” and “little” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “By this time Pearl had reached the margin of the brook, and stood on the farther side, gazing silently at Hester and…” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 8), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

34. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] In the line “But, whether influenced by the jealousy that seems instinctive with every petted child towards a dangerous rival, or from whatever caprice of her freakish nature, Pearl would show no favor to the clergyman.”, what does “freakish” most nearly mean?
   A. the decorated front of a building
   B. unpredictable and odd
   C. a small, close-fitting cap
   D. removed or done away with

   Key: B (unpredictable and odd)

35. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 4 shapes its tone: “It was with a feeling which neither of them had ever before experienced, that they sat and watched Pearl’s slow advance.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words “experienced” and “neither” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 4) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

36. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 12 shapes its tone: “For some unaccountable reason, as Arthur Dimmesdale felt the child’s eyes upon himself, his hand—with that gesture so habitual as to have become involuntary—stole over his heart.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words “unaccountable” and “involuntary” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 12) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Is Pearl a moral guide in this scene? Argue.

    Sample answer: A reasoned view: the letter at the brook's edge. The evidence is “there lay the scarlet letter, so close upon the margin of the stream, that the gold embroidery was reflected in it” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 21). This develops public shame and private identity: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child. She refuses to come until Hester restores the letter and asks whether the minister will go "hand in hand, we three together, into the town.".

38. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “Will he go back with us, hand in hand, we three together, into the town” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 33) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Pearl's question. The evidence is “Will he go back with us, hand in hand, we three together, into the town” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 33). This develops public shame and private identity: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child.

39. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What does this passage most clearly show? “Come thou and take it up” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 23)

    A. Pearl's demand that Hester take up the letter.

    B. Ironic exaggeration of the reaction.

    C. The core of his hypocrisy.

    D. The opening, with its ironic self-presentation.

    Key: A (Pearl's demand that Hester take up the letter.)

40. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Which literary element does this describe in “XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side”? Pearl refuses to cross the brook until Hester puts the letter back.

    A. Personification

    B. Irony

    C. Characterization

    D. Hyperbole

    Key: C (Characterization)

41. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Connect this passage from XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 19 to the story's treatment of women and independence: “Hester turned again towards Pearl, with a crimson blush upon her cheek, a conscious glance aside at the clergyman, and then a heavy sigh; while, even before she had time to speak, the blush yielded to a deadly pallor.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 19) develops women and independence: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child. Its words “clergyman” and “conscious” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “There!—before thee!—on the hither side of the brook!” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 20), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

42. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] In the line “I pray you,’ answered the minister, ‘if thou hast any means of pacifying the child, do it forthwith!”, what does “pacifying” most nearly mean?

    A. approaching and speaking to (someone)

    B. in a way that gives hope or confidence

    C. calming

    D. unpredictable and odd

Key: C (calming)

43. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “there lay the scarlet letter, so close upon the margin of the stream, that the gold embroidery was reflected in it” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 21) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The letter at the brook's edge. The evidence is “there lay the scarlet letter, so close upon the margin of the stream, that the gold embroidery was reflected in it” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 21). This develops public shame and private identity: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child. The words “embroidery” and “reflected” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. She refuses to come until Hester restores the letter and asks whether the minister will go "hand in hand, we three together, into the town.".

44. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Will he go back with us, hand in hand, we three together, into the town” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 33) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Pearl's question. The evidence is “Will he go back with us, hand in hand, we three together, into the town” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 33). This develops public shame and private identity: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child. The words “together” and “three” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. She refuses to come until Hester restores the letter and asks whether the minister will go "hand in hand, we three together, into the town.".

45. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] What does this passage most clearly show? “there lay the scarlet letter, so close upon the margin of the stream, that the gold embroidery was reflected in it” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 21)

    A. His imagined ancestors' contempt for him.

    B. The harshest woman in the crowd.

    C. The letter at the brook's edge.

    D. The changed meaning of the letter.

    Key: C (The letter at the brook's edge.)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	1, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 13, 24, 12, 11, 25, 15, 26, 27	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	28, 6, 18, 22, 2, 29, 10, 12, 24, 11, 13, 30, 31, 25, 32, 33	recall 7, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	4, 5, 17, 7, 9, 18, 34, 12, 11, 13, 35, 15, 36, 31, 37, 27	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	21, 19, 18, 5, 23, 11, 12, 38, 13, 31, 15, 35, 25, 32, 27, 16	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	21, 20, 29, 3, 22, 13, 12, 14, 31, 36, 25, 26, 32, 16, 37, 33	recall 5, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	18, 10, 34, 24, 11, 13, 39, 25, 40, 36, 26, 35, 32, 27, 41, 16	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4

College Sophomore	42, 29, 10, 39, 13, 12, 15, 26, 25, 36, 35, 37, 32, 43, 33, 41	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	22, 3, 10, 29, 21, 40, 26, 36, 35, 31, 32, 33, 16, 37, 44, 41	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	29, 10, 21, 3, 30, 31, 40, 35, 36, 25, 27, 33, 16, 41, 37, 32	recall 4, inference 0, analysis 6, synthesis 6
Graduate / PhD	42, 10, 29, 45, 25, 36, 31, 14, 26, 40, 32, 27, 16, 41, 33, 37	recall 3, inference 1, analysis 6, synthesis 6

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side," how does Hawthorne show the child at the brook-side? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the symbolism you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of the child at the brook-side? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the symbolism in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side develops the idea of the child at the brook-side. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of symbolism and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side (where it begins, turns and ends) and its symbolism shape the reader's understanding of the child at the brook-side. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side suggests about the child at the brook-side. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's symbolism and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses symbolism in XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side to complicate the reader's understanding of the child at the brook-side. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the child at the brook-side responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the child at the brook-side follows or bends those conventions, using the symbolism as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side and its treatment of the child at the brook-side. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's symbolism and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side as evidence for a larger claim about the child at the brook-side in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the child at the brook-side. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

SAT-style questions

1. *"I pray you," answered the minister, "if thou hast any means of pacifying the child, do it forthwith!*

   As used in the text, what does the word "pacifying" most nearly mean?

   A. bitter and corrupted

   B. forever, beyond death

   C. echoed

   D. calming

2. *"Let her see nothing strange—no passion nor eagerness—in thy way of accosting her," whispered Hester. "Our Pearl is a fitful and fantastic little elf, sometimes. Especially, she is seldom tolerant of emotion, when she does not fully comprehend the why and wherefore. But the child hath strong affections! She loves me, and will love thee!"*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side"?

   A. The elf-child and the minister

   B. The procession

   C. The pastor and his parishioner

   D. The child at the brook-side

SAT key: 1. D (calming); 2. D (The child at the brook-side)

Lesson 23: XX: The Minister in a Maze

Focus: the minister in a maze

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in "XX: The Minister in a Maze" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): This section mentions drinking or a drug ("…lf this freak, as unworthy of his cloth, he met a drunken seaman, one of the ship's crew from the…"). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: This section mentions drinking or a drug.
Suggested language: "What does this detail add to the scene?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Walking home, Dimmesdale feels transformed and tempted to wicked acts: to argue blasphemy with a deacon, shock an old widow, corrupt a young maiden, teach children bad words and swear with a sailor. Mistress Hibbins hints that he has met the devil. He refuses Chillingworth's medicine, burns his sermon and writes a new Election Sermon all night.

Background: The Election Sermon was a major annual sermon preached when a new governor took office.

Significance: Planned hypocrisy loosens all his restraint.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What happens when someone decides to break a big rule? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to hypocrisy and truth because.... Content note before we start: This section mentions drinking or a drug.
Prompt: What happens when someone decides to break a big rule?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to hypocrisy and truth because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the double face.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: tapestried — hung with tapestries; irresponsibility — lack of accountability to anyone; underbrush — shrubs and small plants under forest trees; comport — fit together; agree; importunately — insistently, in a troubling way. “tapestried”: Origin: an English formation from tapestry + -ed. “irresponsibility”: Origin: an English formation from ir- + responsibility. “comport”: Origin: Old French comporter; earlier Latin comportare (“to bring together”).
Words: tapestried: hung with tapestries · irresponsibility: lack of accountability to anyone · underbrush: shrubs and small plants under forest trees · comport: fit together; agree · importunately: insistently, in a troubling way

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The Election Sermon was a major annual sermon preached when a new governor took office. Planned hypocrisy loosens all his restraint. Characterization: Returning to town, Dimmesdale is tempted to blasphemy, to corrupt a young maiden and to curse. Irony: He feels a new energy and writes the Election Sermon with fervor. Theme: "No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true." Watch for the scarlet letter: The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: “in advance of Hester Prynne and little Pearl, he threw a backward glance; half expecting that he should discover only some faintly” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 1).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as..." slowly and put it in my own words: The narrator says no one can show one face to himself and another to the crowd for long without becoming confused about which is true. Next, craft. I notice the general, proverb-like statement, which applies to Dimmesdale without naming him. The strongest word is "bewildered": it means confused and lost, the state of a man who has lived a lie too long. Then, effect. What warning does the narrator give about double lives? My answer: The narrator warns that no one can wear one face to himself and another to the crowd without losing track of which is true; Dimmesdale's double life is destroying his sense of who he is.

> *No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as…" slowly and put it in my own words: The narrator says no one can show one face to himself and another to the crowd for long without becoming confused about which is true. Next, craft. I notice the general, proverb-like statement, which applies to Dimmesdale without naming him. The strongest word is "bewildered": it means confused and lost, the state of a man who has lived a lie too long. Then, effect. What warning does the narrator give about double lives? My answer: The narrator warns that no one can wear one face to himself and another to the crowd without losing track of which is true; Dimmesdale's double life is destroying his sense of who he is.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Dimmesdale fears the Black Man. Look at the craft: He feels a new energy and writes the Election Sermon with fervor. Ask: How does this line connect to hypocrisy and truth? Expected: The double face. (Dimmesdale fears the Black Man.)

> *Did I make a contract with him in the forest (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Dimmesdale fears the Black Man. Look at the craft: He feels a new energy and writes the Election Sermon with fervor.
Ask: How does this line connect to hypocrisy and truth?
Expected answer: The double face. (Dimmesdale fears the Black Man.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the minister in a maze? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XX: The Minister in a Maze develops the idea of the minister in a maze. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints. When the text says “Did I make a contract with him in the forest” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10), it shows this directly. He wonders whether he made "a contract with him in the forest," and the narrator warns that no man can "wear one face to himself and another to the multitude" without losing the true one.

Task: Annotate the chapter for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the minister in a maze? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XX: The Minister in a Maze develops the idea of the minister in a maze. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints. When the text says “Did I make a contract with him in the forest” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10), it shows this directly. He wonders whether he made "a contract with him in the forest," and the narrator warns that no man can "wear one face to himself and another to the multitude" without losing the true one.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: What happens when someone decides to break a big rule? Ask: what are Dimmesdale's temptations on the way home, and why does Hawthorne make them almost comic?

Anchor question: What happens when someone decides to break a big rule?

Facilitation: Ask: what are Dimmesdale's temptations on the way home, and why does Hawthorne make them almost comic?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the minister in a maze? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints. (“Did I make a contract with him in the forest”, XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the minister in a maze? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints. (“Did I make a contract with him in the forest”, XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes the minister in a maze. Key takeaway: the double face.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Returning to town, Dimmesdale is tempted to blasphemy, to corrupt a young maiden and to curse.
- **Irony:** He feels a new energy and writes the Election Sermon with fervor.
- **Theme:** "No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true."

Themes and how they develop

- **hypocrisy and truth:** the double face.

Symbols and motifs

- **the scarlet letter:** The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: “in advance of Hester Prynne and little Pearl, he threw a backward glance; half expecting that he should discover only some faintly” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 1).
- **light and darkness:** Sunshine avoids Hester but plays around Pearl; the forest is dim; the minister's vigil happens at midnight under a meteor. In this chapter: “hope, that was to assume brighter substance as life grew dark around her, and which would gild the utter gloom with final” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 8).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3) The novel's best-known statement on hypocrisy.
- “Did I make a contract with him in the forest” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10) Dimmesdale fears the Black Man.
- “Have I then sold myself … to the fiend” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 16) Dimmesdale after meeting Mistress Hibbins.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints.
Evidence: “Did I make a contract with him in the forest” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10)

Reasoning: He wonders whether he made "a contract with him in the forest," and the narrator warns that no man can "wear one face to himself and another to the multitude" without losing the true one.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
tapestried (adjective)	hung with tapestries	*He entered the accustomed room, and looked around him on its books, its windows, its fireplace, and the tapestried comfort of the walls, with the same perception of strangeness that had haunted him throughout his walk from the forest-dell into the town, and thitherward.*	“tapestried”: Origin: an English formation from tapestry + -ed. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/tapestried#Etymology)
irresponsibility (noun)	lack of accountability to anyone	*In furtherance of this choice, it so happened that a ship lay in the harbor; one of those questionable cruisers, frequent at that day, which, without being absolutely outlaws of the deep, yet roamed over its surface with a remarkable irresponsibility of character.*	“irresponsibility”: Origin: an English formation from ir- + responsibility. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/irresponsibility#Etymology)
underbrush (noun)	shrubs and small plants under forest trees	*But he leaped across the plashy places, thrust himself through the clinging underbrush, climbed the ascent, plunged into the hollow, and overcame, in short, all the difficulties of the track, with an unweariable activity that astonished him.*	
comport (verb)	fit together; agree	*Never was there a more beautiful example of how the majesty of age and wisdom may comport with the obeisance and respect enjoined upon it, as from a lower social rank, and inferior order of endowment, towards a higher.*	“comport”: Origin: Old French comporter; earlier Latin comportare (“to bring together”). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/comport#Etymology)
importunately (adverb)	insistently, in a troubling way	*Not the less, however, came this importunately obtrusive sense of change.*	
cruisers (noun)	ships that roam the seas	*In furtherance of this choice, it so happened that a ship lay in the harbor; one of those questionable cruisers, frequent at that day, which, without being absolutely outlaws of*	

		the deep, yet roamed over its surface with a remarkable irresponsibility of character.	
indistinctness (noun)	lack of clarity; blurriness	*In order to free his mind from this indistinctness and duplicity of impression, which vexed it with a strange disquietude, he recalled and more thoroughly defined the plans which Hester and himself had sketched for their departure.*	

Discussion questions

1. What happens when someone decides to break a big rule?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with public shame and private identity?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. When is the ship due to sail? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: On the fourth day, after the Election Sermon.
2. How does Dimmesdale feel on the way home? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Transformed and tempted
3. Whom does he want to shock? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A deacon, a widow and a young maiden
4. Who hints he met the devil? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Mistress Hibbins
5. What does he refuse? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Chillingworth's medicine
6. What does he write? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A new Election Sermon
7. Retell the three most important events of "XX: The Minister in a Maze" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Walking home, Dimmesdale feels transformed and tempted to wicked acts: to argue blasphemy with a deacon, shock an old widow, corrupt a young maiden, teach children bad words and swear with a sailor. Mistress Hibbins hints that he has met the devil. He refuses Chillingworth's medicine, burns his sermon and writes a new Election Sermon all night.

8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “XX: The Minister in a Maze”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “XX: The Minister in a Maze” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: “He entered the accustomed room, and looked around him on its books, its windows, its fireplace, and the tapestried comfort of the walls, with the same perception of strangeness that had haunted him throughout his walk…” What does “tapestried” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: tapestried: hung with tapestries.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why is Dimmesdale glad the ship sails after the sermon? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: He can preach and leave with his reputation intact.
2. What does “XX: The Minister in a Maze” suggest about the minister in a maze? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Planned hypocrisy loosens all his restraint.
3. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the irony in this chapter shape what we understand about the minister in a maze? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints. Useful evidence: “No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3): The novel's best-known statement on hypocrisy. On irony: He feels a new energy and writes the Election Sermon with fervor. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “As the minister departed, in advance of Hester Prynne and little Pearl, he threw a backward glance; half expecting that he should discover only some faintly traced features or…”, why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “XX: The Minister in a Maze”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Walking home, Dimmesdale feels transformed and tempted to wicked acts: to argue blasphemy with a deacon, shock an old widow, corrupt a young maiden, teach children bad words and swear with a sailor. Mistress Hibbins hints that he has met the devil. He refuses Chillingworth's medicine, burns his…
7. How does “XX: The Minister in a Maze” build on “XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints. Useful evidence: “Did I make a contract with him in the forest” (XX: The Minister in a Maze,

paragraph 10): Dimmesdale fears the Black Man. Theme link: the double face. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints. Useful evidence: “Have I then sold myself … to the fiend” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 16): Dimmesdale after meeting Mistress Hibbins. On characterization: Returning to town, Dimmesdale is tempted to blasphemy, to corrupt a young maiden and to curse. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: “What happens when someone decides to break a big rule?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

10. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with public shame and private identity? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints. Useful evidence: “No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3): The novel's best-known statement on hypocrisy. On theme: "No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Can anyone wear two faces without losing the true one? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints. Useful evidence: “Did I make a contract with him in the forest” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10): Dimmesdale fears the Black Man. On theme: "No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “Planned hypocrisy loosens all his restraint.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints. Useful evidence: “Have I then sold myself … to the fiend” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 16): Dimmesdale after meeting Mistress Hibbins. On theme: "No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints. Useful evidence: “No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3): The novel's best-known statement on hypocrisy. On characterization: Returning to town, Dimmesdale is tempted to blasphemy, to corrupt a young maiden and to curse. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Rewrite one moment of “XX: The Minister in a Maze” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the minister in a maze? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints. Useful evidence: “Did I make a contract with him in the forest” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10): Dimmesdale fears the Black Man. Theme link: the double face. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “XX: The Minister in a Maze”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints. Useful evidence: “Have I then sold myself … to the fiend” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 16): Dimmesdale after meeting Mistress Hibbins. On theme: "No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to hypocrisy and truth: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints. Useful evidence: “No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3): The novel's best-known statement on hypocrisy. On theme: "No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints. Useful evidence: “Did I make a contract with him in the forest” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10): Dimmesdale fears the Black Man. On characterization: Returning to town, Dimmesdale is

tempted to blasphemy, to corrupt a young maiden and to curse. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “XX: The Minister in a Maze” treats the minister in a maze with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints. Useful evidence: “Have I then sold myself … to the fiend” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 16): Dimmesdale after meeting Mistress Hibbins. On theme: "No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “XXI: The New England Holiday” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints. Useful evidence: “No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3): The novel's best-known statement on hypocrisy. Theme link: the double face. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the minister in a maze? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints. Useful evidence: “Did I make a contract with him in the forest” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10): Dimmesdale fears the Black Man. On theme: "No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who hints he met the devil?
   A. Wilson
   B. Pearl
   C. Mistress Hibbins
   D. Chillingworth

Key: C (Mistress Hibbins)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 16: "Have I then sold _____ … to the fiend"
   Key: myself
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whom does he want to shock?
   A. Hester
   B. Pearl
   C. A deacon, a widow and a young maiden
   D. The governor

   Key: C (A deacon, a widow and a young maiden)
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does he refuse?
   A. Sleep
   B. Chillingworth's medicine
   C. Food
   D. The sermon

   Key: B (Chillingworth's medicine)
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "But he leaped across the plashy places, thrust himself through the clinging underbrush, climbed the ascent, plunged into the hollow, and overcame, in short, all the difficulties of the track, with an unwearіable…", what does "underbrush" most nearly mean?
   A. lack of modesty or tact
   B. shrubs and small plants under forest trees
   C. dislike or distrust of people
   D. deep, sad thoughtfulness

   Key: B (shrubs and small plants under forest trees)
6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Dimmesdale feel on the way home?
   A. Bored
   B. Transformed and tempted
   C. Sick and weak
   D. Calm

   Key: B (Transformed and tempted)
7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "In order to free his mind from this _____ and duplicity of impression, which vexed it with a strange disquietude, he recalled and more thoroughly defined the plans which Hester and himself had sketched for their departure." Word bank: tapestried, underbrush, indistinctness, irresponsibility
   Key: indistinctness
8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "In furtherance of this choice, it so happened that a ship lay in the harbor; one of those questionable _____, frequent at that day, which, without being absolutely outlaws of the deep, yet roamed over its surface with a remarkable irresponsibility of…" Word bank: cruisers, underbrush, irresponsibility, tapestried
   Key: cruisers

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Never was there a more beautiful example of how the majesty of age and wisdom may comport with the obeisance and respect enjoined upon it, as from a lower social rank, and inferior order of endowment, towards a higher.”, what does “comport” most nearly mean?

    A. fit together; agree

    B. like a shifting series of dreamlike images

    C. the state of being guilty

    D. open the fastening of

    Key: A (fit together; agree)

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “He entered the accustomed room, and looked around him on its books, its windows, its fireplace, and the tapestried comfort of the walls, with the same perception of strangeness that had haunted him throughout his walk…”, what does “tapestried” most nearly mean?

    A. the act of committing (a crime)

    B. denies having (a motive or intention)

    C. hung with tapestries

    D. having a face of a certain kind

    Key: C (hung with tapestries)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why is Dimmesdale glad the ship sails after the sermon?

    Sample answer: He can preach and leave with his reputation intact. The evidence is “No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to…” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3), which shows the novel's best-known statement on hypocrisy.

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The novel's best-known statement on hypocrisy. The evidence is “No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to…” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3).

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Did I make a contract with him in the forest” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Dimmesdale fears the Black Man. The evidence is “Did I make a contract with him in the forest” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10). This develops hypocrisy and truth: the double face.

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “Have I then sold myself … to the fiend” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 16). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Dimmesdale after meeting Mistress Hibbins. The evidence is “Have I then sold myself … to the fiend” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 16). This develops hypocrisy and truth: the double face. The words “myself” and “fiend” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? The double face.

    A. Hypocrisy and truth

    B. Public shame and private identity

C. Nature and the individual against society

D. Sin and guilt

Key: A (Hypocrisy and truth)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Can anyone wear two faces without losing the true one? Argue.

Sample answer: A reasoned view: the novel's best-known statement on hypocrisy. The evidence is “No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to…” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3). This develops hypocrisy and truth: the double face. He wonders whether he made "a contract with him in the forest," and the narrator warns that no man can "wear one face to himself and another to the multitude" without losing the true one.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does he write?

A. A new Election Sermon

B. A confession

C. A letter to Hester

D. A will

Key: A (A new Election Sermon)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3: “No man, for any _____ period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true”

Key: considerable

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10: “Did I make a _____ with him in the forest”

Key: contract

20. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which literary element does this describe in “XX: The Minister in a Maze”? He feels a new energy and writes the Election Sermon with fervor.

A. Irony

B. Hyperbole

C. Setting

D. Imagery

Key: A (Irony)

21. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “Did I make a contract with him in the forest” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10) supports it: He wonders whether he made "a contract with him in the forest," and the narrator warns that no man can "wear one face to himself and another to the multitude" without losing the true one. But “No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3) complicates it: The novel's best-known statement on hypocrisy, and its “No” marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. A fair verdict is that the claim is mostly right but overstated; it needs a limiting clause to cover that passage.

22. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] When is the ship due to sail?
    Sample answer: On the fourth day, after the Election Sermon.

23. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 4: "The excitement of Mr. Dimmesdale's feelings, as he returned from his interview with Hester, lent him _____ physical energy, and hurried him townward at a rapid pace." Word bank: instance, familiar, unaccustomed, frequent
    Key: unaccustomed

24. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 6 reveal about the character or situation? "And, even with this terror in his heart, he could hardly avoid laughing, to imagine how the sanctified old patriarchal deacon would have been petrified by his minister's impiety!" Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The passage (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 6) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: the double face. The words "patriarchal" and "sanctified" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

25. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 1 reveal about the character or situation? "So great a vicissitude in his life could not at once be received as real." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The passage (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 1) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: the double face. The words "vicissitude" and "received" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 8 shapes its tone: "Such was his sense of power over this virgin soul, trusting him as she did, that the minister felt potent to blight all the field of innocence with but one wicked look, and develop all its opposite with but a word." Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words "innocence" and "minister" (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 8) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: the double face. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 7 shapes its tone: "Assuredly, as the minister looked back, he beheld an expression of divine gratitude and ecstasy that seemed like the shine of the celestial city on her face, so wrinkled and ashy pale." Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words "expression" and "gratitude" (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 7) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: the double face. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 12 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: "Without taking overmuch upon myself, my good word will go far towards gaining any strange gentleman a fair reception from yonder potentate you wot of!" Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 12) develops hypocrisy and truth: the double face. Its words "gentleman" and "potentate" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "I went not into the forest to seek a potentate; neither do I, at any future time, design a visit thither, with a view…" (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 13), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

29. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 4? “The same was true as regarded the _____ whom he met, and all the well-known shapes of human life, about the little town.”

    A. communicated

    B. acquaintances

    C. civilization

    D. probably

    Key: B (acquaintances)

30. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Which literary element does this describe in “XX: The Minister in a Maze”? Returning to town, Dimmesdale is tempted to blasphemy, to corrupt a young maiden and to curse.

    A. Personification

    B. Characterization

    C. Alliteration

    D. Diction / vocabulary

    Key: B (Characterization)

31. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 4 shapes its tone: “The pathway among the woods seemed wilder, more uncouth with its rude natural obstacles, and less trodden by the foot of man, than he remembered it on his outward journey.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “remembered” and “obstacles” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 4) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: the double face. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Synthesis: trace how hypocrisy and truth develops from XV: Hester and Pearl to XX: The Minister in a Maze. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Earlier, in XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 4, the text reads “Yes, I hate him” — Hester's admission. In XX: The Minister in a Maze, “No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to…” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3), which shows the novel's best-known statement on hypocrisy. The double face.

33. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Not the less, however, came this _____ obtrusive sense of change.” Word bank: importunately, tapestried, irresponsibility, underbrush

    Key: importunately

34. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3 shapes its tone: “The minister had inquired of Hester, with no little interest, the precise time at which the vessel might be expected to depart.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “expected” and “minister” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: the double face. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

35. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 9 to the story's treatment of women and independence: “It was not so much a better principle as

partly his natural good taste, and still more his buckramed habit of clerical decorum, that carried him safely through the latter crisis." Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 9) develops women and independence: the double face. Its words "principle" and "buckramed" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "And does he now summon me to its fulfilment, by suggesting the performance of every wickedness which his most foul…" (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

36. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 4 to the story's treatment of women and independence: "A similar impression struck him most remarkably, as he passed under the walls of his own church." Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 4) develops women and independence: the double face. Its words "impression" and "remarkably" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "This phenomenon, in the various shapes which it assumed, indicated no external change, but so sudden and important a…" (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 5), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

37. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? "Have I then sold myself … to the fiend" (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 16)

A. Why Hester names her Pearl.

B. Dimmesdale after meeting Mistress Hibbins.

C. Pearl and the rose.

D. His imagined ancestors' contempt for him.

Key: B (Dimmesdale after meeting Mistress Hibbins.)

38. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Which word completes this sentence from XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 2? "Hester Prynne—whose vocation, as a self-enlisted Sister of Charity, had brought her acquainted with the captain and crew—could take upon herself to secure the passage of two individuals and a child, with all the secrecy which _____ rendered more than desirable."

A. expecting

B. transformation

C. circumstances

D. intrusive

Key: C (circumstances)

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Connect this passage from XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 6 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: "Before Mr. Dimmesdale reached home, his inner man gave him other evidences of a revolution in the sphere of thought and feeling." Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 6) develops hypocrisy and truth: the double face. Its words "revolution" and "evidences" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "At every step he was incited to do some strange, wild, wicked thing or other, with a sense that it would be at once…" (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 6), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

40. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Which word completes this sentence from XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 6? "He _____ trembled and turned pale as ashes, lest his tongue should wag

itself, in utterance of these horrible matters, and plead his own consent for so doing, without his having fairly given it.”

A. circumstances

B. absolutely

C. yesterday

D. nothing

Key: B (absolutely)

41. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] What does this passage most clearly show? “Did I make a contract with him in the forest” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10)

A. Pearl on the sunshine.

B. First description of the letter.

C. Hester casts off the letter.

D. Dimmesdale fears the Black Man.

Key: D (Dimmesdale fears the Black Man.)

42. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Claim: Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Did I make a contract with him in the forest” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10).

Sample answer: He wonders whether he made "a contract with him in the forest," and the narrator warns that no man can "wear one face to himself and another to the multitude" without losing the true one. The evidence is “Did I make a contract with him in the forest” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10) — Dimmesdale fears the Black Man. This develops hypocrisy and truth: the double face.

43. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: The novel's best-known statement on hypocrisy. The evidence is “No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to…” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3). This develops hypocrisy and truth: the double face. The words “considerable” and “bewildered” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He wonders whether he made "a contract with him in the forest," and the narrator warns that no man can "wear one face to himself and another to the multitude" without losing the true one.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 10, 3, 1, 5, 6, 18, 7, 19, 4, 13, 11, 20, 15, 14, 21	recall 10, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	6, 3, 18, 22, 1, 19, 23, 4, 24, 25, 11, 26, 14, 27, 28, 21	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	17, 9, 29, 18, 2, 1, 24, 11, 25, 13, 30, 27, 26, 31, 32, 21	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	2, 33, 3, 5, 6, 1, 24, 13, 25, 14, 27, 34, 26, 35, 21, 36	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	33, 8, 4, 24, 12, 13, 37, 20, 34, 27, 26, 15, 21, 16, 35, 28	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4

College Freshman	38, 2, 33, 12, 11, 37, 25, 27, 26, 34, 15, 30, 39, 36, 32, 16	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	23, 9, 33, 6, 3, 24, 34, 31, 14, 30, 26, 28, 16, 32, 21, 36	recall 5, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	18, 40, 33, 6, 41, 14, 15, 27, 34, 31, 32, 16, 28, 35, 21, 39	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	1, 33, 8, 6, 15, 27, 31, 42, 20, 28, 35, 39, 16, 36, 32, 21	recall 4, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	29, 33, 8, 6, 3, 15, 31, 34, 32, 43, 36, 16, 28, 35, 39, 21	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 3, synthesis 8

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “XX: The Minister in a Maze,” how does Hawthorne show the minister in a maze? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In XX: The Minister in a Maze, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of the minister in a maze? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how XX: The Minister in a Maze develops the idea of the minister in a maze. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of XX: The Minister in a Maze (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of the minister in a maze. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what XX: The Minister in a Maze suggests about the minister in a maze. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses characterization in XX: The Minister in a Maze to complicate the reader's understanding of the minister in a maze. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate XX: The Minister in a Maze within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the minister in a maze responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read XX: The Minister in a Maze alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the minister in a maze follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to XX: The Minister in a Maze and its treatment of the minister in a maze. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and irony, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads XX: The Minister in a Maze as evidence for a larger claim about the minister in a maze in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads XX: The Minister in a Maze as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the minister in a maze. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

SAT-style questions

1. *But he leaped across the plashy places, thrust himself through the clinging underbrush, climbed the ascent, plunged into the hollow, and overcame, in short, all the difficulties of the track, with an unweariable activity that astonished him.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “underbrush” most nearly mean?

   A. ships that roam the seas

   B. lack of clarity; blurriness

   C. insistently, in a troubling way

   D. shrubs and small plants under forest trees

2. *As the minister departed, in advance of Hester Prynne and little Pearl, he threw a backward glance; half expecting that he should discover only some faintly traced features or outline of the mother and the child, slowly fading into the twilight of the woods. So great a vicissitude in his life could not at once be received as real. But there was Hester, clad in her gray robe, still standing beside the tree-trunk, which some blast had overthrown a long antiquity ago, and which time had ever since been covering with moss, so that these two fated ones, with earth’s heaviest burden on them, might there sit down together, and find a single hour’s rest and solace. And there was Pearl, too, lightly dancing from the margin of the brook—now that the intrusive third person was gone—and taking her old place by her mother’s side. So the minister had not fallen asleep and dreamed!*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “XX: The Minister in a Maze”?

   A. Another view of Hester

   B. The minister in a maze

   C. Hester on the scaffold

D. The frame narrative and the found letter

SAT key: 1. D (shrubs and small plants under forest trees); 2. B (The minister in a maze)

Lesson 24: XXI: The New England Holiday

Focus: the New England holiday

Objective: Students will analyze how setting develops in "XXI: The New England Holiday" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (period depictions of Native people, alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): The holiday crowd includes Native people described as 'savage' in period language. Name the language and discuss whose point of view it reflects. This section mentions drinking or a drug ("…s of womanhood had been perpetually flavored? The wine of life, henceforth to be presented to…"). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: The narrator describes Native people in outdated, prejudiced language.
Suggested language: "How does the narrator's language reflect his time?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Election Day brings a festive crowd: Native people, sailors and townsfolk. Hester's face is calm, as if this were the last day of her ordeal. The ship's captain tells her that Chillingworth has booked passage on the same ship. Chillingworth smiles at her across the square.

Background: Election Day was one of the few public holidays Puritans allowed; Hawthorne notes they were still English in their pleasures.

Significance: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How do celebrations show what a community values? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to public shame and private identity because.... Content note before we start: The narrator describes Native people in outdated, prejudiced language.
Prompt: How do celebrations show what a community values?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to public shame and private identity because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: bondslave — a slave; one bound to serve; desperadoes — bold, reckless lawbreakers; galliard — lively and bold; jocularity — joking; fun; inquietude — restlessness; uneasiness. "bondslave": Origin: an English formation from bond + slave.
Words: bondslave: a slave; one bound to serve · desperadoes: bold, reckless lawbreakers · galliard: lively and bold · jocularity: joking; fun · inquietude: restlessness; uneasiness

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Election Day was one of the few public holidays Puritans allowed; Hawthorne notes they were still English in their pleasures. Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. Setting: Election Day: a holiday crowd, sailors, Indians and townspeople in the marketplace. Irony: Hester learns that Chillingworth has taken passage on the same ship. Characterization: Hester's face is like a mask; she expects to be free soon. Watch for the scarlet letter: The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "other occasions, for seven years past, Hester was clad in a garment of coarse gray cloth. Not more by its hue than" (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 2).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Hester was clad in a garment of coarse gray cloth" slowly and put it in my own words: On the public holiday, Hester wears the same coarse gray garment she has worn for seven years. Next, craft. I notice the contrast between a festive day and her unchanging dull dress. The strongest word is "coarse": it shows the rough, humble clothing she has accepted as part of her penance. Then, effect. Why does the narrator stress Hester's plain gray clothes at the holiday? My answer: The narrator stresses Hester's plain gray clothes at the holiday because they make her almost invisible while the letter still stands out; secretly she is planning to escape, so her calm look hides a great change.

> *Hester was clad in a garment of coarse gray cloth (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 2)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Hester was clad in a garment of coarse gray cloth" slowly and put it in my own words: On the public holiday, Hester wears the same coarse gray garment she has worn for seven years. Next, craft. I notice the contrast between a festive day and her unchanging dull dress. The strongest word is "coarse": it shows the rough, humble clothing she has accepted as part of her penance. Then, effect. Why does the narrator stress Hester's plain gray clothes at the holiday? My answer: The narrator stresses Hester's plain gray clothes at the holiday because they make her almost invisible while the letter still stands out; secretly she is planning to escape, so her calm look hides a great change.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Chillingworth's smile across the square shows he still controls their fate. Expected link: irony; sin and guilt. Ask: How does this line connect to public shame and private identity? Expected: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks. (The shipmaster's news.)

> *that this physician here—Chillingworth, he calls himself—is minded to try my cabin-fare with you (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 24)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Chillingworth's smile across the square shows he still controls their fate. Expected link: irony; sin and guilt.
Ask: How does this line connect to public shame and private identity?
Expected answer: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks. (The shipmaster's news.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for setting, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the New England holiday? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XXI: The New England Holiday develops the idea of the New England holiday. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. When the text says "that this physician here—Chillingworth, he calls himself—is minded to try my cabin-fare with you" (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 24), it shows this directly. The shipmaster reveals that "Chillingworth, he calls himself" will sail with them, and Hester sees him "smiling on her" across the square.
Task: Annotate the chapter for setting, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the New England holiday? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XXI: The New England Holiday develops the idea of the New England holiday. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. When the text says "that this physician here—Chillingworth, he calls himself—is minded to try my cabin-fare with you" (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 24), it shows this directly. The shipmaster reveals that "Chillingworth, he calls himself" will sail with them, and Hester sees him "smiling on her" across the square.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: How do celebrations show what a community values? Ask: what does the holiday tell us about Puritan society?
Anchor question: How do celebrations show what a community values?
Facilitation: Ask: what does the holiday tell us about Puritan society?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the New England holiday? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. (“that this physician here—Chillingworth, he calls himself—is minded to try my cabin-fare with you”, XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 24). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the New England holiday? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. (“that this physician here—Chillingworth, he calls himself—is minded to try my cabin-fare with you”, XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 24). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how setting shapes the New England holiday. Key takeaway: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Setting:** Election Day: a holiday crowd, sailors, Indians and townspeople in the marketplace.
- **Irony:** Hester learns that Chillingworth has taken passage on the same ship.
- **Characterization:** Hester's face is like a mask; she expects to be free soon.

Themes and how they develop

- **public shame and private identity:** Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks.

Symbols and motifs

- **the scarlet letter:** The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: “other occasions, for seven years past, Hester was clad in a garment of coarse gray cloth. Not more by its hue than” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 2).
- **light and darkness:** Sunshine avoids Hester but plays around Pearl; the forest is dim; the minister's vigil happens at midnight under a meteor. In this chapter: “the child, as if speaking partly to herself. “In the dark nighttime he calls us to him, and holds thy hand and” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 12).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Hester was clad in a garment of coarse gray cloth” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 2) Hester's appearance on the holiday.
- “that this physician here—Chillingworth, he calls himself—is minded to try my cabin-fare with you” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 24) The shipmaster's news.
- “she beheld old Roger Chillingworth himself, standing in the remotest corner of the marketplace, and smiling on her” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 26) Chillingworth's smile.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan.
Evidence: “that this physician here—Chillingworth, he calls himself—is minded to try my cabin-fare with you” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 24)
Reasoning: The shipmaster reveals that "Chillingworth, he calls himself" will sail with them, and Hester sees him "smiling on her" across the square.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
bondslave (noun)	a slave; one bound to serve	*“Look your last on the scarlet letter and its wearer!”—the people’s victim and lifelong bondslave, as they fancied her, might say to them.*	“bondslave”: Origin: an English formation from bond + slave. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/bondslave#Etymology)
desperadoes (noun)	bold, reckless lawbreakers	*They were rough-looking desperadoes, with sun-blackened faces, and an immensity of beard; their wide, short trousers were confined about the waist by belts, often clasped with a rough plate of gold, and sustaining always a long knife, and, in some instances, a sword.*	
galliard (adjective)	lively and bold	*A landsman could hardly have worn this garb and shown this face, and worn and shown them both with such a galliard air, without undergoing stern question before a magistrate, and probably incurring fine or imprisonment, or perhaps an exhibition in the stocks.*	
jocularity (noun)	joking; fun	*All such professors of the several branches of jocularity would have been sternly repressed, not only by the rigid discipline of law, but by the general sentiment which gives law its vitality.*	

inquietude (noun)	restlessness; uneasiness	*On this eventful day, moreover, there was a certain singular inquietude and excitement in her mood, resembling nothing so much as the shimmer of a diamond, that sparkles and flashes with the varied throbbings of the breast on which it is displayed.*	

Discussion questions

1. How do celebrations show what a community values?
2. Where does setting appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with hypocrisy and truth?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. How is Pearl dressed? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: In bright, airy finery.
2. What day is it? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Election Day
3. What does Hester feel? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: That her ordeal will soon be over
4. Who has booked passage? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Chillingworth
5. Who tells Hester? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The ship's captain
6. What groups are in the crowd? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Native people, sailors and townspeople
7. Retell the three most important events of "XXI: The New England Holiday" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Election Day brings a festive crowd: Native people, sailors and townsfolk. Hester's face is calm, as if this were the last day of her ordeal. The ship's captain tells her that Chillingworth has booked passage on the same ship. Chillingworth smiles at her across the square.
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "XXI: The New England Holiday"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "XXI: The New England Holiday" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: ""Look your last on the scarlet letter and its wearer!"—the people's victim and lifelong bondslave, as they fancied her, might say to them." What does "bondslave" mean here, and what is literally happening

in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: bondslave: a slave; one bound to serve.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Chillingworth smile? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: He has blocked their escape.
2. What does "XXI: The New England Holiday" suggest about the New England holiday? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan.
3. Find one example of setting in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
4. How does the irony in this chapter shape what we understand about the New England holiday? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. Useful evidence: "Hester was clad in a garment of coarse gray cloth" (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 2): Hester's appearance on the holiday. On irony: Hester learns that Chillingworth has taken passage on the same ship. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "Betimes in the morning of the day on which the new Governor was to receive his office at the hands of the people, Hester Prynne and little Pearl came into the marketplace.", why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "XXI: The New England Holiday", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Election Day brings a festive crowd: Native people, sailors and townsfolk. Hester's face is calm, as if this were the last day of her ordeal. The ship's captain tells her that Chillingworth has booked passage on the same ship. Chillingworth smiles at her across the square.
7. How does "XXI: The New England Holiday" build on "XX: The Minister in a Maze"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. Useful evidence: "that this physician here—Chillingworth, he calls himself—is minded to try my cabin-fare with you" (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 24): The shipmaster's news. Theme link: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. Useful evidence: "she beheld old Roger Chillingworth himself, standing in the remotest corner of the marketplace, and smiling on her" (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 26): Chillingworth's smile.

On characterization: Hester's face is like a mask; she expects to be free soon. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: "How do celebrations show what a community values?" Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with hypocrisy and truth? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. Useful evidence: "Hester was clad in a garment of coarse gray cloth" (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 2): Hester's appearance on the holiday. On characterization: Hester's face is like a mask; she expects to be free soon. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. What does the holiday reveal about Puritan society? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. Useful evidence: "that this physician here—Chillingworth, he calls himself—is minded to try my cabin-fare with you" (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 24): The shipmaster's news. Theme link: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: "Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. Useful evidence: "she beheld old Roger Chillingworth himself, standing in the remotest corner of the marketplace, and smiling on her" (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 26): Chillingworth's smile. Theme link: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. Useful evidence: "Hester was clad in a garment of coarse gray cloth" (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 2): Hester's appearance on the holiday. On characterization: Hester's face is like a mask; she expects to be free soon. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Rewrite one moment of "XXI: The New England Holiday" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the New England holiday? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. Useful evidence: "that this physician here—Chillingworth, he calls himself—is minded to try my cabin-fare

with you" (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 24): The shipmaster's news. Theme link: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about "XXI: The New England Holiday": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. Useful evidence: "she beheld old Roger Chillingworth himself, standing in the remotest corner of the marketplace, and smiling on her" (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 26): Chillingworth's smile. Theme link: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to nature and the individual against society: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. Useful evidence: "Hester was clad in a garment of coarse gray cloth" (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 2): Hester's appearance on the holiday. Theme link: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the setting in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. Useful evidence: "that this physician here—Chillingworth, he calls himself—is minded to try my cabin-fare with you" (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 24): The shipmaster's news. On setting: Election Day: a holiday crowd, sailors, Indians and townspeople in the marketplace. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how "XXI: The New England Holiday" treats the New England holiday with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. Useful evidence: "she beheld old Roger Chillingworth himself, standing in the remotest corner of the marketplace, and smiling on her" (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 26): Chillingworth's smile. Theme link: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what "XXII: The Procession" will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. Useful evidence: "Hester was clad in a garment of coarse gray cloth" (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 2): Hester's appearance on the holiday. Theme link: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the New England holiday? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. Useful evidence: “that this physician here—Chillingworth, he calls himself—is minded to try my cabin-fare with you” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 24): The shipmaster's news. Theme link: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “On this eventful day, moreover, there was a certain singular _____ and excitement in her mood, resembling nothing so much as the shimmer of a diamond, that sparkles and flashes with the varied throbbings of the breast on which it is displayed.” Word bank: bondslave, desperadoes, inquietude, galliard
    Key: inquietude
2. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How is Pearl dressed?
    Sample answer: In bright, airy finery.
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “They were rough-looking desperadoes, with sun-blackened faces, and an immensity of beard; their wide, short trousers were confined about the waist by belts, often clasped with a rough plate of gold, and sustaining…”, what does “desperadoes” most nearly mean?
    A. bold, reckless lawbreakers
    B. never having happened before
    C. dressing in fine clothes
    D. unpredictable and odd
    Key: A (bold, reckless lawbreakers)
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “‘Look your last on the scarlet letter and its wearer!’—the people’s victim and lifelong bondslave, as they fancied her, might say to them.”, what does “bondslave” most nearly mean?
    A. the system of coats of arms
    B. a slave; one bound to serve
    C. a source that never runs dry
    D. shakily, nervously
    Key: B (a slave; one bound to serve)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 26: "she beheld old Roger Chillingworth himself, standing in the remotest corner of the _____, and smiling on her"

   Key: marketplace

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What groups are in the crowd?

   A. Only soldiers
   B. Native people, sailors and townspeople
   C. Only children
   D. Only ministers

   Key: B (Native people, sailors and townspeople)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who has booked passage?

   A. Bellingham
   B. Chillingworth
   C. Wilson
   D. Pearl alone

   Key: B (Chillingworth)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "All such professors of the several branches of jocularity would have been sternly repressed, not only by the rigid discipline of law, but by the general sentiment which gives law its vitality.", what does "jocularity" most nearly mean?

   A. joking; fun
   B. insistently, in a troubling way
   C. proof or confirmation
   D. being a sign of

   Key: A (joking; fun)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Hester feel?

   A. Afraid
   B. That her ordeal will soon be over
   C. Joyful
   D. Bored

   Key: B (That her ordeal will soon be over)

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "A landsman could hardly have worn this garb and shown this face, and worn and shown them both with such a galliard air, without undergoing stern question before a magistrate, and probably incurring fine or imprisonment,…", what does "galliard" most nearly mean?

    A. carrying too heavy a load
    B. lively and bold
    C. without proper respect
    D. marked out as shameful

    Key: B (lively and bold)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “that this physician here—Chillingworth, he calls himself—is minded to try my cabin-fare with you” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 24) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The shipmaster's news. The evidence is “that this physician here—Chillingworth, he calls himself—is minded to try my cabin-fare with you” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 24). This develops public shame and private identity: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks.
12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Chillingworth smile?
    Sample answer: He has blocked their escape: the shipmaster's news. The evidence is “that this physician here—Chillingworth, he calls himself—is minded to try my cabin-fare with you” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 24).
13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Hester was clad in a garment of coarse gray cloth” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 2) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Hester's appearance on the holiday. The evidence is “Hester was clad in a garment of coarse gray cloth” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 2). This develops public shame and private identity: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks.
14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks.
    A. Hypocrisy and truth
    B. Sin and guilt
    C. Nature and the individual against society
    D. Public shame and private identity

    Key: D (Public shame and private identity)
15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which literary element does this describe in “XXI: The New England Holiday”? Hester learns that Chillingworth has taken passage on the same ship.
    A. Diction / vocabulary
    B. Irony
    C. Hyperbole
    D. Allusion

    Key: B (Irony)
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how public shame and private identity develops from XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side to XXI: The New England Holiday. Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Earlier, in XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 21, the text reads “there lay the scarlet letter, so close upon the margin of the stream, that the gold embroidery was reflected in it”, which shows the letter at the brook's edge. In XXI: The New England Holiday, “Hester was clad in a garment of coarse gray cloth” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 2) — Hester's appearance on the holiday. Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks.
17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 2: “Hester was clad in a _____ of coarse gray cloth”
    Key: garment
18. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 5: “She broke continually into shouts of a wild, _____, and sometimes piercing music.” Word

bank: inarticulate, marketplace, forehead, clothes

Key: inarticulate

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 8? “He may nod at thee, if he will; for thou art clad in gray, and _____ the scarlet letter.”

    A. wearest

    B. people

    C. forehead

    D. irresistible

    Key: A (wearest)

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who tells Hester?

    A. The ship's captain

    B. Dimmesdale

    C. Pearl

    D. Mistress Hibbins

    Key: A (The ship's captain)

21. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 9 reveal about the character or situation? “For the Governor and the magistrates are to go by, and the ministers, and all the great people and good people, with the music and the soldiers marching before them.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 9) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks. The words “magistrates” and “ministers” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

22. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 18 reveal about the character or situation? “Nor, wild as were these painted barbarians, were they the wildest feature of the scene.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 18) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks. The words “barbarians” and “wildest” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 19 shapes its tone: “But the sea, in those old times, heaved, swelled, and foamed, very much at its own will, or subject only to the tempestuous wind, with hardly any attempts at regulation by human law.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “tempestuous” and “regulation” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 19) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “XXI: The New England Holiday”? Election Day: a holiday crowd, sailors, Indians and townspeople in the marketplace.

    A. Setting

    B. Theme

    C. Simile

D. Alliteration

Key: A (Setting)

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 16 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: “Wrestling-matches, in the different fashions of Cornwall and Devonshire, were seen here and there about the marketplace” Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 16) develops hypocrisy and truth: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks. Its words “marketplace” and “different” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Their immediate posterity, the generation next to the early emigrants, wore the blackest shade of Puritanism, and so…” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 17), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

26. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 24: “that this _____ here—Chillingworth, he calls himself—is minded to try my cabin-fare with you”

Key: physician

27. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 12: “And he kisses my _____, too, so that the little brook would hardly wash it off!” Word bank: wearest, indescribable, forehead, marketplace

Key: forehead

28. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in XXI: The New England Holiday?

A. “It was already thronged with the craftsmen and other plebeian inhabitants of the town, in considerable numbers”

B. “Her face, so long familiar to the townspeople, showed the marble quietude which they were accustomed to behold there.”

C. “Betimes in the morning of the day on which the new Governor was to receive his office at the hands of the people, Hester Prynne and little…”

D. “Not more by its hue than by some indescribable peculiarity in its fashion, it had the effect of making her fade personally out of sight and…”

Key: C (“Betimes in the morning of the day on which the new Governor was to receive his office at the hands of the people, Hester Prynne and little…”)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 2 shapes its tone: “Her face, so long familiar to the townspeople, showed the marble quietude which they were accustomed to behold there.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “townspeople” and “accustomed” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 2) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 15 shapes its tone: “But we perhaps exaggerate the gray or sable tinge, which undoubtedly characterized the mood and manners of the age.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “characterized” and “undoubtedly” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 15) make the

tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 1: “Betimes in the morning of the day on which the new Governor was to receive his office at the hands of the people, Hester Prynne and little Pearl came into the _____.” Word bank: strange, irresistible, marketplace, forehead
    Key: marketplace

32. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 12 shapes its tone: “But here, in the sunny day, and among all the people, he knows us not; nor must we know him!” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “people” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 12) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

33. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: Hester's hope of escape meets Chillingworth's plan. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “that this physician here—Chillingworth, he calls himself—is minded to try my cabin-fare with you” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 24).
    Sample answer: The shipmaster reveals that "Chillingworth, he calls himself" will sail with them, and Hester sees him "smiling on her" across the square. The evidence is “that this physician here—Chillingworth, he calls himself—is minded to try my cabin-fare with you” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 24) — The shipmaster's news. This develops public shame and private identity: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks.

34. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does the holiday reveal about Puritan society? Argue.
    Sample answer: A reasoned view: Hester's appearance on the holiday. The evidence is “Hester was clad in a garment of coarse gray cloth” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 2). This develops public shame and private identity: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks. The shipmaster reveals that "Chillingworth, he calls himself" will sail with them, and Hester sees him "smiling on her" across the square.

35. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 6 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: “Is it a play-day for the whole world?” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 6) develops hypocrisy and truth: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks. Its words its wording carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “And there is Master Brackett, the old jailer, nodding and smiling at me.” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 6), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

36. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Hester was clad in a garment of coarse gray cloth” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 2) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Hester's appearance on the holiday. The evidence is “Hester was clad in a garment of coarse gray cloth” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 2). This develops public shame and private identity: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks. The words “garment” and “coarse” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The shipmaster reveals that "Chillingworth, he calls himself" will sail with them, and Hester sees him "smiling on her" across the square.

37. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] What does this passage most clearly show? “Hester was clad in a garment of coarse gray cloth” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 2)

    A. Mistress Hibbins to Pearl.

    B. Hester's appearance on the holiday.

    C. The end of the chapter.

    D. The letter's mysterious power.

    Key: B (Hester's appearance on the holiday.)

38. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Analyze the word choice in “she beheld old Roger Chillingworth himself, standing in the remotest corner of the marketplace, and smiling on her” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 26). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Chillingworth's smile. The evidence is “she beheld old Roger Chillingworth himself, standing in the remotest corner of the marketplace, and smiling on her” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 26). This develops public shame and private identity: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks. The words “marketplace” and “remotest” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Connect this passage from XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 4 to the story's treatment of women and independence: “As with these, so with the child; her garb was all of one idea with her nature.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 4) develops women and independence: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks. Its words “nature” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “This effervescence made her flit with a birdlike movement, rather than walk by her mother’s side.” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 5), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

40. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] What day is it?

    A. Election Day

    B. The Sabbath

    C. Christmas

    D. Thanksgiving

    Key: A (Election Day)

41. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Connect this passage from XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 15 to the story's treatment of women and independence: “The fathers and founders of the commonwealth—the statesman, the priest, and the soldier—deemed it a duty then to assume the outward state and majesty, which, in accordance with antique style, was looked upon as the proper garb of public or…” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 15) develops women and independence: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks. Its words “commonwealth” and “accordance” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Then, too, the people were countenanced, if not encouraged, in relaxing the severe and close application to their…” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 16), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

42. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “that this physician here—Chillingworth, he calls himself—is minded to try my cabin-fare with you” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 24) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The shipmaster's news. The evidence is “that this physician here—Chillingworth, he calls himself—is

minded to try my cabin-fare with you" (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 24). This develops public shame and private identity: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks. The words "physician" and "himself" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The shipmaster reveals that "Chillingworth, he calls himself" will sail with them, and Hester sees him "smiling on her" across the square.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 2, 10, 18, 19, 20, 3, 8, 13, 12, 21, 22, 23, 14, 24, 25	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	17, 26, 20, 19, 18, 27, 22, 21, 12, 11, 28, 14, 29, 30, 25, 16	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	10, 4, 2, 7, 5, 31, 21, 22, 12, 28, 30, 14, 32, 24, 16, 25	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	9, 27, 26, 8, 19, 21, 12, 22, 28, 14, 30, 23, 33, 34, 35, 36	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	1, 27, 3, 28, 21, 22, 12, 29, 24, 30, 14, 23, 36, 25, 34, 35	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	1, 17, 8, 22, 12, 21, 28, 23, 24, 14, 29, 30, 36, 35, 34, 25	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	20, 17, 1, 37, 28, 21, 38, 23, 29, 24, 30, 16, 35, 39, 34, 25	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	18, 26, 40, 28, 22, 32, 29, 14, 15, 23, 25, 16, 35, 34, 41, 39	recall 3, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	31, 1, 40, 28, 29, 14, 38, 30, 15, 25, 34, 36, 16, 39, 41, 35	recall 3, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	20, 1, 17, 40, 14, 24, 32, 29, 23, 41, 39, 34, 16, 25, 42, 35	recall 4, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 7

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "XXI: The New England Holiday," how does Hawthorne show the New England holiday? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In XXI: The New England Holiday, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of the New England holiday? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how XXI: The New England Holiday develops the idea of the New England holiday. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of XXI: The New England Holiday (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of the New England holiday. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what XXI: The New England Holiday suggests about the New England holiday. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's setting and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses setting in XXI: The New England Holiday to complicate the reader's understanding of the New England holiday. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate XXI: The New England Holiday within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the New England holiday responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read XXI: The New England Holiday alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the New England holiday follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to XXI: The New England Holiday and its treatment of the New England holiday. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's setting and irony, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads XXI: The New England Holiday as evidence for a larger claim about the New England holiday in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads XXI: The New England Holiday as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the New England holiday. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

SAT-style questions

1. *"Look your last on the scarlet letter and its wearer!"—the people's victim and lifelong bondslave, as they fancied her, might say to them.*

As used in the text, what does the word "bondslave" most nearly mean?

A. restlessness; uneasiness

B. lively and bold

C. joking; fun

D. a slave; one bound to serve

2. *Betimes in the morning of the day on which the new Governor was to receive his office at the hands of the people, Hester Prynne and little Pearl came into the marketplace. It was already thronged with the craftsmen and other plebeian inhabitants of the town, in considerable numbers; among whom, likewise, were many rough figures, whose attire of deerskins marked them as belonging to some of the forest settlements, which surrounded the little metropolis of the colony.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "XXI: The New England Holiday"?

A. The procession

B. The pastor and his parishioner

C. The New England holiday

D. Hester on the scaffold

SAT key: 1. D (a slave; one bound to serve); 2. C (The New England holiday)

Lesson 25: XXII: The Procession

Focus: the procession

Objective: Students will analyze how setting develops in “XXII: The Procession” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

The procession passes; Dimmesdale walks with strange energy and seems far from Hester. Mistress Hibbins tells Hester she knows the minister's secret. Hester stands by the scaffold listening to the sermon's tone through the meetinghouse walls. Pearl brings the captain's message: Chillingworth will bring the minister aboard.

Background: The meetinghouse served as church and town hall in Puritan Boston.

Significance: The lovers stand at opposite poles of public life.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Can you feel far from someone who is close by? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to public shame and private identity because....
Prompt: Can you feel far from someone who is close by?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to public shame and private identity because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: illuminates — lights up; morions — open metal helmets worn by soldiers; honorary — given as an honor; centrifugal — pushing outward from a center; stomacher — a decorated panel on the front of a woman's bodice. “illuminates”: Origin of “illuminate”: Latin illūmināt-us. “morions”: Origin of “morion”: Middle French morion. “honorary”: Origin: Latin honōrārius. “centrifugal”: Origin: New Latin centrifugālis; earlier Latin centrum (“center”).
Words: illuminates: lights up · morions: open metal helmets worn by soldiers · honorary: given as an honor · centrifugal: pushing outward from a center · stomacher: a decorated panel on the front of a woman's bodice

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The meetinghouse served as church and town hall in Puritan Boston. The lovers stand at opposite poles of public life. Characterization: Dimmesdale marches in the procession with unusual energy; Hester feels he is far beyond her reach. Setting: The marketplace, the meetinghouse and the scaffold where Hester stands while he preaches. Irony: Mistress Hibbins tells Hester she knows the minister's secret, and Pearl reports the shipmaster's message. Watch for the scarlet letter: The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "affairs, the sound of military music was heard approaching along a contiguous street. It denoted the advance of the procession of magistrates" (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 1).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "We must not always talk in the marketplace of what happens to us in the forest" slowly and put it in my own words: Hester tells Pearl they must not talk in the marketplace about what happens in the forest. Next, craft. I notice the two places stand for two worlds: the town's public law and the private freedom of the woods. The strongest word is "forest": it stands for the hidden, natural life where she and Dimmesdale were honest with each other. Then, effect. What does Hester mean by keeping the forest out of the marketplace? My answer: By keeping the forest out of the marketplace, Hester means their private plans from the forest must stay hidden in town; the line shows how secrecy divides private truth from public life.

> *We must not always talk in the marketplace of what happens to us in the forest (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 9)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "We must not always talk in the marketplace of what happens to us in the forest" slowly and put it in my own words: Hester tells Pearl they must not talk in the marketplace about what happens in the forest. Next, craft. I notice the two places stand for two worlds: the town's public law and the private freedom of the woods. The strongest word is "forest": it stands for the hidden, natural life where she and Dimmesdale were honest with each other. Then, effect. What does Hester mean by keeping the forest out of the marketplace? My answer: By keeping the forest out of the marketplace, Hester means their private plans from the forest must stay hidden in town; the line shows how secrecy divides private truth from public life.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Mistress Hibbins hints at the minister's secret. Expected link: irony; hypocrisy and truth. Ask: How does this line connect to public shame and private identity? Expected: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit. (Mistress Hibbins to Pearl.)

> *thou shalt know wherefore the minister keeps his hand over his heart (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 17)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Mistress Hibbins hints at the minister's secret. Expected link: irony; hypocrisy and truth.
Ask: How does this line connect to public shame and private identity?
Expected answer: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit. (Mistress Hibbins to Pearl.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for characterization, setting (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the procession? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XXII: The Procession develops the idea of the procession. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life. When the text says “The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 30), it shows this directly. Hester must stand in the marketplace while the minister preaches, the contrast the narrator draws: "The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace!"
Task: Annotate the chapter for characterization, setting (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the procession? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XXII: The Procession develops the idea of the procession. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life. When the text says “The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 30), it shows this directly. Hester must stand in the marketplace while the minister preaches, the contrast the narrator draws: "The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace!"

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Can you feel far from someone who is close by? Ask: what does Hester hear in the sermon without understanding its words?
Anchor question: Can you feel far from someone who is close by?
Facilitation: Ask: what does Hester hear in the sermon without understanding its words?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the procession? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life. ("The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace", XXII: The Procession, paragraph 30). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the procession? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life. ("The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace", XXII: The Procession, paragraph 30). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes the procession. Key takeaway: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Dimmesdale marches in the procession with unusual energy; Hester feels he is far beyond her reach.
- **Setting:** The marketplace, the meetinghouse and the scaffold where Hester stands while he preaches.
- **Irony:** Mistress Hibbins tells Hester she knows the minister's secret, and Pearl reports the shipmaster's message.

Themes and how they develop

- **public shame and private identity:** Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit.

Symbols and motifs

- **the scarlet letter:** The embroidered "A" changes meaning as the town and the reader watch it: adultery, then "Able," then something like "Angel," and finally an emblem Hester chooses to keep. In this chapter: "affairs, the sound of military music was heard approaching along a contiguous street. It denoted the advance of the procession of magistrates" (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 1).
- **light and darkness:** Sunshine avoids Hester but plays around Pearl; the forest is dim; the minister's vigil happens at midnight under a meteor. In this chapter: "back to her former mood by the shimmer of

the sunshine on the weapons and bright armor of the military company, which" (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 2).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "We must not always talk in the marketplace of what happens to us in the forest" (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 9) Hester to Pearl: town against forest.
- "thou shalt know wherefore the minister keeps his hand over his heart" (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 17) Mistress Hibbins to Pearl.
- "The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace" (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 30) The chapter's contrast.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life.
Evidence: "The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace" (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 30)
Reasoning: Hester must stand in the marketplace while the minister preaches, the contrast the narrator draws: "The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace!"

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
illuminates (verb)	lights up	*She made the sombre crowd cheerful by her erratic and glistening ray; even as a bird of bright plumage illuminates a whole tree of dusky foliage, by darting to and fro, half seen and half concealed amid the twilight of the clustering leaves.*	"illuminates": Origin of "illuminate": Latin illūmināt**us**. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/illuminate#Etymology)
morions (noun)	open metal helmets worn by soldiers	*The entire array, moreover, clad in burnished steel, and with plumage nodding over their bright morions, had a brilliancy of effect which no modern display can aspire to equal.*	"morions": Origin of "morion": Middle French morion. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/morion#Etymology)
honorary (adjective)	given as an honor	*But she was brought back to her former mood by the shimmer of the sunshine on the weapons and bright armor of the military company, which followed after the music, and formed the honorary escort of the procession.*	"honorary": Origin: Latin honōrārius. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/honorary#Etymology)
centrifugal (adjective)	pushing outward from a center	*At that distance they accordingly stood, fixed there by the centrifugal force of the repugnance which the mystic symbol inspired.*	"centrifugal": Origin: New Latin centrifugālis; earlier Latin centrum ("center"). (Liber et Libri origin note,

			https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/centrifugal#Etymology)
stomacher (noun)	a decorated panel on the front of a woman's bodice	*It was Mistress Hibbins, who, arrayed in great magnificence, with a triple ruff, a broidered stomacher, a gown of rich velvet, and a gold-headed cane, had come forth to see the procession.*	
ministrations (noun)	acts of care or service	*It might be spiritual, and imparted to him by angelic ministrations.*	
intentness (noun)	close, focused attention	*Muffled as the sound was by its passage through the church-walls, Hester Prynne listened with such intentness, and sympathized so intimately, that the sermon had throughout a meaning for her, entirely apart from its indistinguishable words.*	

Discussion questions

1. Can you feel far from someone who is close by?
2. Where does setting appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with nature and the individual against society?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Hester hear of the sermon? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The tone and cadence, not the words.
2. How does Dimmesdale walk in the procession? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: With unusual energy
3. How does Hester feel? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: That he is far from her
4. Who claims to know the secret? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Mistress Hibbins
5. Where does Hester stand during the sermon? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: By the scaffold

6. What message does Pearl bring? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Chillingworth will bring the minister aboard
7. Retell the three most important events of "XXII: The Procession" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The procession passes; Dimmesdale walks with strange energy and seems far from Hester. Mistress Hibbins tells Hester she knows the minister's secret. Hester stands by the scaffold listening to the sermon's tone through the meetinghouse walls. Pearl brings the captain's message: Chillingworth will bring the minister aboard.
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "XXII: The Procession"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "XXII: The Procession" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: "She made the sombre crowd cheerful by her erratic and glistening ray; even as a bird of bright plumage illuminates a whole tree of dusky foliage, by darting to and fro, half seen and half concealed amid the twilight of…" What does "illuminates" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: illuminates: lights up.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Mistress Hibbins's talk unsettle Hester? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: She seems to know the forest meeting.
2. What does "XXII: The Procession" suggest about the procession? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The lovers stand at opposite poles of public life.
3. Find one example of setting in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
4. How does the irony in this chapter shape what we understand about the procession? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life. Useful evidence: "We must not always talk in the marketplace of what happens to us in the forest" (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 9): Hester to Pearl: town against forest. On irony: Mistress Hibbins tells Hester she knows the minister's secret, and Pearl reports the shipmaster's message. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "Before Hester Prynne could call together her thoughts, and consider what was practicable to be done in this new and startling aspect of affairs, the sound of military music was…", why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "XXII: The Procession", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: The procession passes; Dimmesdale walks with strange energy and seems far from Hester. Mistress Hibbins tells Hester she knows the minister's secret. Hester stands by the scaffold listening to the sermon's tone through the meetinghouse walls. Pearl brings the captain's message: Chillingworth will…

7. How does “XXII: The Procession” build on “XXI: The New England Holiday”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life. Useful evidence: “thou shalt know wherefore the minister keeps his hand over his heart” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 17): Mistress Hibbins to Pearl. Theme link: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life. Useful evidence: “The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 30): The chapter's contrast. On characterization: Dimmesdale marches in the procession with unusual energy; Hester feels he is far beyond her reach. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Can you feel far from someone who is close by?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with nature and the individual against society? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life. Useful evidence: “We must not always talk in the marketplace of what happens to us in the forest” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 9): Hester to Pearl: town against forest. On characterization: Dimmesdale marches in the procession with unusual energy; Hester feels he is far beyond her reach. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. What does the contrast of pulpit and scaffold suggest? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life. Useful evidence: “thou shalt know wherefore the minister keeps his hand over his heart” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 17): Mistress Hibbins to Pearl. Theme link: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The lovers stand at opposite poles of public life.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life. Useful evidence: “The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the

marketplace” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 30): The chapter's contrast. Theme link: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life. Useful evidence: “We must not always talk in the marketplace of what happens to us in the forest” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 9): Hester to Pearl: town against forest. On characterization: Dimmesdale marches in the procession with unusual energy; Hester feels he is far beyond her reach. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Rewrite one moment of “XXII: The Procession” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the procession? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life. Useful evidence: “thou shalt know wherefore the minister keeps his hand over his heart” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 17): Mistress Hibbins to Pearl. Theme link: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “XXII: The Procession”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life. Useful evidence: “The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 30): The chapter's contrast. Theme link: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to women and independence: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life. Useful evidence: “We must not always talk in the marketplace of what happens to us in the forest” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 9): Hester to Pearl: town against forest. Theme link: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the setting in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life. Useful evidence: “thou shalt know wherefore the minister keeps his hand over his heart” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 17): Mistress Hibbins to Pearl. On setting: The marketplace, the

meetinghouse and the scaffold where Hester stands while he preaches. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “XXII: The Procession” treats the procession with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life. Useful evidence: “The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 30): The chapter's contrast. Theme link: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life. Useful evidence: “We must not always talk in the marketplace of what happens to us in the forest” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 9): Hester to Pearl: town against forest. Theme link: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the procession? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life. Useful evidence: “thou shalt know wherefore the minister keeps his hand over his heart” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 17): Mistress Hibbins to Pearl. Theme link: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What message does Pearl bring?

   A. Dimmesdale is ill

   B. Chillingworth will bring the minister aboard

   C. The ship has left

   D. The governor wants Hester

   Key: B (Chillingworth will bring the minister aboard)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "It might be spiritual, and imparted to him by angelic _____." Word bank: morions, honorary, illuminates, ministrations
   Key: ministrations
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Muffled as the sound was by its passage through the church-walls, Hester Prynne listened with such _____, and sympathized so intimately, that the sermon had throughout a meaning for her, entirely apart from its indistinguishable words." Word bank: honorary, morions, intentness, illuminates
   Key: intentness
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from XXII: The Procession, paragraph 6? "One glance of _____, she had imagined, must needs pass between them."
   A. occasional
   B. recognition
   C. represented
   D. marketplace

   Key: B (recognition)
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "The entire array, moreover, clad in burnished steel, and with plumage nodding over their bright morions, had a brilliancy of effect which no modern display can aspire to equal.", what does "morions" most nearly mean?
   A. devilish
   B. slowly decay into dust
   C. open metal helmets worn by soldiers
   D. is right or necessary for

   Key: C (open metal helmets worn by soldiers)
6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from XXII: The Procession, paragraph 1: "Before Hester Prynne could call together her thoughts, and consider what was _____ to be done in this new and startling aspect of affairs, the sound of military music was heard approaching along a contiguous street." Word bank: marketplace, occasional, immediately, practicable
   Key: practicable
7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XXII: The Procession, paragraph 30: "The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the _____"
   Key: marketplace
8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who claims to know the secret?
   A. The sexton
   B. Mistress Hibbins
   C. The captain
   D. Bellingham

   Key: B (Mistress Hibbins)
9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XXII: The Procession, paragraph 17: "thou shalt know _____ the minister keeps his hand over his heart"
   Key: wherefore

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from XXII: The Procession, paragraph 2? “The high _____ then placed upon the military character might be seen in the lofty port of each individual member of the company.”

    A. estimation

    B. successful

    C. recognition

    D. unaccustomed

    Key: A (estimation)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from XXII: The Procession, paragraph 6 reveal about the character or situation? “She thought of the dim forest, with its little dell of solitude, and love, and anguish, and the mossy tree-trunk, where, sitting hand in hand, they had mingled their sad and passionate talk with the melancholy murmur of the brook.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 6) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit. The words “melancholy” and “passionate” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Mistress Hibbins's talk unsettle Hester?

    Sample answer: She seems to know the forest meeting. The evidence is “We must not always talk in the marketplace of what happens to us in the forest” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 9) — Hester to Pearl: town against forest.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from XXII: The Procession, paragraph 1 reveal about the character or situation? “It denoted the advance of the procession of magistrates and citizens, on its way towards the meetinghouse; where, in compliance with a custom thus early established, and ever since observed, the Reverend Mr. Dimmesdale was to deliver an…” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 1) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit. The words “meetinghouse” and “magistrates” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XXII: The Procession, paragraph 3 shapes its tone: “In that old day, the English settler on these rude shores—having left king, nobles, and all degrees of awful rank behind, while still the faculty and necessity of reverence were strong in him—bestowed it on the white hair and venerable…” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “venerable” and “reverence” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 3) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XXII: The Procession, paragraph 7 shapes its tone: “While the procession passed, the child was uneasy, fluttering up and down, like a bird on the point of taking flight.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “fluttering” and “procession” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 7) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “thou shalt know wherefore the minister keeps his hand over his heart” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 17) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Mistress Hibbins to Pearl. The evidence is “thou shalt know wherefore the minister keeps his hand over his heart” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 17). This develops public shame and private identity: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit. The words “wherefore” and “minister” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Hester must stand in the marketplace while the minister preaches, the contrast the narrator draws: "The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace!".
17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “But she was brought back to her former mood by the shimmer of the sunshine on the weapons and bright armor of the military company, which followed after the music, and formed the honorary escort of the procession.”, what does “honorary” most nearly mean?
    A. keeps causing bitter pain
    B. given as an honor
    C. like a shifting series of dreamlike images
    D. without proper respect

    Key: B (given as an honor)
18. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Hester hear of the sermon?
    Sample answer: The tone and cadence, not the words.
19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where does Hester stand during the sermon?
    A. By the scaffold
    B. In the front pew
    C. At home
    D. On the ship

    Key: A (By the scaffold)
20. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XXII: The Procession, paragraph 9: “We must not always talk in the _____ of what happens to us in the forest”
    Key: marketplace
21. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Hester feel?
    A. Happy
    B. Calm
    C. That he is far from her
    D. Angry

    Key: C (That he is far from her)
22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “It was Mistress Hibbins, who, arrayed in great magnificence, with a triple ruff, a broidered _____, a gown of rich velvet, and a gold-headed cane, had come forth to see the procession.” Word bank: honorary, morions, illuminates, stomacher
    Key: stomacher
23. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “thou shalt know wherefore the minister keeps his hand over his heart” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 17) Answer in two

or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Mistress Hibbins to Pearl. The evidence is “thou shalt know wherefore the minister keeps his hand over his heart” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 17). This develops public shame and private identity: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit.

24. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 30). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: The chapter's contrast. The evidence is “The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 30). This develops public shame and private identity: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit. The words “marketplace” and “minister” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Hester in her ‘magic circle of ignominy’ while the minister triumphs in the pulpit.

    A. Sin and guilt

    B. Public shame and private identity

    C. Nature and the individual against society

    D. Hypocrisy and truth

    Key: B (Public shame and private identity)

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “XXII: The Procession”? The marketplace, the meetinghouse and the scaffold where Hester stands while he preaches.

    A. Metaphor

    B. Setting

    C. Point of view

    D. Conflict

    Key: B (Setting)

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 30) supports it: Hester must stand in the marketplace while the minister preaches, the contrast the narrator draws: "The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace!". But “We must not always talk in the marketplace of what happens to us in the forest” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 9) complicates it: Hester to Pearl: town against forest, and its “not” marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. So the claim stands only in a qualified form: true of the chapter's main pattern, but not of every moment in it.

28. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “At that distance they accordingly stood, fixed there by the centrifugal force of the repugnance which the mystic symbol inspired.”, what does “centrifugal” most nearly mean?

    A. pushing outward from a center

    B. a reddish glow

    C. slowly decay into dust

    D. belonging to a small, inner circle

Key: A (pushing outward from a center)

29. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “We must not always talk in the marketplace of what happens to us in the forest” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 9) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Hester to Pearl: town against forest. The evidence is “We must not always talk in the marketplace of what happens to us in the forest” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 9).

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how public shame and private identity develops from XXI: The New England Holiday to XXII: The Procession. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Earlier, in XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 2, the text reads “Hester was clad in a garment of coarse gray cloth” — Hester's appearance on the holiday. In XXII: The Procession, “We must not always talk in the marketplace of what happens to us in the forest” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 9) — Hester to Pearl: town against forest. Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit.

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from XXII: The Procession, paragraph 5: “Or, perchance, his sensitive _____ was invigorated by the loud and piercing music, that swelled heavenward, and uplifted him on its ascending wave.” Word bank: practicable, effervescence, temperament, recognition

    Key: temperament

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from XXII: The Procession, paragraph 3: “The change may be for good or ill, and is partly, _____, for both.” Word bank: successful, perhaps, estimation, immediately

    Key: perhaps

33. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from XXII: The Procession, paragraph 4? “Next in order to the magistrates came the young and eminently _____ divine, from whose lips the religious discourse of the anniversary was expected.”

    A. marketplace

    B. unaccustomed

    C. distinguished

    D. immediately

    Key: C (distinguished)

34. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XXII: The Procession, paragraph 11 shapes its tone: “Well for thee, foolish child, that thou didst not speak to him!” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “foolish” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 11) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

35. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from XXII: The Procession, paragraph 4 to the story's treatment of women and independence: “His was the profession, at that era, in which intellectual ability displayed itself far more than in political life” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 4) develops women and independence: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit. Its words “intellectual” and “profession” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “There was no feebleness of step, as at other times; his frame was not bent; nor

did his hand rest ominously upon his…" (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 5), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

36. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] How does Dimmesdale walk in the procession?

    A. Not at all

    B. With unusual energy

    C. On horseback

    D. Weakly

    Key: B (With unusual energy)

37. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] In the line "She made the sombre crowd cheerful by her erratic and glistening ray; even as a bird of bright plumage illuminates a whole tree of dusky foliage, by darting to and fro, half seen and half concealed amid the twilight of…", what does "illuminates" most nearly mean?

    A. inflicted (revenge or harm)

    B. a small, close-fitting cap

    C. splash (with water or mud)

    D. lights up

    Key: D (lights up)

38. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: The procession places the two lovers at opposite ends of public life. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: "The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace" (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 30).

    Sample answer: Hester must stand in the marketplace while the minister preaches, the contrast the narrator draws: "The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace!". The evidence is "The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace" (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 30) — The chapter's contrast. This develops public shame and private identity: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit.

39. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Which literary element does this describe in "XXII: The Procession"? Dimmesdale marches in the procession with unusual energy; Hester feels he is far beyond her reach.

    A. Allusion

    B. Metaphor

    C. Hyperbole

    D. Characterization

    Key: D (Characterization)

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from XXII: The Procession, paragraph 5 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: "Nevertheless, so abstracted was his look, it might be questioned whether Mr. Dimmesdale even heard the music." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 5) develops hypocrisy and truth: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit. Its words "questioned" and "abstracted" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Far and deep in its own region, busying itself, with preternatural activity, to marshal a procession of stately…" (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 5), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

41. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “We must not always talk in the marketplace of what happens to us in the forest” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 9)

    A. The opening, with its ironic self-presentation.

    B. The letter's mysterious power.

    C. Hester to Pearl: town against forest.

    D. The question the letter's "new sense" raises.

    Key: C (Hester to Pearl: town against forest.)

42. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XXII: The Procession, paragraph 2 shapes its tone: “Some of them, indeed, by their services in the Low Countries and on other fields of European warfare, had fairly won their title to assume the name and pomp of soldiership.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “soldiership” and “services” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 2) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

43. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Connect this passage from XXII: The Procession, paragraph 13 to the story's treatment of women and independence: “But, truly, forsooth, I find it hard to believe him the same man.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 13) develops women and independence: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit. Its words “forsooth” and “believe” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “That is but a trifle, when a woman knows the world.” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 13), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

44. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What does the contrast of pulpit and scaffold suggest? Argue.

    Sample answer: A reasoned view: Hester to Pearl: town against forest. The evidence is “We must not always talk in the marketplace of what happens to us in the forest” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 9). This develops public shame and private identity: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit. Hester must stand in the marketplace while the minister preaches, the contrast the narrator draws: "The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace!".

45. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Connect this passage from XXII: The Procession, paragraph 15 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: “Yea; though no leaf of the wild garlands, which they wore while they danced, be left in their hair!” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 15) develops hypocrisy and truth: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit. Its words “garlands” and “though” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “We may all see it in the sunshine; and it glows like a red flame in the dark.” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 15), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

46. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] What does this passage most clearly show? “thou shalt know wherefore the minister keeps his hand over his heart” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 17)

    A. The prison as an image.

B. Chillingworth on Hester's punishment.

C. Mistress Hibbins to Pearl.

D. Hawthorne refuses to revise.

Key: C (Mistress Hibbins to Pearl.)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 18, 2, 9, 19, 5, 20, 3, 21, 22, 23, 12, 24, 25, 26, 27	recall 10, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	1, 18, 2, 22, 17, 8, 28, 5, 23, 12, 29, 26, 24, 25, 27, 30	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	31, 4, 28, 32, 6, 33, 5, 11, 12, 13, 34, 15, 14, 25, 35, 27	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	2, 36, 4, 22, 18, 37, 11, 12, 13, 38, 34, 15, 39, 30, 16, 40	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	22, 17, 19, 2, 11, 13, 41, 26, 38, 14, 34, 42, 40, 16, 27, 30	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	36, 37, 32, 22, 11, 12, 34, 14, 26, 25, 24, 35, 43, 44, 45, 16	recall 4, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	28, 36, 22, 2, 41, 12, 15, 42, 14, 26, 34, 44, 27, 40, 35, 30	recall 4, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	4, 3, 22, 46, 13, 42, 25, 14, 39, 34, 35, 45, 44, 27, 43, 30	recall 3, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	22, 2, 46, 41, 15, 25, 26, 34, 14, 44, 45, 40, 27, 35, 30, 43	recall 2, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	8, 22, 2, 36, 21, 25, 14, 34, 27, 40, 45, 16, 44, 30, 43, 35	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 3, synthesis 8

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "XXII: The Procession," how does Hawthorne show the procession? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In XXII: The Procession, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of the procession? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how XXII: The Procession develops the idea of the procession. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual

evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of XXII: The Procession (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of the procession. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what XXII: The Procession suggests about the procession. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's setting and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses setting in XXII: The Procession to complicate the reader's understanding of the procession. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate XXII: The Procession within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the procession responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read XXII: The Procession alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the procession follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to XXII: The Procession and its treatment of the procession. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's setting and irony, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads XXII: The Procession as evidence for a larger claim about the procession in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads XXII: The Procession as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the procession. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

SAT-style questions

1. *But she was brought back to her former mood by the shimmer of the sunshine on the weapons and bright armor of the military company, which followed after the music, and formed the honorary escort of the procession.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "honorary" most nearly mean?

   A. close, focused attention

   B. a decorated panel on the front of a woman's bodice

   C. acts of care or service

   D. given as an honor

2. *Before Hester Prynne could call together her thoughts, and consider what was practicable to be done in this new and startling aspect of affairs, the sound of military music was heard approaching along a contiguous street. It denoted the advance of the procession of magistrates and citizens, on its way towards the meetinghouse; where, in compliance with a custom thus early established, and ever since observed, the Reverend Mr. Dimmesdale was to deliver an Election Sermon.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "XXII: The Procession"?

   A. The child at the brook-side

   B. The frame narrative and the found letter

   C. A flood of sunshine

   D. The procession

SAT key: 1. D (given as an honor); 2. D (The procession)

Lesson 26: XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter

Focus: the revelation

Objective: Students will analyze how plot develops in "XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (death): Dimmesdale dies on the scaffold after confessing. Discuss confession and grief; keep the focus on what the scene means.
Student preview: A character dies in this chapter.
Suggested language: "Is the ending just?"

Teacher only · spoilers

After his triumphant sermon, Dimmesdale, near collapse, calls Hester and Pearl to the scaffold. Chillingworth tries to stop him. Leaning on Hester, he confesses before the people and tears open his vestment. Chillingworth says he has escaped him. Pearl kisses him, and he dies, unsure whether he and Hester will meet again.

Background: Public confession before the congregation was a Puritan practice of repentance.

Significance: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Is it ever too late to tell the truth? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to hypocrisy and truth because.... Content note before we start: A character dies in this chapter.
Prompt: Is it ever too late to tell the truth?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to hypocrisy and truth because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the public confession the novel has waited for.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: apotheosized — raised to the level of a god; idolized; concentred — focused together on one point; undisclosed — not revealed; clangor — a loud, ringing noise; etherealized — made spiritual and unearthly.
"undisclosed": Origin of "undisclose": an English formation from un- + disclose.
Words: apotheosized: raised to the level of a god; idolized · concentred: focused together on one point · undisclosed: not revealed · clangor: a loud, ringing noise · etherealized: made spiritual and unearthly

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Public confession before the congregation was a Puritan practice of repentance. Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. Plot: The climax: after the sermon Dimmesdale mounts the scaffold with Hester and Pearl, confesses, bares his breast and dies. Characterization: Chillingworth tries to stop him: "Thou hast escaped me!" Symbolism: Pearl's kiss breaks "a spell"; her tears pledge that she will be "a woman in it." Watch for the scaffold: The third scaffold scene, now at noon, before the whole town.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold" slowly and put it in my own words: As Dimmesdale climbs the scaffold to confess, Chillingworth cries that nowhere else on earth could he have escaped him. Next, craft. I notice the long, bitter build-up, "hadst thou sought the whole earth over," ending on "this very scaffold." The strongest word is "scaffold": the place of public shame is the one place where confession frees him. Then, effect. Why does Chillingworth say the scaffold was the only place Dimmesdale could escape him? My answer: By confessing publicly, Dimmesdale ends Chillingworth's power over him; the scene shows that the truth, not escape, is the only way out.

> *Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold" slowly and put it in my own words: As Dimmesdale climbs the scaffold to confess, Chillingworth cries that nowhere else on earth could he have escaped him. Next, craft. I notice the long, bitter build-up, "hadst thou sought the whole earth over," ending on "this very scaffold." The strongest word is "scaffold": the place of public shame is the one place where confession frees him. Then, effect. Why does Chillingworth say the scaffold was the only place Dimmesdale could escape him? My answer: By confessing publicly, Dimmesdale ends Chillingworth's power over him; the scene shows that the truth, not escape, is the only way out.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Dimmesdale asks whether confession is "better … than what we dreamed of in the forest." Expected link: theme; the forest's freedom against truth. Ask: How does this line connect to hypocrisy and truth? Expected: The public confession the novel has waited for. (Dimmesdale to Hester.)

> *Is not this better … than what we dreamed of in the forest (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 21)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Dimmesdale asks whether confession is "better ... than what we dreamed of in the forest." Expected link: theme; the forest's freedom against truth.
Ask: How does this line connect to hypocrisy and truth?
Expected answer: The public confession the novel has waited for. (Dimmesdale to Hester.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for plot, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the revelation? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter develops the idea of the revelation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. When the text says "Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18), it shows this directly. Chillingworth admits the scaffold was the one place the minister "couldst have escaped me," and when "Pearl kissed his lips. A spell was broken."

Task: Annotate the chapter for plot, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the revelation? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter develops the idea of the revelation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. When the text says "Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18), it shows this directly. Chillingworth admits the scaffold was the one place the minister "couldst have escaped me," and when "Pearl kissed his lips. A spell was broken."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Is it ever too late to tell the truth? Ask: why does Hawthorne refuse to describe what was on the minister's breast?

Anchor question: Is it ever too late to tell the truth?

Facilitation: Ask: why does Hawthorne refuse to describe what was on the minister's breast?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the revelation? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. ("Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold", XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the revelation? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. ("Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold", XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how plot shapes the revelation. Key takeaway: the public confession the novel has waited for.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Plot:** The climax: after the sermon Dimmesdale mounts the scaffold with Hester and Pearl, confesses, bares his breast and dies.
- **Characterization:** Chillingworth tries to stop him: "Thou hast escaped me!"
- **Symbolism:** Pearl's kiss breaks "a spell"; her tears pledge that she will be "a woman in it."

Themes and how they develop

- **hypocrisy and truth:** the public confession the novel has waited for.

Symbols and motifs

- **the scaffold:** The third scaffold scene, now at noon, before the whole town.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18) Chillingworth's defeat.
- “Is not this better … than what we dreamed of in the forest” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 21) Dimmesdale to Hester.
- “Pearl kissed his lips. A spell was broken” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 33) Pearl's transformation.
- “People of New England” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 25) The confession begins.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth.
Evidence: “Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18)
Reasoning: Chillingworth admits the scaffold was the one place the minister "couldst have escaped me," and when "Pearl kissed his lips. A spell was broken."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history

apotheosized (verb)	raised to the level of a god; idolized	*So etherealized by spirit as he was, and so apotheosized by worshipping admirers, did his footsteps, in the procession, really tread upon the dust of earth?*	
concentred (verb)	focused together on one point	*For an instant, the gaze of the horror-stricken multitude was concentred on the ghastly miracle; while the minister stood, with a flush of triumph in his face, as one who, in the crisis of acutest pain, had won a victory.*	
undisclosed (adjective)	not revealed	*It seemed, at this point, as if the minister must leave the remainder of his secret undisclosed.*	"undisclosed": Origin of "undisclose": an English formation from un- + disclose. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/undisclose#Etymology)
clangor (noun)	a loud, ringing noise	*Now was heard again the clangor of the music, and the measured tramp of the military escort, issuing from the church-door.*	
etherealized (verb)	made spiritual and unearthly	*So etherealized by spirit as he was, and so apotheosized by worshipping admirers, did his footsteps, in the procession, really tread upon the dust of earth?*	
blacken (verb)	damage (a reputation)	*Do not blacken your fame, and perish in dishonor!*	"blacken": Origin: an English formation from black + -en. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/blacken#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. Is it ever too late to tell the truth?
2. Where does plot appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with women and independence?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Chillingworth say repeatedly? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Thou hast escaped me!
2. Where does Dimmesdale confess? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: On the scaffold
3. Who tries to stop him? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Chillingworth
4. What does he reveal? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: His breast
5. What does Pearl do? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Kisses him
6. What happens to Dimmesdale? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He dies
7. Retell the three most important events of "XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: After his triumphant sermon, Dimmesdale, near collapse, calls Hester and Pearl to the scaffold. Chillingworth tries to stop him. Leaning on Hester, he confesses before the people and tears open his vestment. Chillingworth says he has escaped him. Pearl kisses him, and he dies, unsure whether he and Hester will meet again.
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: "So etherealized by spirit as he was, and so apotheosized by worshipping admirers, did his footsteps, in the procession, really tread upon the dust of earth?" What does "apotheosized" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: apotheosized: raised to the level of a god; idolized.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Hawthorne not describe what is revealed? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: To keep the meaning uncertain and spiritual.
2. What does "XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter" suggest about the revelation? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth.
3. Find one example of plot in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for key events and the causes linking them.
4. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about the revelation? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. Useful evidence: "Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18): Chillingworth's defeat. On characterization: Chillingworth tries to stop him:

"Thou hast escaped me!" Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “Now was heard again the clangor of the music, and the measured tramp of the military escort, issuing from the church-door.”, why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: After his triumphant sermon, Dimmesdale, near collapse, calls Hester and Pearl to the scaffold. Chillingworth tries to stop him. Leaning on Hester, he confesses before the people and tears open his vestment. Chillingworth says he has escaped him. Pearl kisses him, and he dies, unsure whether he and…
7. How does “XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter” build on “XXII: The Procession”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. Useful evidence: “Is not this better … than what we dreamed of in the forest” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 21): Dimmesdale to Hester. Theme link: the public confession the novel has waited for. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. Useful evidence: “Pearl kissed his lips. A spell was broken” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 33): Pearl's transformation. On characterization: Chillingworth tries to stop him: "Thou hast escaped me!" Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Is it ever too late to tell the truth?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does symbolism appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with women and independence? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. Useful evidence: “People of New England” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 25): The confession begins. On symbolism: Pearl's kiss breaks "a spell"; her tears pledge that she will be "a woman in it." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is the ending just? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. Useful evidence: “Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place

so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18): Chillingworth's defeat. Theme link: the public confession the novel has waited for. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: "Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. Useful evidence: "Is not this better … than what we dreamed of in the forest" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 21): Dimmesdale to Hester. Theme link: the public confession the novel has waited for. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. Useful evidence: "Pearl kissed his lips. A spell was broken" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 33): Pearl's transformation. On characterization: Chillingworth tries to stop him: "Thou hast escaped me!" Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Rewrite one moment of "XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the revelation? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. Useful evidence: "People of New England" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 25): The confession begins. Theme link: the public confession the novel has waited for. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about "XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. Useful evidence: "Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18): Chillingworth's defeat. Theme link: the public confession the novel has waited for. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this chapter to sin and guilt: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. Useful evidence: "Is not this better … than what we dreamed of in the forest" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 21): Dimmesdale to Hester. Theme link: the public

confession the novel has waited for. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the plot in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. Useful evidence: “Pearl kissed his lips. A spell was broken” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 33): Pearl's transformation. On plot: The climax: after the sermon Dimmesdale mounts the scaffold with Hester and Pearl, confesses, bares his breast and dies. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter” treats the revelation with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. Useful evidence: “People of New England” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 25): The confession begins. Theme link: the public confession the novel has waited for. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “XXIV: Conclusion” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. Useful evidence: “Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18): Chillingworth's defeat. Theme link: the public confession the novel has waited for. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the revelation? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. Useful evidence: “Is not this better … than what we dreamed of in the forest” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 21): Dimmesdale to Hester. Theme link: the public confession the novel has waited for. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Plot:** look for key events and the causes linking them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "So _____ by spirit as he was, and so apotheosized by worshipping admirers, did his footsteps, in the procession, really tread upon the dust of earth?" Word bank: concentred, etherealized, apotheosized, undisclosed
   Key: etherealized
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 33: "Pearl _____ his lips. A spell was broken"
   Key: kissed
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "For an instant, the gaze of the horror-stricken multitude was concentred on the ghastly miracle; while the minister stood, with a flush of triumph in his face, as one who, in the crisis of acutest pain, had won a…", what does "concentred" most nearly mean?
   A. focused together on one point
   B. reasoned about life in a thoughtful, abstract way
   C. a source that never runs dry
   D. took cruel pleasure in someone's suffering

   Key: A (focused together on one point)
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who tries to stop him?
   A. Chillingworth
   B. Pearl
   C. Wilson
   D. Hester

   Key: A (Chillingworth)
5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 21: "Is not this better … than what we _____ of in the forest"
   Key: dreamed
6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "It seemed, at this point, as if the minister must leave the remainder of his secret undisclosed.", what does "undisclosed" most nearly mean?
   A. making glad
   B. forever, beyond death
   C. not revealed
   D. the wish to do harm to others

   Key: C (not revealed)
7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Pearl do?
   A. Kisses him
   B. Prays
   C. Runs away
   D. Screams

   Key: A (Kisses him)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Do not _____ your fame, and perish in dishonor!" Word bank: apotheosized, undisclosed, concentred, blacken

    Key: blacken

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Now was heard again the clangor of the music, and the measured tramp of the military escort, issuing from the church-door.", what does "clangor" most nearly mean?

    A. speaking at length (about)

    B. one's deepest feelings

    C. a loud, ringing noise

    D. not saved from sin

    Key: C (a loud, ringing noise)

10. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Chillingworth say repeatedly?

    Sample answer: Thou hast escaped me!

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where does Dimmesdale confess?

    A. On the ship

    B. In the pulpit

    C. In the forest

    D. On the scaffold

    Key: D (On the scaffold)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Hawthorne not describe what is revealed?

    Sample answer: To keep the meaning uncertain and spiritual. The evidence is "Is not this better … than what we dreamed of in the forest" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 21) — Dimmesdale to Hester.

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter"?

    A. An author answering his critics

    B. Hester on the scaffold

    C. The prison door and the rose

    D. The revelation

    Key: D (The revelation)

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? The public confession the novel has waited for.

    A. Sin and guilt

    B. Women and independence

    C. Nature and the individual against society

    D. Hypocrisy and truth

    Key: D (Hypocrisy and truth)

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: "Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18).

Sample answer: Chillingworth admits the scaffold was the one place the minister "couldst have escaped me," and when "Pearl kissed his lips. A spell was broken.". The evidence is “Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18) — Chillingworth's defeat. This develops hypocrisy and truth: the public confession the novel has waited for.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how hypocrisy and truth develops from XX: The Minister in a Maze to XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter. Use one quotation from each.
Sample answer: Earlier, in XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3, the text reads “No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to…”, which shows the novel's best-known statement on hypocrisy. In XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, “Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18) — Chillingworth's defeat. The public confession the novel has waited for.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “So etherealized by spirit as he was, and so apotheosized by worshipping admirers, did his footsteps, in the procession, really tread upon the dust of earth?”, what does “apotheosized” most nearly mean?

    A. pure; not mixed with anything weaker
    B. based on guesswork
    C. setting aside; declining to pursue
    D. raised to the level of a god; idolized

    Key: D (raised to the level of a god; idolized)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does he reveal?

    A. A letter
    B. A will
    C. A knife
    D. His breast

    Key: D (His breast)

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: Chillingworth's defeat. The evidence is “Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18).

20. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “Pearl kissed his lips. A spell was broken” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 33). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
Sample answer: Pearl's transformation. The evidence is “Pearl kissed his lips. A spell was broken” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 33). This develops hypocrisy and truth: the public confession the novel has waited for. The words “broken” and “kissed” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

21. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in "XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter"? The climax: after the sermon Dimmesdale mounts the scaffold with Hester and Pearl, confesses, bares his breast and dies.

    A. Allusion

    B. Conflict

    C. Plot

    D. Alliteration

    Key: C (Plot)

22. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: "Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth." Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. "Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18) supports it: Chillingworth admits the scaffold was the one place the minister "couldst have escaped me," and when "Pearl kissed his lips. A spell was broken.". But "Is not this better … than what we dreamed of in the forest" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 21) complicates it: the line (Dimmesdale to Hester) shows the same issue from another side, and its "not" marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. The claim is therefore a strong reading, not a complete one, and a careful answer says where it stops applying.

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What happens to Dimmesdale?

    A. He is arrested

    B. He recovers

    C. He leaves on the ship

    D. He dies

    Key: D (He dies)

24. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 5: "Never, on New England soil, had stood the man so honored by his mortal _____ as the preacher!" Word bank: neighbor, brethren, interpreted, inspiration

    Key: brethren

25. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 2: "But, throughout it all, and through the whole discourse, there had been a certain deep, sad undertone of pathos, which could not be _____ otherwise than as the natural regret of one soon to pass away." Word bank: interpreted, communities, atmosphere, standing

    Key: interpreted

26. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 7 reveal about the character or situation? "It seemed hardly the face of a man alive, with such a deathlike hue; it was hardly a man with life in him, that tottered on his path so nervelessly, yet tottered, and did not fall!" Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 7) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: the public confession the novel has waited for. The words "nervelessly" and "deathlike" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

27. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 1 reveal about the character or situation? "There was a momentary silence,

profound as what should follow the utterance of oracles." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The passage (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 1) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: the public confession the novel has waited for. The words "momentary" and "utterance" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 2 shapes its tone: "His hearers could not rest until they had told one another of what each knew better than he could tell or hear." Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words "another" and "hearers" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 2) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: the public confession the novel has waited for. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 6 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: "Were there not the brilliant particles of a halo in the air about his head?" Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 6) develops hypocrisy and truth: the public confession the novel has waited for. Its words "particles" and "brilliant" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "The shout died into a murmur, as one portion of the crowd after another obtained a glimpse of him." (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 7), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

30. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 2? "The street and the _____ absolutely babbled, from side to side, with applauses of the minister."

A. listening

B. military

C. marketplace

D. extinguished

Key: C (marketplace)

31. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 9 shapes its tone: "The crowd, meanwhile, looked on with awe and wonder." Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words "meanwhile" and "wonder" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 9) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: the public confession the novel has waited for. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

32. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 8 shapes its tone: "And there was the scarlet letter on her breast!" Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words "scarlet" and "breast" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 8) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: the public confession the novel has waited for. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

33. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 2 shapes its tone: "Yes; their minister whom they so loved —and who so loved them all, that he could not depart heavenward without a sigh—had the foreboding of

untimely death upon him, and would soon leave them in their tears!" Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words "heavenward" and "foreboding" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 2) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: the public confession the novel has waited for. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

34. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 16 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: "This wretched and wronged old man is opposing it with all his might!—with all his own might, and the fiend's!" Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 16) develops hypocrisy and truth: the public confession the novel has waited for. Its words "wretched" and "opposing" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Old Roger Chillingworth followed, as one intimately connected with the drama of guilt and sorrow in which they had all…" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 17), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

35. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 1: "The eloquent voice, on which the souls of the _____ audience had been borne aloft as on the swelling waves of the sea, at length came to a pause." Word bank: neighbor, interpreted, listening, transitory

Key: listening

36. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Is not this better … than what we dreamed of in the forest" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 21) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Dimmesdale to Hester. The evidence is "Is not this better … than what we dreamed of in the forest" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 21). This develops hypocrisy and truth: the public confession the novel has waited for. The words "dreamed" and "better" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Chillingworth admits the scaffold was the one place the minister "couldst have escaped me," and when "Pearl kissed his lips. A spell was broken.".

37. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 5? "When they were fairly in the _____, their presence was greeted by a shout."

A. neighbor
B. transported
C. inspiration
D. marketplace

Key: D (marketplace)

38. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Which literary element does this describe in "XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter"? Chillingworth tries to stop him: 'Thou hast escaped me!'

A. Simile
B. Theme
C. Characterization
D. Alliteration

Key: C (Characterization)

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Is the ending just? Argue.

    Sample answer: A reasoned view: Dimmesdale to Hester. The evidence is “Is not this better … than what we dreamed of in the forest” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 21). This develops hypocrisy and truth: the public confession the novel has waited for. Chillingworth admits the scaffold was the one place the minister "couldst have escaped me," and when "Pearl kissed his lips. A spell was broken.".

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 12 to the story's treatment of women and independence: “At this instant, old Roger Chillingworth thrust himself through the crowd—or, perhaps, so dark, disturbed, and evil, was his look, he rose up out of some nether region—to snatch back his victim from what he sought to do!” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 12) develops women and independence: the public confession the novel has waited for. Its words “disturbed” and “instant” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Would you bring infamy on your sacred profession?” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 13), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

41. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] What can you infer from this line? “Is not this better … than what we dreamed of in the forest” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 21) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Dimmesdale to Hester. The evidence is “Is not this better … than what we dreamed of in the forest” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 21). This develops hypocrisy and truth: the public confession the novel has waited for.

42. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Chillingworth's defeat. The evidence is “Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18). This develops hypocrisy and truth: the public confession the novel has waited for. The words “scaffold” and “couldst” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Chillingworth admits the scaffold was the one place the minister "couldst have escaped me," and when "Pearl kissed his lips. A spell was broken.".

43. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Connect this passage from XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 5 to the story's treatment of women and independence: “This—though doubtless it might acquire additional force and volume from the childlike loyalty which the age awarded to its rulers—was felt to be an irrepressible outburst of enthusiasm kindled in the auditors by that high strain of…” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 5) develops women and independence: the public confession the novel has waited for. Its words “irrepressible” and “reverberating” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Within the church, it had hardly been kept down; beneath the sky, it pealed upward to the zenith.” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 5), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix

Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 11, inference 2, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	7, 6, 2, 17, 1, 11, 8, 18, 10, 4, 19, 12, 20, 21, 14, 22	recall 10, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	9, 17, 23, 24, 2, 25, 4, 26, 12, 13, 27, 20, 14, 28, 16, 29	recall 7, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	9, 1, 30, 18, 6, 8, 27, 26, 12, 13, 31, 32, 14, 33, 34, 16	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	11, 17, 8, 35, 3, 26, 12, 27, 13, 32, 20, 31, 33, 36, 22, 34	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	37, 18, 6, 1, 8, 27, 31, 20, 33, 38, 28, 22, 34, 16, 39, 40	recall 5, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Freshman	9, 7, 18, 1, 8, 12, 28, 31, 20, 14, 33, 29, 40, 39, 16, 34	recall 5, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	35, 17, 1, 11, 27, 41, 28, 38, 14, 31, 20, 39, 42, 22, 40, 16	recall 4, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	8, 23, 1, 11, 12, 14, 28, 38, 32, 31, 34, 39, 42, 43, 29, 22	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	37, 1, 8, 11, 13, 28, 31, 33, 14, 22, 29, 43, 40, 36, 39, 34	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 4, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	5, 1, 11, 4, 18, 38, 15, 32, 28, 39, 16, 34, 29, 40, 43, 22	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 4, synthesis 7

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter,” how does Hawthorne show the revelation? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the plot you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of the revelation? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the plot in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter develops the idea of the revelation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter (where it begins, turns and ends) and its plot shape the reader's understanding of the revelation. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter suggests about the revelation. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's plot and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses plot in XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter to complicate the reader's understanding of the revelation. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the revelation responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the revelation follows or bends those conventions, using the plot as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter and its treatment of the revelation. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's plot and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter as evidence for a larger claim about the revelation in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the revelation. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

SAT-style questions

1. *It seemed, at this point, as if the minister must leave the remainder of his secret undisclosed.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “undisclosed” most nearly mean?

   A. made spiritual and unearthly

   B. not revealed

   C. damage (a reputation)

   D. a loud, ringing noise

2. *Now was heard again the clangor of the music, and the measured tramp of the military escort, issuing from the church-door. The procession was to be marshalled thence to the town-hall, where a solemn banquet would complete the ceremonies of the day.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter”?

   A. The revelation

   B. Hester on the scaffold

C. The New England holiday

D. Pearl

SAT key: 1. B (not revealed); 2. A (The revelation)

Lesson 27: XXIV: Conclusion

Focus: conclusion

Objective: Students will analyze how structure develops in “XXIV: Conclusion” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Critical voice: “The sin of her seducer too, seems to be considered as lying not so much in the deed itself, as in his long concealment of it, and, in fact, the whole moral of the tale is given in the words--"Be true--be true," as if sincerity in sin were virtue, and as if "Be clean--be clean," were not the more fitting conclusion.” (Arthur Cleveland Coxe, clergyman and critic, *"The Writings of Hawthorne," Church Review (January 1851), pp. 489-511 (excerpt), excerpt*; public domain). Final-paper prompt: is concealment or the act itself Dimmesdale's real sin? Answer Coxe. *Objective:* Determine the novel's final moral ("Be true!"). *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.2, W.11-12.1

Teacher only · spoilers

Witnesses disagree: most saw a scarlet letter in the minister's flesh, but some saw nothing. Chillingworth withers and dies within a year, leaving his fortune to Pearl, who goes abroad and seems to marry happily. Hester returns years later, wears the letter by choice and counsels troubled women. She is buried near Dimmesdale under one tombstone.

Background: King's Chapel burying ground in Boston contains graves from the colonial period; Hawthorne places the tomb there.

Significance: Hester makes the letter her own and its meaning changes.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Can a symbol of shame become something else? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to women and independence because....
Prompt: Can a symbol of shame become something else?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to women and independence because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground."

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: escutcheon — a shield bearing a coat of arms; wilting — drooping and withering; unvalued — not valued or loved; necromancer — a sorcerer; heraldry — the system of coats of arms.
Words: escutcheon: a shield bearing a coat of arms · wilting: drooping and withering · unvalued: not valued or loved · necromancer: a sorcerer · heraldry: the system of coats of arms

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
King's Chapel burying ground in Boston contains graves from the colonial period; Hawthorne places the tomb there. Hester makes the letter her own and its meaning changes. Structure: The conclusion offers several accounts of what was seen and withholds certainty. Characterization: Chillingworth withers and dies within the year, leaving his property to Pearl; Hester returns and wears the letter freely. Symbolism: The shared tombstone and its heraldic letter A. Watch for the scarlet letter: Hester resumes it "of her own free will."

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Among many morals which press upon us from the poor minister's miserable experience, we put only this into a sentence:—"Be true! Be..." slowly and put it in my own words: Of the many lessons, the narrator chooses one: "Be true! Be true! Be true!" Next, craft. I notice the triple repetition, like a sermon's final cry. The strongest word is "true": it names the novel's central demand: honesty about oneself. Then, effect. What moral does the narrator draw from Dimmesdale's story? My answer: The narrator says that if you cannot show the world your worst, you should at least show some sign of it; Dimmesdale's ruin came from hiding, not only from sin.

> *Among many morals which press upon us from the poor minister's miserable experience, we put only this into a sentence:—"Be true! Be true! Be true* *(XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 4)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Among many morals which press upon us from the poor minister's miserable experience, we put only this into a sentence:—"Be true! Be…" slowly and put it in my own words: Of the many lessons, the narrator chooses one: "Be true! Be true! Be true!" Next, craft. I notice the triple repetition, like a sermon's final cry. The strongest word is "true": it names the novel's central demand: honesty about oneself. Then, effect. What moral does the narrator draw from Dimmesdale's story? My answer: The narrator says that if you cannot show the world your worst, you should at least show some sign of it; Dimmesdale's ruin came from hiding, not only from sin.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: One account of the revelation. Look at the craft: Chillingworth withers and dies within the year, leaving his property to Pearl; Hester returns and wears the letter freely. Ask: How does this line connect to women and independence? Expected: Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground." (One account of the revelation.)

> *Most of the spectators testified to having seen, on the breast of the unhappy minister, a scarlet letter* *(XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 2)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: One account of the revelation. Look at the craft: Chillingworth withers and dies within the year, leaving his property to Pearl; Hester returns and wears the letter freely.
Ask: How does this line connect to women and independence?
Expected answer: Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground." (One account of the revelation.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for structure, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about conclusion? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XXIV: Conclusion develops the idea of conclusion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Hester finally makes the letter her own. When the text says "Here had been her sin; here, her sorrow; and here was yet to be her penitence" (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 11), it shows this directly. She returns because "here was yet to be her penitence," resuming the letter of her own will, and the narrator's one moral is "Be true! Be true! Be true!"
Task: Annotate the chapter for structure, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about conclusion? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how XXIV: Conclusion develops the idea of conclusion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Hester finally makes the letter her own. When the text says "Here had been her sin; here, her sorrow; and here was yet to be her penitence" (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 11), it shows this directly. She returns because "here was yet to be her penitence," resuming the letter of her own will, and the narrator's one moral is "Be true! Be true! Be true!"

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Can a symbol of shame become something else? Ask: is the ending hopeful? Compare the first scaffold scene with the tombstone.
Anchor question: Can a symbol of shame become something else?
Facilitation: Ask: is the ending hopeful? Compare the first scaffold scene with the tombstone.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about conclusion? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Hester finally makes the letter her own. ("Here had been her sin; here, her sorrow; and here was yet to be her penitence", XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 11). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about conclusion? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Hester finally makes the letter her own. ("Here had been her sin; here, her sorrow; and here was yet to be her penitence", XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 11). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how structure shapes conclusion. Key takeaway: Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground."*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Structure:** The conclusion offers several accounts of what was seen and withholds certainty.
- **Characterization:** Chillingworth withers and dies within the year, leaving his property to Pearl; Hester returns and wears the letter freely.
- **Symbolism:** The shared tombstone and its heraldic letter A.

Themes and how they develop

- **women and independence:** Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground."

Symbols and motifs

- **the scarlet letter:** Hester resumes it "of her own free will."

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Among many morals which press upon us from the poor minister’s miserable experience, we put only this into a sentence:—“Be true! Be true! Be true” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 4) The novel's moral.
- “Most of the spectators testified to having seen, on the breast of the unhappy minister, a scarlet letter” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 2) One account of the revelation.
- “Here had been her sin; here, her sorrow; and here was yet to be her penitence” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 11) Why Hester returns.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Hester finally makes the letter her own.
Evidence: “Here had been her sin; here, her sorrow; and here was yet to be her penitence” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 11)
Reasoning: She returns because "here was yet to be her penitence," resuming the letter of her own will, and the narrator's one moral is "Be true! Be true! Be true!"

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history

escutcheon (noun)	a shield bearing a coat of arms	*All around, there were monuments carved with armorial bearings; and on this simple slab of slate—as the curious investigator may still discern, and perplex himself with the purport—there appeared the semblance of an engraved escutcheon.*	
wilting (verb)	drooping and withering	*All his strength and energy—all his vital and intellectual force—seemed at once to desert him; insomuch that he positively withered up, shrivelled away, and almost vanished from mortal sight, like an uprooted weed that lies wilting in the sun.*	
unvalued (adjective)	not valued or loved	*Women, more especially—in the continually recurring trials of wounded, wasted, wronged, misplaced, or erring and sinful passion—or with the dreary burden of a heart unyielded, because unvalued and unsought—came to Hester's cottage, demanding why they were so wretched, and what the remedy!*	
necromancer (noun)	a sorcerer	*Others contended that the stigma had not been produced until a long time subsequent, when old Roger Chillingworth, being a potent necromancer, had caused it to appear, through the agency of magic and poisonous drugs.*	
heraldry (noun)	the system of coats of arms	*Letters came, with armorial seals upon them, though of bearings unknown to English heraldry.*	
conjectural (adjective)	based on guesswork	*As regarded its origin, there were various explanations, all of which must necessarily have been conjectural.*	

Discussion questions

1. Can a symbol of shame become something else?
2. Where does structure appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with sin and guilt?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What is the inscription? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: On a field, sable, the letter A, gules.
2. What do most witnesses say they saw? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A scarlet letter on his breast

3. What happens to Chillingworth? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He dies within a year
4. Who inherits his fortune? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Pearl
5. What does Hester do on her return? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Wears the letter by choice
6. Where is Hester buried? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Near Dimmesdale under one tombstone
7. Retell the three most important events of "XXIV: Conclusion" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Witnesses disagree: most saw a scarlet letter in the minister's flesh, but some saw nothing. Chillingworth withers and dies within a year, leaving his fortune to Pearl, who goes abroad and seems to marry happily. Hester returns years later, wears the letter by choice and counsels troubled women. She is buried near Dimmesdale under one tombstone.
8. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "XXIV: Conclusion"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "XXIV: Conclusion" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
10. Reread: "All around, there were monuments carved with armorial bearings; and on this simple slab of slate —as the curious investigator may still discern, and perplex himself with the purport—there appeared the semblance of an…" What does "escutcheon" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: escutcheon: a shield bearing a coat of arms.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Hester return? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Boston is where her sin, sorrow and penitence belong.
2. What does "XXIV: Conclusion" suggest about conclusion? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Hester makes the letter her own and its meaning changes.
3. Find one example of structure in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for how the chapter is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.
4. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about conclusion? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester finally makes the letter her own. Useful evidence: "Among many morals which press upon us from the poor minister's miserable experience, we put only this into a sentence:—"Be true! Be true! Be true" (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 4): The novel's moral. On characterization: Chillingworth withers and dies within the year, leaving his property to Pearl; Hester returns and wears the letter freely. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "After many days, when time sufficed for the people to arrange their thoughts in reference to the foregoing scene, there was more than one account of what had been witnessed on the…",

why might Hawthorne have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

6. What causes the main turn in “XXIV: Conclusion”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Witnesses disagree: most saw a scarlet letter in the minister's flesh, but some saw nothing. Chillingworth withers and dies within a year, leaving his fortune to Pearl, who goes abroad and seems to marry happily. Hester returns years later, wears the letter by choice and counsels troubled women…
7. How does “XXIV: Conclusion” build on “XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester finally makes the letter her own. Useful evidence: “Most of the spectators testified to having seen, on the breast of the unhappy minister, a scarlet letter” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 2): One account of the revelation. On structure: The conclusion offers several accounts of what was seen and withholds certainty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester finally makes the letter her own. Useful evidence: “Here had been her sin; here, her sorrow; and here was yet to be her penitence” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 11): Why Hester returns. On characterization: Chillingworth withers and dies within the year, leaving his property to Pearl; Hester returns and wears the letter freely. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Can a symbol of shame become something else?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does symbolism appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with sin and guilt? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester finally makes the letter her own. Useful evidence: “Among many morals which press upon us from the poor minister’s miserable experience, we put only this into a sentence:—“Be true! Be true! Be true” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 4): The novel's moral. On symbolism: The shared tombstone and its heraldic letter A. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is the ending hopeful? Argue. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A reasoned view comparing the first scaffold scene and the tomb.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester finally makes the letter her own. Useful evidence: “Most of the spectators testified to having seen, on the breast of the unhappy minister, a scarlet letter” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 2): One account of the revelation. Theme link: Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground." Credit

any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “Hester makes the letter her own and its meaning changes.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester finally makes the letter her own. Useful evidence: “Here had been her sin; here, her sorrow; and here was yet to be her penitence” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 11): Why Hester returns. Theme link: Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester finally makes the letter her own. Useful evidence: “Among many morals which press upon us from the poor minister’s miserable experience, we put only this into a sentence:—“Be true! Be true! Be true” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 4): The novel's moral. On characterization: Chillingworth withers and dies within the year, leaving his property to Pearl; Hester returns and wears the letter freely. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Rewrite one moment of “XXIV: Conclusion” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about conclusion? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester finally makes the letter her own. Useful evidence: “Most of the spectators testified to having seen, on the breast of the unhappy minister, a scarlet letter” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 2): One account of the revelation. Theme link: Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “XXIV: Conclusion”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester finally makes the letter her own. Useful evidence: “Here had been her sin; here, her sorrow; and here was yet to be her penitence” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 11): Why Hester returns. Theme link: Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this chapter to public shame and private identity: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Hawthorne need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester finally makes the letter her own. Useful evidence: “Among many morals which press upon us from the poor minister’s miserable experience, we put only this into a sentence:—“Be true! Be true! Be true” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 4): The novel's moral. Theme link: Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women

will be on "surer ground." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the structure in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester finally makes the letter her own. Useful evidence: “Most of the spectators testified to having seen, on the breast of the unhappy minister, a scarlet letter” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 2): One account of the revelation. On structure: The conclusion offers several accounts of what was seen and withholds certainty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “XXIV: Conclusion” treats conclusion with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Scarlet Letter see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester finally makes the letter her own. Useful evidence: “Here had been her sin; here, her sorrow; and here was yet to be her penitence” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 11): Why Hester returns. Theme link: Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. As the final chapter, does this ending resolve sin and guilt? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester finally makes the letter her own. Useful evidence: “Among many morals which press upon us from the poor minister’s miserable experience, we put only this into a sentence:—“Be true! Be true! Be true” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 4): The novel's moral. Theme link: Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about conclusion? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Hester finally makes the letter her own. Useful evidence: “Most of the spectators testified to having seen, on the breast of the unhappy minister, a scarlet letter” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 2): One account of the revelation. Theme link: Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Structure:** look for how the chapter is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 5: "It is a curious subject of _____ and inquiry, whether hatred and love be not the same thing at bottom." Word bank: observation, reference, distinctness, circumstance

   Key: observation

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Hester do on her return?

   A. Wears the letter by choice

   B. Hides at home

   C. Remarries

   D. Throws it away

   Key: A (Wears the letter by choice)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where is Hester buried?

   A. In the forest

   B. In England

   C. By the sea

   D. Near Dimmesdale under one tombstone

   Key: D (Near Dimmesdale under one tombstone)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 7? "Not improbably, this _____ wrought a very material change in the public estimation; and, had the mother and child remained here, little Pearl, at a marriageable period of life, might have mingled her wild blood with the lineage of the devoutest Puritan among them all."

   A. hesitation

   B. essentially

   C. circumstance

   D. womanhood

   Key: C (circumstance)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "All his strength and energy—all his vital and intellectual force—seemed at once to desert him; insomuch that he positively withered up, shrivelled away, and almost vanished from mortal sight, like an uprooted weed that…", what does "wilting" most nearly mean?

   A. drooping and withering

   B. too deep to be explored or understood

   C. a woman who founds something

   D. is right or necessary for

   Key: A (drooping and withering)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 11: "Here had been her sin; here, her sorrow; and here was yet to be her _____"

   Key: penitence

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Letters came, with armorial seals upon them, though of bearings unknown to English _____." Word bank: wilting, unvalued,

escutcheon, heraldry

Key: heraldry

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 4: “Among many morals which press upon us from the poor minister’s miserable _____, we put only this into a sentence:—‘Be true! Be true! Be true”

   Key: experience

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What do most witnesses say they saw?

   A. Nothing

   B. A scarlet letter on his breast

   C. A cross

   D. A wound

   Key: B (A scarlet letter on his breast)

10. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “As regarded its origin, there were various explanations, all of which must necessarily have been _____.” Word bank: wilting, escutcheon, conjectural, unvalued

    Key: conjectural

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 2 reveal about the character or situation? “Some affirmed that the Reverend Mr. Dimmesdale, on the very day when Hester Prynne first wore her ignominious badge, had begun a course of penance—which he afterwards, in so many futile methods, followed out—by inflicting a hideous torture…” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 2) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground.". The words “ignominious” and “inflicting” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 9 reveal about the character or situation? “In the cottage there were articles of comfort and luxury such as Hester never cared to use, but which only wealth could have purchased, and affection have imagined for her.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 9) shows the situation turning on sin and guilt: Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground.". The words “affection” and “purchased” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Hester return?

    Sample answer: Boston is where her sin, sorrow and penitence belong. The evidence is “Here had been her sin; here, her sorrow; and here was yet to be her penitence” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 11) — Why Hester returns.

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 4 shapes its tone: “The authority which we have chiefly followed—a manuscript of old date, drawn up from the verbal testimony of individuals, some of whom had known Hester Prynne, while others had heard the tale from contemporary witnesses—fully confirms the…” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “contemporary” and “individuals” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 4) make the tone heavy and

deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 11 shapes its tone: “She had returned, therefore, and resumed—of her own free will, for not the sternest magistrate of that iron period would have imposed it—resumed the symbol of which we have related so dark a tale.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “magistrate” and “therefore” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 11) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to nature and the individual against society: Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is the ending hopeful? Argue.
    Sample answer: A reasoned view comparing the first scaffold scene and the tomb. The evidence is “Among many morals which press upon us from the poor minister’s miserable experience, we put only this into a sentence:—‘Be true! Be true!…” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 4) — The novel's moral. This develops women and independence: Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground.". She returns because "here was yet to be her penitence," resuming the letter of her own will, and the narrator's one moral is "Be true! Be true! Be true!".

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What happens to Chillingworth?

    A. He leaves on the ship
    B. He becomes governor
    C. He confesses
    D. He dies within a year

    Key: D (He dies within a year)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 1: “After many days, when time sufficed for the people to arrange their thoughts in _____ to the foregoing scene, there was more than one account of what had been witnessed on the scaffold.” Word bank: hesitation, indications, communicate, reference
    Key: reference

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 3? “It was to teach them, that the holiest among us has but attained so far above his fellows as to discern more clearly the Mercy which looks down, and repudiate more utterly the phantom of human merit, which would look _____ upward.”

    A. acknowledged
    B. aspiringly
    C. impediments
    D. womanhood

    Key: B (aspiringly)

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “All around, there were monuments carved with armorial bearings; and on this simple slab of slate—as the curious investigator may still discern, and perplex himself with the purport—there appeared the semblance of an…”, what does “escutcheon” most nearly mean?

    A. one's deepest feelings

B. forever, beyond death

C. a shield bearing a coat of arms

D. like a shifting series of dreamlike images

Key: C (a shield bearing a coat of arms)

21. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Most of the spectators testified to having seen, on the breast of the unhappy minister, a scarlet letter” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 2) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: One account of the revelation. The evidence is “Most of the spectators testified to having seen, on the breast of the unhappy minister, a scarlet letter” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 2).

22. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 5 shapes its tone: “In the spiritual world, the old physician and the minister—mutual victims as they have been—may, unawares, have found their earthly stock of hatred and antipathy transmuted into golden love.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “transmuted” and “antipathy” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 5) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on ‘surer ground.’

    A. Women and independence

    B. Public shame and private identity

    C. Sin and guilt

    D. Hypocrisy and truth

    Key: A (Women and independence)

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 8 to the story's treatment of hypocrisy and truth: “On the threshold she paused—turned partly round—for, perchance, the idea of entering all alone, and all so changed, the home of so intense a former life, was more dreary and desolate than even she could bear.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 8) develops hypocrisy and truth: Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground.". Its words “threshold” and “perchance” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “And Hester Prynne had returned, and taken up her long-forsaken shame!” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 9), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating hypocrisy and truth as central.

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Others contended that the stigma had not been produced until a long time subsequent, when old Roger Chillingworth, being a potent necromancer, had caused it to appear, through the agency of magic and poisonous drugs.”, what does “necromancer” most nearly mean?

    A. a sorcerer

    B. focused together on one point

    C. in a way that cannot be held back

    D. changeable, unsteady moodiness

Key: A (a sorcerer)

26. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Women, more especially—in the continually recurring trials of wounded, wasted, wronged, misplaced, or erring and sinful passion—or with the dreary burden of a heart unyielded, because unvalued and unsought—came to…”, what does “unvalued” most nearly mean?

    A. took cruel pleasure in someone's suffering

    B. not yet healed

    C. long spears with an axe blade, carried by guards

    D. not valued or loved

    Key: D (not valued or loved)

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 13 shapes its tone: “On a field, sable, the letter A, gules.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “letter” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 13) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to public shame and private identity: Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground.". The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

28. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “XXIV: Conclusion”? Chillingworth withers and dies within the year, leaving his property to Pearl; Hester returns and wears the letter freely.

    A. Imagery

    B. Setting

    C. Alliteration

    D. Characterization

    Key: D (Characterization)

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Among many morals which press upon us from the poor minister’s miserable experience, we put only this into a sentence:—‘Be true! Be true! Be true” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 4) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The novel's moral. The evidence is “Among many morals which press upon us from the poor minister’s miserable experience, we put only this into a sentence:—‘Be true! Be true!…” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 4). This develops women and independence: Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground.". The words “experience” and “miserable” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. She returns because "here was yet to be her penitence," resuming the letter of her own will, and the narrator's one moral is "Be true! Be true! Be true!".

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how women and independence develops from XIII: Another View of Hester to XXIV: Conclusion. Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Earlier, in XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3, the text reads “They said that it meant Able; so strong was Hester Prynne, with a woman’s strength”, which shows the changed meaning of the letter. In XXIV: Conclusion, “Among many morals which press upon us from the poor minister’s miserable experience, we put only this into a sentence:—‘Be true! Be true!…” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 4) — The novel's moral. Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground.".

31. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 9? “But, through the remainder of Hester’s life, there were _____ that the recluse of the scarlet letter was the object of love and interest with some inhabitant of another land.”

    A. unquestionably

    B. indications

    C. inferred

    D. systematic

    Key: B (indications)

32. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What is the inscription?

    Sample answer: On a field, sable, the letter A, gules.

33. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 7: “In all those years it had never once been opened; but either she unlocked it, or the decaying wood and iron yielded to her hand, or she glided shadow-like through these _____—and, at all events, went in.” Word bank: inferred, reference, impediments, scaffold

    Key: impediments

34. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 7 to the story's treatment of women and independence: “Near this latter spot, one afternoon, some children were at play, when they beheld a tall woman, in a gray robe, approach the cottage-door.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 7) develops women and independence: Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground.". Its words “afternoon” and “children” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “So Pearl—the elf-child—the demon offspring, as some people, up to that epoch, persisted in considering her—became the…” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 7), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating women and independence as central.

35. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the quotation from XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 2: “Most of the _____ testified to having seen, on the breast of the unhappy minister, a scarlet letter”

    Key: spectators

36. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Which literary element does this describe in “XXIV: Conclusion”? The conclusion offers several accounts of what was seen and withholds certainty.

    A. Irony

    B. Allusion

    C. Alliteration

    D. Structure

    Key: D (Structure)

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Hester finally makes the letter her own.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “Here had been her sin; here, her sorrow; and here was yet to be her penitence” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 11) supports it: She returns because "here was yet to be her penitence," resuming the letter of her own will, and the narrator's one moral is "Be true! Be true! Be true!". But “Among many morals which press upon us from the poor minister’s miserable experience, we put only this into a sentence:—‘Be true! Be true! Be true” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 4) complicates it: the line (the novel's moral) shows the same issue from another side, and its “only”

marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. A fair verdict is that the claim is mostly right but overstated; it needs a limiting clause to cover that passage.

38. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Most of the spectators testified to having seen, on the breast of the unhappy minister, a scarlet letter” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 2)

    A. Dimmesdale on Pearl's nature.

    B. One account of the revelation.

    C. Pearl links the minister to the letter.

    D. Dimmesdale after meeting Mistress Hibbins.

    Key: B (One account of the revelation.)

39. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the word choice in “Here had been her sin; here, her sorrow; and here was yet to be her penitence” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 11). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Why Hester returns. The evidence is “Here had been her sin; here, her sorrow; and here was yet to be her penitence” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 11). This develops women and independence: Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground.". The words “penitence” and “sorrow” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

40. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Claim: Hester finally makes the letter her own. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Here had been her sin; here, her sorrow; and here was yet to be her penitence” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 11).

    Sample answer: She returns because "here was yet to be her penitence," resuming the letter of her own will, and the narrator's one moral is "Be true! Be true! Be true!". The evidence is “Here had been her sin; here, her sorrow; and here was yet to be her penitence” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 11) — Why Hester returns. This develops women and independence: Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground.".

41. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Who inherits his fortune?

    A. Pearl

    B. Hester

    C. The church

    D. The governor

    Key: A (Pearl)

42. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Most of the spectators testified to having seen, on the breast of the unhappy minister, a scarlet letter” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 2) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: One account of the revelation. The evidence is “Most of the spectators testified to having seen, on the breast of the unhappy minister, a scarlet letter” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 2). This develops women and independence: Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground.". The words “spectators” and “testified” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. She returns because "here was yet to be her penitence," resuming the letter of her own will, and the narrator's one moral is "Be true! Be true! Be true!".

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix

Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 4, 2, 6, 18, 19, 20, 9, 11, 12, 13, 21, 14, 22, 23, 24	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	7, 25, 9, 17, 20, 26, 5, 6, 12, 11, 13, 27, 22, 28, 29, 30	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	9, 10, 31, 32, 33, 1, 2, 13, 11, 12, 14, 15, 27, 23, 34, 24	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	9, 25, 35, 33, 26, 13, 12, 21, 11, 36, 27, 14, 15, 30, 24, 37	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	25, 35, 1, 9, 38, 11, 12, 14, 15, 28, 27, 39, 29, 24, 16, 37	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	33, 31, 7, 9, 17, 21, 12, 27, 22, 23, 14, 40, 37, 30, 34, 29	recall 5, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	6, 4, 7, 9, 12, 13, 14, 36, 15, 23, 27, 24, 16, 30, 37, 29	recall 4, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	7, 41, 10, 38, 12, 22, 28, 14, 15, 23, 27, 37, 34, 24, 30, 16	recall 3, inference 2, analysis 6, synthesis 5
College Senior	7, 10, 9, 17, 22, 36, 14, 15, 23, 27, 24, 30, 37, 16, 34, 29	recall 4, inference 0, analysis 6, synthesis 6
Graduate / PhD	3, 7, 10, 9, 27, 23, 14, 22, 28, 40, 24, 16, 37, 42, 34, 30	recall 4, inference 0, analysis 6, synthesis 6

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "XXIV: Conclusion," how does Hawthorne show conclusion? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the structure you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In XXIV: Conclusion, how does Hawthorne develop the idea of conclusion? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the structure in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how XXIV: Conclusion develops the idea of conclusion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of structure and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of XXIV: Conclusion (where it begins, turns and ends) and its structure shape the reader's understanding of conclusion. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what XXIV: Conclusion suggests about conclusion. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's structure and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne uses structure in XXIV: Conclusion to complicate the reader's understanding of conclusion. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate XXIV: Conclusion within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of conclusion responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read XXIV: Conclusion alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of conclusion follows or bends those conventions, using the structure as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to XXIV: Conclusion and its treatment of conclusion. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's structure and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads XXIV: Conclusion as evidence for a larger claim about conclusion in The Scarlet Letter. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads XXIV: Conclusion as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of conclusion. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Scarlet Letter.

SAT-style questions

1. *Women, more especially—in the continually recurring trials of wounded, wasted, wronged, misplaced, or erring and sinful passion—or with the dreary burden of a heart unyielded, because unvalued and unsought—came to Hester's cottage, demanding why they were so wretched, and what the remedy!*

   As used in the text, what does the word "unvalued" most nearly mean?

   A. based on guesswork

   B. the system of coats of arms

   C. not valued or loved

   D. a sorcerer

2. *After many days, when time sufficed for the people to arrange their thoughts in reference to the foregoing scene, there was more than one account of what had been witnessed on the scaffold.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "XXIV: Conclusion"?

   A. The physician probes the minister

B. Conclusion

C. The revelation

D. The minister's vigil

SAT key: 1. C (not valued or loved); 2. B (Conclusion)

Unit test

The Scarlet Letter: unit test · 90 minutes · 50 questions per rigor version (multiple choice, fill in the blank, short answer). The class rigor level picks the version; student auto-adjust applies.

Short-answer scoring guides

Scaffolded support and HS Freshman (2 points): correct answer in a complete sentence with a detail from the text. HS Sophomore to HS Senior (3 points): claim, one accurate quotation, one sentence of explanation. AP to College Sophomore (4 points): precise claim, two embedded quotations, commentary on word choice or structure, link to theme. College Junior to Graduate (5 points): nuanced thesis, close reading of two passages, synthesis across sections, a competing reading answered. Each item lists a sample answer; partial credit is described in the app.

Unit test: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Much to the author’s surprise, and (if he may say so without additional offence) considerably to his amusement, he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented…”, what does “unprecedented” most nearly mean?

   A. never having happened before

   B. took cruel pleasure in someone's suffering

   C. publicly condemned

   D. insulting and mocking

   Key: A (never having happened before)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse, and _____ its last smoking ember in the blood of a certain venerable personage, against whom he is supposed to cherish a peculiar malevolence.” Word bank: quenched, republish, disclaims, unprecedented

   Key: quenched

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “The young pastor’s voice was _____ sweet, rich, deep, and broken.” Word bank: tremulously, meetinghouse, behooves, disarray

   Key: tremulously

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the stranger signal?

   A. Danger

   B. Love

   C. Escape

   D. Silence

   Key: D (Silence)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Here, to witness the scene which we are describing, sat Governor Bellingham himself, with four sergeants about his

chair, bearing _____, as a guard of honor." Word bank: disarray, meetinghouse, halberds, behooves

Key: halberds

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "There he stood, with a border of grizzled locks beneath his skullcap; while his gray eyes, accustomed to the shaded light of his study, were winking, like those of Hester's infant, in the unadulterated sunshine.", what does "skullcap" most nearly mean?

   A. a small, close-fitting cap

   B. removed or done away with

   C. playfully and imaginatively

   D. shut out from society and its protection

   Key: A (a small, close-fitting cap)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who pleads with Hester to name the father?

   A. Chillingworth

   B. Pearl

   C. Dimmesdale

   D. The jailer

   Key: C (Dimmesdale)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "All this enmity and passion had Pearl inherited, by inalienable right, out of Hester's heart.", what does "inalienable" most nearly mean?

   A. not revealed

   B. lacking curiosity (here 'not incurious' means quite curious)

   C. in a sensible, knowing way

   D. unable to be taken away

   Key: D (unable to be taken away)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from VI: Pearl, paragraph 1: "But she named the infant 'Pearl,' as being of great price—_____ with all she had—her mother's only treasure"

   Key: purchased

10. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How do the town's children treat Pearl?

    Sample answer: They gather to fling mud and insults; she fights back.

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Dimmesdale say keeps some sinners silent?

    A. Their nature and their zeal for good works

    B. Love of money

    C. Ignorance

    D. Fear of hell

    Key: A (Their nature and their zeal for good works)

12. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Her only justification lay in the fact, that she had been able to discern no method of rescuing him from a blacker ruin than had overwhelmed herself, except by acquiescing in Roger Chillingworth's scheme of disguise.", what does "acquiescing" most nearly mean?

    A. accepting something without protest

    B. sadly; mournfully

    C. the system of coats of arms

D. focused together on one point

Key: A (accepting something without protest)

13. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Then, she might have come down to us in history, hand in hand with Ann Hutchinson, as the _____ of a religious sect." Word bank: obviated, retrieving, foundress, acquiescing

    Key: foundress

14. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "She who has once been woman, and ceased to be so, might at any moment become a woman again if there were only the magic touch to effect the _____." Word bank: obviated, retrieving, transfiguration, acquiescing

    Key: transfiguration

15. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3: "They said that it meant Able; so strong was Hester Prynne, with a woman's _____"

    Key: strength

16. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What has happened to Hester's appearance?

    Sample answer: Her beauty has turned cold and severe; her hair is hidden.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 7: "her life had turned, in a great _____, from passion and feeling, to thought"

    Key: measure

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the brook do?

    A. Freezes

    B. Babbles but tells no secret

    C. Dries up

    D. Floods

    Key: B (Babbles but tells no secret)

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "It straggled onward into the mystery of the primeval forest.", what does "straggled" most nearly mean?

    A. fully satisfying

    B. carrying too heavy a load

    C. strengthened; given new energy

    D. wandered in a scattered, irregular way

    Key: D (wandered in a scattered, irregular way)

20. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 22: "Once in my life I met the Black Man … This _____ letter is his mark"

    Key: scarlet

21. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "In furtherance of this choice, it so happened that a ship lay in the harbor; one of those questionable cruisers, frequent at that day, which, without being absolutely outlaws of the deep, yet roamed over its surface…", what does "irresponsibility" most nearly mean?

    A. reasoned about life in a thoughtful, abstract way

    B. lack of accountability to anyone

    C. not yet healed

D. prying and suspicious, like an investigator

Key: B (lack of accountability to anyone)

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Not the less, however, came this _____ obtrusive sense of change." Word bank: importunately, tapestried, irresponsibility, underbrush

    Key: importunately

23. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3: "No man, for any _____ period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true"

    Key: considerable

24. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10: "Did I make a _____ with him in the forest"

    Key: contract

25. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] When is the ship due to sail?

    Sample answer: On the fourth day, after the Election Sermon.

26. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does he reveal?

    A. A letter

    B. A will

    C. A knife

    D. His breast

    Key: D (His breast)

27. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18: "Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very _____"

    Key: scaffold

28. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What happens to Dimmesdale?

    A. He is arrested

    B. He recovers

    C. He leaves on the ship

    D. He dies

    Key: D (He dies)

29. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "So etherealized by spirit as he was, and so apotheosized by worshipping admirers, did his footsteps, in the procession, really tread upon the dust of earth?", what does "apotheosized" most nearly mean?

    A. pure; not mixed with anything weaker

    B. based on guesswork

    C. setting aside; declining to pursue

    D. raised to the level of a god; idolized

    Key: D (raised to the level of a god; idolized)

30. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Preface to the Second Edition"?

    A. The prison door and the rose

    B. The physician probes the minister

    C. An author answering his critics

    D. The forest walk

    Key: C (An author answering his critics)

31. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What does this passage most clearly show? "a neutral territory, somewhere between the real world and fairyland, where the Actual and the Imaginary may meet" (The Customhouse, paragraph 44)

    A. The sexton's unknowing irony.

    B. Chillingworth's verdict on concealed sinners.

    C. Hawthorne's definition of romance.

    D. The prison as an image.

    Key: C (Hawthorne's definition of romance.)

32. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What does this passage most clearly show? "I experienced a sensation not altogether physical, yet almost so, of burning heat" (The Customhouse, paragraph 39)

    A. The opening irony about utopias.

    B. The letter's mysterious power.

    C. The letter at the brook's edge.

    D. Pearl on the sunshine.

    Key: B (The letter's mysterious power.)

33. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "Speak, woman … Speak; and give your child a father" (III: The Recognition, paragraph 31) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Mr. Wilson presses Hester. The evidence is "Speak, woman … Speak; and give your child a father" (III: The Recognition, paragraph 31). This develops hypocrisy and truth: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects.

34. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "Thou knowest—for thou hast sympathies which these men lack!—thou knowest what is in my heart" (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 24) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Hester demands Dimmesdale speak. The evidence is "Thou knowest—for thou hast sympathies which these men lack!—thou knowest what is in my heart" (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 24).

35. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What does this passage most clearly show? "None, save the freedom of a broken law" (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 21)

    A. Hawthorne refuses to revise.

    B. Dimmesdale on Pearl's nature.

    C. Hester casts off the letter.

    D. The letter's mysterious power.

    Key: B (Dimmesdale on Pearl's nature.)

36. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "X: The Leech and His Patient"?

    A. An author answering his critics

    B. The revelation

    C. The frame narrative and the found letter

    D. The physician probes the minister

    Key: D (The physician probes the minister)

37. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "old Roger Chillingworth was a striking evidence of man's faculty of transforming himself into a devil, if he will only, for a reasonable space of time, undertake a devil's office" (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 8) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The narrator's judgment. The evidence is "old Roger Chillingworth was a striking evidence of man's faculty of transforming himself into a devil, if he will only, for a reasonable…" (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 8).

38. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "Such was the sympathy of Nature—that wild, heathen Nature of the forest, never subjugated by human law, nor illumined by higher truth—with the bliss of these two spirits" (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 13) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Nature's response. The evidence is "Such was the sympathy of Nature—that wild, heathen Nature of the forest, never subjugated by human law, nor illumined by higher truth—with…" (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 13).

39. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What does this passage most clearly show? "Have I then sold myself … to the fiend" (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 16)

    A. Hester's answer, full of irony for the reader who will learn the truth.

    B. Dimmesdale after meeting Mistress Hibbins.

    C. The changed meaning of the letter.

    D. Anguish as his only truth.

    Key: B (Dimmesdale after meeting Mistress Hibbins.)

40. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "thou shalt know wherefore the minister keeps his hand over his heart" (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 17) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Mistress Hibbins to Pearl. The evidence is "thou shalt know wherefore the minister keeps his hand over his heart" (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 17). This develops public shame and private identity: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit.

41. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "Among many morals which press upon us from the poor minister's miserable experience, we put only this into a sentence:—'Be true! Be true! Be true" (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 4) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The novel's moral. The evidence is "Among many morals which press upon us from the poor minister's miserable experience, we put only this into a sentence:—'Be true! Be true!…" (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 4).

42. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in "The author is constrained, therefore, to republish his introductory sketch without the change of a word" (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 2). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Hawthorne refuses to revise. The evidence is "The author is constrained, therefore, to republish his introductory sketch without the change of a word" (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 2). This develops public

shame and private identity: Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position. The words “introductory” and “constrained” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

43. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment.

    A. Nature and the individual against society

    B. Public shame and private identity

    C. Hypocrisy and truth

    D. Sin and guilt

    Key: D (Sin and guilt)

44. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Which literary element does this describe in “XVI: A Forest Walk”? Sunlight plays around Pearl but vanishes as Hester reaches for it.

    A. Characterization

    B. Plot

    C. Symbolism

    D. Metaphor

    Key: C (Symbolism)

45. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “It runs away and hides itself, because it is afraid of something on your bosom” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Pearl on the sunshine. The evidence is “It runs away and hides itself, because it is afraid of something on your bosom” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4). This develops nature and the individual against society: the forest as a world outside Puritan law. The words “something” and “because” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

46. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter”? Chillingworth tries to stop him: ‘Thou hast escaped me!’

    A. Metaphor

    B. Diction / vocabulary

    C. Personification

    D. Characterization

    Key: D (Characterization)

47. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “Pearl kissed his lips. A spell was broken” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 33). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Pearl's transformation. The evidence is “Pearl kissed his lips. A spell was broken” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 33). This develops hypocrisy and truth: the public confession the novel has waited for. The words “broken” and “kissed” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

48. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community immediately around him” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1) shape

its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: The author describes the local outrage at "The Customhouse.". The evidence is “he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable…” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1). This develops public shame and private identity: Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position. The words “unprecedented” and “introductory” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He says the reaction "could hardly have been more violent" if he had burned down the Customhouse, then announces he will republish "without the change of a word.".

49. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how nature and the individual against society develops from XV: Hester and Pearl to XVI: A Forest Walk. Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: Earlier, in XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 4, the text reads “Yes, I hate him” — Hester's admission. In XVI: A Forest Walk, “Mother … the sunshine does not love you” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4) — Pearl's observation. The forest as a world outside Puritan law.

50. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18) supports it: Chillingworth admits the scaffold was the one place the minister "couldst have escaped me," and when "Pearl kissed his lips. A spell was broken.". But “Is not this better … than what we dreamed of in the forest” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 21) complicates it: the line (Dimmesdale to Hester) shows the same issue from another side, and its “not” marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. The claim is therefore a strong reading, not a complete one, and a careful answer says where it stops applying.

51. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 2: “The author is constrained, therefore, to republish his _____ sketch without the change of a word”

Key: introductory

52. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Pearl say about a Heavenly Father?

A. She loves him

B. She fears him

C. She has met him

D. She has none

Key: D (She has none)

53. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Hester could only account for the child’s character—and even then most vaguely and imperfectly—by recalling what she herself had been, during that momentous period while Pearl was imbibing her soul from the spiritual…”, what does “imbibing” most nearly mean?

A. dislike or distrust of people

B. nearness; closeness

C. taking in, as if drinking

D. mixed together

Key: C (taking in, as if drinking)

54. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Day after day, she looked fearfully into the child's expanding nature, ever dreading to detect some dark and wild peculiarity, that should correspond with the _____ to which she owed her being." Word bank: inalienable, guiltiness, flightiness, imbibing

    Key: guiltiness

55. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Pearl throw at the letter?

    A. Wildflowers
    B. Water
    C. Stones
    D. Mud

    Key: A (Wildflowers)

56. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "She could recognize her wild, desperate, defiant mood, the flightiness of her temper, and even some of the very cloud-shapes of gloom and despondency that had brooded in her heart.", what does "flightiness" most nearly mean?

    A. changeable, unsteady moodiness
    B. that cannot be taken away or cancelled
    C. nearness; closeness
    D. damage (a reputation)

    Key: A (changeable, unsteady moodiness)

57. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who is the Black Man?

    A. A minister
    B. The devil of local legend
    C. Chillingworth's servant
    D. A sailor

    Key: B (The devil of local legend)

58. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where does Hester wait?

    A. In the forest
    B. At home
    C. By the scaffold
    D. At church

    Key: A (In the forest)

59. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4: "Mother … the _____ does not love you"

    Key: sunshine

60. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where is Dimmesdale coming from?

    Sample answer: A visit to the Apostle Eliot among the Native converts.

61. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "'O, a story about the Black Man,' answered Pearl, taking hold of her mother's gown, and looking up, half earnestly, half _____, into her face." Word bank: straggled, humanize, scintillating, mischievously

    Key: mischievously

62. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Pearl set forth, at a great pace, and, as Hester smiled to perceive, did actually catch the sunshine, and stood laughing in the midst of it, all brightened by its splendor, and scintillating with the vivacity excited by…”, what does “scintillating” most nearly mean?

    A. sparkling

    B. the quality of being believable

    C. serving as an introduction to what follows

    D. a complete change of appearance

    Key: A (sparkling)

63. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What avoids Hester?

    A. Sunshine

    B. The brook

    C. Pearl

    D. Birds

    Key: A (Sunshine)

64. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Never was there a more beautiful example of how the majesty of age and wisdom may comport with the obeisance and respect enjoined upon it, as from a lower social rank, and inferior order of endowment, towards a higher.”, what does “comport” most nearly mean?

    A. fit together; agree

    B. like a shifting series of dreamlike images

    C. the state of being guilty

    D. open the fastening of

    Key: A (fit together; agree)

65. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “For an instant, the gaze of the horror-stricken multitude was concentred on the ghastly miracle; while the minister stood, with a flush of triumph in his face, as one who, in the crisis of acutest pain, had won a…”, what does “concentred” most nearly mean?

    A. focused together on one point

    B. reasoned about life in a thoughtful, abstract way

    C. a source that never runs dry

    D. took cruel pleasure in someone's suffering

    Key: A (focused together on one point)

66. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Now was heard again the clangor of the music, and the measured tramp of the military escort, issuing from the church-door.”, what does “clangor” most nearly mean?

    A. speaking at length (about)

    B. one's deepest feelings

    C. a loud, ringing noise

    D. not saved from sin

    Key: C (a loud, ringing noise)

67. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 21: “Is not this better … than what we _____ of in the forest”

    Key: dreamed

68. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community immediately around him” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The author describes the local outrage at "The Customhouse.". The evidence is “he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable…” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1).

69. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Never … It is too deeply branded. Ye cannot take it off. And would that I might endure his agony, as well as mine” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 30)

    A. The mirror in the armor.

    B. The novel's best-known statement on hypocrisy.

    C. Hester's answer, full of irony for the reader who will learn the truth.

    D. Dimmesdale's argument that Pearl is a blessing.

    Key: C (Hester's answer, full of irony for the reader who will learn the truth.)

70. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Chillingworth's probing image. The evidence is “these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10).

71. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “These men deceive themselves” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 16) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Chillingworth's verdict on concealed sinners. The evidence is “These men deceive themselves” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 16). This develops hypocrisy and truth: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception.

72. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “The scarlet letter had not done its office” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The letter's failure as a punishment. The evidence is “The scarlet letter had not done its office” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10). This develops women and independence: Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women.

73. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “XVI: A Forest Walk”?

    A. Hester on the scaffold

    B. The physician probes the minister

    C. The minister's vigil

    D. The forest walk

    Key: D (The forest walk)

74. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “We must not always talk in the marketplace of what happens to us in the forest” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 9) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Hester to Pearl: town against forest. The evidence is “We must not always talk in the marketplace of what happens to us in the forest” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 9).

75. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Which literary element does this describe in “VI: Pearl”? Pearl is dressed in crimson and gold, ‘the scarlet letter in another form.’

    A. Simile

    B. Metaphor

    C. Foreshadowing

    D. Symbolism

    Key: D (Symbolism)

76. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “Thy Heavenly Father sent thee” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 21). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Hester's answer, which Pearl rejects. The evidence is “Thy Heavenly Father sent thee” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 21). This develops sin and guilt: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment. The words “sent” and “thee” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

77. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which literary element does this describe in “XIII: Another View of Hester”? Her life turns ‘from passion and feeling, to thought,’ including radical thoughts about women.

    A. Theme

    B. Foreshadowing

    C. Imagery

    D. Diction / vocabulary

    Key: A (Theme)

78. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: The forest offers freedom, but Hester carries the letter's darkness into it. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Mother … the sunshine does not love you” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4).

    Sample answer: Pearl says "the sunshine does not love you," and Hester tells her "This scarlet letter is his mark!". The evidence is “Mother … the sunshine does not love you” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4) — Pearl's observation. This develops nature and the individual against society: the forest as a world outside Puritan law.

79. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “XX: The Minister in a Maze”? Returning to town, Dimmesdale is tempted to blasphemy, to corrupt a young maiden and to curse.

    A. Personification

    B. Characterization

    C. Alliteration

    D. Diction / vocabulary

    Key: B (Characterization)

80. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Did I make a contract with him in the forest”

(XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10).

Sample answer: He wonders whether he made "a contract with him in the forest," and the narrator warns that no man can "wear one face to himself and another to the multitude" without losing the true one. The evidence is “Did I make a contract with him in the forest” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10) — Dimmesdale fears the Black Man. This develops hypocrisy and truth: the double face.

81. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Child, what art thou” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 13) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Hester's question. The evidence is “Child, what art thou” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 13). This develops sin and guilt: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment. The words “what” and “thou” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Hester names her Pearl "as being of great price,—purchased with all she had," yet asks in fear "Child, what art thou?", and Pearl insists "I have no Heavenly Father!".

82. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is the forest good or evil in the novel? Argue.

Sample answer: A reasoned view: Hester's answer. The evidence is “Once in my life I met the Black Man … This scarlet letter is his mark” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 22). This develops nature and the individual against society: the forest as a world outside Puritan law. Pearl says "the sunshine does not love you," and Hester tells her "This scarlet letter is his mark!".

83. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is the ending just? Argue.

Sample answer: A reasoned view: Dimmesdale to Hester. The evidence is “Is not this better … than what we dreamed of in the forest” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 21). This develops hypocrisy and truth: the public confession the novel has waited for. Chillingworth admits the scaffold was the one place the minister "couldst have escaped me," and when "Pearl kissed his lips. A spell was broken.".

84. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1: “he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an _____ excitement in the respectable community immediately around him”

Key: unprecedented

85. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1: “It could hardly have been more _____, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse”

Key: violent

86. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why is she named Pearl?

A. She is of great price

B. After a ship

C. After her grandmother

D. For her pale skin

Key: A (She is of great price)

87. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4: “It runs away and hides itself, because it is afraid of _____ on your bosom”

Key: something

88. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Hester call the letter?

A. A gift

B. Her shame alone

C. The Black Man's mark

D. An angel's sign

Key: C (The Black Man's mark)

89. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Do not _____ your fame, and perish in dishonor!” Word bank: apotheosized, undisclosed, concentred, blacken

Key: blacken

90. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Pearl do?

A. Kisses him

B. Prays

C. Runs away

D. Screams

Key: A (Kisses him)

91. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where does Dimmesdale confess?

A. On the ship

B. In the pulpit

C. In the forest

D. On the scaffold

Key: D (On the scaffold)

92. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “So _____ by spirit as he was, and so apotheosized by worshipping admirers, did his footsteps, in the procession, really tread upon the dust of earth?” Word bank: concentred, etherealized, apotheosized, undisclosed

Key: etherealized

93. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “A writer of storybooks! What kind of a business in life … may that be” (The Customhouse, paragraph 9) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: His imagined ancestors' contempt for him. The evidence is “A writer of storybooks! What kind of a business in life … may that be” (The Customhouse, paragraph 9). This develops public shame and private identity: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks.".

94. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “I will not speak” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 32) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Hester's refusal. The evidence is “I will not speak” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 32). This develops hypocrisy and truth: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects.

95. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “But she named the infant ‘Pearl,’ as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother’s only treasure” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Why Hester names her Pearl. The evidence is “But she named the infant ‘Pearl,’ as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother’s only treasure” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1).

96. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Child, what art thou” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 13) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Hester's question. The evidence is “Child, what art thou” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 13). This develops sin and guilt: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment.

97. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “He had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 7) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The core of his hypocrisy. The evidence is “He had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 7). This develops hypocrisy and truth: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie.

98. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “A pure hand needs no glove to cover it” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 49)

    A. The sexton's unknowing irony.

    B. One account of the revelation.

    C. The novel's best-known statement on hypocrisy.

    D. Dimmesdale on Pearl's nature.

    Key: A (The sexton's unknowing irony.)

99. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “They said that it meant Able; so strong was Hester Prynne, with a woman’s strength” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The changed meaning of the letter. The evidence is “They said that it meant Able; so strong was Hester Prynne, with a woman’s strength” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3).

100. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “and why does the minister keep his hand over his heart” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 19)

    A. The harshest woman in the crowd.

    B. His imagined ancestors' contempt for him.

    C. The letter at the brook's edge.

    D. Pearl links the minister to the letter.

    Key: D (Pearl links the minister to the letter.)

101. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Come thou and take it up” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 23)

    A. The mirror in the armor.

    B. Dimmesdale after meeting Mistress Hibbins.

    C. Pearl's demand that Hester take up the letter.

    D. The rose-bush as hope.

    Key: C (Pearl's demand that Hester take up the letter.)

102. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Did I make a contract with him in the forest” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Dimmesdale fears the Black Man. The evidence is “Did I make a contract with him in the forest” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10). This develops hypocrisy and truth: the double face.

103. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Hester was clad in a garment of coarse gray cloth” (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 2) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Hester's appearance on the holiday. The evidence is “Hester was clad in a garment of coarse gray cloth”

(XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 2). This develops public shame and private identity: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks.

104. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Most of the spectators testified to having seen, on the breast of the unhappy minister, a scarlet letter” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 2) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: One account of the revelation. The evidence is “Most of the spectators testified to having seen, on the breast of the unhappy minister, a scarlet letter” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 2).

105. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which literary element does this describe in “Preface to the Second Edition”? He calls his satirical sketch harmless and the outrage ‘unprecedented excitement,’ exaggerating to mock his critics.

A. Irony

B. Setting

C. Structure

D. Allusion

Key: A (Irony)

106. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: The letter changes meaning in the community but fails as a punishment. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “The scarlet letter had not done its office” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10).

Sample answer: People say "it meant Able," yet Hawthorne admits "The scarlet letter had not done its office," because Hester's life "had turned ... to thought.". The evidence is “The scarlet letter had not done its office” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10), which shows the letter's failure as a punishment. This develops women and independence: Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women.

107. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? The forest as a world outside Puritan law.

A. Hypocrisy and truth

B. Nature and the individual against society

C. Public shame and private identity

D. Sin and guilt

Key: B (Nature and the individual against society)

108. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? The double face.

A. Hypocrisy and truth

B. Public shame and private identity

C. Nature and the individual against society

D. Sin and guilt

Key: A (Hypocrisy and truth)

109. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter”? The climax: after the sermon Dimmesdale mounts the scaffold with Hester and Pearl, confesses, bares his breast and dies.

A. Allusion

B. Conflict

C. Plot

D. Alliteration

Key: C (Plot)

110. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is Pearl a realistic child or a symbol? Argue.

Sample answer: A reasoned view with evidence for both. The evidence is “But she named the infant ‘Pearl,’ as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother’s only treasure” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1), which shows why Hester names her Pearl. This develops sin and guilt: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment. Hester names her Pearl "as being of great price,—purchased with all she had," yet asks in fear "Child, what art thou?", and Pearl insists "I have no Heavenly Father!".

111. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how sin and guilt develops from IV: The Interview to VI: Pearl. Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: Earlier, in IV: The Interview, paragraph 20, the text reads “Mine was the first wrong, when I betrayed thy budding youth into a false and unnatural relation with my decay” — Chillingworth admits his part. In VI: Pearl, “But she named the infant ‘Pearl,’ as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother’s only treasure” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1), which shows why Hester names her Pearl. Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment.

112. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Does the narrator approve of Hester's thoughts about women? Argue.

Sample answer: A reasoned view: the changed meaning of the letter. The evidence is “They said that it meant Able; so strong was Hester Prynne, with a woman’s strength” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3). This develops women and independence: Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women. People say "it meant Able," yet Hawthorne admits "The scarlet letter had not done its office," because Hester's life "had turned ... to thought.".

113. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Mother … the sunshine does not love you” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Pearl's observation. The evidence is “Mother … the sunshine does not love you” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4). This develops nature and the individual against society: the forest as a world outside Puritan law. The words “sunshine” and “does” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Pearl says "the sunshine does not love you," and Hester tells her "This scarlet letter is his mark!".

114. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse, and quenched its last smoking ember in the blood of a certain venerable personage, against whom he is supposed to cherish a peculiar _____.” Word bank: disclaims, unprecedented, republish, malevolence

Key: malevolence

115. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] In the line “The sportive sunlight—feebly sportive, at best, in the predominant pensiveness of the day and scene—withdrew itself as they came nigh, and left the spots where it had danced the drearier, because they had hoped to find…”, what does “pensiveness” most nearly mean?

A. promising solemnly

B. a poisonous plant

C. restless turning movements

D. deep, sad thoughtfulness

Key: D (deep, sad thoughtfulness)

116. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Who tries to stop him?

    A. Chillingworth

    B. Pearl

    C. Wilson

    D. Hester

    Key: A (Chillingworth)

117. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What does Chillingworth say repeatedly?

    Sample answer: Thou hast escaped me!

118. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “the black flower of civilized society, a prison” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The prison as an image. The evidence is “the black flower of civilized society, a prison” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2). This develops sin and guilt: the colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail.

119. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “Mine was the first wrong, when I betrayed thy budding youth into a false and unnatural relation with my decay” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 20) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Chillingworth admits his part. The evidence is “Mine was the first wrong, when I betrayed thy budding youth into a false and unnatural relation with my decay” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 20).

120. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance” (VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 20) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The mirror in the armor. The evidence is “the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance” (VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 20).

121. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “the letter A, which we interpret to stand for Angel” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 51) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The sexton's reading of the sign. The evidence is “the letter A, which we interpret to stand for Angel” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 51). This develops public shame and private identity: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing.

122. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “I have left thee to the scarlet letter” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 25) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Chillingworth on Hester's punishment. The evidence is “I have left thee to the scarlet letter” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 25). This develops sin and guilt: revenge has made a wise man into a fiend.

123. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “What we did had a consecration of its own. We felt it so! We said so to each other” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 32) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Hester's defense. The evidence is “What we did had a consecration of its own. We felt it so! We said so to each other” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 32).

124. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “she undid the clasp that fastened the scarlet letter, and, taking it from her bosom, threw it to a distance among the withered leaves” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 11) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Hester casts off the letter. The evidence is "she undid the clasp that fastened the scarlet letter, and, taking it from her bosom, threw it to a distance among the withered leaves" (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 11).

125. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? "that this physician here—Chillingworth, he calls himself—is minded to try my cabin-fare with you" (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 24) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The shipmaster's news. The evidence is "that this physician here—Chillingworth, he calls himself—is minded to try my cabin-fare with you" (XXI: The New England Holiday, paragraph 24). This develops public shame and private identity: Hester endures the crowd one last time, she thinks.

126. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Which literary element does this describe in "X: The Leech and His Patient"? Under talk of weeds on an unmarked grave, the physician and the minister argue about whether hidden sinners should confess.

A. Setting

B. Conflict

C. Simile

D. Structure

Key: D (Structure)

127. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception.

A. Nature and the individual against society

B. Sin and guilt

C. Hypocrisy and truth

D. Public shame and private identity

Key: C (Hypocrisy and truth)

128. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the word choice in "Have I then sold myself … to the fiend" (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 16). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: Dimmesdale after meeting Mistress Hibbins. The evidence is "Have I then sold myself … to the fiend" (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 16). This develops hypocrisy and truth: the double face. The words "myself" and "fiend" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

129. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? "On the breast of her gown, in fine red cloth, surrounded with an elaborate embroidery and fantastic flourishes of gold-thread, appeared the letter A" (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 10) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: First description of the letter. The evidence is "On the breast of her gown, in fine red cloth, surrounded with an elaborate embroidery and fantastic flourishes of gold-thread, appeared the…" (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 10).

130. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? "Sooner or later, he must needs be mine" (IV: The Interview, paragraph 22) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: His vow. The evidence is "Sooner or later, he must needs be mine" (IV: The Interview, paragraph 22). This develops sin and guilt: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins.

131. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? "Pearl, seeing the rosebushes, began to cry for a red rose" (VII: The Governor's Hall, paragraph 23)

A. The letter's mysterious power.

B. Mr. Wilson presses Hester.

C. Pearl and the rose.

D. Dimmesdale after meeting Mistress Hibbins.

Key: C (Pearl and the rose.)

132. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “That old man’s revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Dimmesdale's verdict. The evidence is “That old man’s revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31).

133. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The novel's best-known statement on hypocrisy. The evidence is “No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to…” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3).

134. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why is Dimmesdale glad the ship sails after the sermon?

Sample answer: He can preach and leave with his reputation intact. The evidence is “No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to…” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3), which shows the novel's best-known statement on hypocrisy.

135. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Which literary element does this describe in “Preface to the Second Edition”? Hawthorne answers Salem's anger with mock surprise and amusement, refusing to apologize.

A. Allusion

B. Personification

C. Tone / mood

D. Simile

Key: C (Tone / mood)

136. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the word choice in “her life had turned, in a great measure, from passion and feeling, to thought” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 7). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: Hester's change. The evidence is “her life had turned, in a great measure, from passion and feeling, to thought” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 7). This develops women and independence: Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women. The words “feeling” and “measure” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

137. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Which literary element does this describe in “XIII: Another View of Hester”? Seven years on, Hester is a sister of mercy; many say the A means ‘Able.’

A. Characterization

B. Imagery

C. Personification

D. Alliteration

Key: A (Characterization)

138. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? The public confession the novel has waited for.

A. Sin and guilt

B. Women and independence

C. Nature and the individual against society

D. Hypocrisy and truth

Key: D (Hypocrisy and truth)

139. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Synthesis: trace how women and independence develops from XII: The Minister's Vigil to XIII: Another View of Hester. Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: Earlier, in XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 21, the text reads "Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide" — Pearl's question. In XIII: Another View of Hester, "They said that it meant Able; so strong was Hester Prynne, with a woman's strength" (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3), which shows the changed meaning of the letter. Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women.

140. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Can anyone wear two faces without losing the true one? Argue.

Sample answer: A reasoned view: the novel's best-known statement on hypocrisy. The evidence is "No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to…" (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3). This develops hypocrisy and truth: the double face. He wonders whether he made "a contract with him in the forest," and the narrator warns that no man can "wear one face to himself and another to the multitude" without losing the true one.

141. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Synthesis: trace how hypocrisy and truth develops from XX: The Minister in a Maze to XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter. Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: Earlier, in XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3, the text reads "No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to…", which shows the novel's best-known statement on hypocrisy. In XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, "Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold" (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18) — Chillingworth's defeat. The public confession the novel has waited for.

142. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "It throws its unobtrusive tinge throughout the room, with a faint _____ upon the walls and ceiling, and a reflected gleam from the polish of the furniture." Word bank: recreating, dutiable, ruddiness, affrighting

Key: ruddiness

143. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "So, with _____ hearts, and the happy consciousness of being usefully employed—in their own behalf, at least, if not for our beloved country—these good old gentlemen went through the various formalities of office." Word bank: affrighting, recreating, dutiable, lightsome

Key: lightsome

144. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? "The author is constrained, therefore, to republish his introductory sketch without the change of a word" (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 2)

A. Hester's answer, full of irony for the reader who will learn the truth.

B. Hawthorne refuses to revise.

C. The core of his hypocrisy.

D. The opening irony about utopias.

Key: B (Hawthorne refuses to revise.)

145. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “It is a little remarkable, that—though disinclined to talk overmuch of myself and my affairs at the fireside” (The Customhouse, paragraph 1)

A. The opening, with its ironic self-presentation.

B. Hawthorne refuses to revise.

C. Ironic exaggeration of the reaction.

D. Hester demands Dimmesdale speak.

Key: A (The opening, with its ironic self-presentation.)

146. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Thy Heavenly Father sent thee” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 21)

A. Hester's answer, which Pearl rejects.

B. The letter's mysterious power.

C. Chillingworth admits his part.

D. The author describes the local outrage at "The Customhouse."

Key: A (Hester's answer, which Pearl rejects.)

147. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “These men deceive themselves” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 16)

A. The letter isolates Hester.

B. Anguish as his only truth.

C. Chillingworth's verdict on concealed sinners.

D. The mirror in the armor.

Key: C (Chillingworth's verdict on concealed sinners.)

148. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “The scarlet letter had not done its office” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10)

A. Chillingworth admits his part.

B. The letter's failure as a punishment.

C. Dimmesdale on Pearl's nature.

D. The cost of falseness.

Key: B (The letter's failure as a punishment.)

149. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “Once in my life I met the Black Man … This scarlet letter is his mark” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 22) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Hester's answer. The evidence is “Once in my life I met the Black Man … This scarlet letter is his mark” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 22). This develops nature and the individual against society: the forest as a world outside Puritan law.

150. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “Is not this better … than what we dreamed of in the forest” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 21) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Dimmesdale to Hester. The evidence is “Is not this better … than what we dreamed of in the forest” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 21). This develops hypocrisy and truth: the public confession the novel has waited for.

151. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Hawthorne not describe what is revealed?

Sample answer: To keep the meaning uncertain and spiritual. The evidence is “Is not this better … than what we dreamed of in the forest” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 21) — Dimmesdale to Hester.

152. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: The preface shows Hawthorne treating his community's judgment with ironic defiance. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1).

Sample answer: He says the reaction "could hardly have been more violent" if he had burned down the Customhouse, then announces he will republish "without the change of a word.". The evidence is “It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1) — Ironic exaggeration of the reaction. This develops public shame and private identity: Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position.

153. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: "The Customhouse" frames the novel as a romance that joins history and imagination. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “a neutral territory, somewhere between the real world and fairyland, where the Actual and the Imaginary may meet” (The Customhouse, paragraph 44).

Sample answer: The narrator presents a real document and a real rag yet says the letter gave "a sensation not altogether physical," and defines his art as "a neutral territory" where "the Actual and the Imaginary may meet.". The evidence is “a neutral territory, somewhere between the real world and fairyland, where the Actual and the Imaginary may meet” (The Customhouse, paragraph 44) — Hawthorne's definition of romance. This develops public shame and private identity: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks.".

154. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.5] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? “Speak, woman … Speak; and give your child a father”

A. V: Hester at Her Needle

B. VII: The Governor’s Hall

C. VI: Pearl

D. III: The Recognition

Key: D (III: The Recognition)

155. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the word choice in “Never … It is too deeply branded. Ye cannot take it off. And would that I might endure his agony, as well as mine” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 30). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: Hester's answer, full of irony for the reader who will learn the truth. The evidence is “Never … It is too deeply branded. Ye cannot take it off. And would that I might endure his agony, as well as mine” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 30). This develops hypocrisy and truth: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects. The words “branded” and “cannot” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

156. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Which literary element does this describe in “III: The Recognition”? A deformed, learned stranger in the crowd recognizes Hester and signals her to be silent.

A. Theme

B. Characterization

C. Setting

D. Metaphor

Key: B (Characterization)

157. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Which literary element does this describe in “VI: Pearl”? Pearl is beautiful, wild, intelligent and ungovernable; Hester fears what she has passed on to her.

A. Characterization

B. Personification

C. Imagery

D. Irony

Key: A (Characterization)

158. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the word choice in “None, save the freedom of a broken law” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 21). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: Dimmesdale on Pearl's nature. The evidence is “None, save the freedom of a broken law” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 21). This develops hypocrisy and truth: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception. The words “freedom” and “broken” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

159. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: Public confession frees Dimmesdale and Pearl and defeats Chillingworth. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18).

Sample answer: Chillingworth admits the scaffold was the one place the minister "couldst have escaped me," and when "Pearl kissed his lips. A spell was broken.". The evidence is “Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18) — Chillingworth's defeat. This develops hypocrisy and truth: the public confession the novel has waited for.

160. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Synthesis: trace how public shame and private identity develops from the opening of “Preface to the Second Edition” to its ending. Use one quotation from each part.

Sample answer: Near the start, “he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable…” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1), which shows the author describes the local outrage at "The Customhouse.". Later, “The author is constrained, therefore, to republish his introductory sketch without the change of a word” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 2) — Hawthorne refuses to revise. Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position.

161. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Synthesis: trace how hypocrisy and truth develops from II: The Marketplace to III: The Recognition. Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: Earlier, in II: The Marketplace, paragraph 10, the text reads “On the breast of her gown, in fine red cloth, surrounded with an elaborate embroidery and fantastic flourishes of gold-thread, appeared the…” — First description of the

letter. In III: The Recognition, “Speak, woman … Speak; and give your child a father” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 31) — Mr. Wilson presses Hester. The man who begs her to speak is the man she protects.

162. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “But she named the infant ‘Pearl,’ as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother’s only treasure” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: Why Hester names her Pearl. The evidence is “But she named the infant ‘Pearl,’ as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother’s only treasure” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1). This develops sin and guilt: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment. The words “purchased” and “treasure” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Hester names her Pearl "as being of great price,—purchased with all she had," yet asks in fear "Child, what art thou?", and Pearl insists "I have no Heavenly Father!".

163. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “They said that it meant Able; so strong was Hester Prynne, with a woman’s strength” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: The changed meaning of the letter. The evidence is “They said that it meant Able; so strong was Hester Prynne, with a woman’s strength” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3). This develops women and independence: Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women. The words “strength” and “strong” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. People say "it meant Able," yet Hawthorne admits "The scarlet letter had not done its office," because Hester's life "had turned ... to thought.".

164. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Do you agree with Dimmesdale's ranking of sins? Argue.
Sample answer: A reasoned view: Dimmesdale's verdict. The evidence is “That old man’s revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31). This develops sin and guilt: a hierarchy of sins. Dimmesdale calls Chillingworth's revenge "blacker than my sin" because it "violated ... the sanctity of a human heart," and Hester insists "What we did had a consecration of its own.".

165. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Did I make a contract with him in the forest” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: Dimmesdale fears the Black Man. The evidence is “Did I make a contract with him in the forest” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10). This develops hypocrisy and truth: the double face. The words “contract” and “forest” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He wonders whether he made "a contract with him in the forest," and the narrator warns that no man can "wear one face to himself and another to the multitude" without losing the true one.

166. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Synthesis: trace how hypocrisy and truth develops from XV: Hester and Pearl to XX: The Minister in a Maze. Use one quotation from each.
Sample answer: Earlier, in XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 4, the text reads “Yes, I hate him” — Hester's admission. In XX: The Minister in a Maze, “No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to…” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3), which shows the novel's best-known statement on hypocrisy. The double face.

167. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: The novel's best-known statement on hypocrisy. The evidence is “No man, for any considerable period, can

wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to…" (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3). This develops hypocrisy and truth: the double face. The words "considerable" and "bewildered" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He wonders whether he made "a contract with him in the forest," and the narrator warns that no man can "wear one face to himself and another to the multitude" without losing the true one.

168. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Much to the author's surprise, and (if he may say so without additional offence) considerably to his amusement, he finds that his sketch of official life, _____ to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community…" Word bank: introductory, unprecedented, disclaims, republish

    Key: introductory

169. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Complete the quotation from The Customhouse, paragraph 9: "A writer of _____! What kind of a business in life … may that be"

    Key: storybooks

170. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Who taunts Pearl?

    A. The governor

    B. Sailors

    C. Puritan children

    D. Chillingworth

    Key: C (Puritan children)

171. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What can you infer from this line? "It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse" (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Ironic exaggeration of the reaction. The evidence is "It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse" (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1). This develops public shame and private identity: Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position.

172. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Why is Dimmesdale's plea ironic?

    Sample answer: He is the father, urging her to name him while he hides. The evidence is "for, believe me, Hester, though he were to step down from a high place, and stand there beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame, yet better…" (III: The Recognition, paragraph 26) — Dimmesdale's double-edged plea.

173. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What does this passage most clearly show? "They said that it meant Able; so strong was Hester Prynne, with a woman's strength" (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 3)

    A. The changed meaning of the letter.

    B. The end of the chapter.

    C. The sexton's reading of the sign.

    D. The core of his hypocrisy.

    Key: A (The changed meaning of the letter.)

174. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What can you infer from this line? "Mother … the sunshine does not love you" (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Pearl's observation. The evidence is “Mother … the sunshine does not love you” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4). This develops nature and the individual against society: the forest as a world outside Puritan law.

175. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Why does the sunshine avoid Hester?
Sample answer: Something on her bosom, the letter, keeps it away. The evidence is “It runs away and hides itself, because it is afraid of something on your bosom” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4) — Pearl on the sunshine.

176. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What does this passage most clearly show? “It runs away and hides itself, because it is afraid of something on your bosom” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 4)

A. First description of the letter.
B. The letter's "new sense."
C. Pearl on the sunshine.
D. Hawthorne's definition of romance.

Key: C (Pearl on the sunshine.)

177. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Why does Dimmesdale say he cannot flee alone?
Sample answer: He lacks the strength: Dimmesdale's verdict. The evidence is “That old man’s revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31).

178. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Why does Hester return?
Sample answer: Boston is where her sin, sorrow and penitence belong. The evidence is “Here had been her sin; here, her sorrow; and here was yet to be her penitence” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 11) — Why Hester returns.

179. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Claim: Pearl is both Hester's treasure and the visible sign of her sin. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “But she named the infant ‘Pearl,’ as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother’s only treasure” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1).
Sample answer: Hester names her Pearl "as being of great price,—purchased with all she had," yet asks in fear "Child, what art thou?", and Pearl insists "I have no Heavenly Father!". The evidence is “But she named the infant ‘Pearl,’ as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother’s only treasure” (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1), which shows why Hester names her Pearl. This develops sin and guilt: Hester wonders whether her child is a blessing or a living punishment.

180. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] In this chapter, which theme does the following most directly develop? Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women.

A. Sin and guilt
B. Hypocrisy and truth
C. Women and independence
D. Public shame and private identity

Key: C (Women and independence)

181. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Claim: Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Peace, Hester, peace … It is not granted me to pardon” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 32).
Sample answer: The narrator calls him evidence of "man's faculty of transforming himself into a devil," and he himself asks "A fiend! Who made me so?" yet says "It is not granted me to pardon.". The evidence is “Peace, Hester, peace … It is not

granted me to pardon” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 32) — Chillingworth's refusal. This develops sin and guilt: revenge has made a wise man into a fiend.

182. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Claim: In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “That old man’s revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31).

Sample answer: Dimmesdale calls Chillingworth's revenge "blacker than my sin" because it "violated ... the sanctity of a human heart," and Hester insists "What we did had a consecration of its own.". The evidence is “That old man’s revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31) — Dimmesdale's verdict. This develops sin and guilt: a hierarchy of sins.

183. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Which literary element does this describe in “XX: The Minister in a Maze”? He feels a new energy and writes the Election Sermon with fervor.

A. Irony

B. Conflict

C. Personification

D. Hyperbole

Key: A (Irony)

184. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “for, believe me, Hester, though he were to step down from a high place, and stand there beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame, yet better were it so than to…” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 26) supports it: He says it is better to stand "beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame" than "to hide a guilty heart through life," and Hester answers "I will not speak!". But “Never … It is too deeply branded. Ye cannot take it off. And would that I might endure his agony, as well as mine” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 30) complicates it: Hester's answer, full of irony for the reader who will learn the truth, and its “Never” marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. Weighing the two passages, the claim survives, but only once it admits the tension the second passage creates.

185. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Is Hester's silence admirable or harmful? Argue.

Sample answer: A reasoned view weighing loyalty against truth. The evidence is “Never … It is too deeply branded. Ye cannot take it off. And would that I might endure his agony, as well as mine” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 30) — Hester's answer, full of irony for the reader who will learn the truth. This develops hypocrisy and truth: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects. He says it is better to stand "beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame" than "to hide a guilty heart through life," and Hester answers "I will not speak!".

186. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Chillingworth's probing image. The evidence is “these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10). This develops hypocrisy and truth: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception. The words “manifest” and “unspoken” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He describes weeds springing "out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime" and insists "These

men deceive themselves," and when he finally sees the minister's breast his joy differs from Satan's only by "the trait of wonder in it!".

187. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “The scarlet letter had not done its office” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: The letter's failure as a punishment. The evidence is “The scarlet letter had not done its office” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10). This develops women and independence: Hester imagines the whole system of society torn down and rebuilt for women. The words “scarlet” and “letter” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. People say "it meant Able," yet Hawthorne admits "The scarlet letter had not done its office," because Hester's life "had turned ... to thought.".

188. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Once in my life I met the Black Man … This scarlet letter is his mark” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 22) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Hester's answer. The evidence is “Once in my life I met the Black Man … This scarlet letter is his mark” (XVI: A Forest Walk, paragraph 22). This develops nature and the individual against society: the forest as a world outside Puritan law. The words “scarlet” and “letter” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Pearl says "the sunshine does not love you," and Hester tells her "This scarlet letter is his mark!".

189. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Dimmesdale's plan to flee loosens all his moral restraints.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “Did I make a contract with him in the forest” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10) supports it: He wonders whether he made "a contract with him in the forest," and the narrator warns that no man can "wear one face to himself and another to the multitude" without losing the true one. But “No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3) complicates it: The novel's best-known statement on hypocrisy, and its “No” marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. A fair verdict is that the claim is mostly right but overstated; it needs a limiting clause to cover that passage.

190. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Chillingworth's defeat. The evidence is “Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18). This develops hypocrisy and truth: the public confession the novel has waited for. The words “scaffold” and “couldst” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Chillingworth admits the scaffold was the one place the minister "couldst have escaped me," and when "Pearl kissed his lips. A spell was broken.".

191. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Complete the quotation from The Customhouse, paragraph 39: “I _____ a sensation not altogether physical, yet almost so, of burning heat”

Key: experienced

192. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] In the line “It seemed, at this point, as if the minister must leave the remainder of his secret undisclosed.”, what does “undisclosed” most nearly mean?

    A. raised to the level of a god; idolized

    B. a loud, ringing noise

    C. not revealed

    D. focused together on one point

    Key: C (not revealed)

193. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Why has the letter 'not done its office'?

    Sample answer: It made her think freely, not repent. The evidence is “The scarlet letter had not done its office” (XIII: Another View of Hester, paragraph 10), which shows the letter's failure as a punishment.

194. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] What does this passage most clearly show? “Did I make a contract with him in the forest” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 10)

    A. Pearl on the sunshine.

    B. First description of the letter.

    C. Hester casts off the letter.

    D. Dimmesdale fears the Black Man.

    Key: D (Dimmesdale fears the Black Man.)

195. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] What does this passage most clearly show? “No man, for any considerable period, can wear one face to himself, and another to the multitude, without finally getting bewildered as to which may be the true” (XX: The Minister in a Maze, paragraph 3)

    A. The novel's best-known statement on hypocrisy.

    B. Hester's fear of him.

    C. Chillingworth on Hester's punishment.

    D. Pearl links the minister to the letter.

    Key: A (The novel's best-known statement on hypocrisy.)

196. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? “Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold”

    A. XV: Hester and Pearl

    B. XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter

    C. XIV: Hester and the Physician

    D. XII: The Minister’s Vigil

    Key: B (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter)

197. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Does 'The Customhouse' help or hurt the novel? Argue.

    Sample answer: A reasoned view about the frame's purpose and pace. The evidence is “It is a little remarkable, that—though disinclined to talk overmuch of myself and my affairs at the fireside” (The Customhouse, paragraph 1), which shows the opening, with its ironic self-presentation. This develops public shame and private identity: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks.". The narrator presents a real document and a real rag yet says the letter gave "a sensation not altogether physical," and defines his art as "a neutral territory" where "the Actual and the Imaginary may meet.".

198. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Sooner or later, he must needs be mine” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 22) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: His vow. The evidence is “Sooner or later, he must needs be mine” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 22). This develops sin and guilt: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins. The words “needs” and “later” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He admits "Mine was the first wrong," yet vows that the unknown father "must needs be mine," and Hester can only ask whether he is "the Black Man that haunts the forest.".

199. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “It was the scarlet letter in another form; the scarlet letter endowed with life” (VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 4) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Pearl's dress. The evidence is “It was the scarlet letter in another form; the scarlet letter endowed with life” (VII: The Governor’s Hall, paragraph 4). This develops public shame and private identity: the letter dominates Hester's image in the eyes of authority. The words “another” and “scarlet” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. In the breastplate the letter appears "in exaggerated and gigantic proportions," and Pearl herself is "the scarlet letter endowed with life!".

200. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “These men deceive themselves” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 16) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Chillingworth's verdict on concealed sinners. The evidence is “These men deceive themselves” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 16). This develops hypocrisy and truth: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception. The words “themselves” and “deceive” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He describes weeds springing "out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime" and insists "These men deceive themselves," and when he finally sees the minister's breast his joy differs from Satan's only by "the trait of wonder in it!".

201. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Chillingworth's revenge has destroyed him more than his victim.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “Peace, Hester, peace … It is not granted me to pardon” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 32) supports it: The narrator calls him evidence of "man's faculty of transforming himself into a devil," and he himself asks "A fiend! Who made me so?" yet says "It is not granted me to pardon.". But “old Roger Chillingworth was a striking evidence of man’s faculty of transforming himself into a devil, if he will only, for a reasonable space of time,…” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 8) complicates it: the line (the narrator's judgment) shows the same issue from another side, and its “only” marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. A fair verdict is that the claim is mostly right but overstated; it needs a limiting clause to cover that passage.

202. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “I have left thee to the scarlet letter” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 25) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Chillingworth on Hester's punishment. The evidence is “I have left thee to the scarlet letter” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 25). This develops sin and guilt: revenge has made a wise man into a fiend. The words “scarlet” and “letter” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The narrator calls him evidence of "man's faculty of transforming himself into a devil," and he himself asks "A fiend! Who made me so?" yet says "It is not granted me to pardon.".

203. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Synthesis: trace how sin and guilt develops from XIV: Hester and the Physician to XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner. Use one quotation from each.
Sample answer: Earlier, in XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 8, the text reads “old Roger Chillingworth was a striking evidence of man’s faculty of transforming himself into a devil, if he will only, for a reasonable…” — The narrator's judgment. In XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, “What we did had a consecration of its own. We felt it so! We said so to each other” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 32) — Hester's defense. A hierarchy of sins.

204. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Is the narrator celebrating or warning? Argue.
Sample answer: A reasoned view: the narrator's qualification. The evidence is “She had wandered, without rule or guidance, in a moral wilderness” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 2). This develops nature and the individual against society: nature responds to their happiness. Nature shows "sympathy" with "these two spirits," yet Hester has "wandered, without rule or guidance, in a moral wilderness.".

205. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “We must not always talk in the marketplace of what happens to us in the forest” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 9) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: Hester to Pearl: town against forest. The evidence is “We must not always talk in the marketplace of what happens to us in the forest” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 9). This develops public shame and private identity: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit. The words “marketplace” and “happens” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Hester must stand in the marketplace while the minister preaches, the contrast the narrator draws: "The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace!".

206. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “thou shalt know wherefore the minister keeps his hand over his heart” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 17) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: Mistress Hibbins to Pearl. The evidence is “thou shalt know wherefore the minister keeps his hand over his heart” (XXII: The Procession, paragraph 17). This develops public shame and private identity: Hester in her "magic circle of ignominy" while the minister triumphs in the pulpit. The words “wherefore” and “minister” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Hester must stand in the marketplace while the minister preaches, the contrast the narrator draws: "The sainted minister in the church! The woman of the scarlet letter in the marketplace!".

207. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Is not this better … than what we dreamed of in the forest” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 21) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: Dimmesdale to Hester. The evidence is “Is not this better … than what we dreamed of in the forest” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 21). This develops hypocrisy and truth: the public confession the novel has waited for. The words “dreamed” and “better” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Chillingworth admits the scaffold was the one place the minister "couldst have escaped me," and when "Pearl kissed his lips. A spell was broken.".

208. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Which choice best states a central concern of “XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter”?

A. The revelation

B. The interview in prison

C. The Governor's hall

D. Hester on the scaffold

Key: A (The revelation)

209. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? “he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable community immediately around him”

A. VII: The Governor’s Hall

B. XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter

C. Preface to the Second Edition

D. XXII: The Procession

Key: C (Preface to the Second Edition)

210. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “III: The Recognition”? Dimmesdale, urged to make Hester name her partner, pleads with her to do it.

A. Symbolism

B. Point of view

C. Irony

D. Plot

Key: C (Irony)

211. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner”? Dimmesdale's despair; Hester's strength: ‘Thou shalt not go alone!’

A. Alliteration

B. Diction / vocabulary

C. Imagery

D. Characterization

Key: D (Characterization)

212. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Synthesis: trace how public shame and private identity develops from Preface to the Second Edition to The Customhouse. Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: Earlier, in Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1, the text reads “he finds that his sketch of official life, introductory to The Scarlet Letter, has created an unprecedented excitement in the respectable…”, which shows the author describes the local outrage at "The Customhouse.". In The Customhouse, “A writer of storybooks! What kind of a business in life … may that be” (The Customhouse, paragraph 9), which shows his imagined ancestors' contempt for him. Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks.".

213. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “This woman has brought shame upon us all, and ought to die. Is there not law for it” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 7) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: The harshest woman in the crowd. The evidence is “This woman has brought shame upon us all, and ought to die. Is there not law for it” (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 7). This develops public shame and private identity: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art. The words “brought” and “shame” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Instead of a plain badge she wears a letter with "fantastic flourishes of gold thread," and it has "the effect of a spell" that sets her "in a sphere by herself.".

214. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Mine was the first wrong, when I betrayed thy budding youth into a false and unnatural relation with my decay” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 20) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Chillingworth admits his part. The evidence is “Mine was the first wrong, when I betrayed thy budding youth into a false and unnatural relation with my decay” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 20). This develops sin and guilt: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins. The words “unnatural” and “relation” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He admits "Mine was the first wrong," yet vows that the unknown father "must needs be mine," and Hester can only ask whether he is "the Black Man that haunts the forest.".

215. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “God gave me the child … She is my happiness!—she is my torture, none the less” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 22) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Hester's plea. The evidence is “God gave me the child … She is my happiness!—she is my torture, none the less” (VIII: The Elf-Child and the Minister, paragraph 22). This develops sin and guilt: Dimmesdale's speech defends Hester and reveals his own pain. The words “happiness” and “torture” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Hester calls on him, "thou knowest what is in my heart," and he argues for the child she calls "my happiness" and "my torture.".

216. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10) supports it: He describes weeds springing "out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime" and insists "These men deceive themselves," and when he finally sees the minister's breast his joy differs from Satan's only by "the trait of wonder in it!". But “But what distinguished the physician’s ecstasy from Satan’s was the trait of wonder in it” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 45) complicates it: The end of the chapter, and its “But” marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. The claim is therefore a strong reading, not a complete one, and a careful answer says where it stops applying.

217. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Synthesis: trace how hypocrisy and truth develops from X: The Leech and His Patient to XI: The Interior of a Heart. Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: Earlier, in X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10, the text reads “these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime” — Chillingworth's probing image. In XI: The Interior of a Heart, “He had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 7), which shows the core of his hypocrisy. His "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie.

218. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 21) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Pearl's question. The evidence is “Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide” (XII: The Minister’s Vigil, paragraph 21). This develops public shame and private identity: a private, unseen confession that changes nothing. The words “noontide” and “tomorrow” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He refuses Pearl's request to stand with them "tomorrow noontide," and the town reads the red letter as "Angel" while the sexton praises "a pure hand.".

219. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Synthesis: trace how sin and guilt develops from IX: The Leech to XIV: Hester and the Physician. Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: Earlier, in IX: The Leech, paragraph 7, the text reads “it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart” — Dimmesdale's telltale gesture. In XIV: Hester and the Physician, “old Roger Chillingworth was a striking evidence of man’s faculty of transforming himself into a devil, if he will only, for a

reasonable…" (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 8) — The narrator's judgment. Revenge has made a wise man into a fiend.

220. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Is Hester's lie justified? Argue.
Sample answer: A reasoned view: Hester's admission. The evidence is "Yes, I hate him" (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 4). This develops hypocrisy and truth: Hester's first lie to Pearl. She asks "what does the scarlet letter mean?" and "why does the minister keep his hand over his heart?", and Hester, who has never lied, evades her.

221. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "What we did had a consecration of its own. We felt it so! We said so to each other" (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 32) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: Hester's defense. The evidence is "What we did had a consecration of its own. We felt it so! We said so to each other" (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 32). This develops sin and guilt: a hierarchy of sins. The words "consecration" and "other" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Dimmesdale calls Chillingworth's revenge "blacker than my sin" because it "violated ... the sanctity of a human heart," and Hester insists "What we did had a consecration of its own.".

222. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Synthesis: trace how public shame and private identity develops from XII: The Minister's Vigil to XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side. Use one quotation from each.
Sample answer: Earlier, in XII: The Minister's Vigil, paragraph 21, the text reads "Wilt thou stand here with mother and me, tomorrow noontide" — Pearl's question. In XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, "there lay the scarlet letter, so close upon the margin of the stream, that the gold embroidery was reflected in it" (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 21), which shows the letter at the brook's edge. The letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child.

223. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Among many morals which press upon us from the poor minister's miserable experience, we put only this into a sentence:—'Be true! Be true! Be true" (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 4) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: The novel's moral. The evidence is "Among many morals which press upon us from the poor minister's miserable experience, we put only this into a sentence:—'Be true! Be true!…" (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 4). This develops women and independence: Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground.". The words "experience" and "miserable" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. She returns because "here was yet to be her penitence," resuming the letter of her own will, and the narrator's one moral is "Be true! Be true! Be true!".

224. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Why does Hester worry about Pearl?
Sample answer: She fears the child inherited her passion and sin. The evidence is "But she named the infant 'Pearl,' as being of great price—purchased with all she had—her mother's only treasure" (VI: Pearl, paragraph 1), which shows why Hester names her Pearl.

225. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in "The Customhouse"? Satirical sketches of the aged officers, especially the Inspector, whose only memories are of good dinners.

A. Irony
B. Hyperbole
C. Diction / vocabulary
D. Characterization

Key: D (Characterization)

226. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Analyze the word choice in “I experienced a sensation not altogether physical, yet almost so, of burning heat” (The Customhouse, paragraph 39). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: The letter's mysterious power. The evidence is “I experienced a sensation not altogether physical, yet almost so, of burning heat” (The Customhouse, paragraph 39). This develops public shame and private identity: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks.". The words “experienced” and “altogether” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

227. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “XIV: Hester and the Physician”? Hester tells him she will reveal his identity to Dimmesdale.

A. Metaphor

B. Structure

C. Conflict

D. Personification

Key: C (Conflict)

228. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Analyze the word choice in “Peace, Hester, peace … It is not granted me to pardon” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 32). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: Chillingworth's refusal. The evidence is “Peace, Hester, peace … It is not granted me to pardon” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 32). This develops sin and guilt: revenge has made a wise man into a fiend. The words “granted” and “pardon” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

229. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “XVI: A Forest Walk”? The forest path, dark and wild, with sunshine that flees from Hester.

A. Characterization

B. Personification

C. Theme

D. Setting

Key: D (Setting)

230. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? “What we did had a consecration of its own. We felt it so! We said so to each other”

A. IX: The Leech

B. XV: Hester and Pearl

C. XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine

D. XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner

Key: D (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner)

231. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Ironic exaggeration of the reaction. The evidence is “It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1). This develops public shame and private identity: Hawthorne himself has been judged by his "respectable community," a small echo of Hester's position. The words

"violent" and "burned" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He says the reaction "could hardly have been more violent" if he had burned down the Customhouse, then announces he will republish "without the change of a word.".

232. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "On the breast of her gown, in fine red cloth, surrounded with an elaborate embroidery and fantastic flourishes of gold-thread, appeared the letter A" (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 10) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: First description of the letter. The evidence is "On the breast of her gown, in fine red cloth, surrounded with an elaborate embroidery and fantastic flourishes of gold-thread, appeared the…" (II: The Marketplace, paragraph 10). This develops public shame and private identity: Hester makes the badge of shame into an elaborate work of art. The words "embroidery" and "surrounded" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Instead of a plain badge she wears a letter with "fantastic flourishes of gold thread," and it has "the effect of a spell" that sets her "in a sphere by herself.".

233. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "I will not speak" (III: The Recognition, paragraph 32) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Hester's refusal. The evidence is "I will not speak" (III: The Recognition, paragraph 32). This develops hypocrisy and truth: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects. The words "speak" and "will" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He says it is better to stand "beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame" than "to hide a guilty heart through life," and Hester answers "I will not speak!".

234. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Is the letter working as the magistrates intended? Argue.

Sample answer: A reasoned view with evidence from the chapter. The evidence is "she felt or fancied, then, that the scarlet letter had endowed her with a new sense" (V: Hester at Her Needle, paragraph 11), which shows the letter's "new sense.". This develops public shame and private identity: Hester chooses to stay where she sinned, making it the scene of her penance. She stays because "here should be the scene of her earthly punishment," and feels the letter "had endowed her with a new sense" of hidden sin.

235. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "the fire in his laboratory had been brought from the lower regions" (IX: The Leech, paragraph 17) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: The townspeople's suspicion. The evidence is "the fire in his laboratory had been brought from the lower regions" (IX: The Leech, paragraph 17). This develops sin and guilt: the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret. The words "laboratory" and "brought" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Dimmesdale's habit "to press his hand over his heart" draws the physician close, and the town comes to believe he is haunted by "Satan's emissary, in the guise of old Roger Chillingworth.".

236. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "He had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood" (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 7) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: The core of his hypocrisy. The evidence is "He had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood" (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 7). This develops hypocrisy and truth: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie. The words "transformed" and "falsehood" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Hawthorne says he "had spoken the very truth, and transformed it into the veriest falsehood," and that only "the anguish in his inmost soul" gives him "a real existence.".

237. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “old Roger Chillingworth was a striking evidence of man’s faculty of transforming himself into a devil, if he will only, for a reasonable space of time, undertake a devil’s office” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 8) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The narrator's judgment. The evidence is “old Roger Chillingworth was a striking evidence of man’s faculty of transforming himself into a devil, if he will only, for a reasonable…” (XIV: Hester and the Physician, paragraph 8). This develops sin and guilt: revenge has made a wise man into a fiend. The words “transforming” and “reasonable” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The narrator calls him evidence of "man's faculty of transforming himself into a devil," and he himself asks "A fiend! Who made me so?" yet says "It is not granted me to pardon.".

238. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Evaluate this claim about the chapter: “In the forest, Hester and Dimmesdale redefine their sin.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “That old man’s revenge has been blacker than my sin. He has violated, in cold blood, the sanctity of a human heart” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 31) supports it: Dimmesdale calls Chillingworth's revenge "blacker than my sin" because it "violated ... the sanctity of a human heart," and Hester insists "What we did had a consecration of its own.". But “Thou shalt not go alone” (XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner, paragraph 56) complicates it: the line (Hester's promise) shows the same issue from another side, and its “not” marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. So the claim stands only in a qualified form: true of the chapter's main pattern, but not of every moment in it.

239. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “she undid the clasp that fastened the scarlet letter, and, taking it from her bosom, threw it to a distance among the withered leaves” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 11) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Hester casts off the letter. The evidence is “she undid the clasp that fastened the scarlet letter, and, taking it from her bosom, threw it to a distance among the withered leaves” (XVIII: A Flood of Sunshine, paragraph 11). This develops nature and the individual against society: nature responds to their happiness. The words “withered” and “distance” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Nature shows "sympathy" with "these two spirits," yet Hester has "wandered, without rule or guidance, in a moral wilderness.".

240. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “there lay the scarlet letter, so close upon the margin of the stream, that the gold embroidery was reflected in it” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 21) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: The letter at the brook's edge. The evidence is “there lay the scarlet letter, so close upon the margin of the stream, that the gold embroidery was reflected in it” (XIX: The Child at the Brook-Side, paragraph 21). This develops public shame and private identity: the letter has become part of Hester's identity even for her child. The words “embroidery” and “reflected” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. She refuses to come until Hester restores the letter and asks whether the minister will go "hand in hand, we three together, into the town.".

241. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] What can you infer from this line? “Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Chillingworth's defeat. The evidence is “Hadst thou sought the whole earth over … there was no one place so secret … where thou couldst have escaped me—save on this very scaffold” (XXIII: The Revelation of the Scarlet Letter, paragraph 18).

242. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “The Customhouse”? A first-person narrator, close to Hawthorne himself, describes his years as surveyor and frames the novel as an edited old record.

A. Theme

B. Point of view

C. Irony

D. Setting

Key: B (Point of view)

243. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “I: The Prison-Door”? The wild rose-bush beside the door, offered as ‘some sweet moral blossom.’

A. Structure

B. Point of view

C. Alliteration

D. Symbolism

Key: D (Symbolism)

244. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Claim: The first chapter sets nature's mercy against society's punishment. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “the black flower of civilized society, a prison” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2).

Sample answer: The prison is "the black flower of civilized society," but beside it grows a rose-bush that may "symbolize some sweet moral blossom.". The evidence is “the black flower of civilized society, a prison” (I: The Prison-Door, paragraph 2), which shows the prison as an image. This develops sin and guilt: the colony's first practical needs are a burial ground and a jail.

245. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Claim: Dimmesdale's plea is dramatic irony: he argues against his own concealment. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “for, believe me, Hester, though he were to step down from a high place, and stand there beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame, yet better were it so than to hide a guilty heart through life” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 26).

Sample answer: He says it is better to stand "beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame" than "to hide a guilty heart through life," and Hester answers "I will not speak!". The evidence is “for, believe me, Hester, though he were to step down from a high place, and stand there beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame, yet better…” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 26) — Dimmesdale's double-edged plea. This develops hypocrisy and truth: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects.

246. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Analyze the word choice in “Art thou like the Black Man that haunts the forest round about us” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 33). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: Hester's fear of him. The evidence is “Art thou like the Black Man that haunts the forest round about us” (IV: The Interview, paragraph 33). This develops sin and guilt: Chillingworth admits he wronged Hester by marrying her young; his revenge begins. The words “haunts” and “forest” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

247. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? “the scarlet letter was represented in exaggerated and gigantic proportions, so as to be greatly the most prominent feature of her appearance”

   A. XV: Hester and Pearl

   B. X: The Leech and His Patient

   C. VII: The Governor’s Hall

   D. XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner

   Key: C (VII: The Governor’s Hall)

248. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “VII: The Governor’s Hall”? Governor Bellingham's mansion, its glittering stucco and the convex breastplate that magnifies the letter.

   A. Point of view

   B. Allusion

   C. Hyperbole

   D. Setting

   Key: D (Setting)

249. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Claim: Chillingworth tortures Dimmesdale by making him argue about his own secret. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10).

   Sample answer: He describes weeds springing "out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime" and insists "These men deceive themselves," and when he finally sees the minister's breast his joy differs from Satan's only by "the trait of wonder in it!". The evidence is “these black weeds have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime” (X: The Leech and His Patient, paragraph 10) — Chillingworth's probing image. This develops hypocrisy and truth: Dimmesdale defends men who keep silent for the sake of their good works; Chillingworth calls it self-deception.

250. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “X: The Leech and His Patient”? Black weeds that ‘have sprung up out of a buried heart, to make manifest an unspoken crime.’

   A. Personification

   B. Allusion

   C. Symbolism

   D. Plot

   Key: C (Symbolism)

251. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Analyze the word choice in “The only truth that continued to give Mr. Dimmesdale a real existence on this earth, was the anguish in his inmost soul” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

   Sample answer: Anguish as his only truth. The evidence is “The only truth that continued to give Mr. Dimmesdale a real existence on this earth, was the anguish in his inmost soul” (XI: The Interior of a Heart, paragraph 9). This develops hypocrisy and truth: his "confessions" in vague terms are a deeper lie. The words “continued” and “existence” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

252. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? “They said that it meant Able; so strong was Hester Prynne, with a woman’s strength”

A. XXI: The New England Holiday

B. XIII: Another View of Hester

C. XIV: Hester and the Physician

D. III: The Recognition

Key: B (XIII: Another View of Hester)

253. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “XIV: Hester and the Physician”? Chillingworth has transformed himself into a devil by undertaking a devil's office.

A. Tone / mood

B. Setting

C. Characterization

D. Alliteration

Key: C (Characterization)

254. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “XVII: The Pastor and His Parishioner”? Hester tells Dimmesdale that Chillingworth is her husband; he is horrified, then forgives her.

A. Plot

B. Foreshadowing

C. Conflict

D. Irony

Key: C (Conflict)

255. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Analyze the word choice in “Here had been her sin; here, her sorrow; and here was yet to be her penitence” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 11). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: Why Hester returns. The evidence is “Here had been her sin; here, her sorrow; and here was yet to be her penitence” (XXIV: Conclusion, paragraph 11). This develops women and independence: Hester counsels women and hopes for a time when relations between men and women will be on "surer ground.". The words “penitence” and “sorrow” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

256. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “XXIV: Conclusion”? The conclusion offers several accounts of what was seen and withholds certainty.

A. Simile

B. Tone / mood

C. Structure

D. Imagery

Key: C (Structure)

257. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “A writer of storybooks! What kind of a business in life … may that be” (The Customhouse, paragraph 9) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: His imagined ancestors' contempt for him. The evidence is “A writer of storybooks! What kind of a

business in life … may that be” (The Customhouse, paragraph 9). This develops public shame and private identity: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks.". The words “storybooks” and “business” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The narrator presents a real document and a real rag yet says the letter gave "a sensation not altogether physical," and defines his art as "a neutral territory" where "the Actual and the Imaginary may meet.".

258. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “It is a little remarkable, that—though disinclined to talk overmuch of myself and my affairs at the fireside” (The Customhouse, paragraph 1) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: The opening, with its ironic self-presentation. The evidence is “It is a little remarkable, that—though disinclined to talk overmuch of myself and my affairs at the fireside” (The Customhouse, paragraph 1). This develops public shame and private identity: Hawthorne feels his Puritan ancestors would scorn him as "a writer of storybooks.". The words “disinclined” and “remarkable” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The narrator presents a real document and a real rag yet says the letter gave "a sensation not altogether physical," and defines his art as "a neutral territory" where "the Actual and the Imaginary may meet.".

259. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Speak, woman … Speak; and give your child a father” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 31) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: Mr. Wilson presses Hester. The evidence is “Speak, woman … Speak; and give your child a father” (III: The Recognition, paragraph 31). This develops hypocrisy and truth: the man who begs her to speak is the man she protects. The words “father” and “child” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. He says it is better to stand "beside thee, on thy pedestal of shame" than "to hide a guilty heart through life," and Hester answers "I will not speak!".

260. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 7) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: Dimmesdale's telltale gesture. The evidence is “it had now become a constant habit, rather than a casual gesture, to press his hand over his heart” (IX: The Leech, paragraph 7). This develops sin and guilt: the physician's search turns into a hunt for the minister's secret. The words “constant” and “gesture” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Dimmesdale's habit "to press his hand over his heart" draws the physician close, and the town comes to believe he is haunted by "Satan's emissary, in the guise of old Roger Chillingworth.".

261. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 29) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: Pearl's question. The evidence is “Mother … what does the scarlet letter mean” (XV: Hester and Pearl, paragraph 29). This develops hypocrisy and truth: Hester's first lie to Pearl. The words “scarlet” and “letter” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. She asks "what does the scarlet letter mean?" and "why does the minister keep his hand over his heart?", and Hester, who has never lied, evades her.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30, 31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40, 41, 42, 43, 44, 45, 46, 47, 48, 49, 50	recall 29, inference 12, analysis 6, synthesis 3

HS Freshman	1, 51, 2, 52, 53, 54, 10, 55, 56, 57, 19, 58, 59, 60, 61, 20, 62, 63, 25, 64, 22, 28, 65, 66, 67, 27, 68, 30, 32, 31, 69, 70, 35, 71, 72, 73, 39, 74, 75, 43, 76, 77, 78, 45, 79, 80, 46, 81, 82, 83	recall 26, inference 12, analysis 9, synthesis 3
HS Sophomore	1, 84, 85, 86, 55, 52, 54, 20, 61, 87, 57, 63, 88, 89, 90, 65, 91, 92, 67, 32, 93, 94, 69, 95, 96, 35, 97, 98, 99, 100, 101, 102, 39, 103, 104, 105, 42, 76, 106, 107, 44, 108, 79, 109, 110, 111, 112, 113, 83, 50	recall 19, inference 16, analysis 9, synthesis 6
HS Junior	84, 114, 1, 10, 55, 8, 115, 87, 57, 62, 20, 91, 67, 116, 28, 117, 31, 32, 118, 94, 119, 120, 35, 121, 122, 100, 73, 123, 124, 125, 40, 104, 105, 42, 75, 76, 126, 127, 77, 107, 128, 108, 109, 47, 110, 111, 113, 82, 50, 83	recall 16, inference 16, analysis 12, synthesis 6
HS Senior	85, 1, 54, 10, 52, 60, 87, 58, 63, 117, 90, 92, 116, 93, 129, 94, 130, 96, 131, 36, 71, 35, 122, 73, 132, 133, 134, 39, 103, 135, 42, 43, 76, 136, 137, 106, 78, 108, 80, 46, 138, 48, 110, 111, 112, 139, 82, 140, 141, 83	recall 13, inference 16, analysis 12, synthesis 9
AP	142, 143, 10, 55, 88, 58, 116, 28, 66, 144, 145, 32, 146, 70, 147, 148, 149, 132, 134, 150, 151, 152, 153, 154, 155, 156, 157, 158, 137, 136, 44, 45, 79, 128, 109, 159, 138, 160, 48, 161, 162, 81, 163, 139, 82, 113, 164, 165, 166, 167	recall 9, inference 12, analysis 16, synthesis 13
College Freshman	168, 169, 86, 170, 115, 57, 116, 65, 28, 68, 171, 172, 146, 173, 174, 175, 176, 177, 150, 178, 41, 42, 135, 153, 155, 156, 179, 77, 136, 180, 181, 44, 182, 183, 80, 128, 46, 161, 184, 185, 110, 81, 186, 139, 187, 188, 189, 167, 190, 50	recall 9, inference 12, analysis 16, synthesis 13
College Sophomore	169, 191, 86, 57, 192, 65, 171, 94, 96, 146, 193, 173, 175, 73, 194, 195, 134, 151, 105, 42, 153, 155, 156, 154, 158, 137, 106, 78, 45, 182, 183, 108, 109, 196, 48, 197, 198, 110, 162, 199, 200, 112, 201, 202, 188, 203, 204, 205, 206, 207	recall 6, inference 12, analysis 16, synthesis 16
College Junior	143, 169, 10, 18, 26, 65, 171, 144, 96, 193, 176, 175, 134, 150, 208, 209, 210, 179, 76, 75, 43, 158, 77, 106, 44, 78, 211, 182, 79, 159, 47, 160, 212, 213, 185, 214, 198, 215, 216, 217, 218, 163, 219, 220, 203, 221, 222, 165, 141, 223	recall 6, inference 9, analysis 16, synthesis 19
College Senior	84, 169, 26, 96, 146, 224, 173, 175, 149, 102, 151, 150, 42, 225, 226, 153, 155, 210, 75, 180, 137, 227, 228, 229, 45, 211, 182, 230, 79, 46, 47, 231, 160, 232, 233, 198, 234, 215, 235, 186, 236, 237, 113, 238, 239, 240, 206, 205, 141, 190	recall 3, inference 9, analysis 19, synthesis 19
Graduate / PhD	88, 89, 30, 73, 149, 241, 208, 242, 153, 243, 244, 245, 156, 246, 247, 248, 249, 158, 250, 127, 251, 77, 252, 181, 253, 45, 230, 182, 254, 79, 128, 47, 138, 255, 256, 231, 48, 257, 258, 259, 198, 214, 81, 235, 260, 236, 187, 202, 261, 207	recall 2, inference 5, analysis 28, synthesis 15

Final paper

The Scarlet Letter: final paper (formal literary analysis). Choose one prompt.

1. Analyze how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops sin and guilt across The Scarlet Letter. Trace the idea through at least three moments (beginning, middle and end) and argue what the ending finally suggests.
2. Choose one recurring symbol, image or motif in The Scarlet Letter and argue how its meaning changes over the novel and why that change matters to public shame and private identity.
3. Analyze a central character's choices in The Scarlet Letter. Argue whether the novel judges that character, and how its structure or point of view shapes your answer.
4. Two readers disagree about whether The Scarlet Letter finally endorses or criticizes its society's view of hypocrisy and truth. Weigh both readings and argue for one, answering the strongest objection.

Length: Scaffolded support 500-700 words; HS Freshman 700-900 words; HS Sophomore 900-1,100 words; HS Junior 1,000-1,300 words; HS Senior 1,200-1,500 words; AP 1,300-1,600 words; College Freshman 1,500-2,000 words; College Sophomore 2,000-2,500 words; College Junior 2,500-3,000 words; College Senior 3,000-4,000 words; Graduate / PhD 4,000-6,000 words

Evidence requirement: at least 6 quotations from at least three sections, from the beginning, middle and end. Quote the reading text exactly and cite the chapter and paragraph (MLA style). HS Senior and above: one scholarly or historical source; College Sophomore and above: two, cited in MLA.

Criterion	Points	Descriptor	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Thesis	20	A specific, arguable claim that answers the prompt and organizes the paper.	Specific, arguable and precise; it organizes every section.	Clear and arguable, but broad in places.	States a topic or a summary more than an argument.	Missing, or restates the prompt.
Evidence	25	Well-chosen, accurately quoted and cited passages from across the work, meeting the evidence requirement.	Accurate, well-chosen quotations from across the work, all cited; meets the requirement.	Accurate and cited, but clustered in one part of the work.	Too few quotations, or some inaccurate or uncited.	Little or no quoted evidence.
Analysis	30	Explains how language, structure and literary elements create meaning; goes beyond summary.	Explains how specific words, structure and devices create meaning; weighs a competing reading.	Explains the evidence, with some close reading.	Mostly summary; the link to the claim is asserted, not shown.	Summary only.
Organization	15					

		Logical progression, clear topic sentences and transitions; introduction and conclusion frame the argument.	Each paragraph advances the argument; transitions show logic.	Logical order with minor jumps.	Order is loose; paragraphs repeat or drift.	No discernible structure.
Style and conventions	10	Formal academic voice, present tense for literature, correct grammar and MLA format.	Formal, precise, present tense; MLA format; virtually error-free.	Formal with a few errors that do not obscure meaning.	Informal or error-prone in ways that distract.	Errors obscure meaning.

Exemplar paragraph: The preface shows Hawthorne treating his community's judgment with ironic defiance. The text makes this visible when it says “It could hardly have been more violent, indeed, had he burned down the Customhouse” (Preface to the Second Edition, paragraph 1). He says the reaction "could hardly have been more violent" if he had burned down the Customhouse, then announces he will republish "without the change of a word.". A full paper would carry this reading through the beginning, middle and end, and answer the strongest competing reading.

Critical voice: “_The Scarlet Letter_ has the beauty and harmony of all original and complete conceptions, and its weaker spots, whatever they are, are not of its essence; they are mere light flaws and inequalities of surface.” (Henry James, novelist and critic, *Hawthorne (English Men of Letters, 1879), Chapter V, Ch. V*; public domain). Closure: name one "light flaw" you found and argue it is not "of its essence." *Objective:* Closing lesson: evaluate the novel's lasting value. *Standards:* Common Core RL.11-12.9, W.11-12.1

Essay assignments

Essay: Sin and guilt

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Scarlet Letter teaches about sin and guilt. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops sin and guilt in The Scarlet Letter. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops sin and guilt across The Scarlet Letter. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Scarlet Letter (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of sin and guilt. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of sin and guilt in The Scarlet Letter. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Nathaniel Hawthorne's choices in The Scarlet Letter (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of sin and guilt, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Scarlet Letter's treatment of sin and guilt in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on sin and guilt in The Scarlet Letter that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on sin and guilt in The Scarlet Letter. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about sin and guilt in The Scarlet Letter, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on sin and guilt in The Scarlet Letter, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Public shame and private identity

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Scarlet Letter teaches about public shame and private identity. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops public shame and private identity in The Scarlet Letter. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops public shame and private identity across The Scarlet Letter. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Scarlet Letter (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of public shame and private identity. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of public shame and private identity in The Scarlet Letter. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Nathaniel Hawthorne's choices in The Scarlet Letter (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of public shame and private identity, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Scarlet Letter's treatment of public shame and private identity in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on public shame and private identity in The Scarlet Letter that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on public shame and private identity in The Scarlet Letter. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about public shame and private identity in The Scarlet Letter, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on public shame and private identity in The Scarlet Letter, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Hypocrisy and truth

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Scarlet Letter teaches about hypocrisy and truth. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops hypocrisy and truth in The Scarlet Letter. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops hypocrisy and truth across The Scarlet Letter. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Scarlet Letter (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of hypocrisy and truth. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of hypocrisy and truth in The Scarlet Letter. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Nathaniel Hawthorne's choices in The Scarlet Letter (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of hypocrisy and truth, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Scarlet Letter's treatment of hypocrisy and truth in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on hypocrisy and truth in The Scarlet Letter that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on hypocrisy and truth in The Scarlet Letter. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about hypocrisy and truth in The Scarlet Letter, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on hypocrisy and truth in The Scarlet Letter, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Nature and the individual against society

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Scarlet Letter teaches about nature and the individual against society. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops nature and the individual against society in The Scarlet Letter. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops nature and the individual against society across The Scarlet Letter. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Scarlet Letter (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of nature and the individual against society. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of nature and the individual against society in The Scarlet Letter. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Nathaniel Hawthorne's choices in The Scarlet Letter (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of nature and the individual against society, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Scarlet Letter's treatment of nature and the individual against society in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on nature and the individual against society in The Scarlet Letter that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

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Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on nature and the individual against society in The Scarlet Letter, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Women and independence

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Scarlet Letter teaches about women and independence. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops women and independence in The Scarlet Letter. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Nathaniel Hawthorne develops women and independence across The Scarlet Letter. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Scarlet Letter (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of women and independence. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of women and independence in The Scarlet Letter. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Nathaniel Hawthorne's choices in The Scarlet Letter (a recurring element, structure and narration)

shape a complex understanding of women and independence, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Scarlet Letter's treatment of women and independence in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on women and independence in The Scarlet Letter that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on women and independence in The Scarlet Letter. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

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Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

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